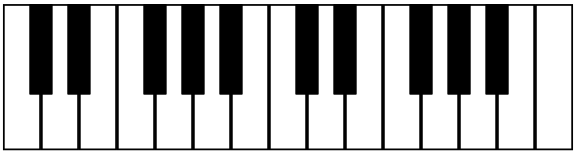
Read at Sight

A graded sight-reading course for piano

Volume 4 - Patterns and Keys



Middle C

Chords in both hands, high and low notes, syncopation and sixteenths, keys with three sharps or flats, and music that changes key.

Exercises generated to graded rules; pieces are original or public domain.

How to use this book

What is new in Volume 4

Both hands now play chords, and the accompaniment falls into patterns you learn to read at a glance: held chords, oom-pah and waltz basses, chorales and after-beat chords. You will read ledger lines far above and below the staves, syncopated rhythms and sixteenth notes, the keys of A major, E-flat major, F-sharp minor and C minor, and music that moves into a new key. 2/4 time joins 3/4, 4/4 and 6/8. Start this book when you can read Volume 3 music: broken-chord and Alberti basses, 6/8, keys with two sharps or flats, and two independent voices.

The five rules

1. Never stop: keep the beat going, even after a wrong note. 2. Count out loud and use a metronome at the speed shown. 3. Keep your eyes on the music, not your hands. 4. Read the shape: up, down, or the same, and by how much. 5. Play each exercise once, tick its box, and move on. Come back only after a few weeks.

Before every exercise: 10 seconds

Check the clef and time signature. Find the first note and its finger number. Scan for the highest and lowest note, and for any bar that repeats an earlier one. Then count one bar in and play.

How each unit is laid out

A unit opens with what is new, keyboard pictures of the hand positions or chord shapes, and reading tips. Then come Parts A to D, which grow slightly harder. Pieces come next, and the unit ends with a checkpoint that tells you when to move on.

A daily routine (15-20 minutes)

Warm up by playing the five notes of the hand position up and down, saying their names (2 minutes). Read 6-10 new exercises, one pass each (10 minutes). Play one piece, aiming for steady and musical (5 minutes).

Contents

Each unit adds exactly one new idea to everything before it.

Unit 1 Block Chords 4
The left hand plays I, IV and V7 as three-note chords: held, oom-pah and waltz

Unit 2 Chords in Both Hands 21
Right-hand three-note chords; 2/4 time

Unit 3 High Notes 36
Ledger lines above the treble staff, up to D6; the hand moves up an octave

Unit 4 Low Notes and the Middle 51
Ledger lines below the bass staff, down to C2; both hands near middle C

Unit 5 Syncopation 65
Notes that start between the beats: ties over the beat and the bar line, accents

Unit 6 Sixteenth Notes 79
Four sixteenths, an eighth and two sixteenths, the dotted eighth and sixteenth

Unit 7 Three Sharps and Three Flats 92
A major, E-flat major, F-sharp minor and C minor

Unit 8 Changing Key 112
A new key mid-piece, shown by a new key signature or by accidentals; review

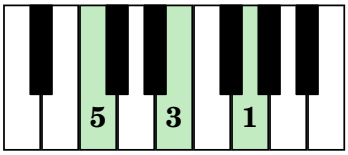
Unit 1

Block Chords

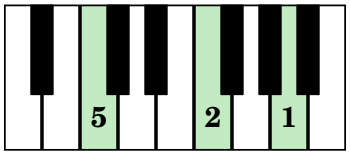
New: The left hand plays I, IV and V7 as three-note chords: held, oom-pah and waltz

In Volume 3 the left hand played its chords one note at a time. Now it plays them as block chords, all three notes together. A block chord is read as one shape, not three notes: you already know the shapes, so the left hand becomes a quick glance while your eyes stay on the tune.

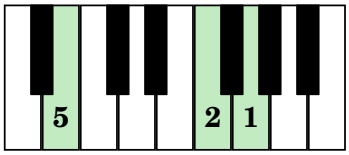
C major: left-hand chord shapes



I = C

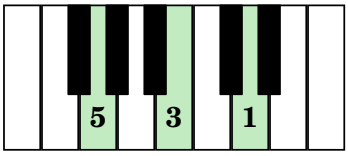


IV = F

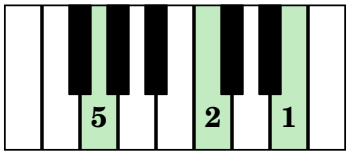


V7 = G7

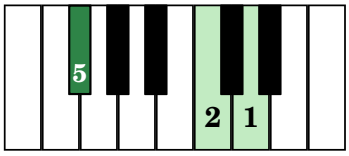
G major: left-hand chord shapes



I = G

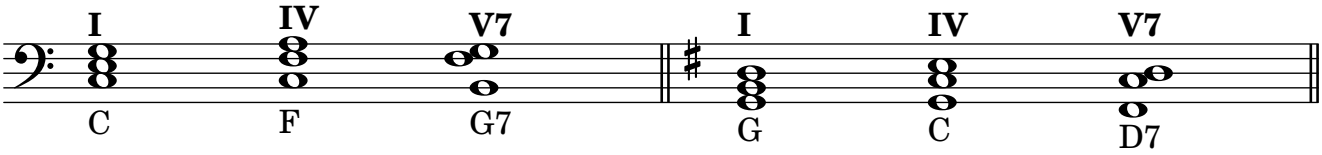


IV = C



V7 = D7

The same shapes on the staff



What is new

Block chords

Three notes stacked on the staff and played together: I is C-E-G (fingers 5 3 1), IV is C-F-A and V7 is B-F-G (both 5 2 1). Drop the hand onto all three keys at once.

Oom-pah

In 4/4 the left hand plays the bottom note of the shape on beats 1 and 3 (the 'oom') and the upper two notes together on beats 2 and 4 (the 'pah').

Waltz bass

In 3/4: the bottom note on beat 1, then the upper two notes on beats 2 and 3. Oom-pah-pah.

Finger numbers in chords

When a new shape starts, its finger numbers are printed next to the notes: 5 on the bottom note, 1 on the top.

Reading tips

1. Before you play, find each new chord shape in the left hand and name it: I, IV or V7.

2. Keep the 'pah' chords light and short. The 'oom' notes carry the bass line.

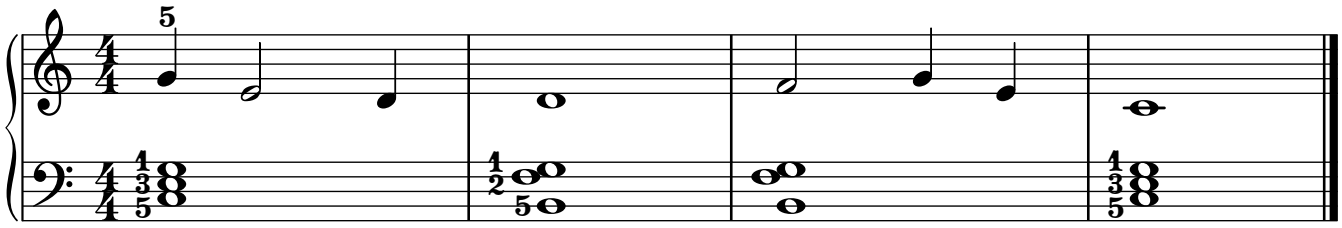
3. The first note of each bar in the right hand belongs to the left hand's chord: check that they fit.

Part A: Held chords under a tune

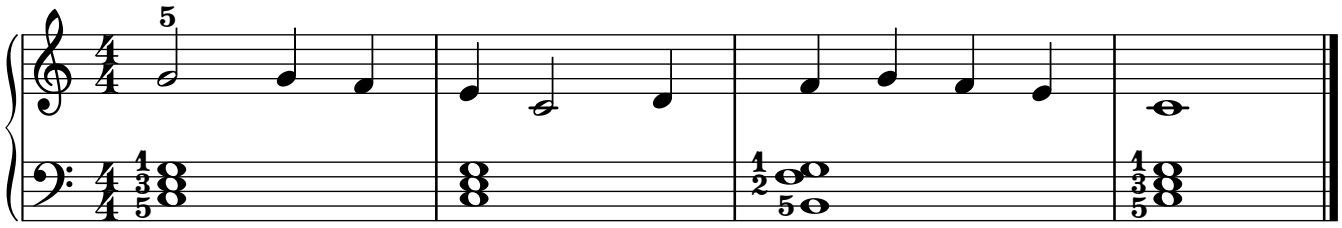
♩ = 60

C major. The left hand holds one chord for each bar.
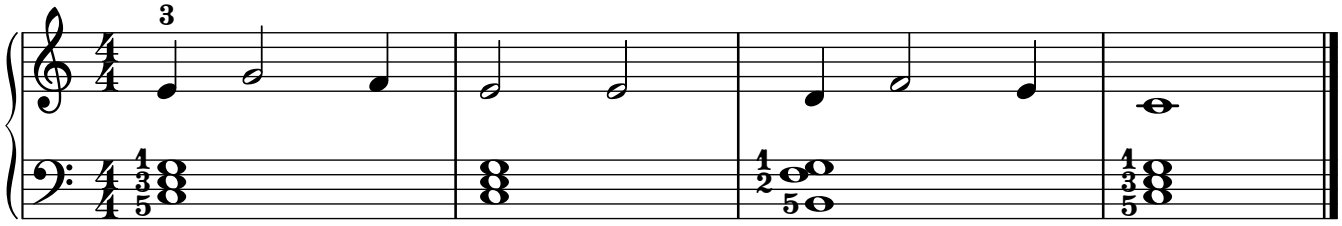
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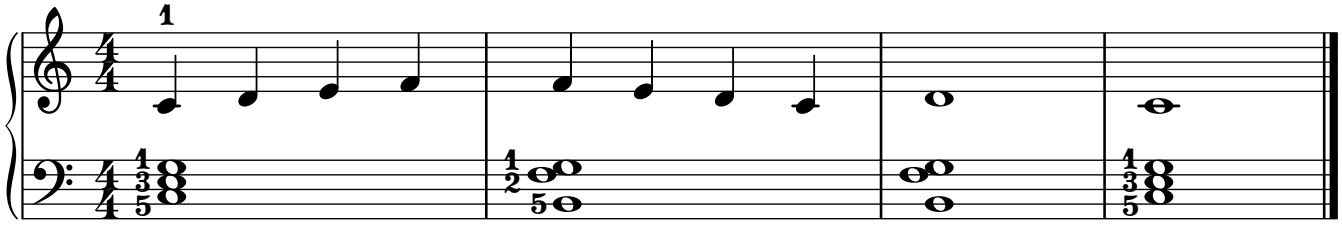
☐ **1.2**



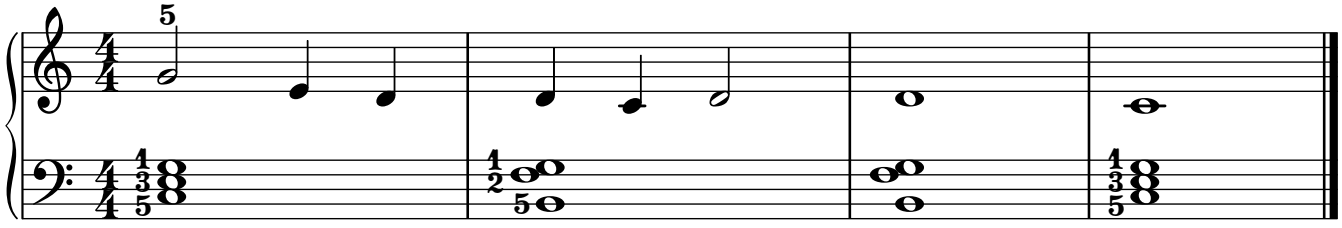
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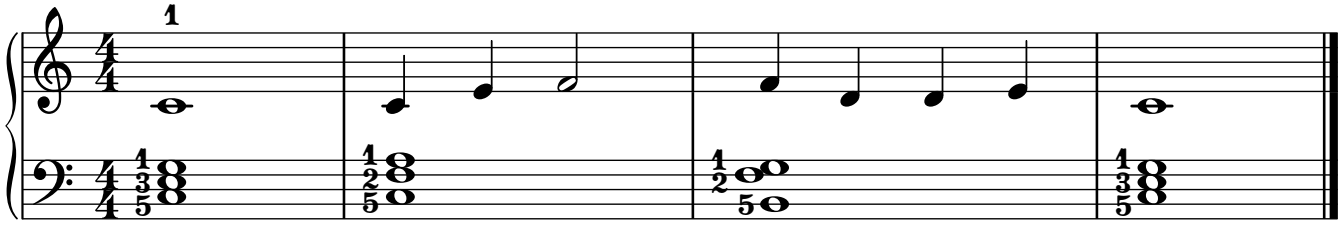


☐ **1.4**



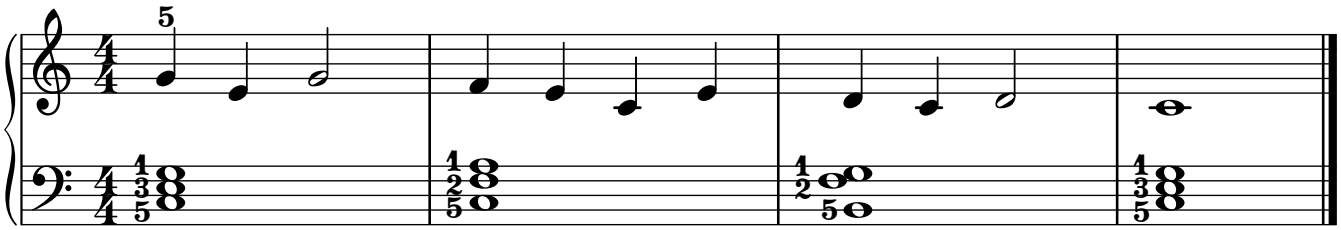
☐ **1.5**
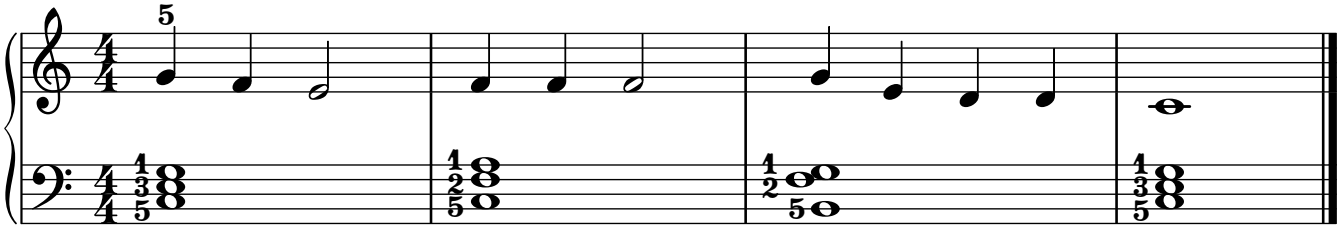


☐ **1.6**



☐ **1.7**
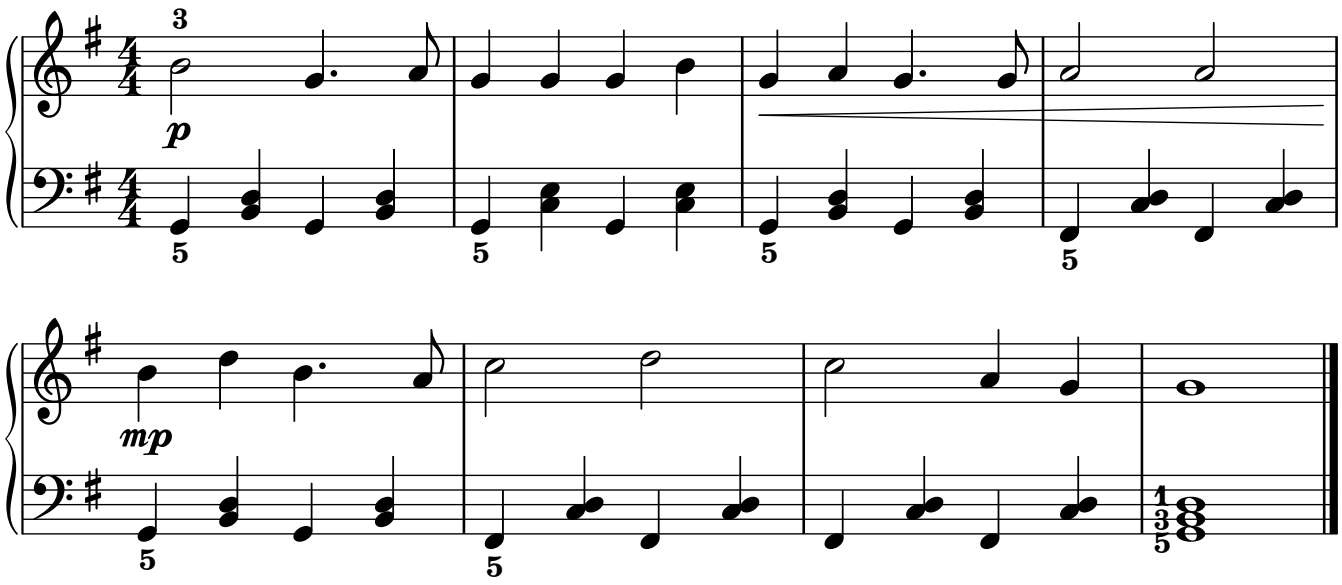


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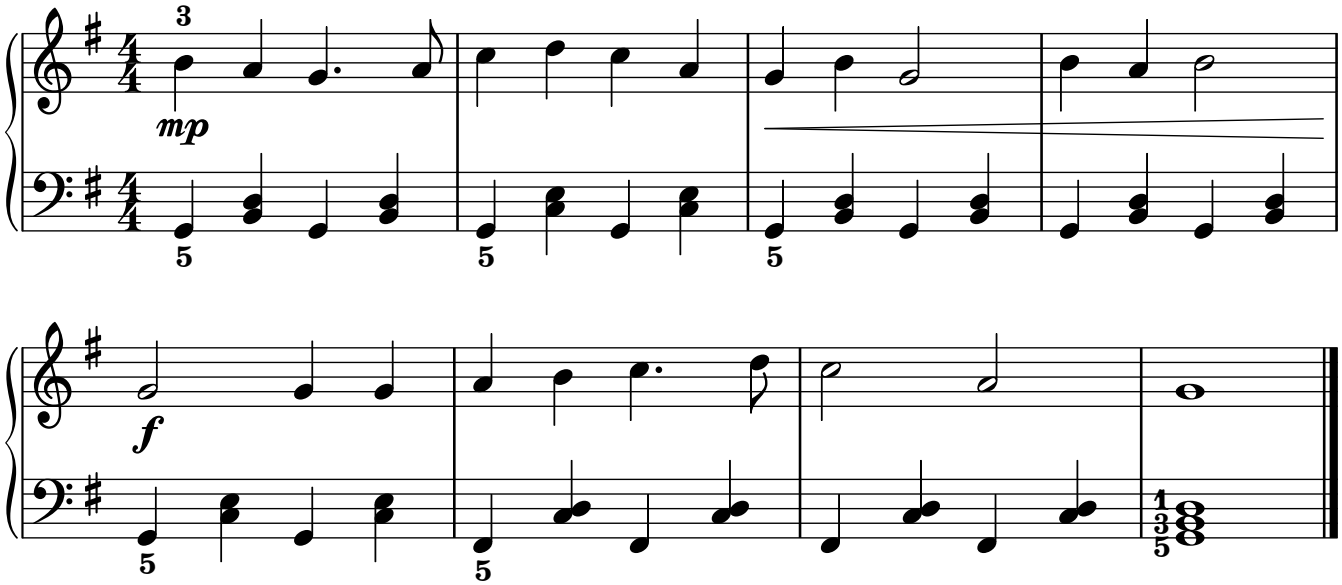


Part B: Oom-pah in G major ♩ = 72

G major with an oom-pah bass: bottom note, then the upper two notes together.
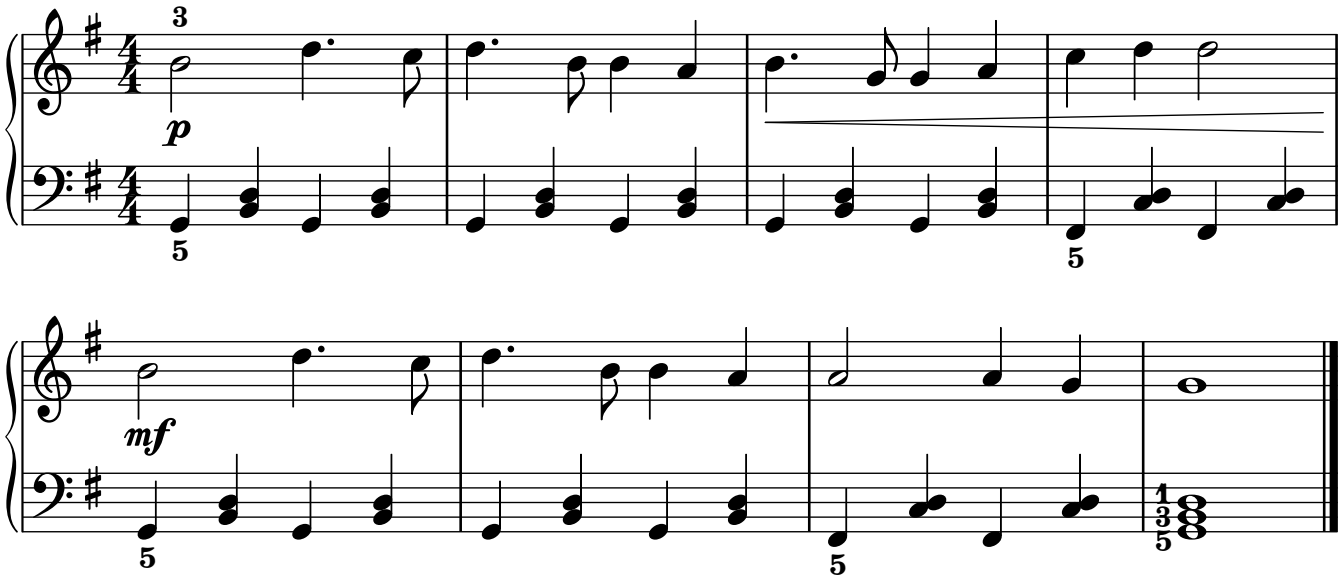
☐ **1.9**



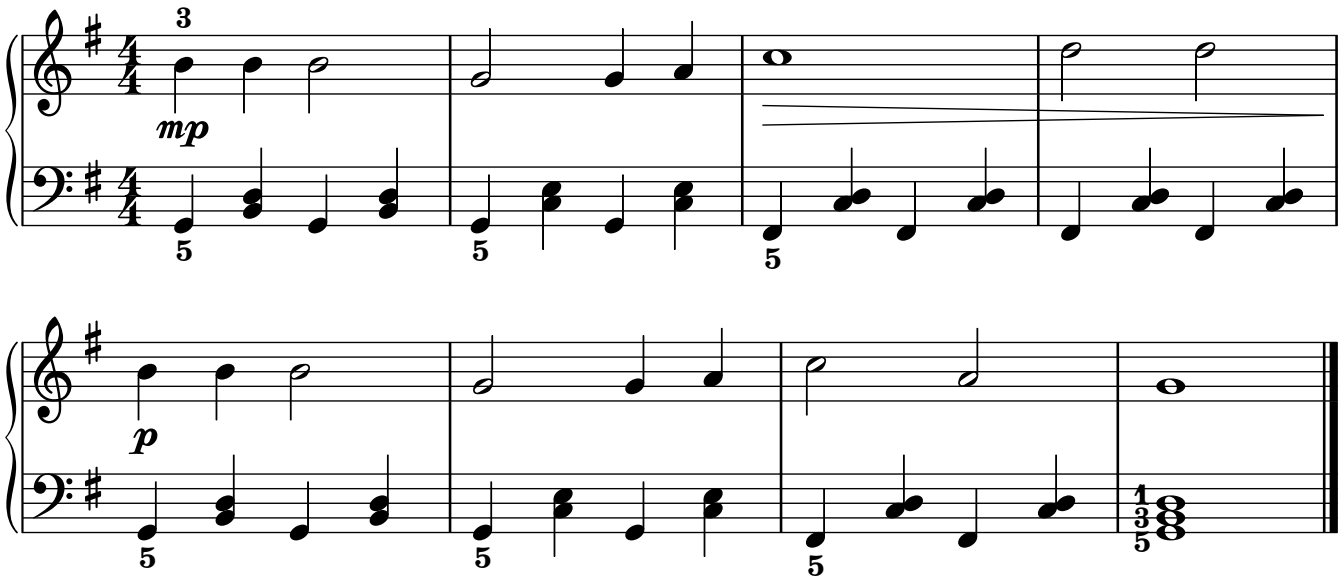
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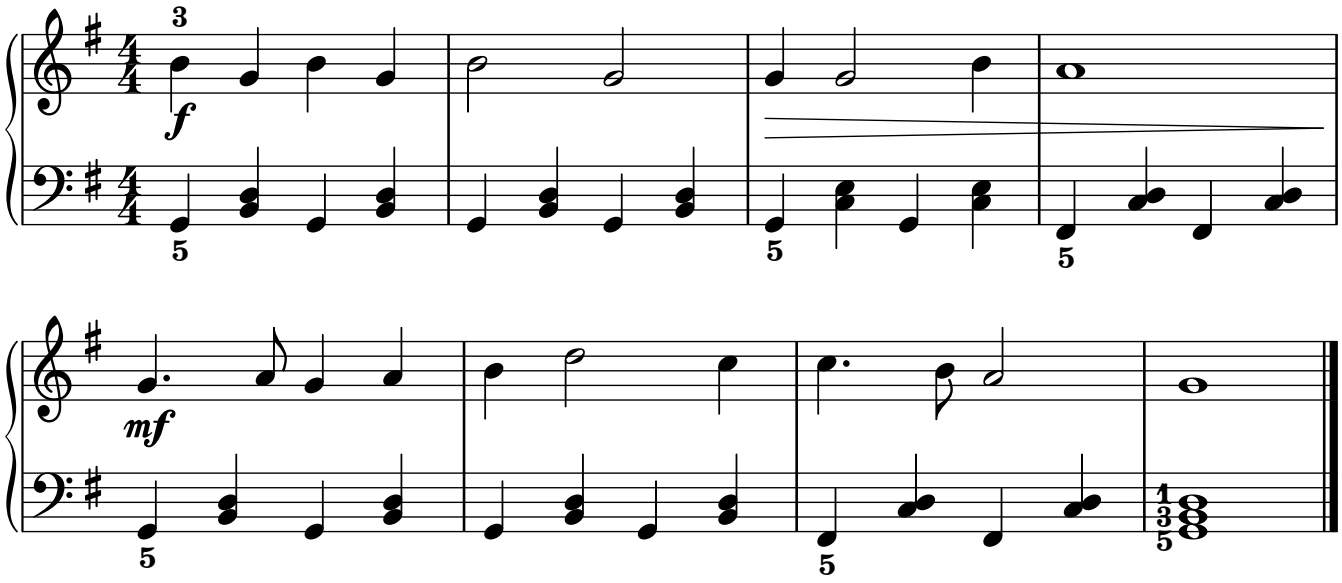


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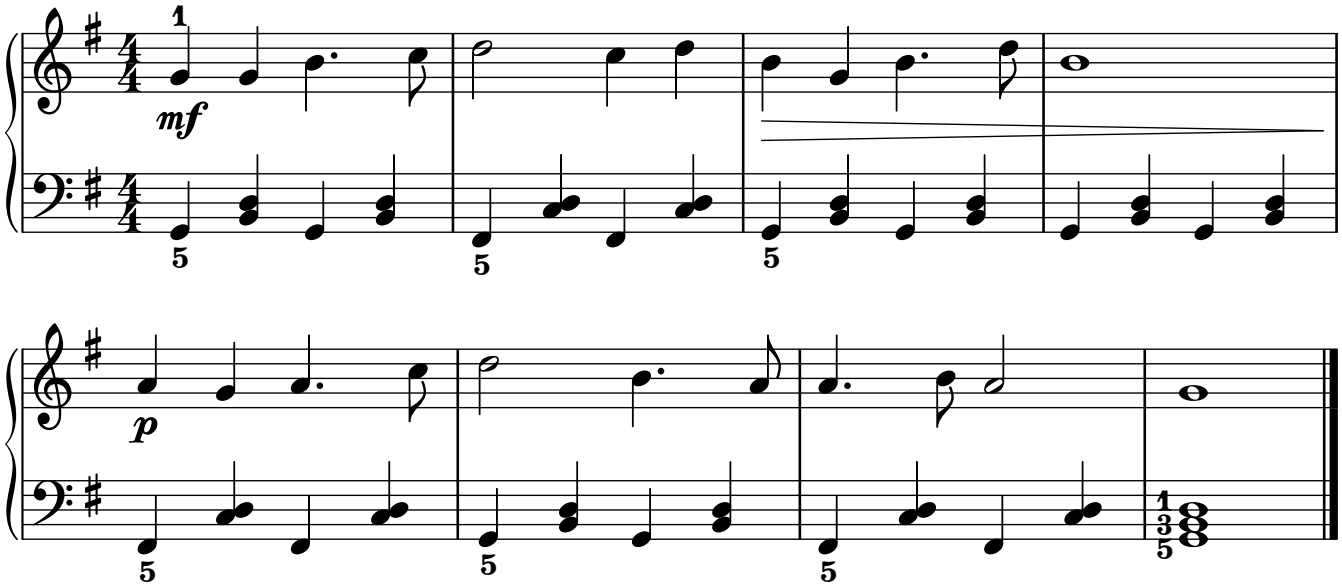
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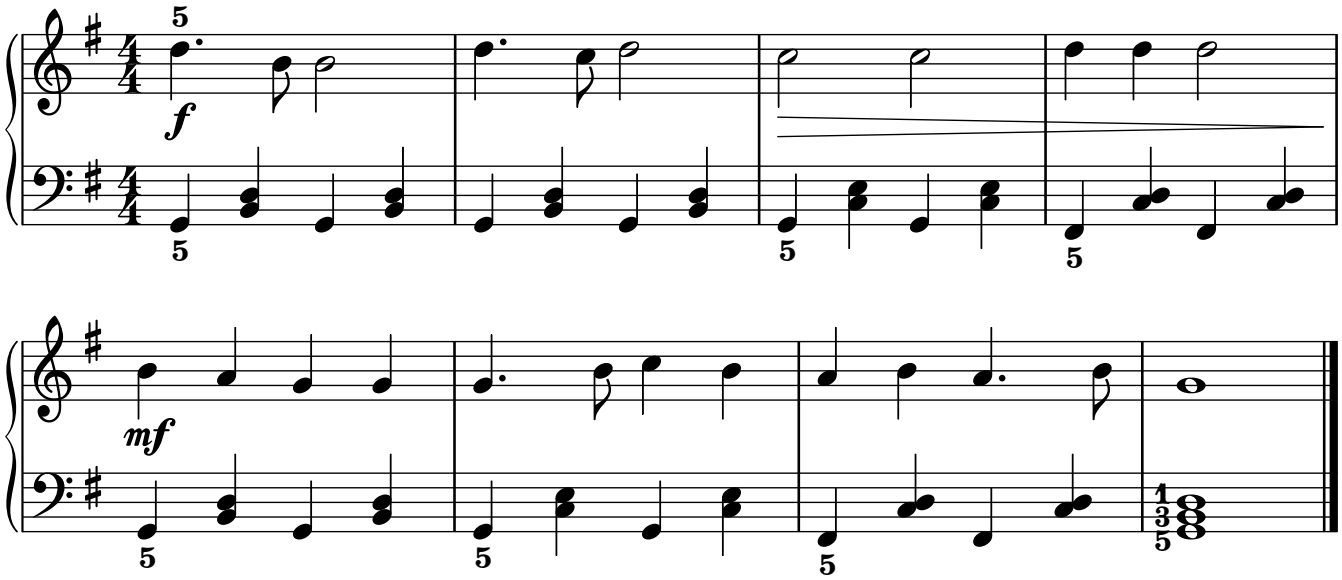
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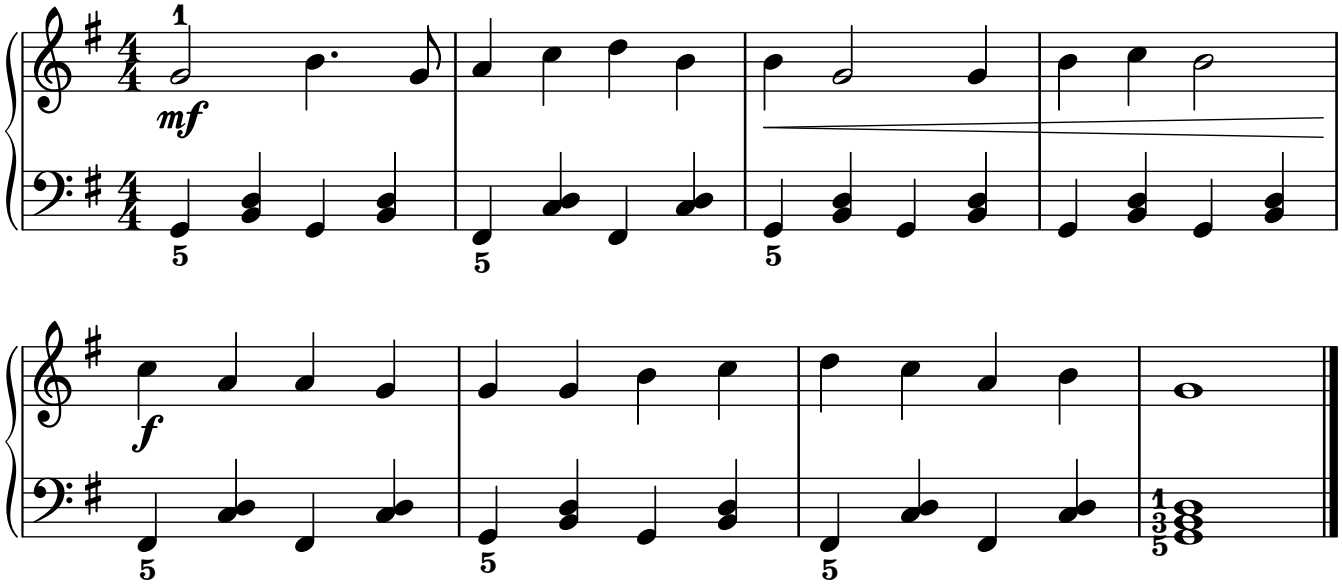
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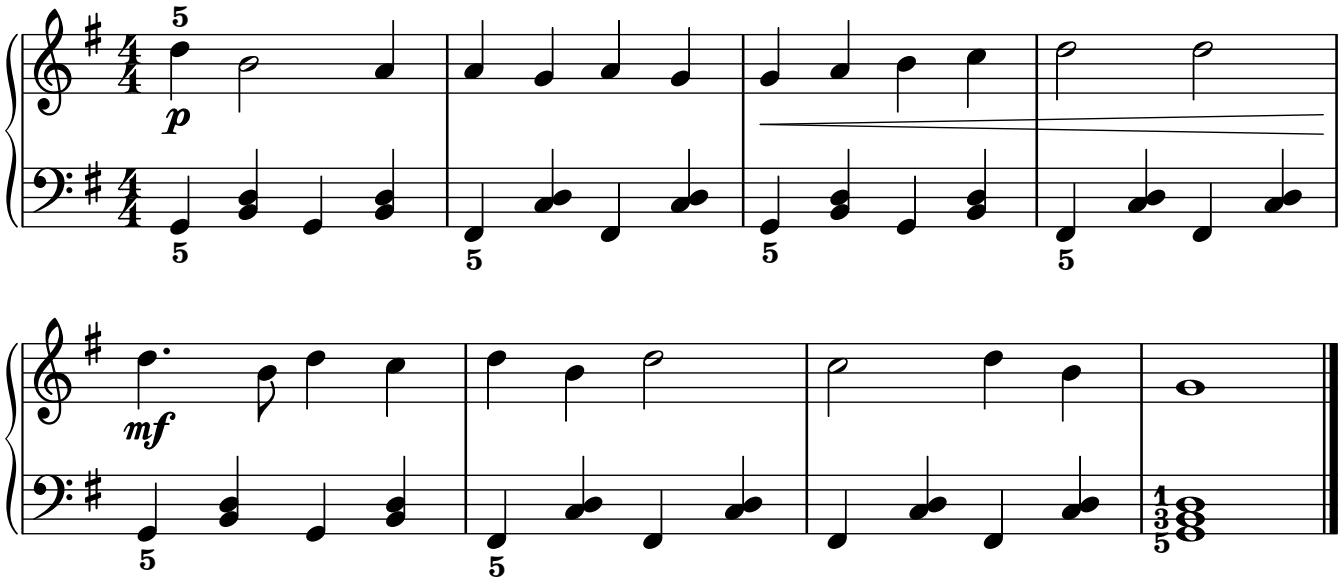
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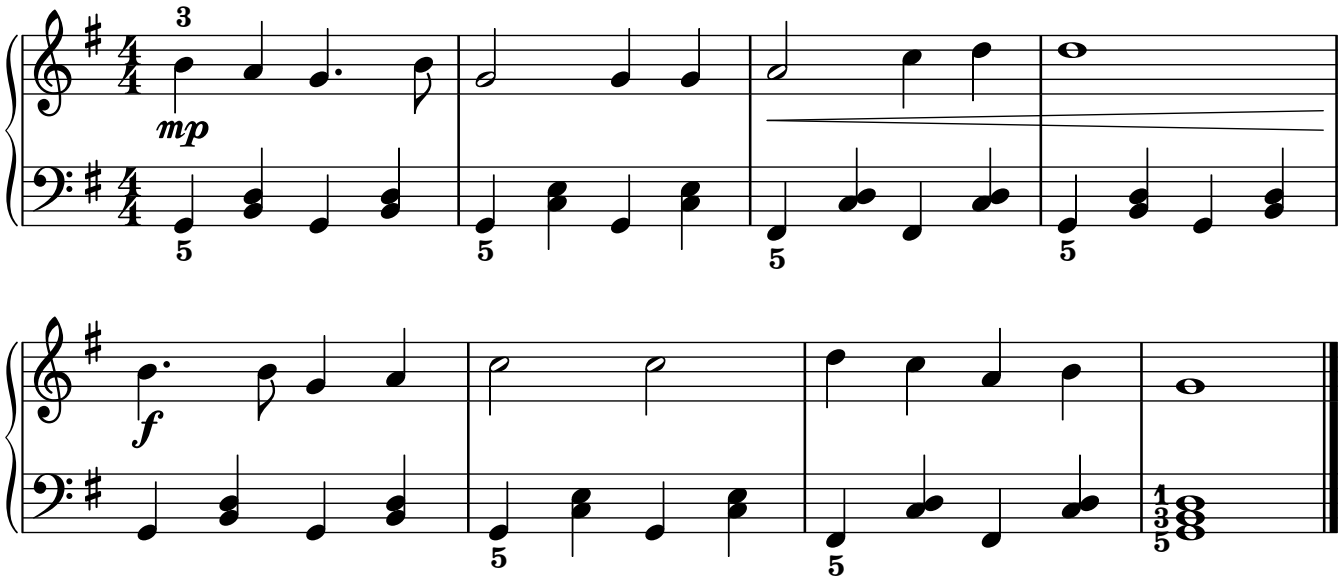
1.16



1.17



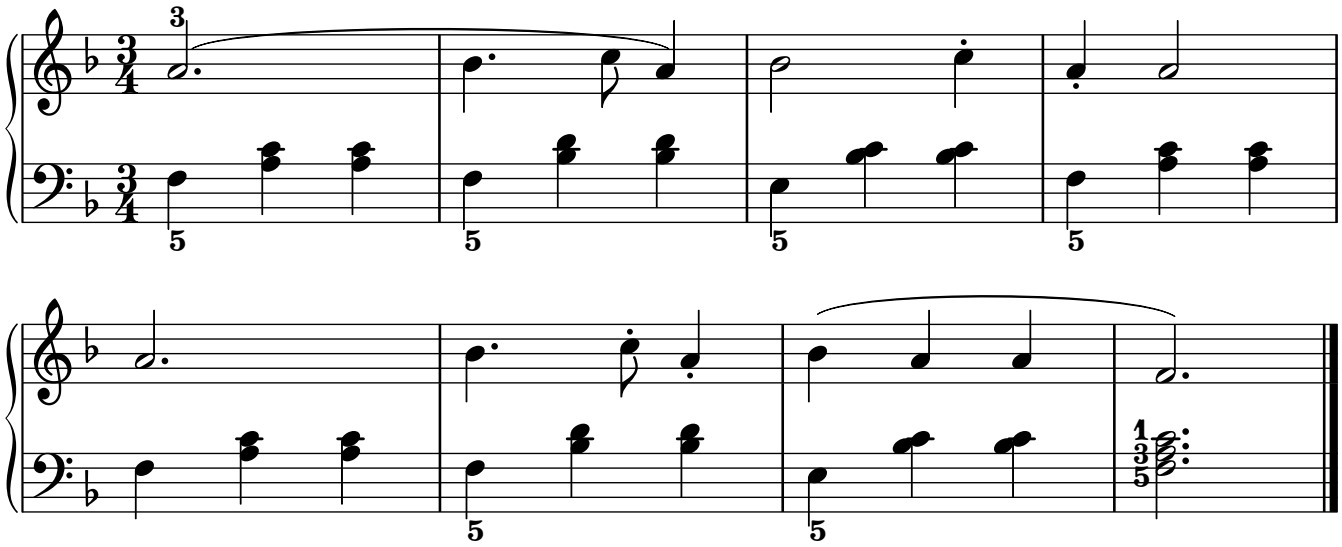
1.18



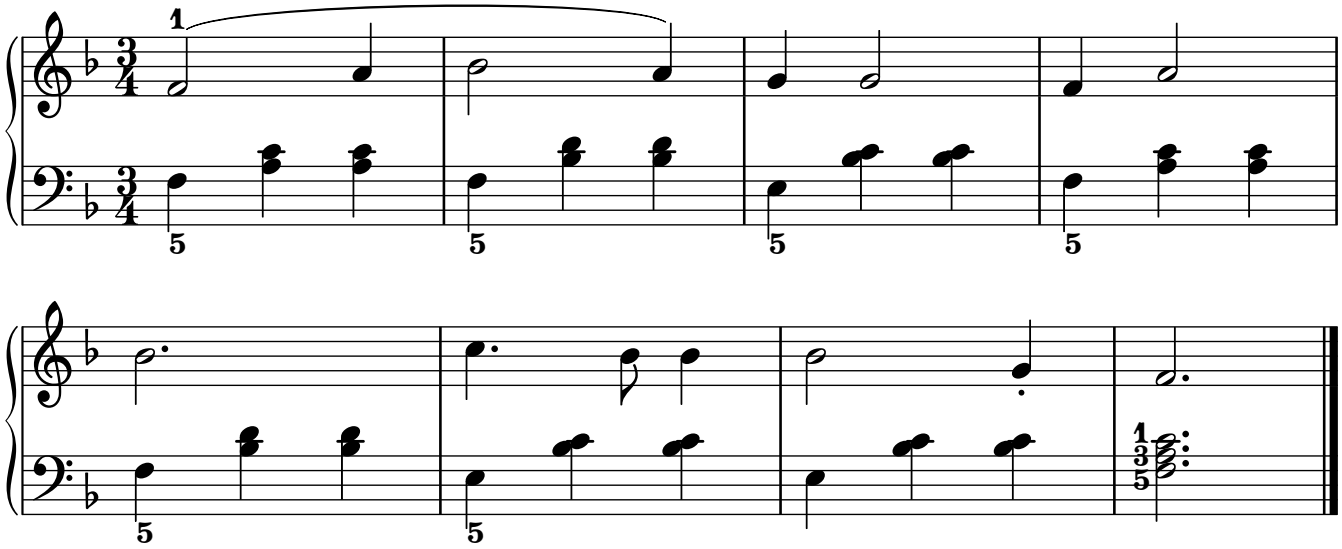
Part C: Waltz bass in F major ♩ = 84

F major waltzes: oom-pah-pah.

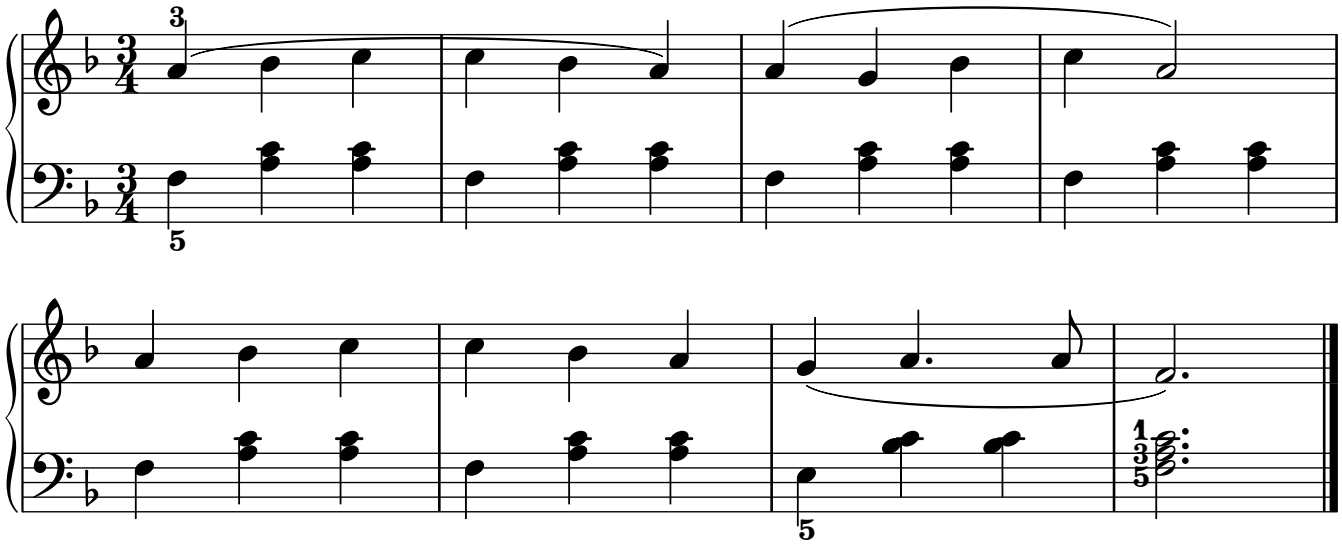
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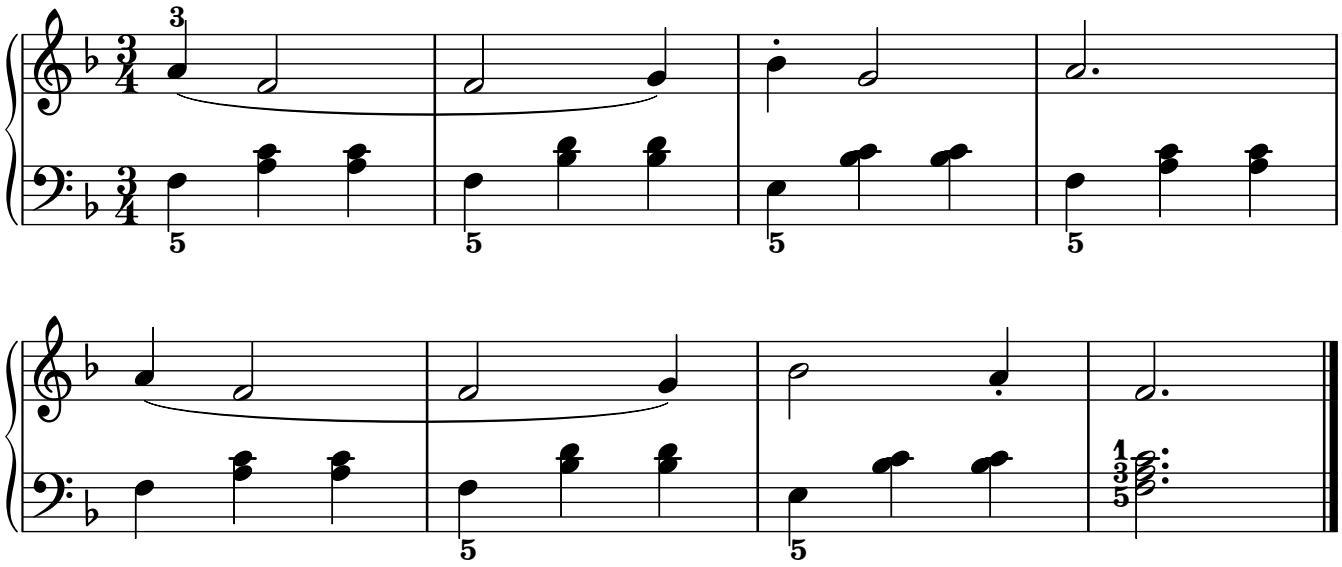
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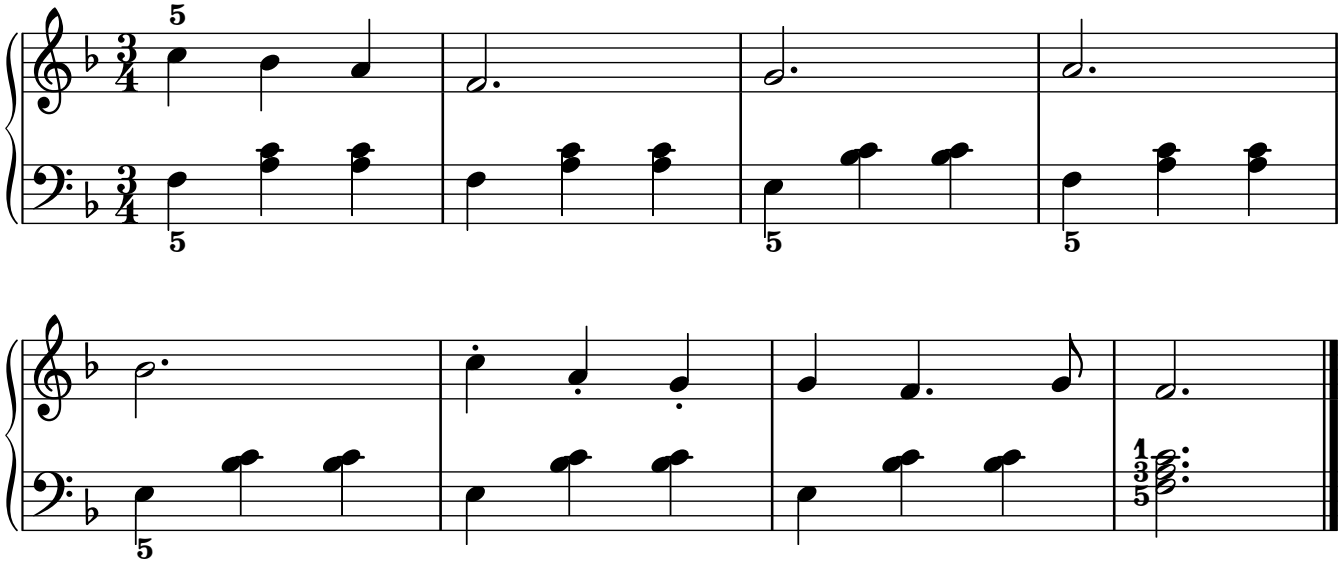
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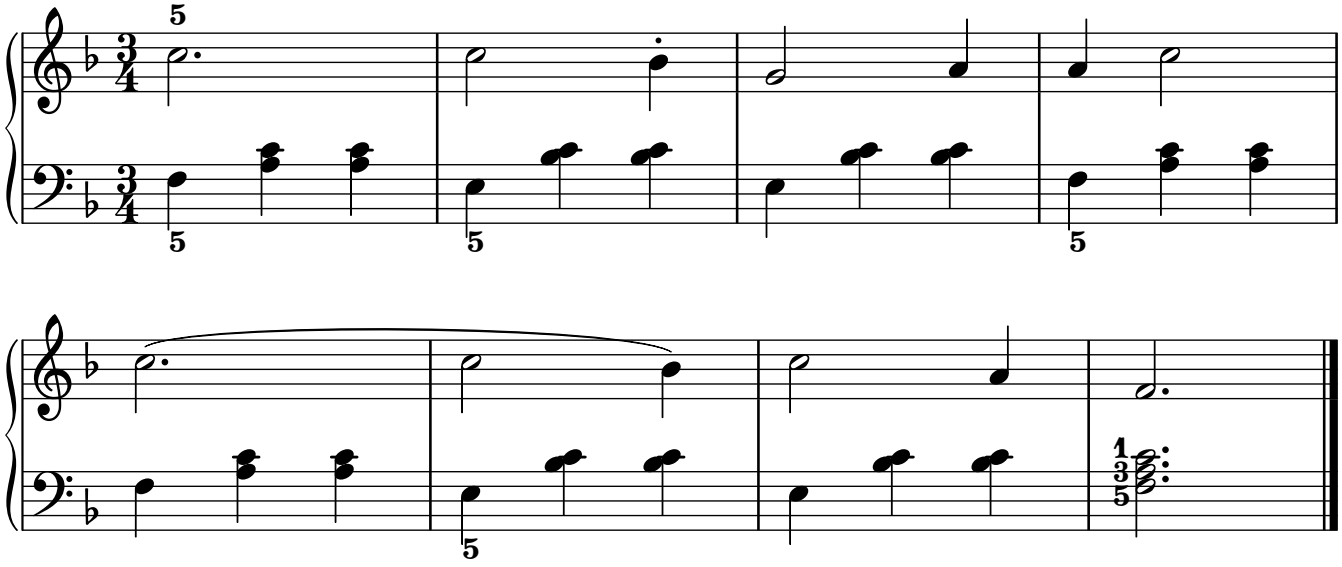
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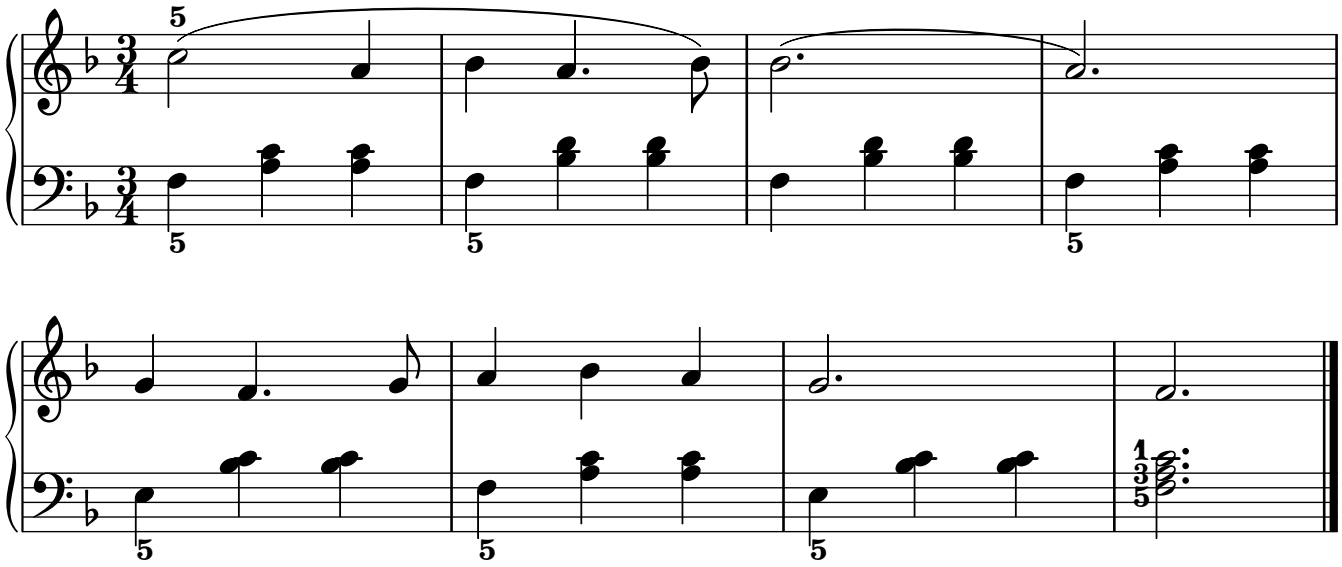
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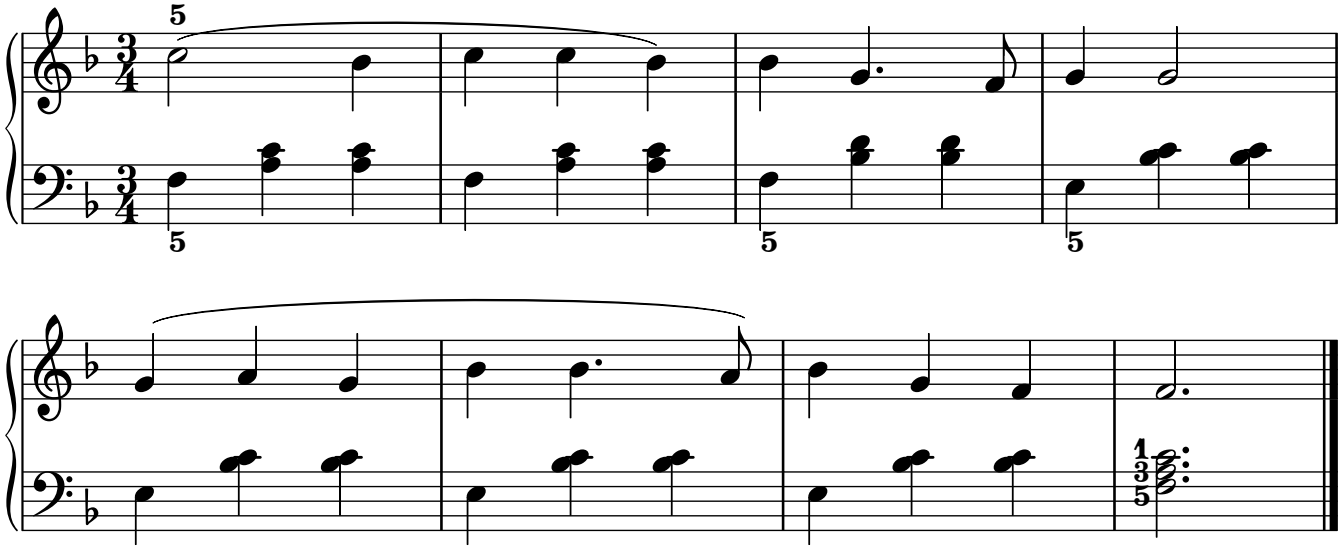
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1.25



1.26

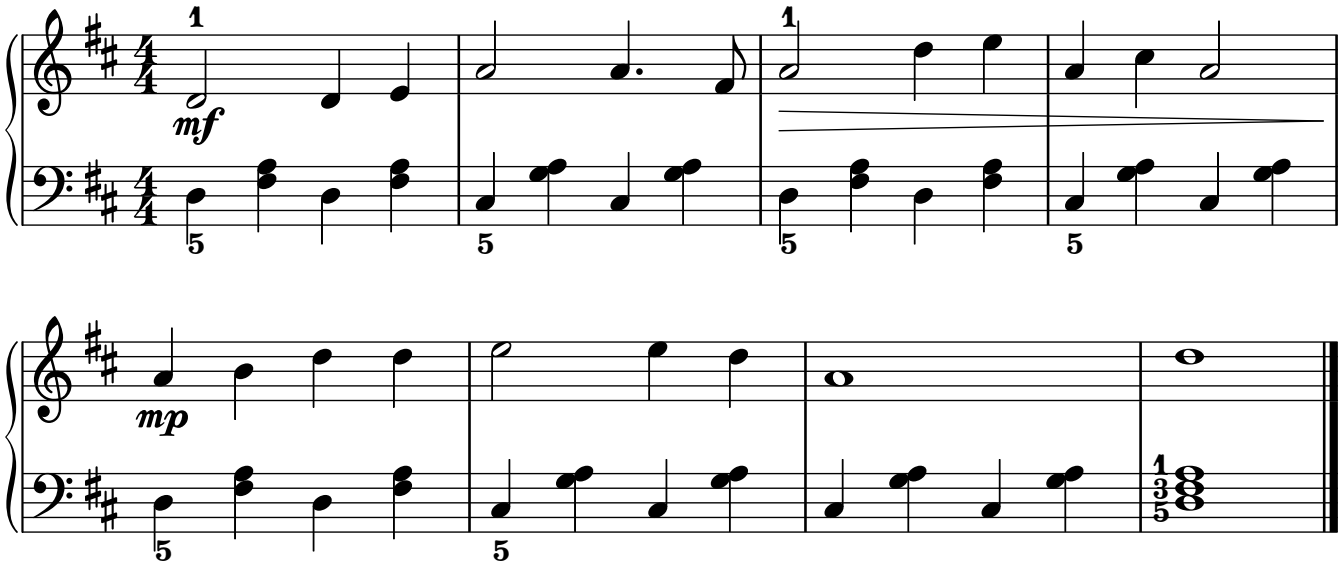


Part D: D major, the right hand on the move
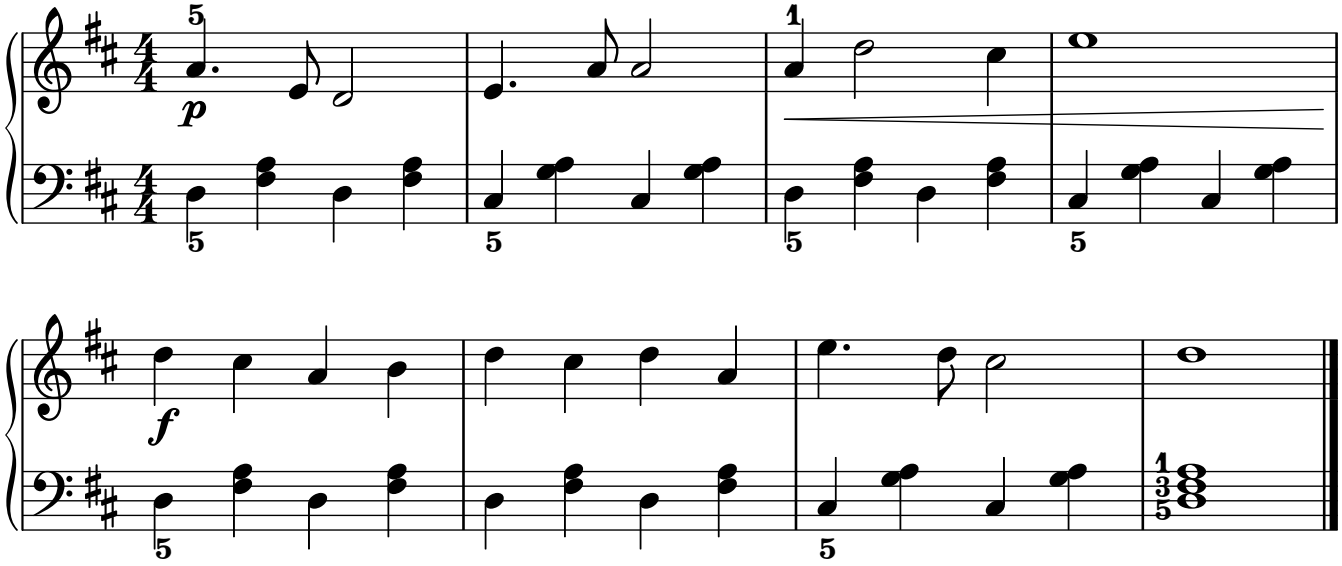
♩ = 72

D major oom-pah. The right hand moves between D position and A position.
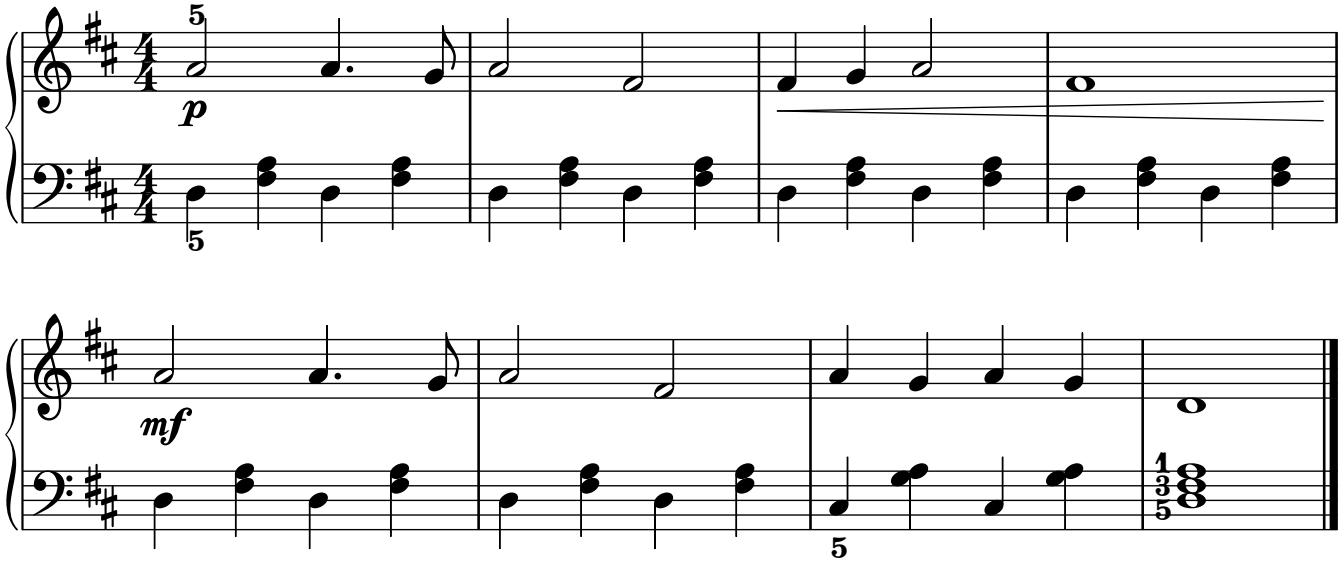
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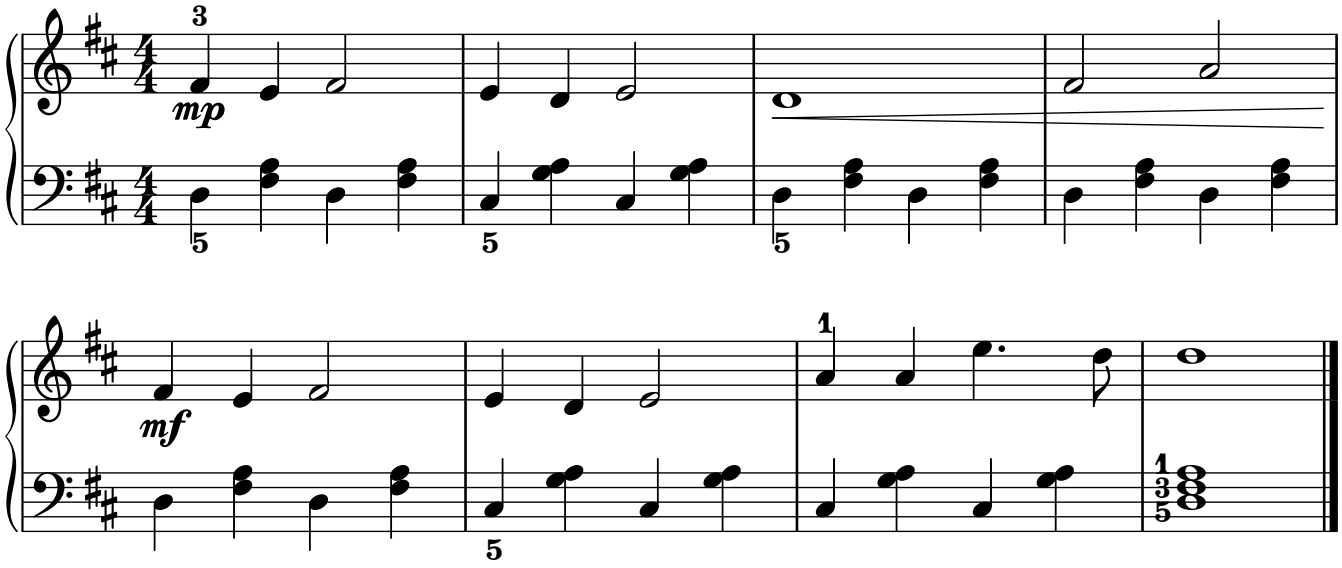
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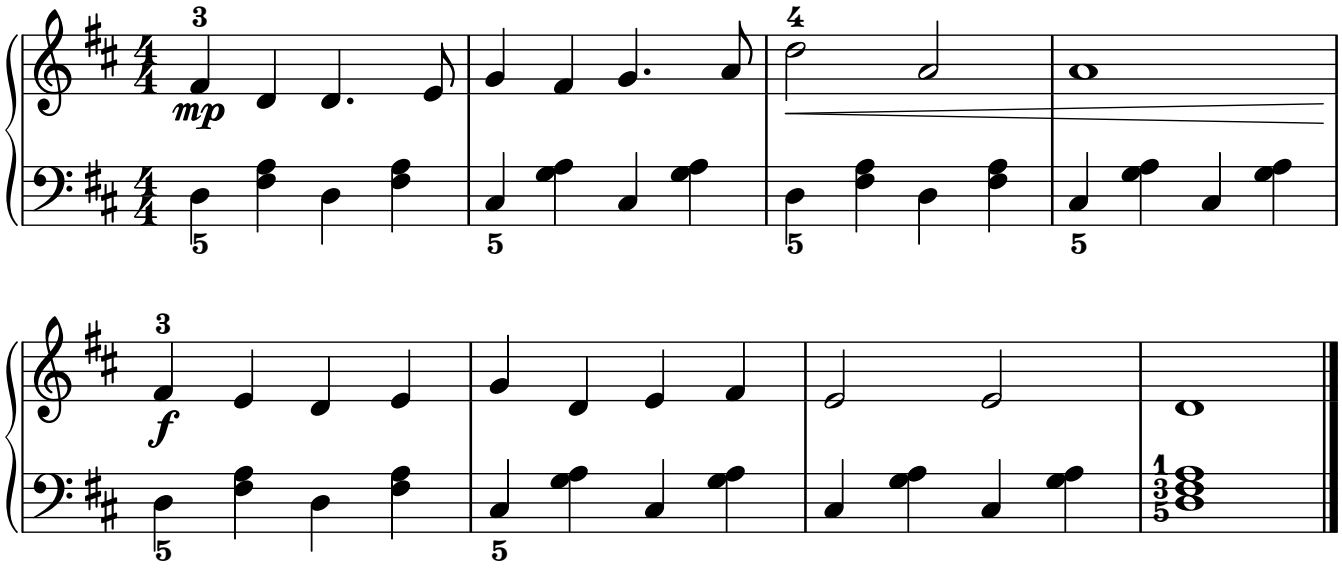


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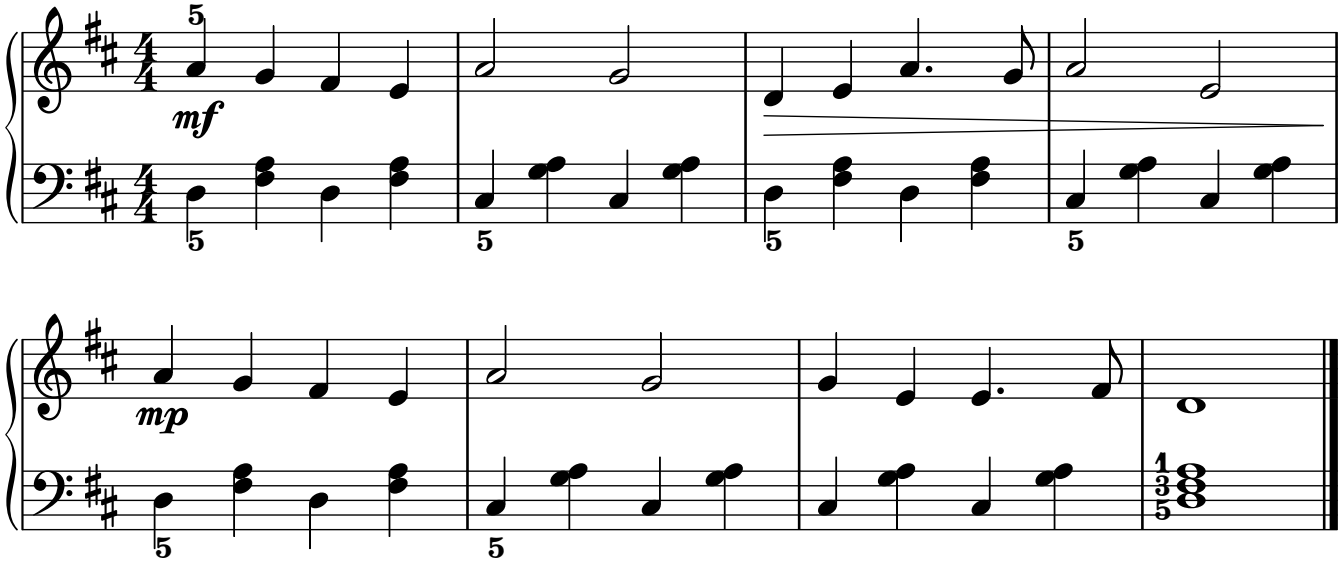
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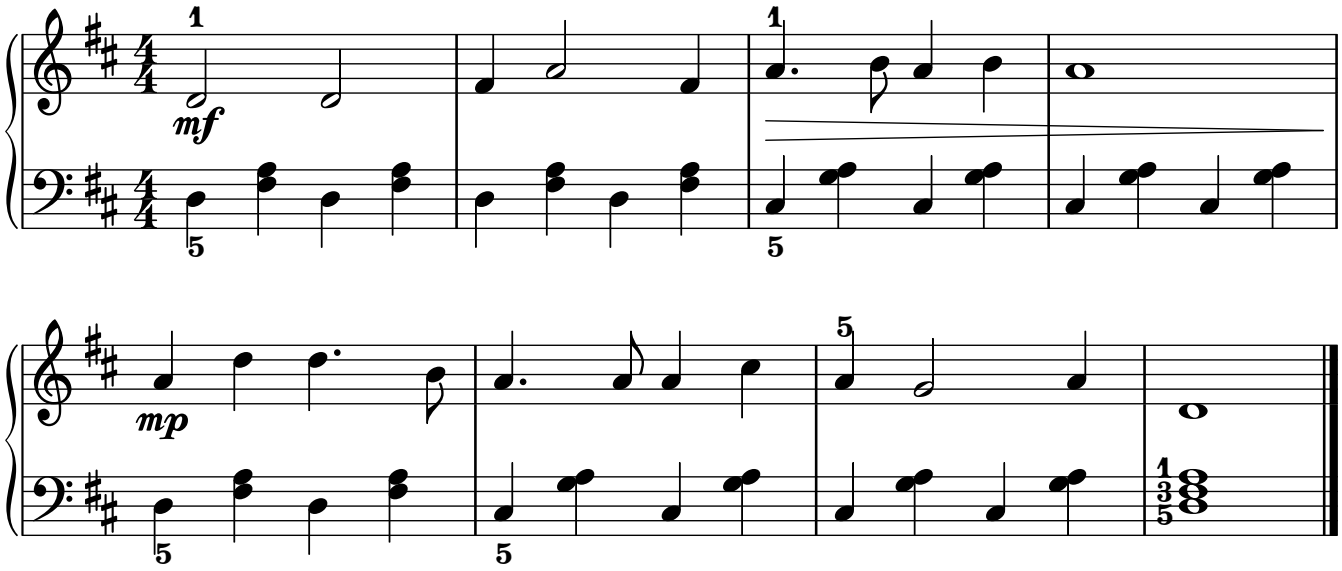
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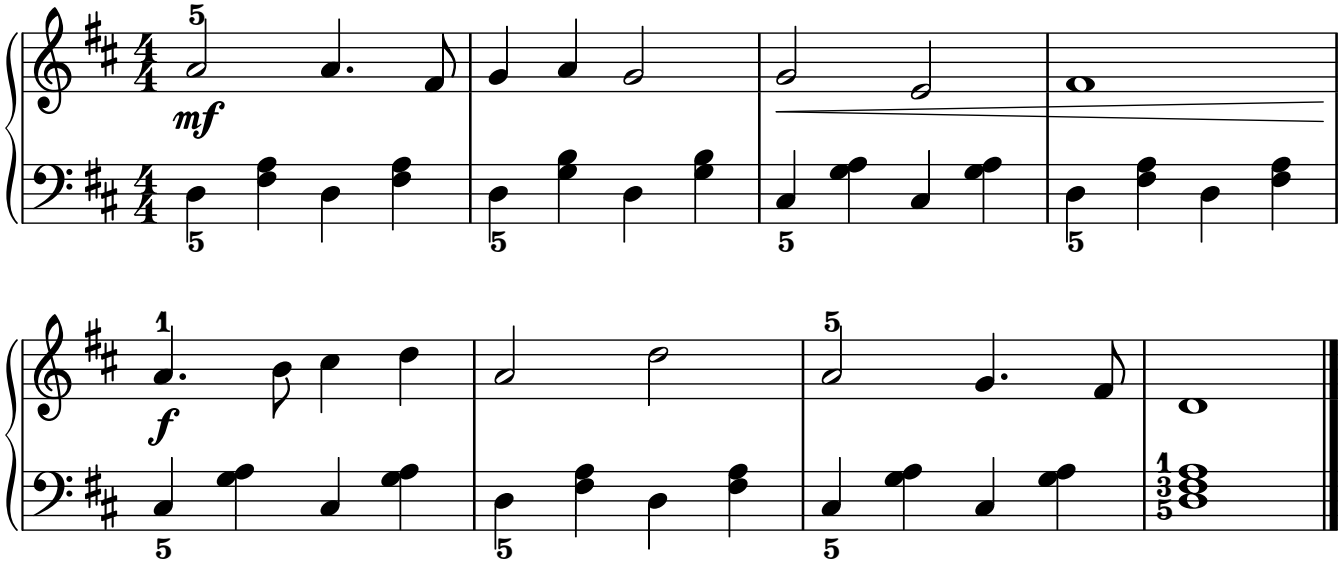


☐ **1.32**



☐ **1.33**



☐ **1.34**



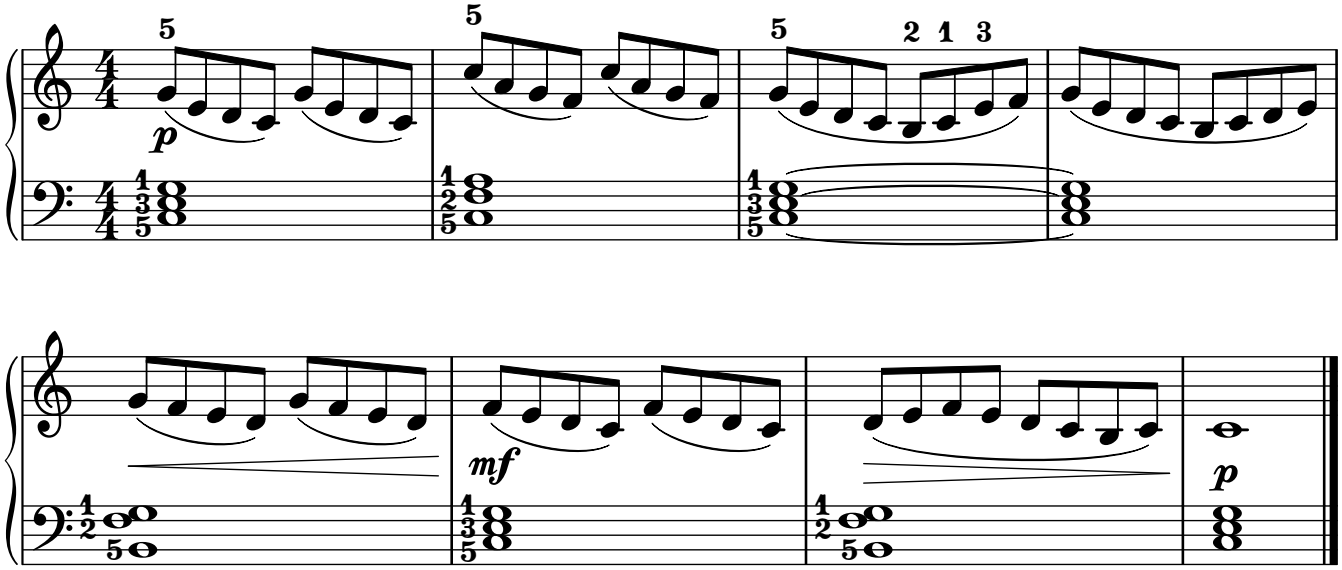
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

La Candeur ♩ = 88

Friedrich Burgmüller, Op. 100 No. 1 (opening) - simplified
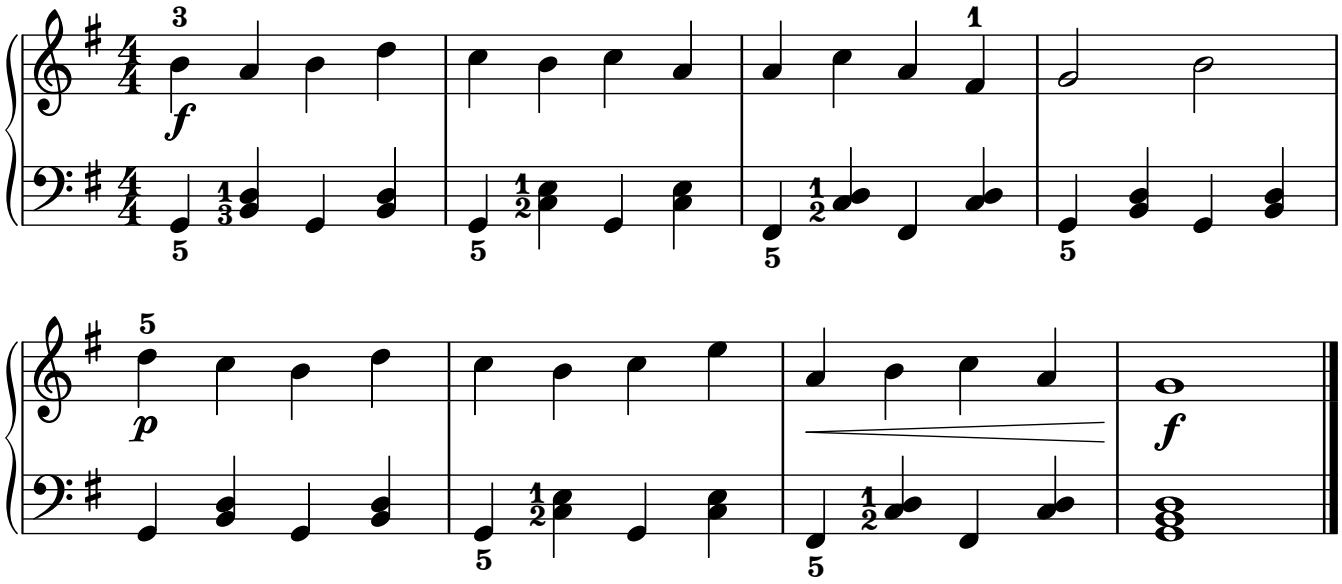
'Candour' (honesty) from Burgmüller's 25 Easy Studies. The left hand holds the chords exactly as Burgmüller wrote them; the right hand is an octave lower than written, and the last two bars are simplified so the piece ends at home. Source: Mutopia Project no. 202.



Oom-pah March ♩ = 96

Original
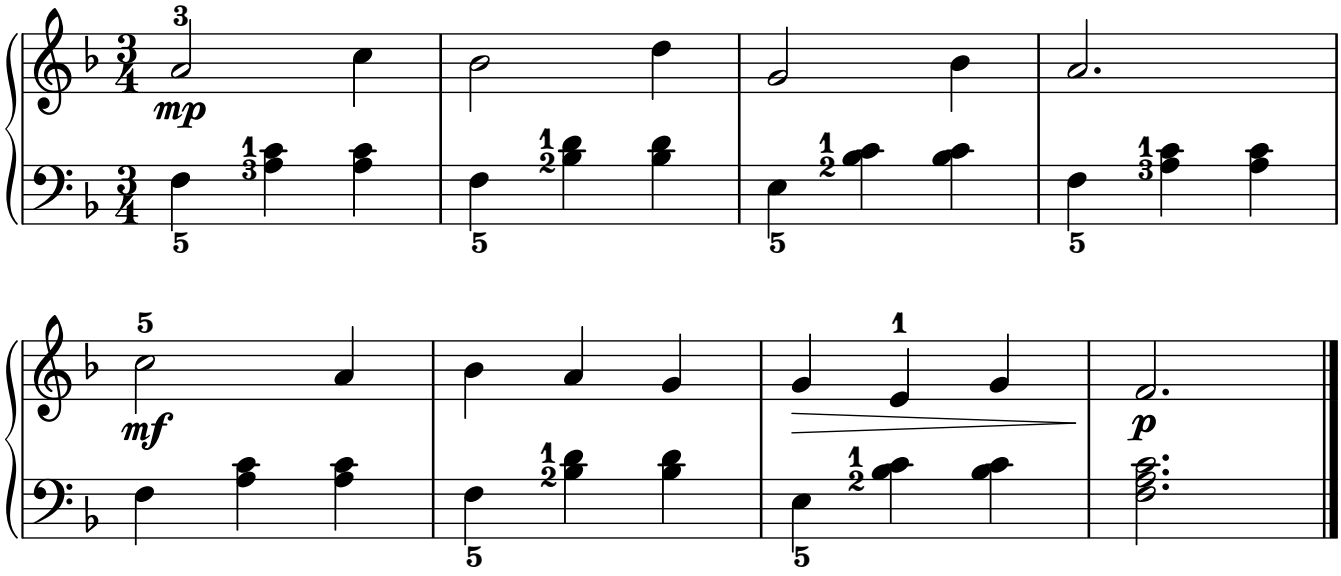
A march over an oom-pah bass in G major. In bars 3 and 7 the left hand's V7 shape has F-sharp at the bottom; in bar 3 the right-hand thumb stretches down to F-sharp too.



Ballroom Waltz ♩ = 120

Original

Oom-pah-pah in F major. The IV shape (F, B-flat, D) and the V7 shape (E, B-flat, C) both have B-flat in the middle.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 2?

- Play five new Part B to D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Every left-hand chord sounds together, and you can name it (I, IV or V7) from its shape.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 2.

Unit 2

Chords in Both Hands

New: Right-hand three-note chords; 2/4 time

Now the right hand plays chords too. A right-hand chord sits under the tune: the top note is the melody, and the two notes below it fill in the harmony. This unit also brings a new time signature, 2/4: two quarter-note beats in a bar, the time of marches and polkas.

What is new

Right-hand chords

Read the top note first: it is the tune. Then recognise the shape below it, two notes a third or fourth apart, all from the same chord as the left hand.

Chorale

A chorale is a hymn texture: every beat is a chord, in both hands, and the music moves slowly in half notes. Listen for the top line.

2/4 time

Two quarter-note beats in each bar: ONE two, ONE two. A half note fills the whole bar. The oom-pah bass in 2/4 is one 'oom' and one 'pah' per bar.

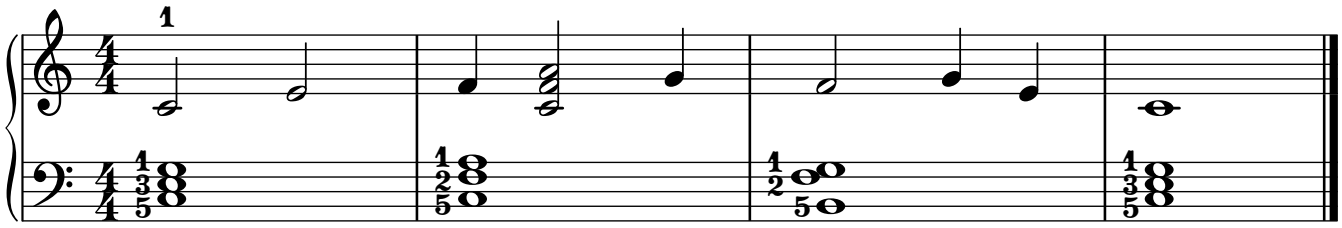
Reading tips

1. Look at the top note of each right-hand chord and follow the tune from top note to top note.
2. Drop the whole hand onto a chord, so all three notes sound exactly together.
3. In 2/4, feel a strong beat at every bar line, like marching feet: LEFT right, LEFT right.
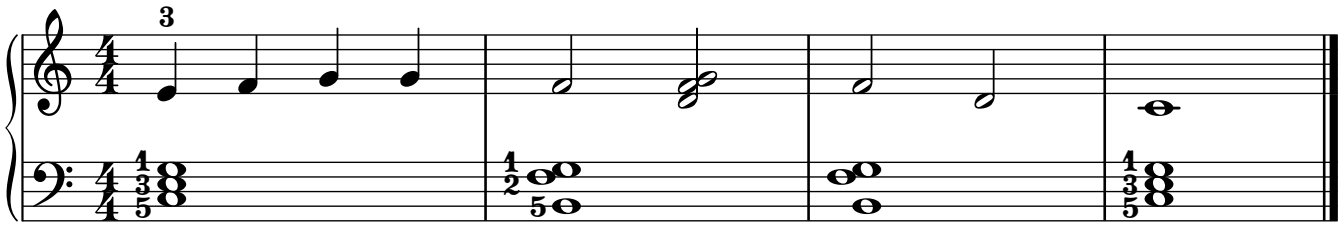
Part A: Chords on the long notes ♩ = 60

C major: right-hand chords on the long notes, block chords in the left hand.

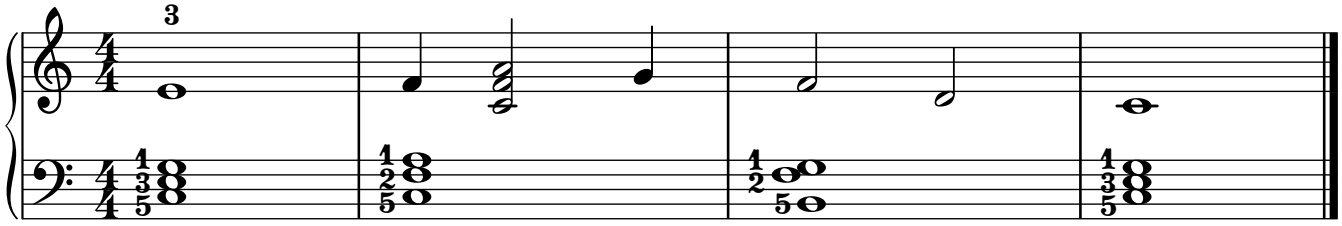
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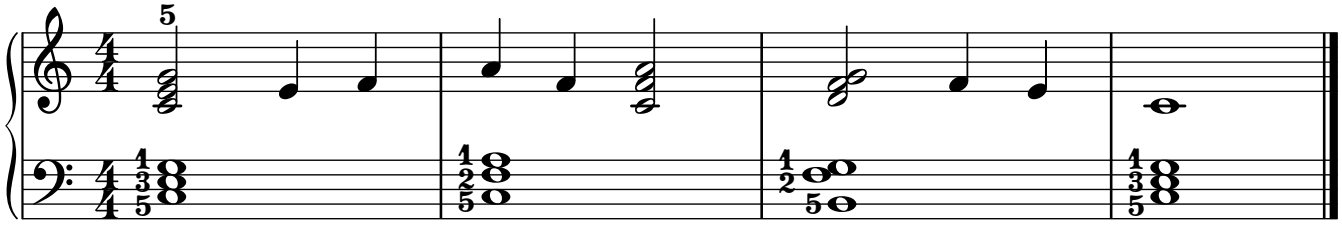
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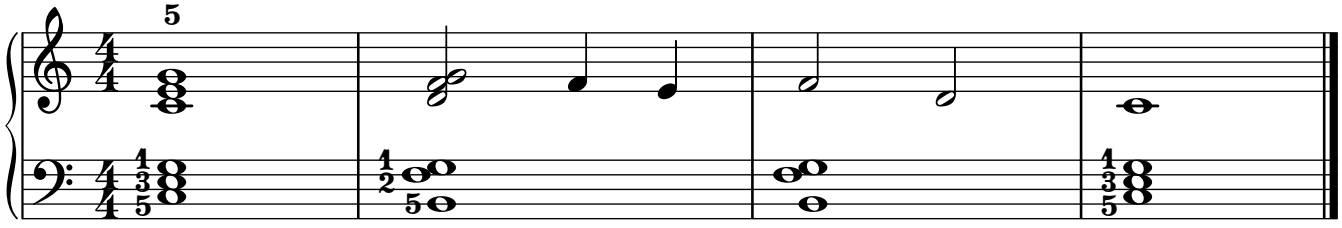
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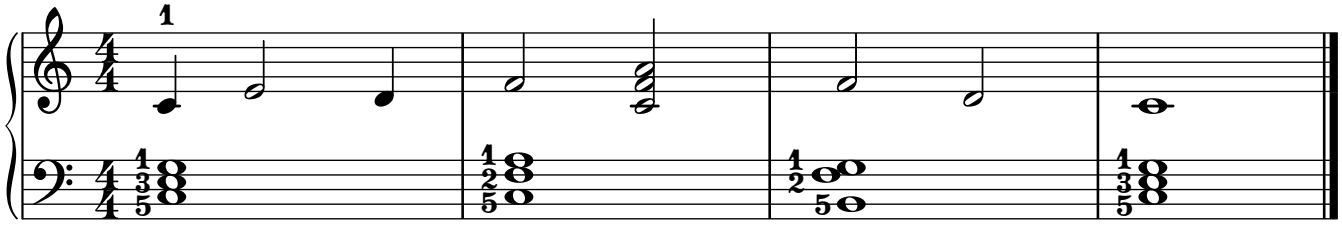
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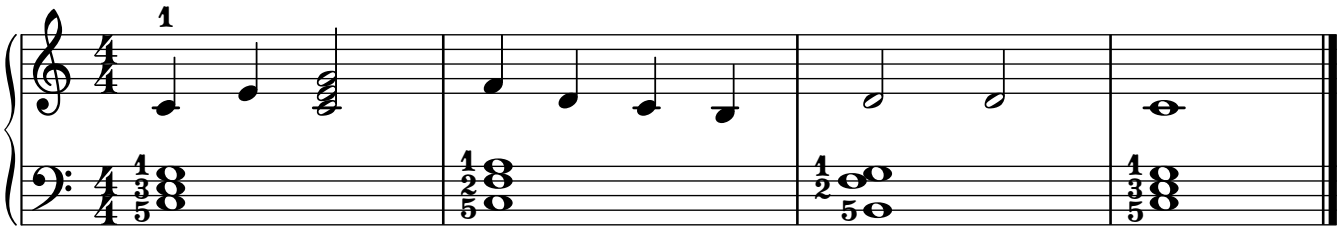
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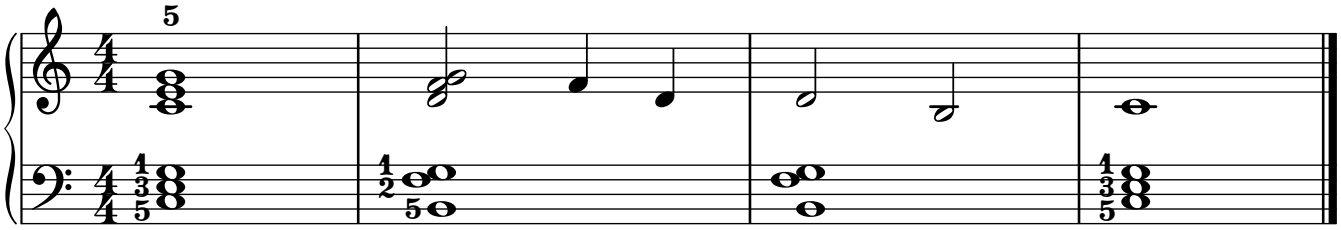


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☐ **2.7**
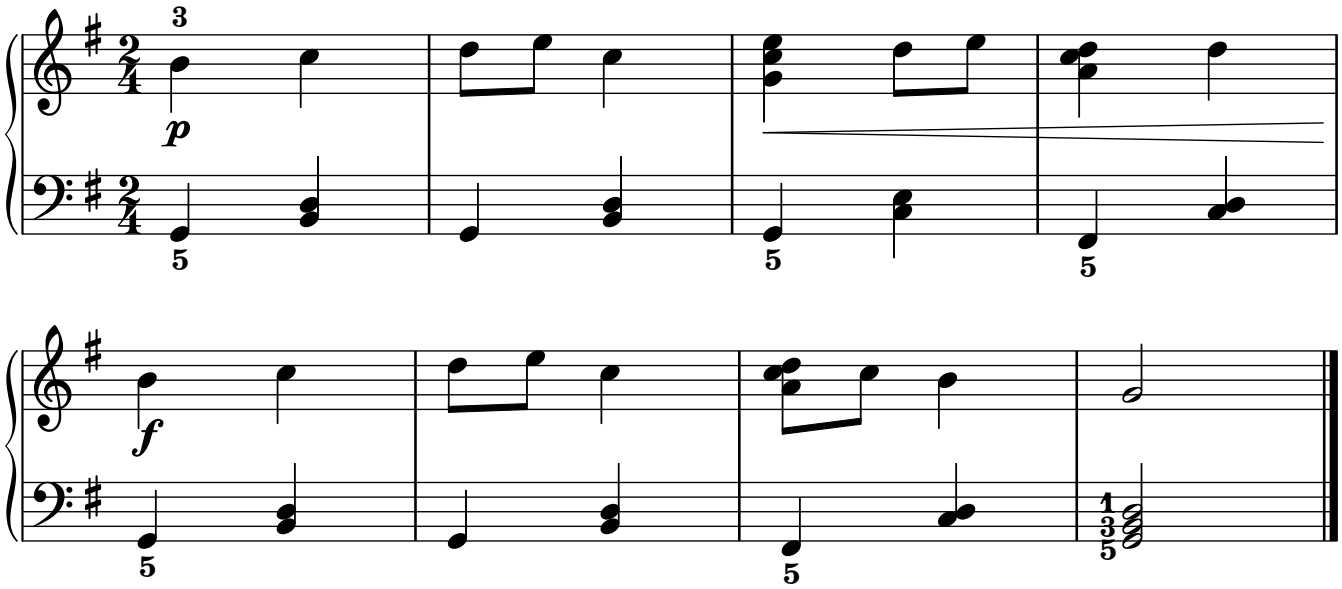


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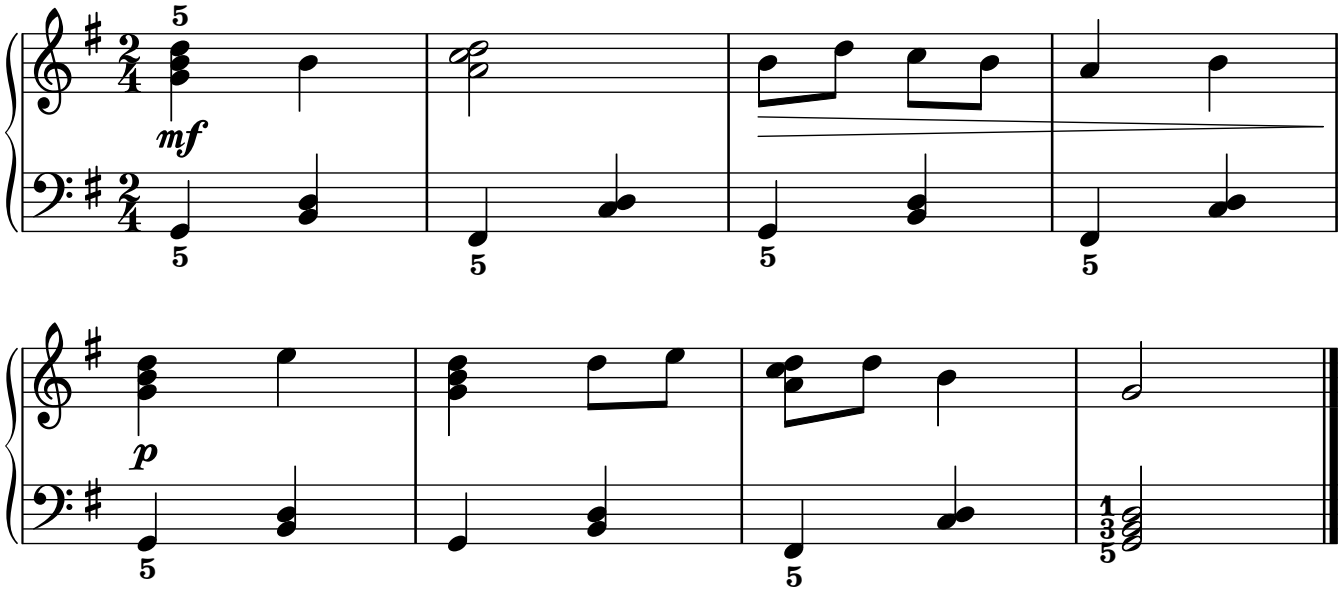


Part B: A march in 2/4 ♩ = 88

A march in 2/4, G major: right-hand chords on the beat, oom-pah in the left hand.

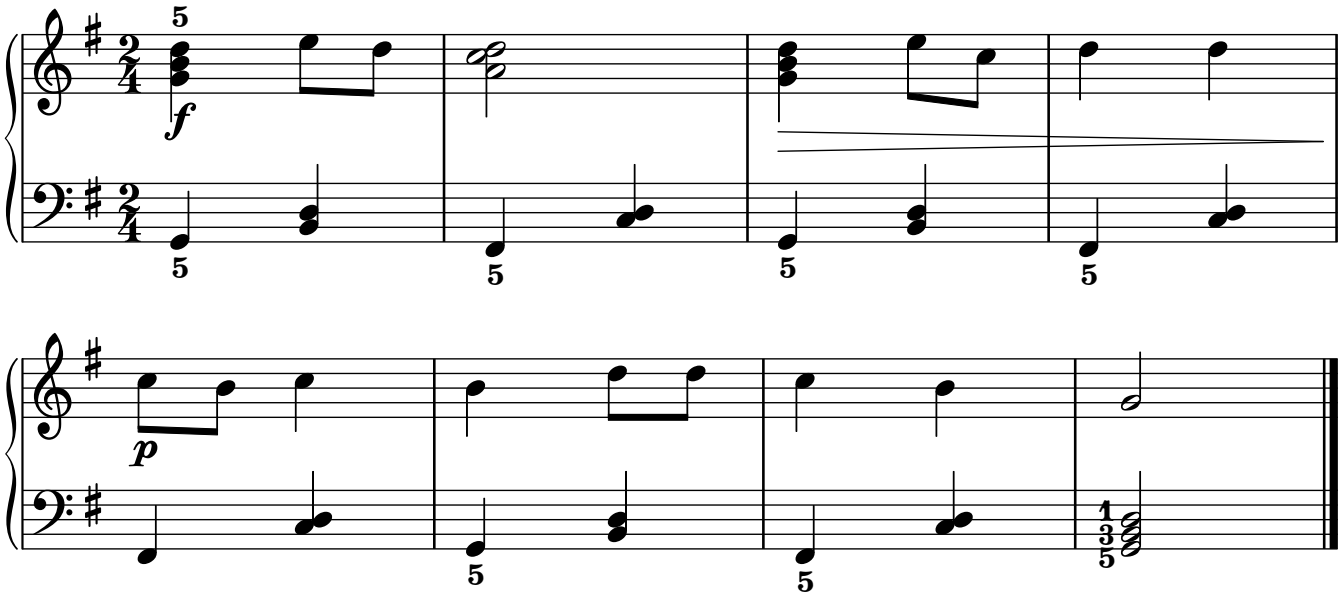
☐ **2.9**



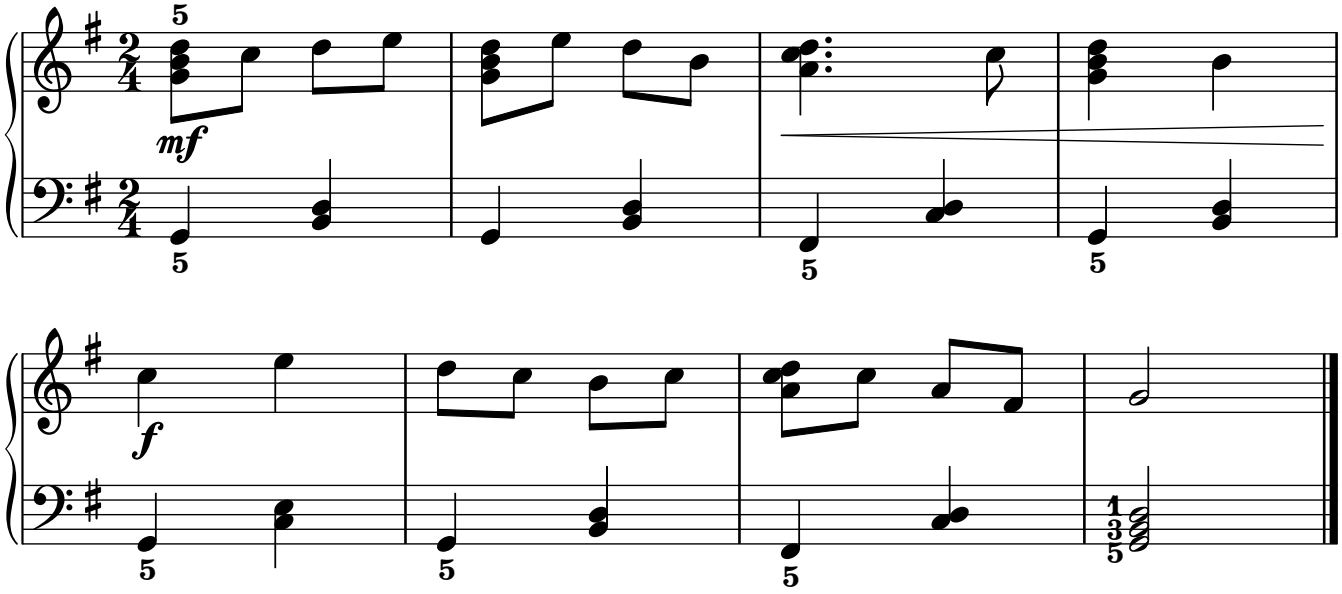
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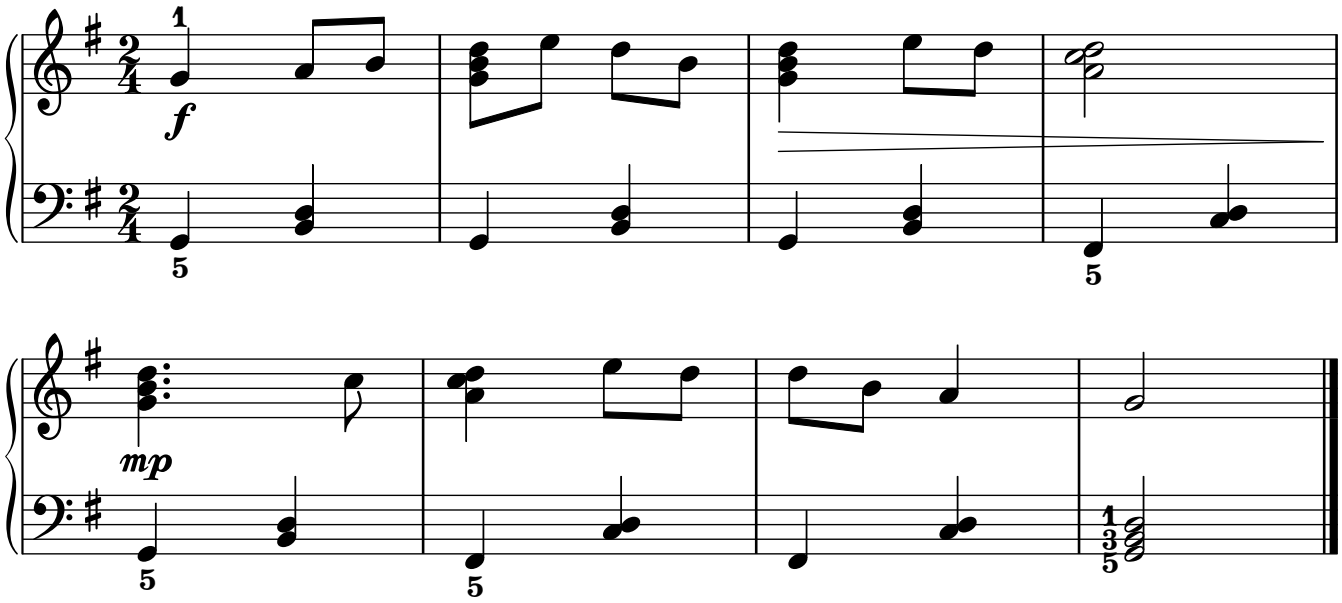


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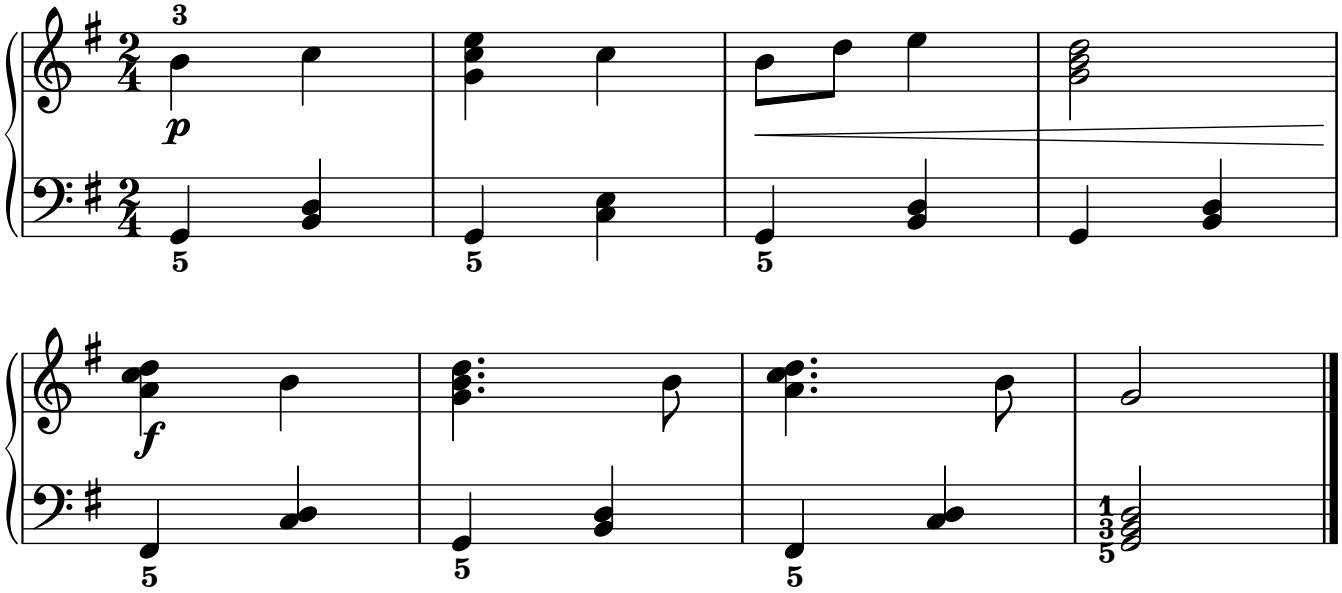


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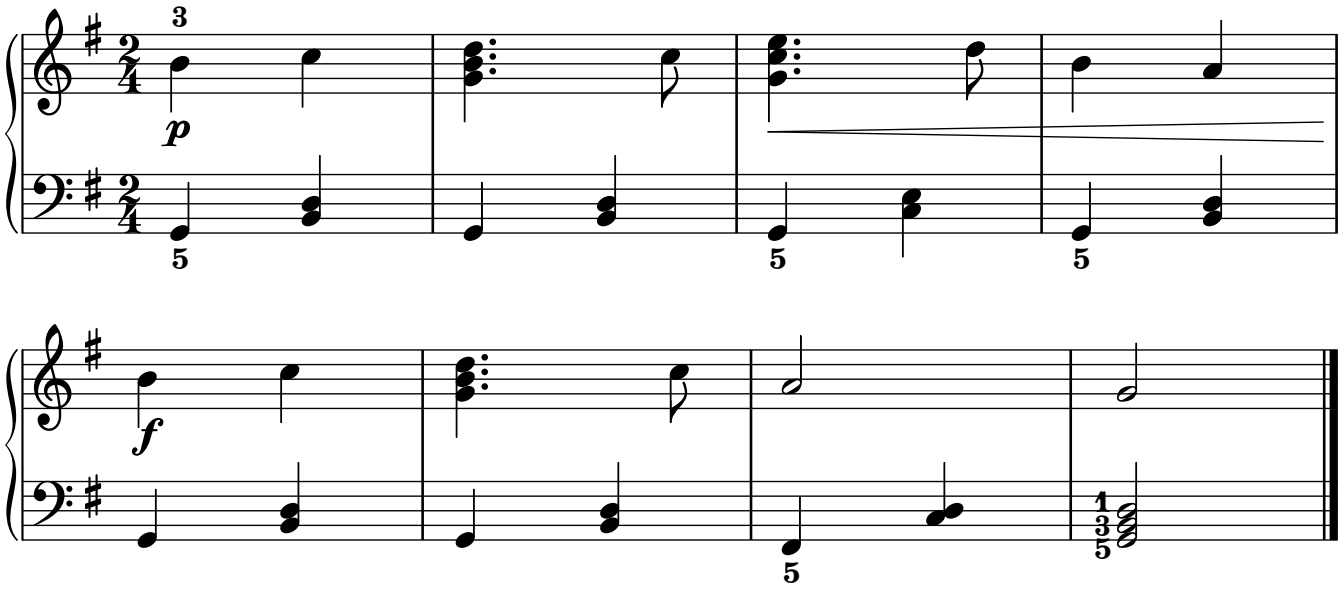
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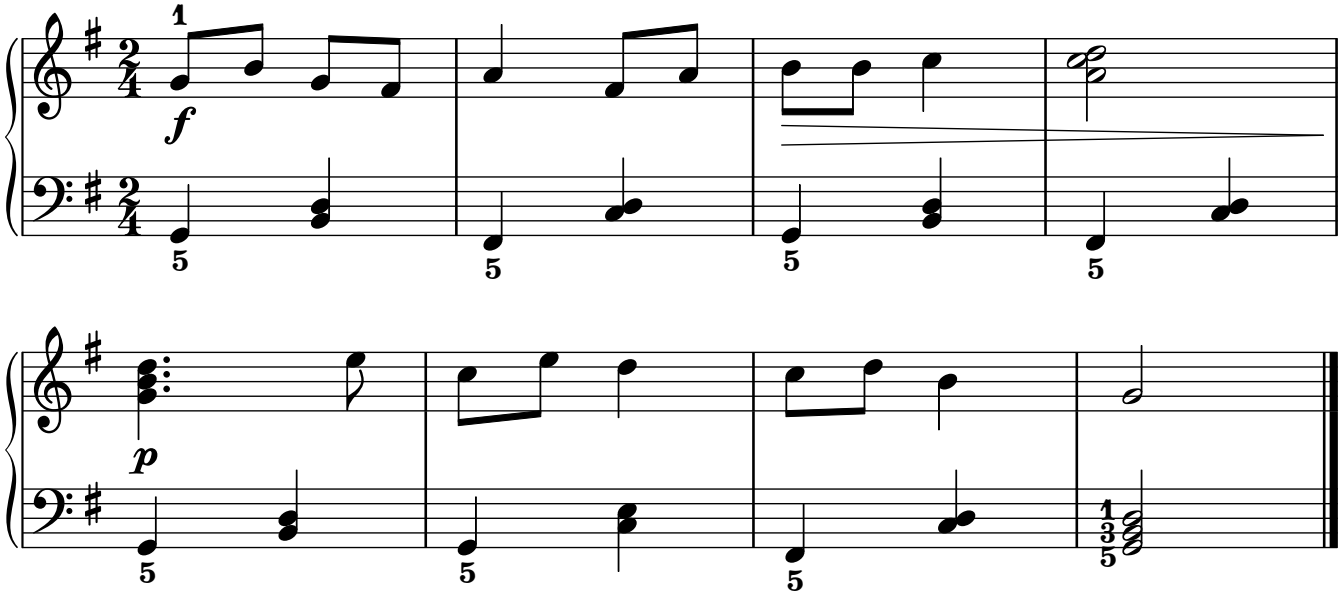
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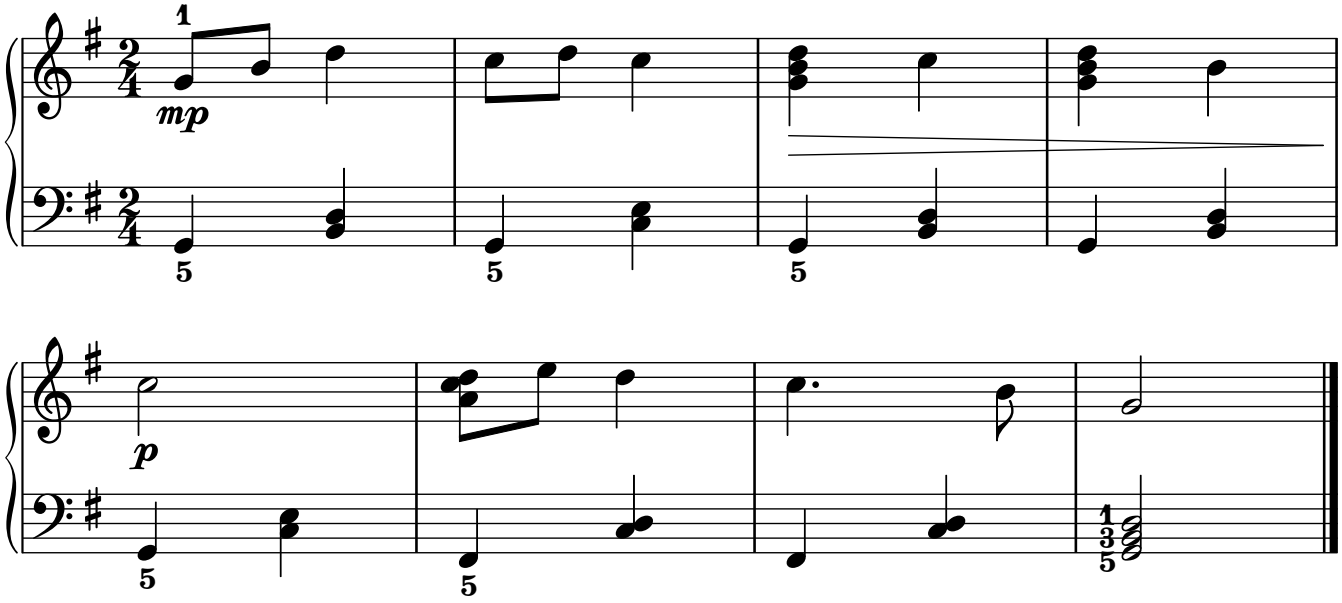


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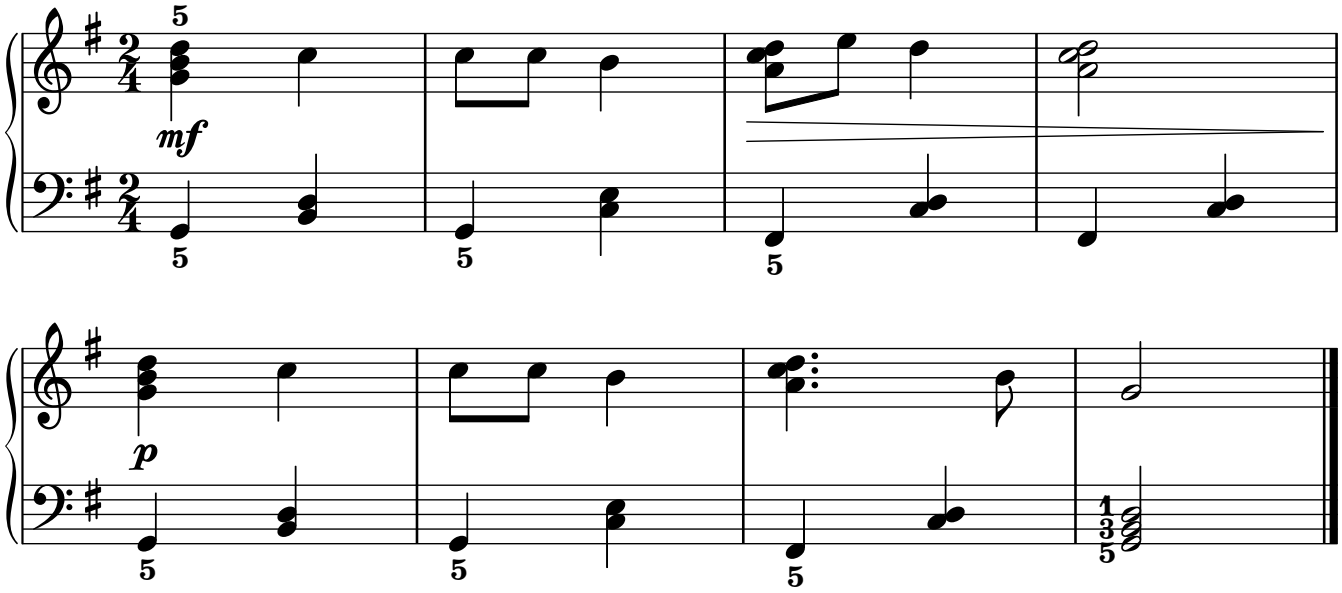


2.16



2.17



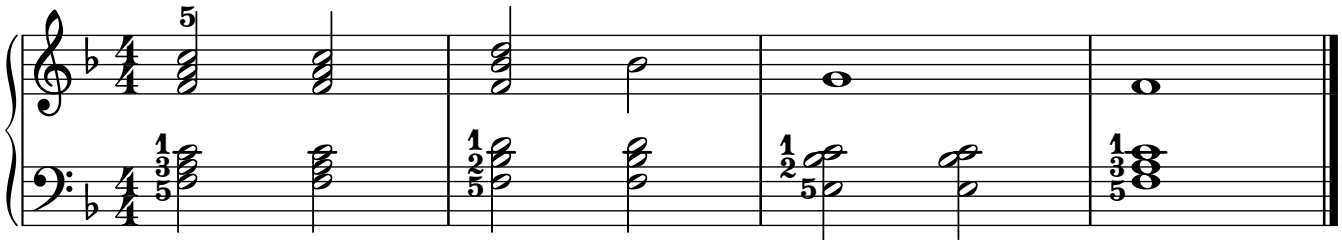
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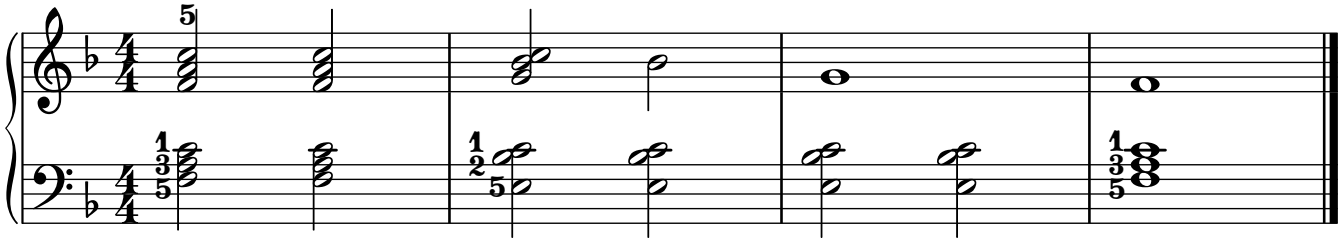


Part C: Chorale: chords in both hands ♩ = 60

F major in half notes, chords in both hands.

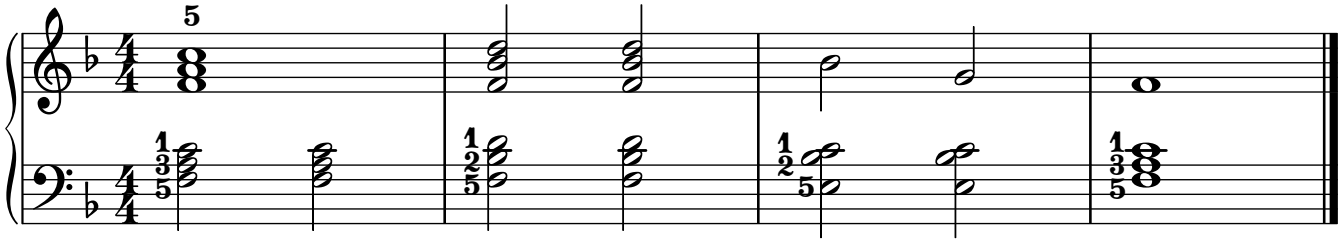
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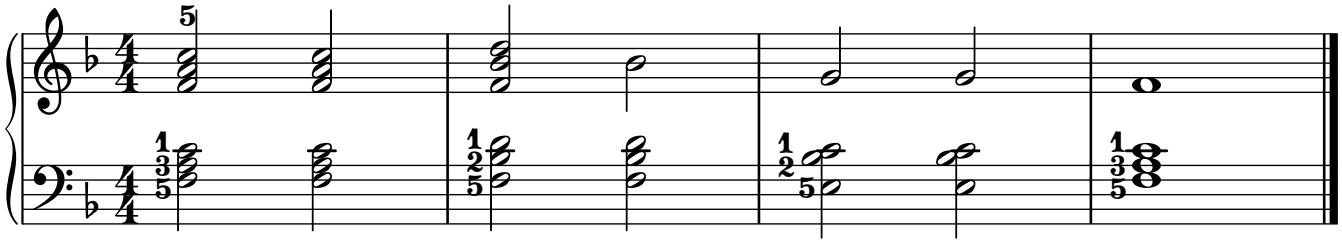
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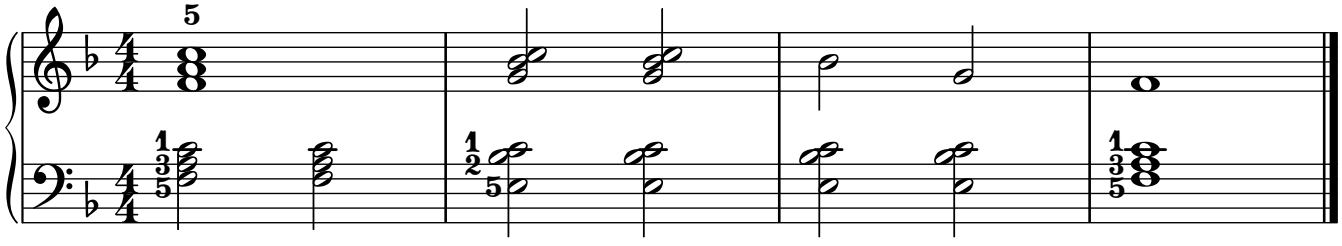
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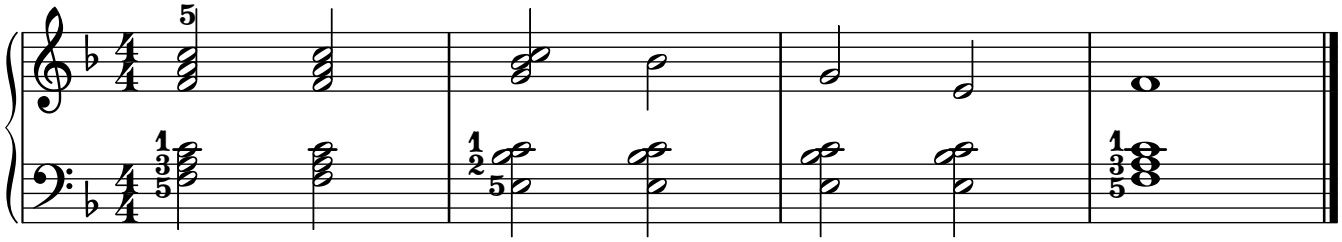


☐ **2.22**



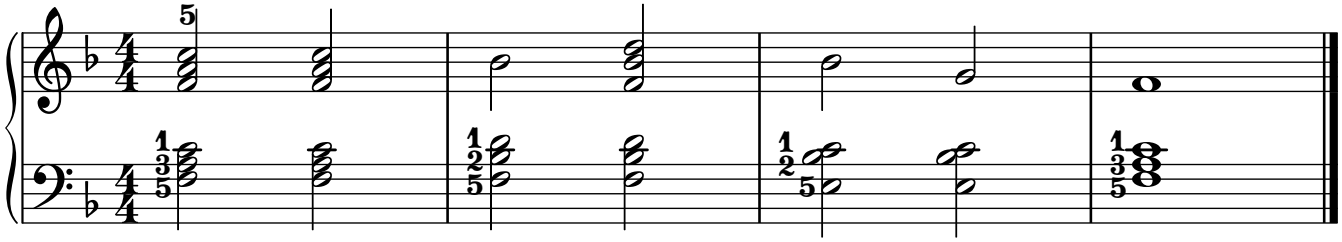
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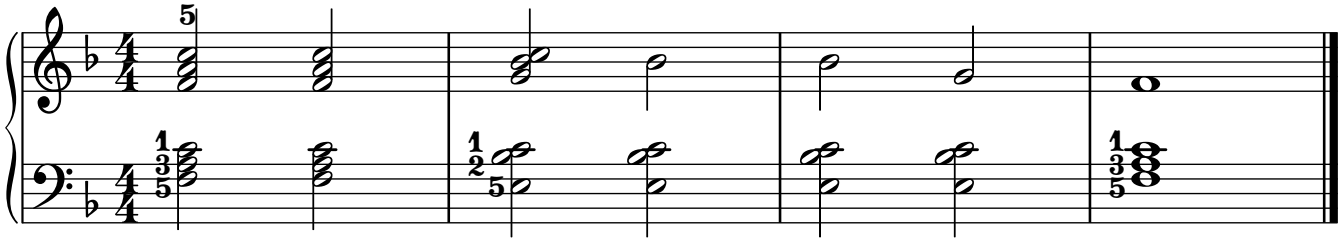
☐ **2.24**



☐ **2.25**



☐ **2.26**
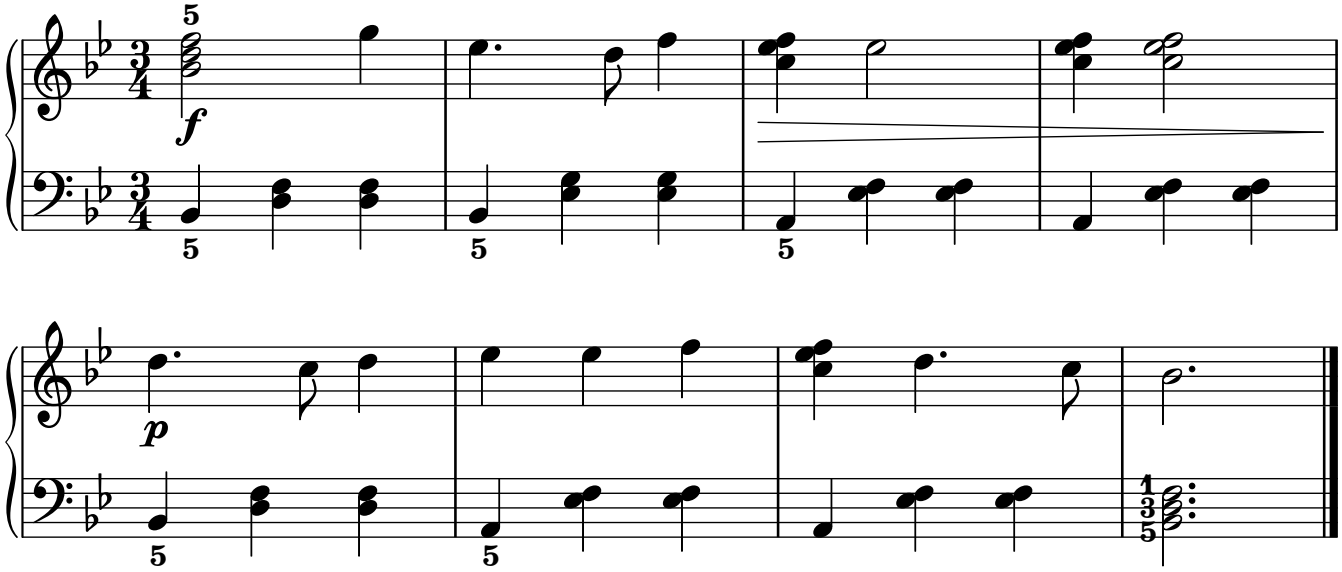


Part D: A B-flat waltz with chords
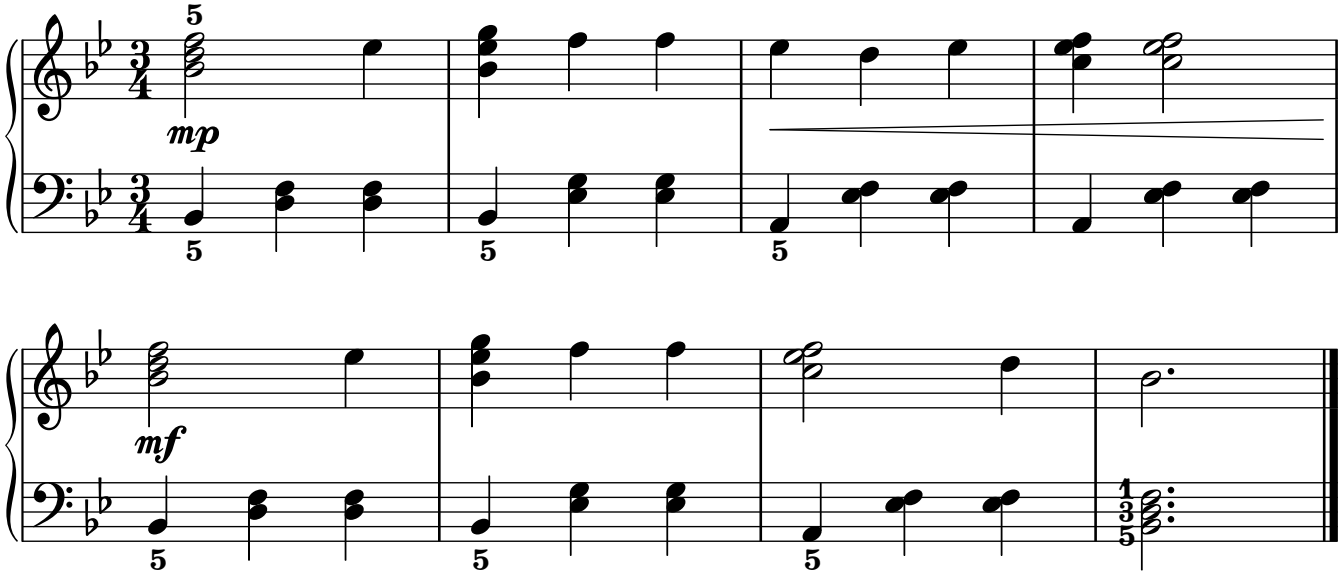
♩ = 84

A B-flat major waltz with right-hand chords on the beat.

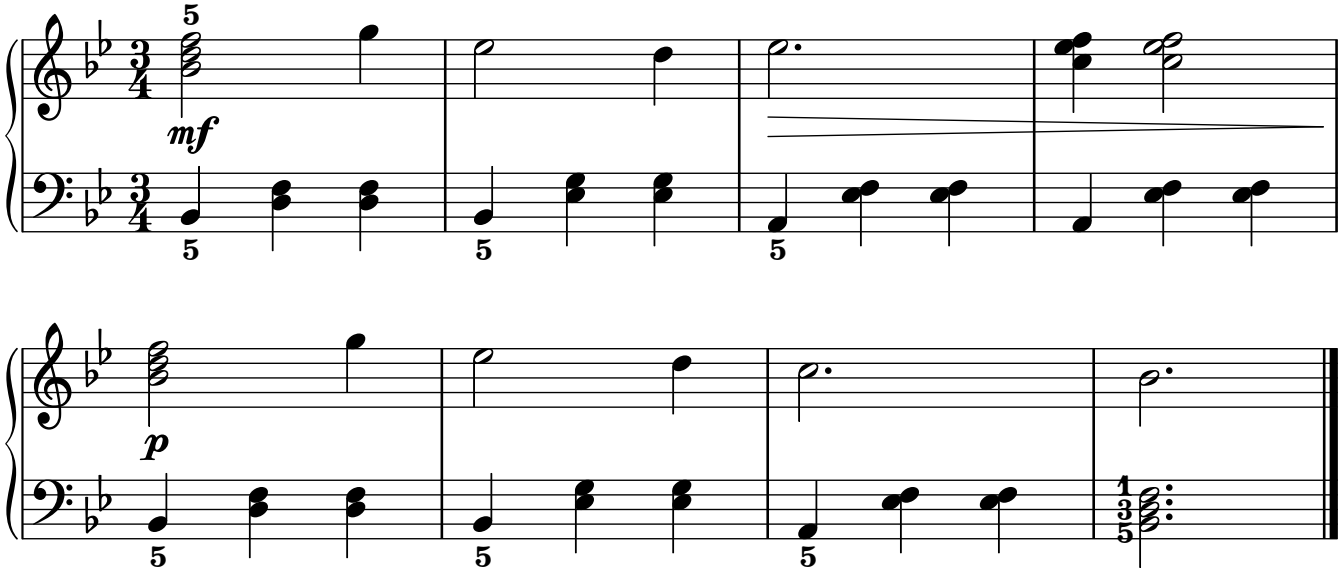
☐ **2.27**



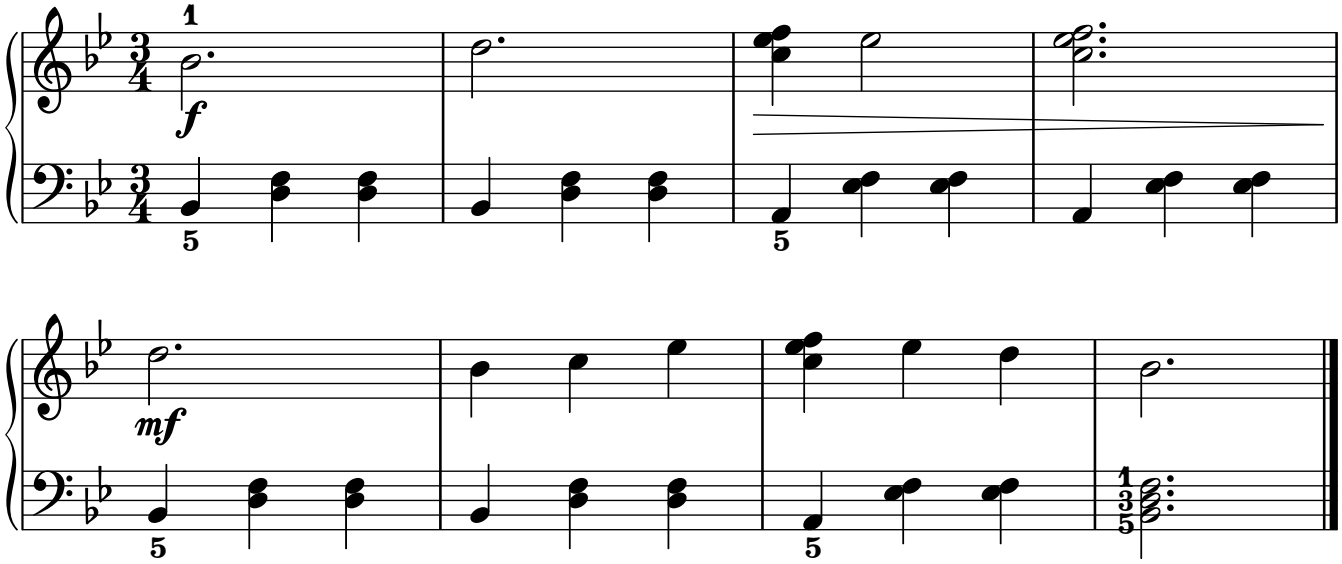
☐ **2.28**



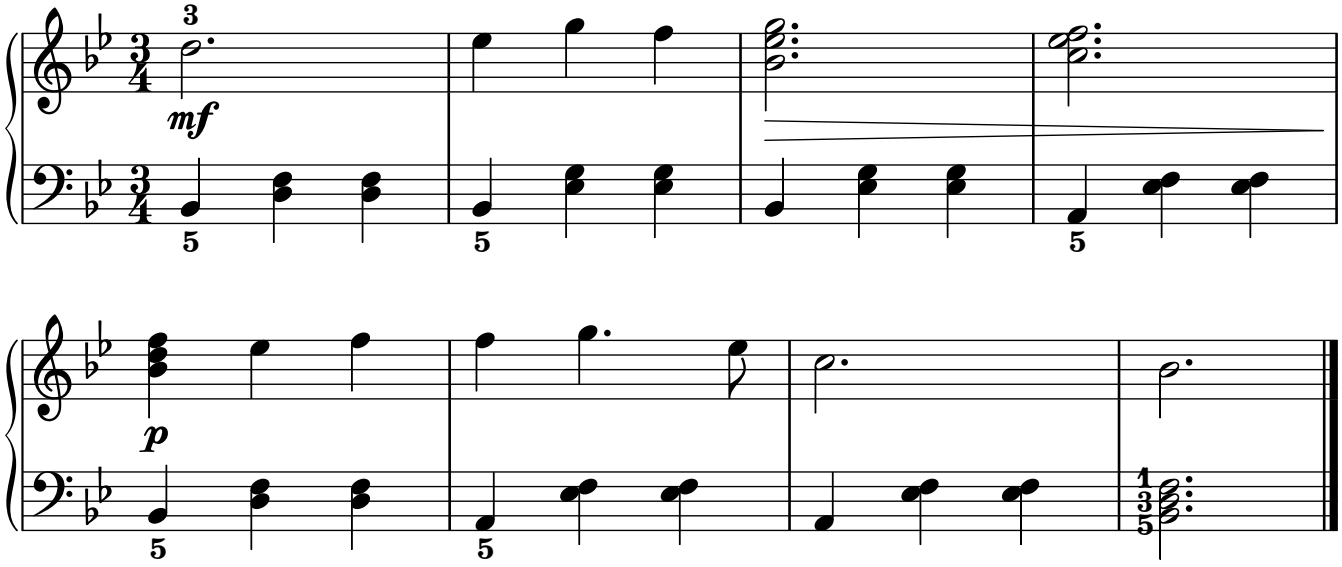
2.29
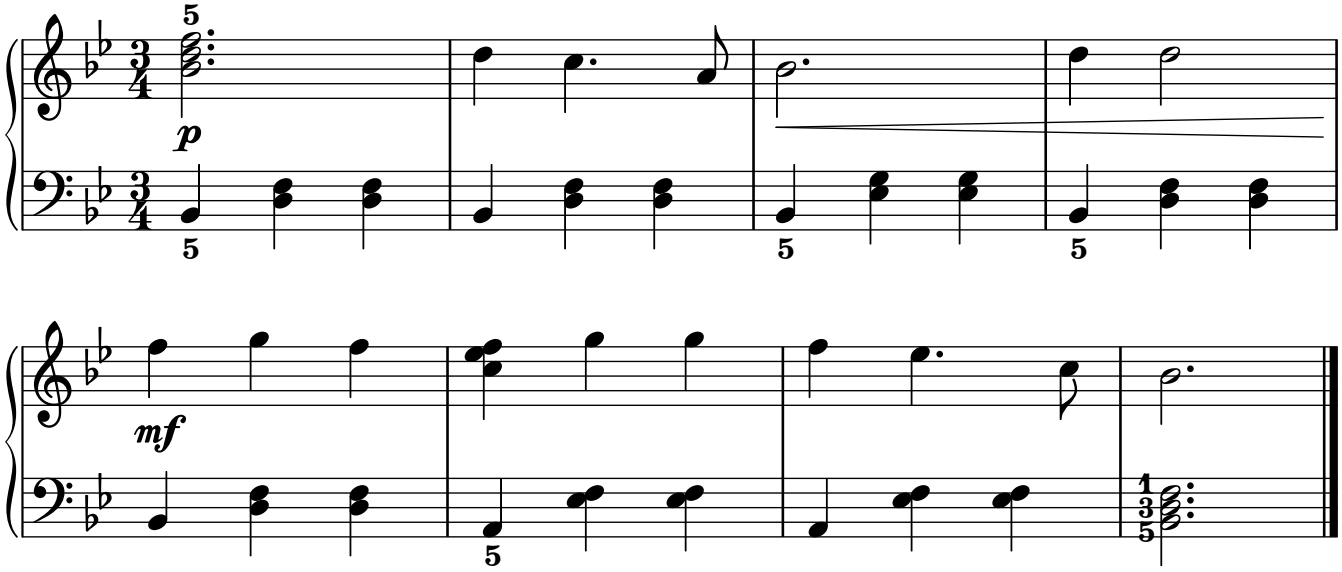


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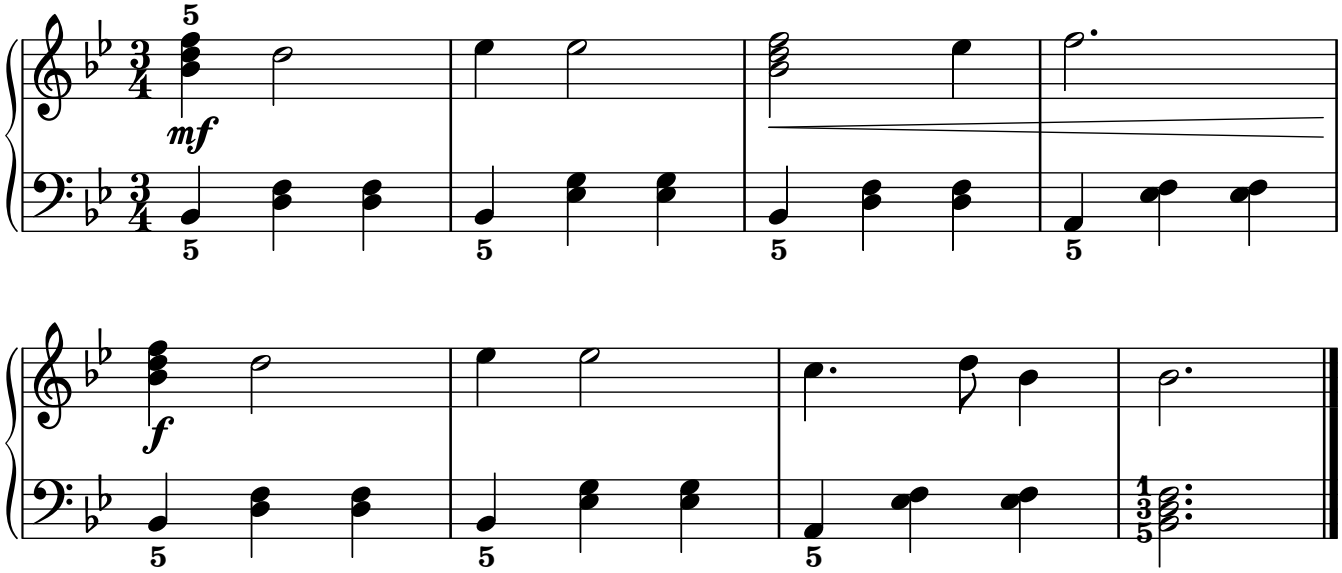


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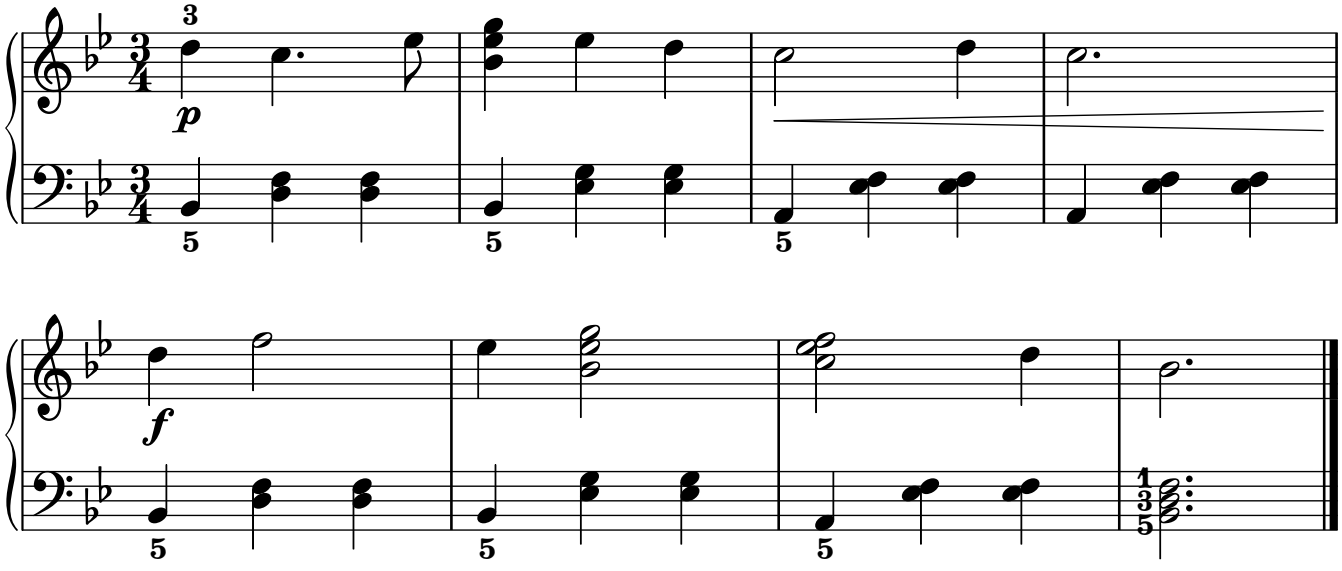
☐ **2.32**



☐ **2.33**



☐ **2.34**
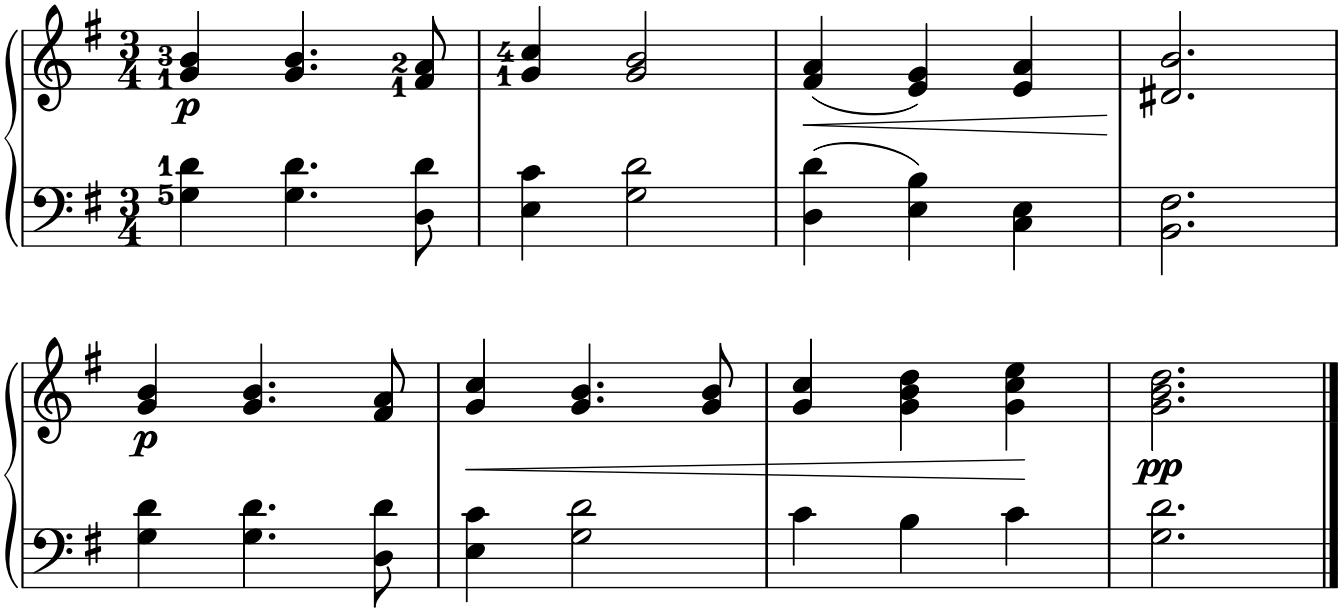


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Morning Prayer ♩ = 56

Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky, Op. 39 No. 1 (opening and close) - simplified
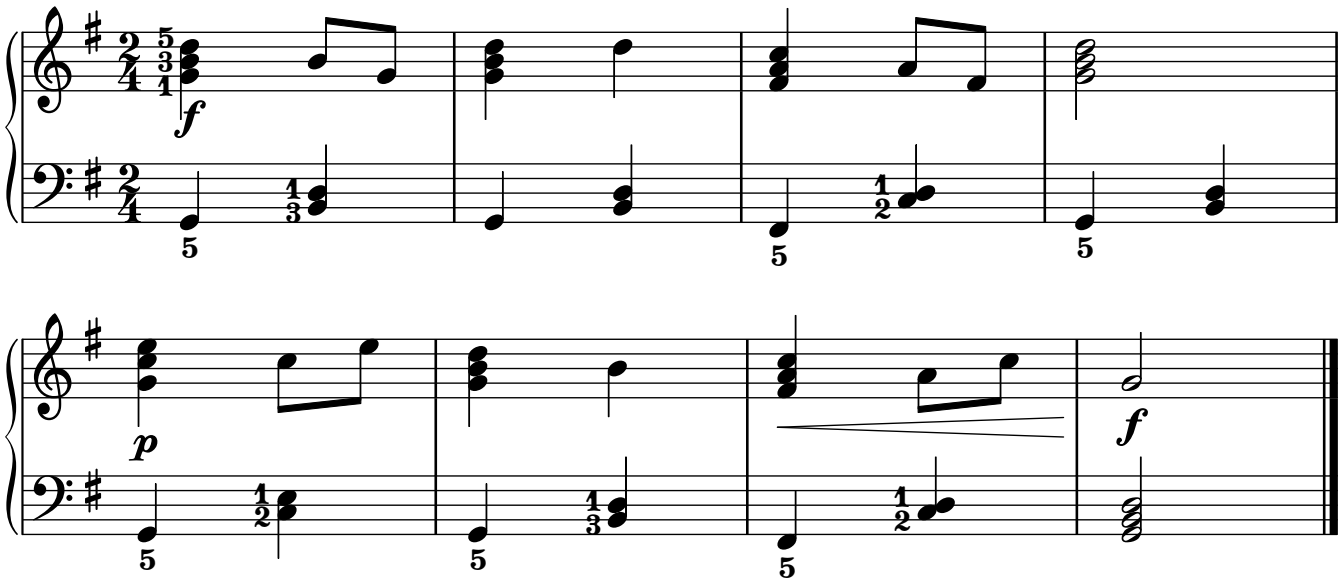
The first piece of Tchaikovsky's Album for the Young, a quiet chorale in both hands. Bars 1-4 are as Tchaikovsky wrote them (the left hand an octave higher); bars 5-8 shorten the rest of the piece. Bar 4 ends on a B major chord: D-sharp is its middle note. Source: Mutopia Project no. 2032.



Toy Soldiers' March ♩ = 96

Original

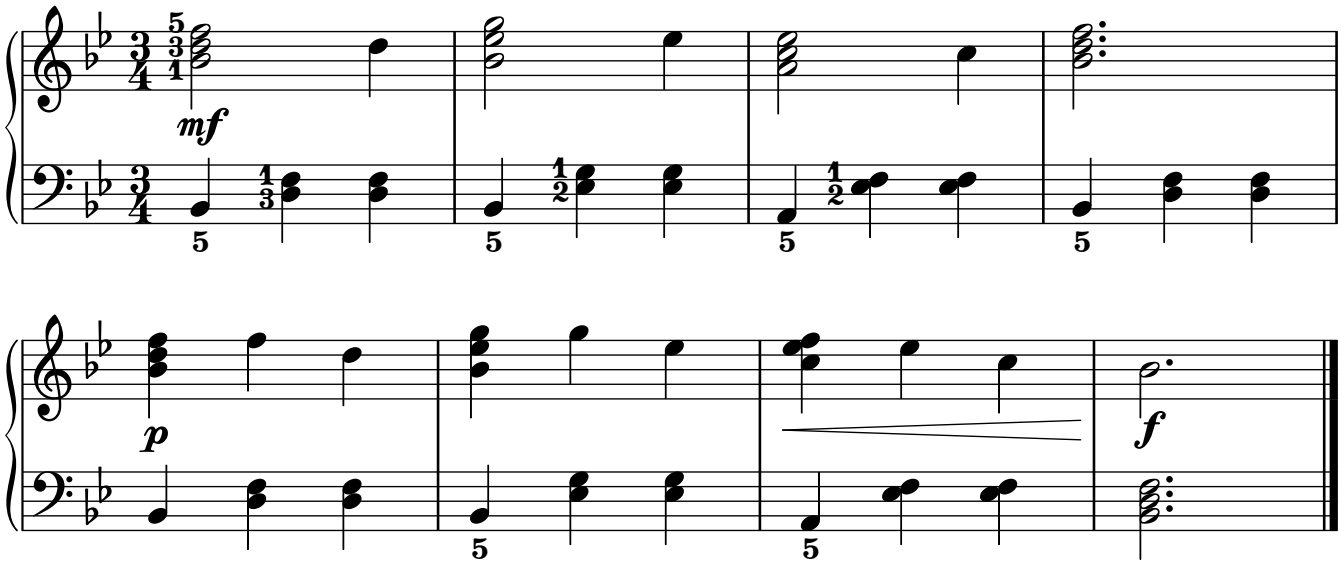
A march in 2/4. The right hand plays a chord on every first beat; the left hand plays oom-pah, one 'oom' and one 'pah' in each bar.



Grand Waltz in B-flat ♩ = 132

Original

Chords in both hands. The right hand's chords are B-flat D F (I), B-flat E-flat G (IV) and A C E-flat or C E-flat F (V7); finger 5 stretches up to G in bars 2 and 6.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 3?

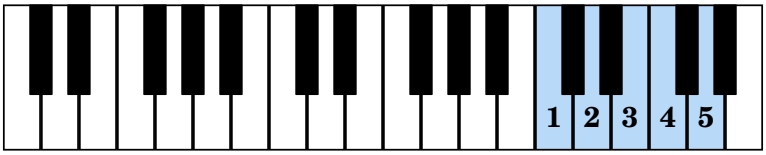
- Play five new Part B to D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Every chord sounds together, and the top line of the right hand sings.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 3.

Unit 3

High Notes

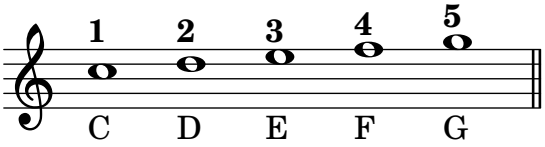
New: Ledger lines above the treble staff, up to D6; the hand moves up an octave

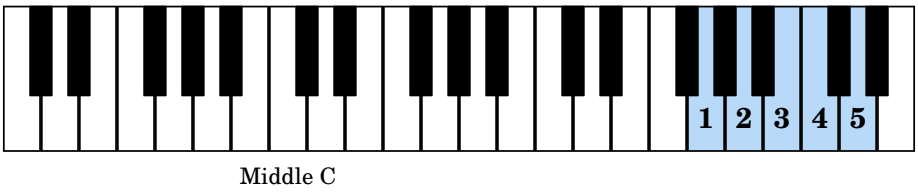
The treble staff ends at F, on its top line. Notes above it are written on short extra lines called ledger lines. Counting ledger lines note by note is slow; instead, learn a few landmarks and read from them. In this unit the right hand works in two high positions, and also jumps up and down an octave.



Right hand high C position: finger numbers on the keys

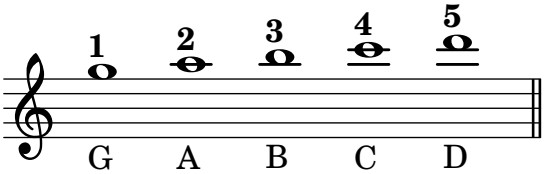
Your five notes





Right hand high G position: finger numbers on the keys

Your five notes



What is new

Ledger lines above

G5 sits just above the staff. A5 is on the first ledger line, B5 just above it, and high C (C6) on the second ledger line. D6 sits above two ledger lines.

Landmarks

Know three Cs at a glance: middle C on its own ledger line below the staff, C5 in the third space, and C6 on two ledger lines above. Read nearby notes as steps from the nearest C.

The octave move

Moving a hand up an octave changes a note on a line to the same letter in a space, and the other way round: G4 is on a line, G5 is in a space. A finger number marks the move.

Reading tips

1. In your scan, find the highest note and name it from a landmark before you start.

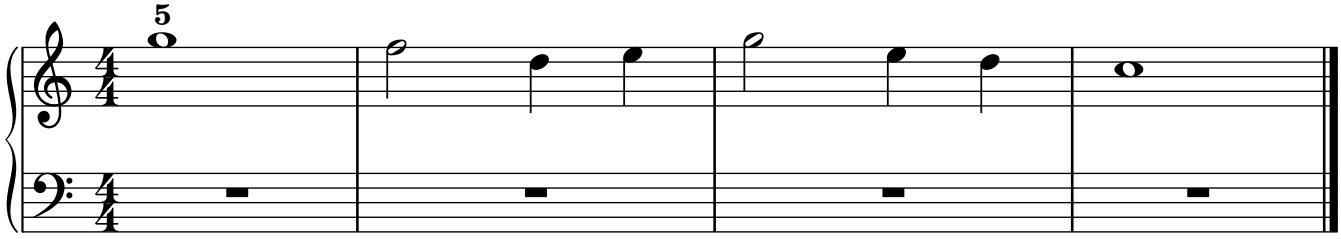
2. For an octave move, keep the same finger on the same letter and let the arm carry the hand.

3. Play high notes lightly: they sound bright and carry easily.
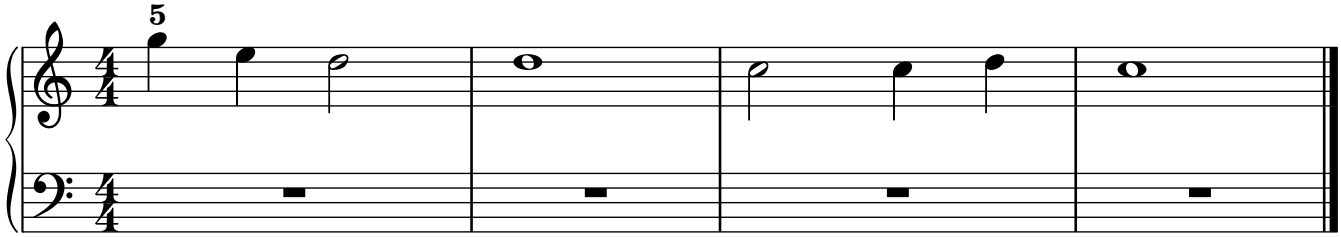
Part A: High C position ♩ = 60

Right hand in high C position: C5 (thumb) to G5 (finger 5).

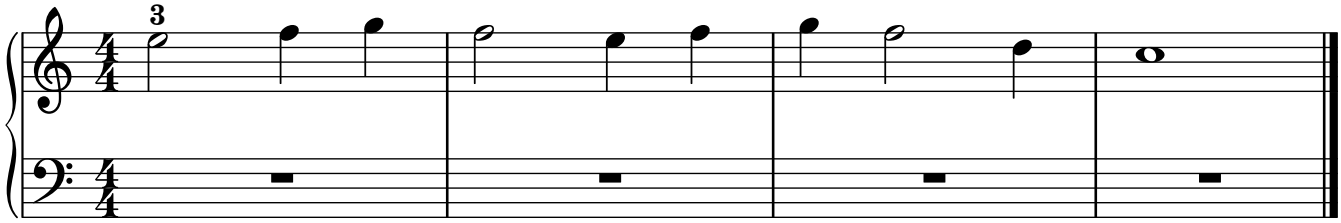
☐ **3.1**



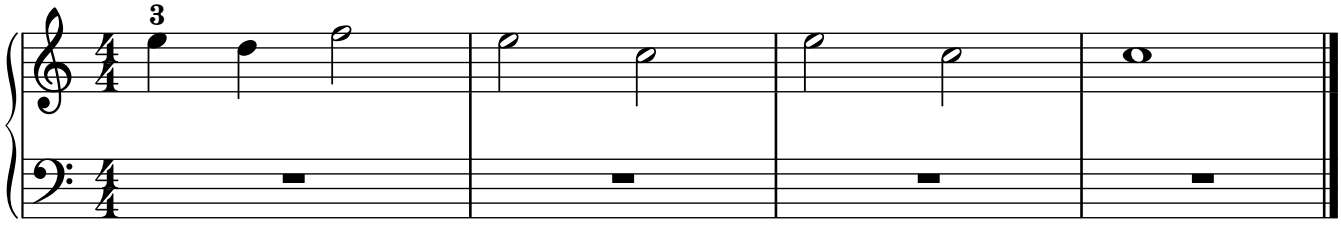
☐ **3.2**



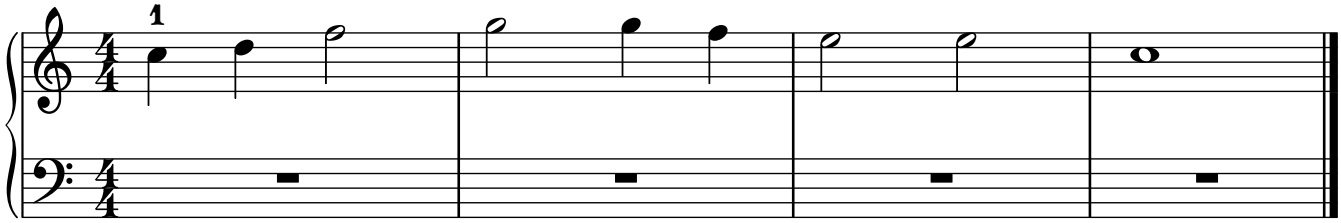
☐ **3.3**



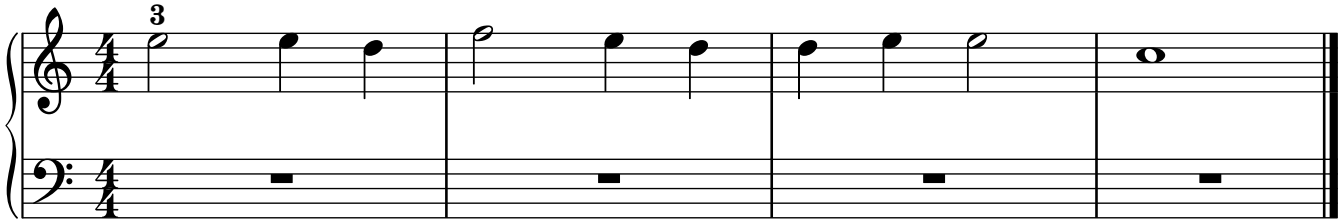
☐ **3.4**



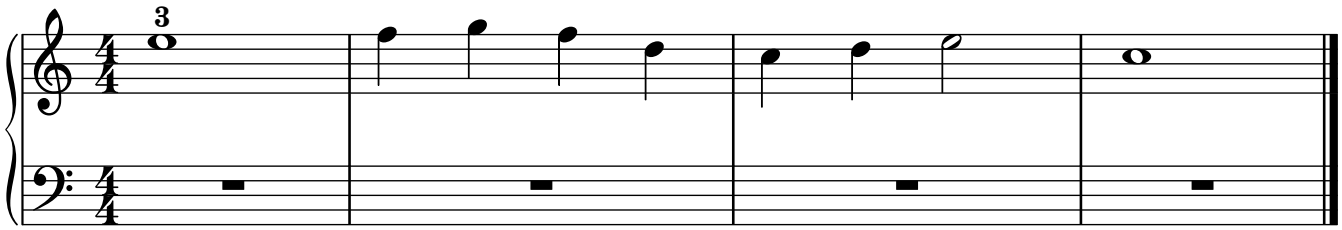
☐ **3.5**



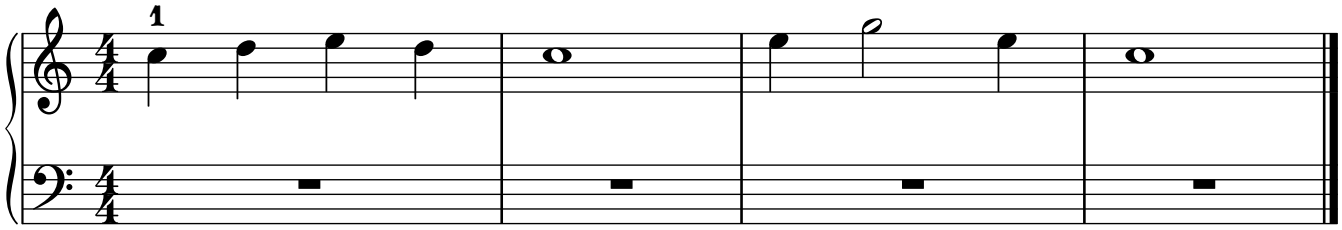
☐ **3.6**



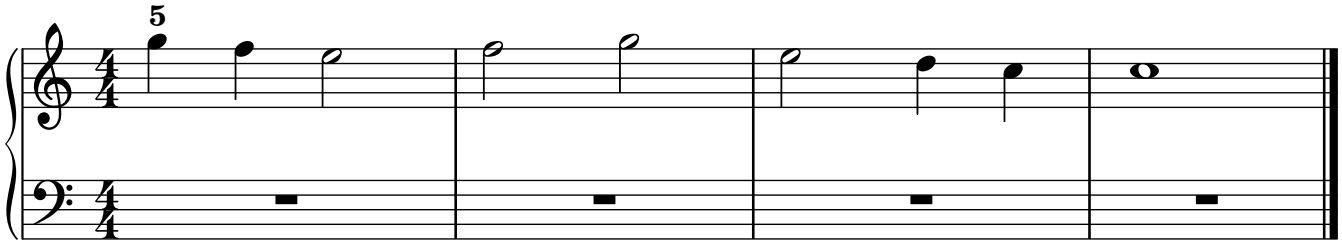
☐ **3.7**



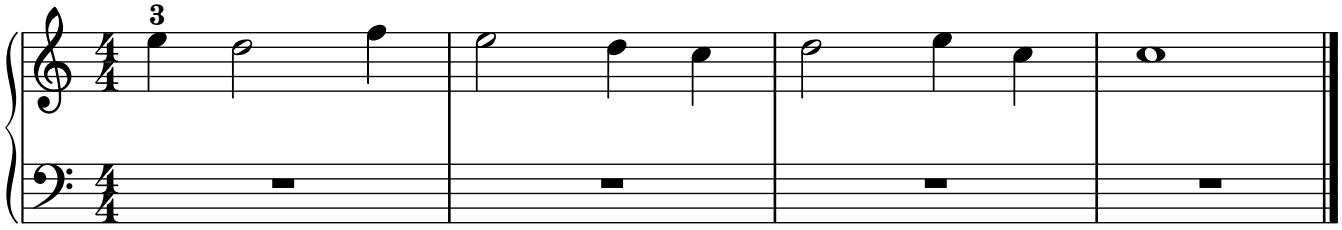
☐ **3.8**



☐ **3.9**



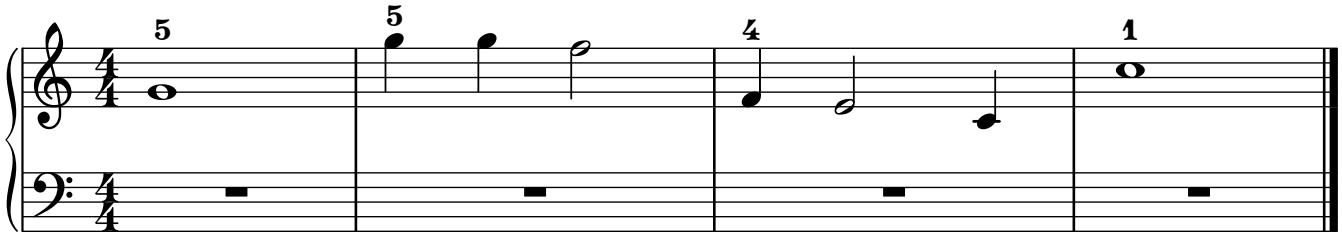
☐ **3.10**



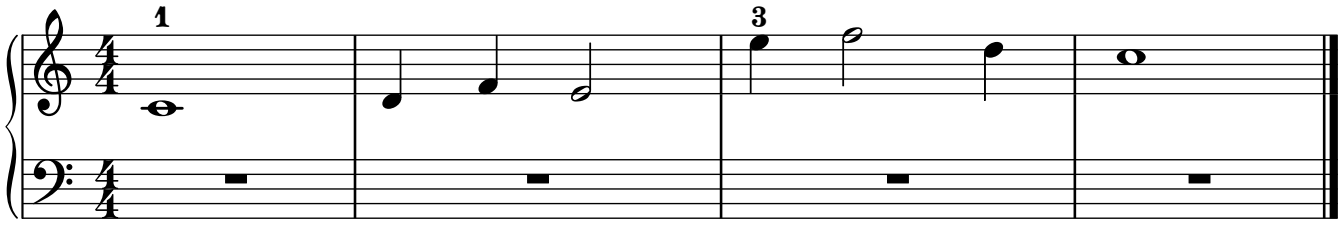
Part B: Up and down an octave ♩ = 60

The right hand moves between C position and high C position, an octave apart. Watch the finger numbers.

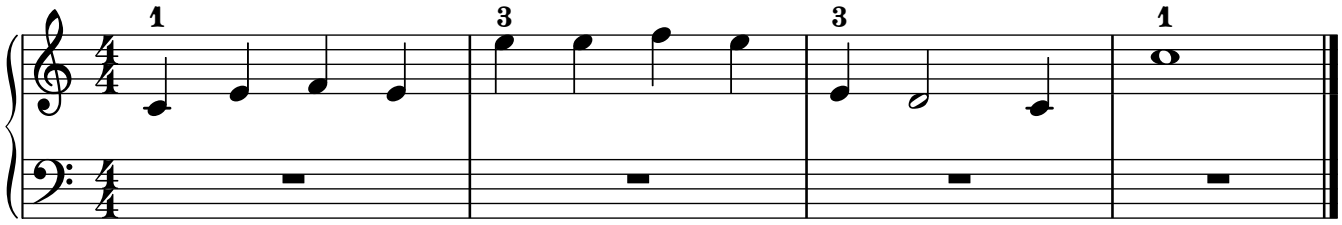
☐ **3.11**



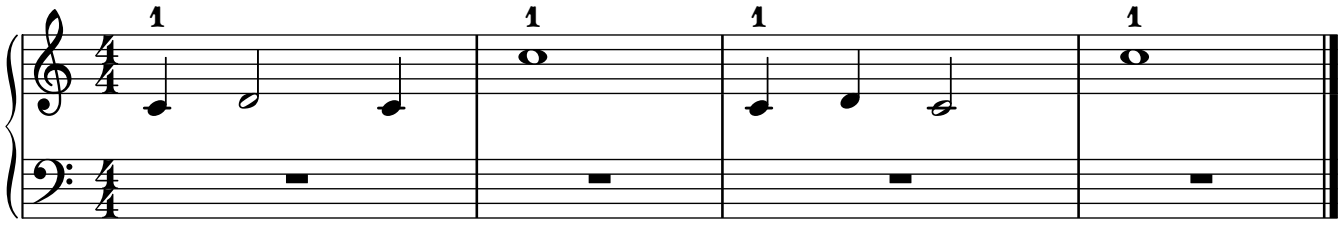
☐ **3.12**



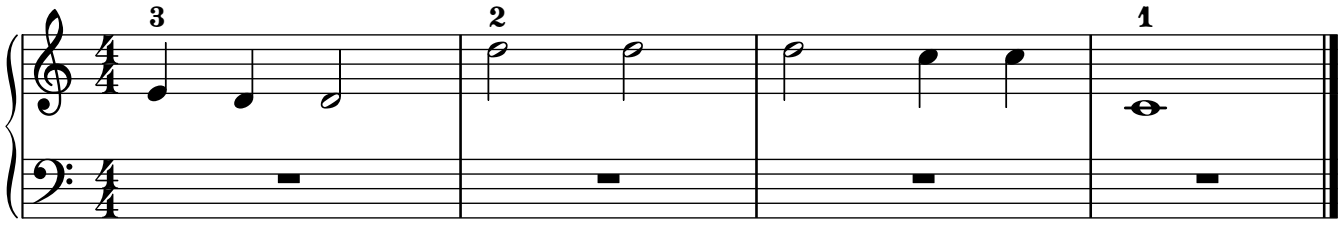
☐ **3.13**



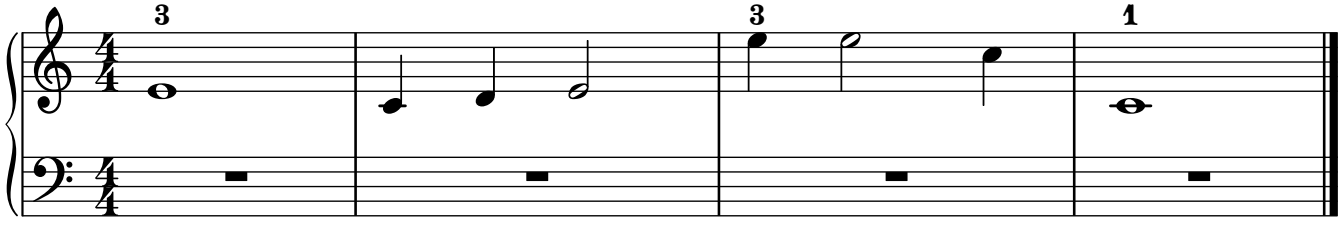
☐ **3.14**



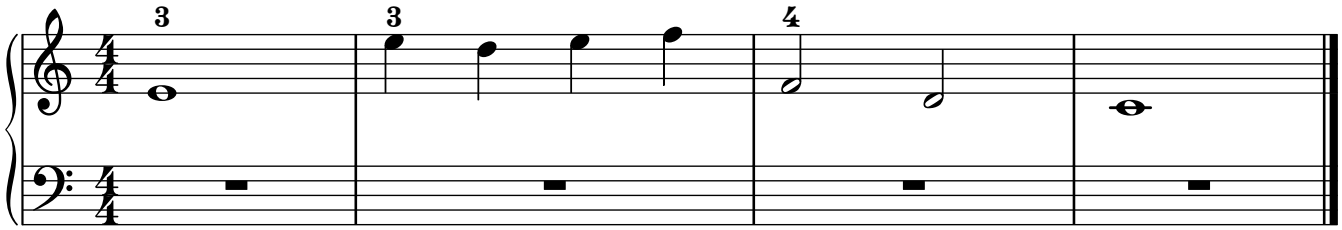
☐ **3.15**



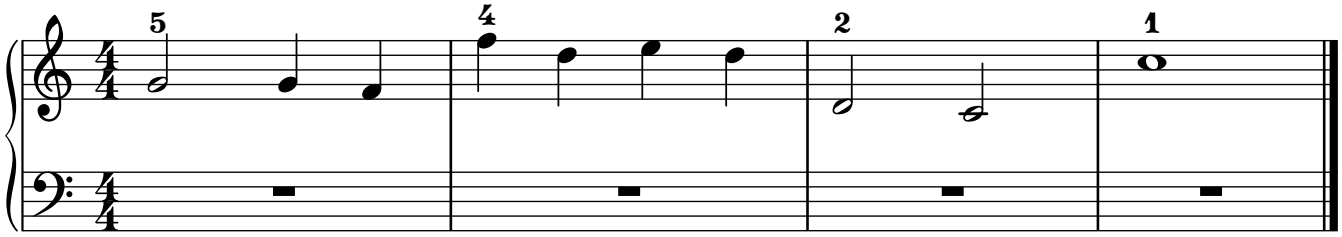
☐ **3.16**



3.17



3.18

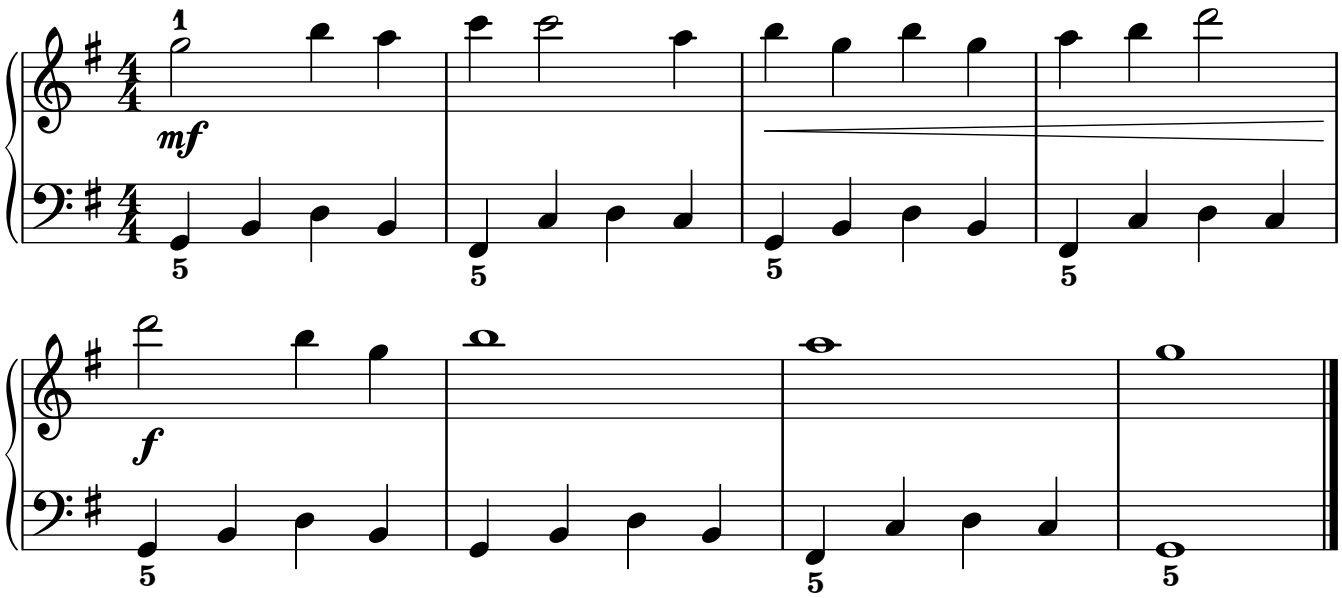


Part C: High G position over broken chords

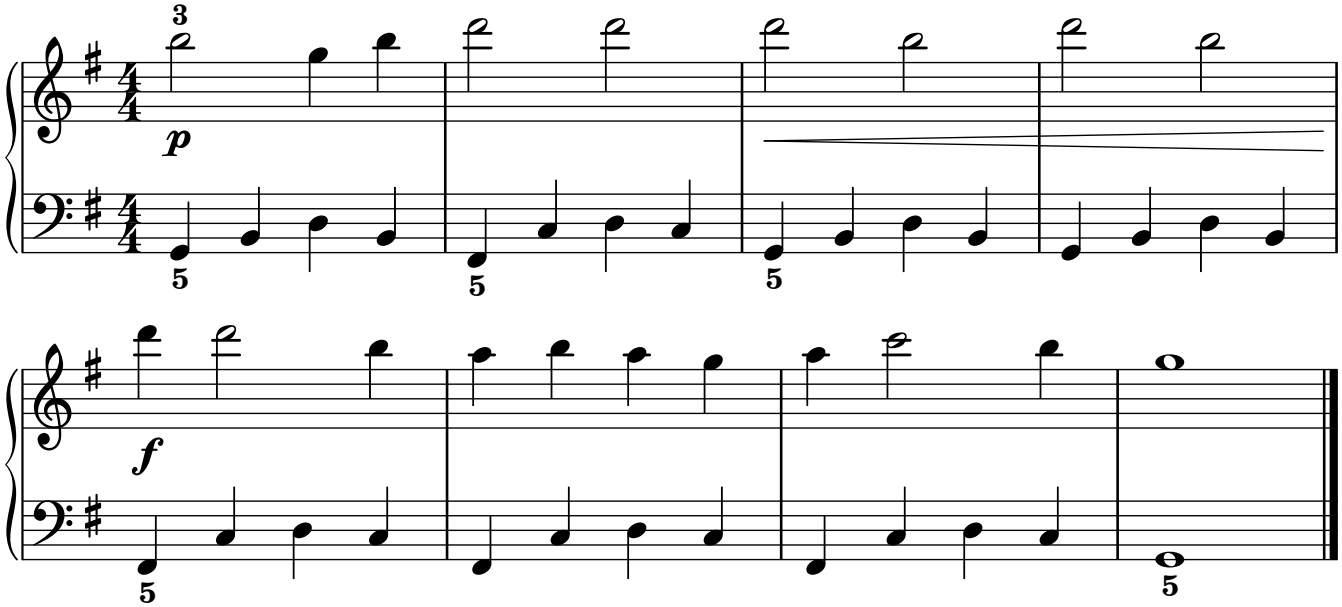
♩ = 66

G major: the right hand in high G position (G5 to D6) over broken chords.

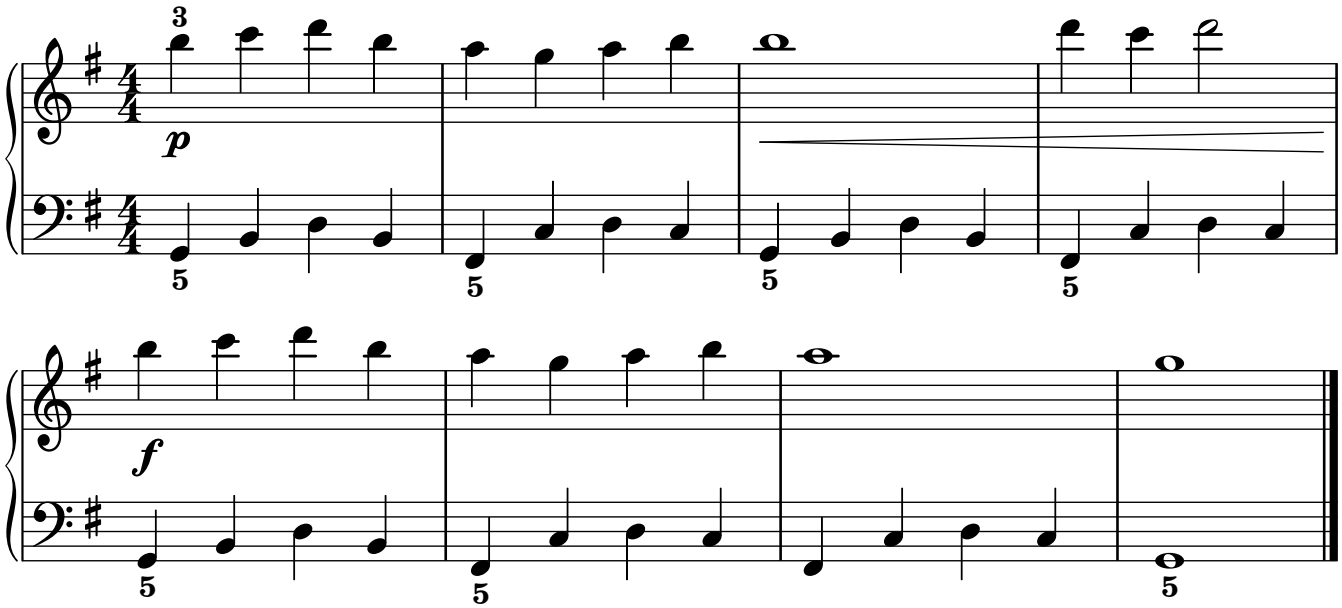
☐ **3.19**



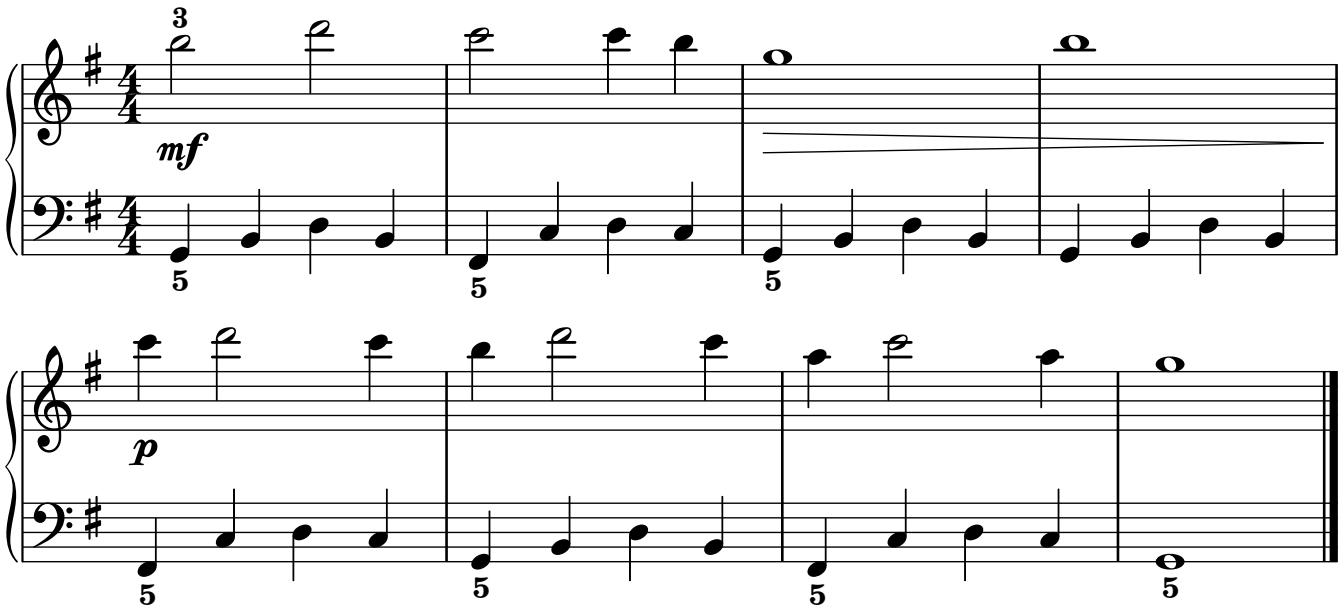
☐ **3.20**



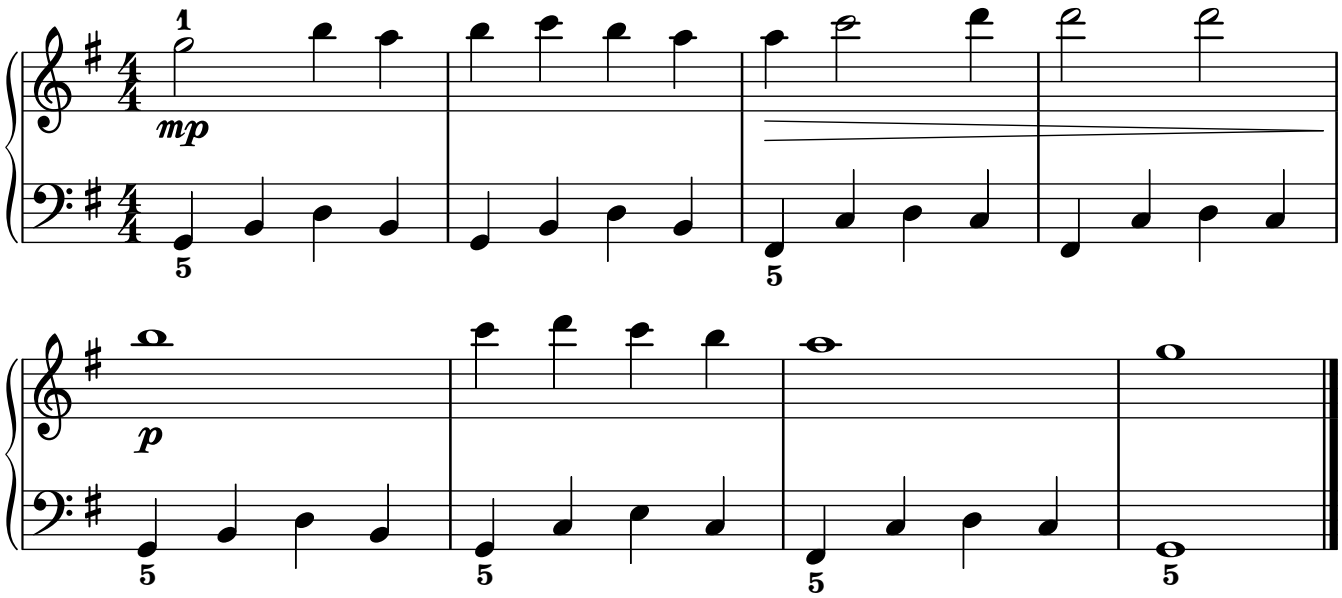
3.21



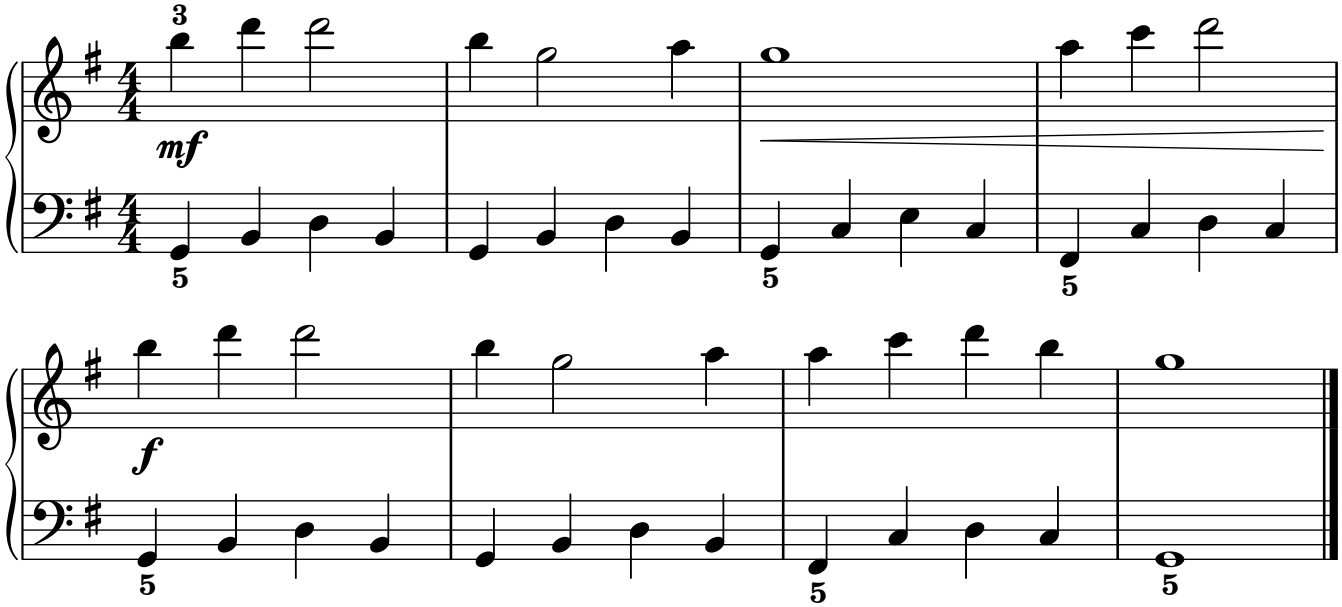
3.22



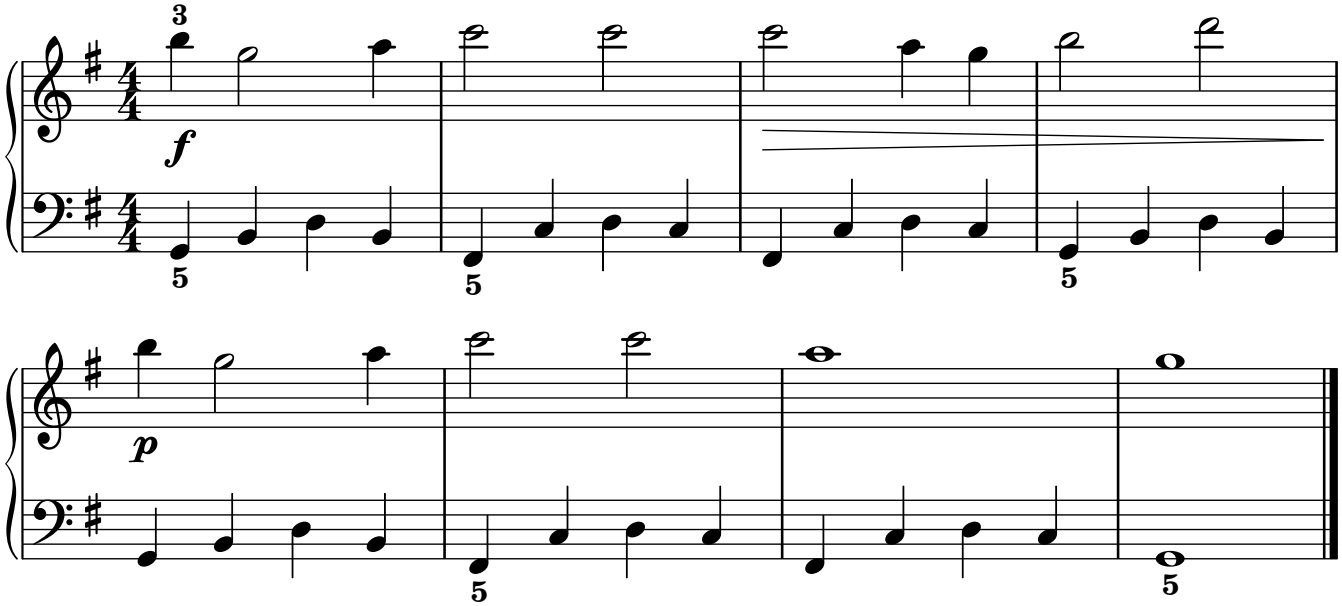
3.23



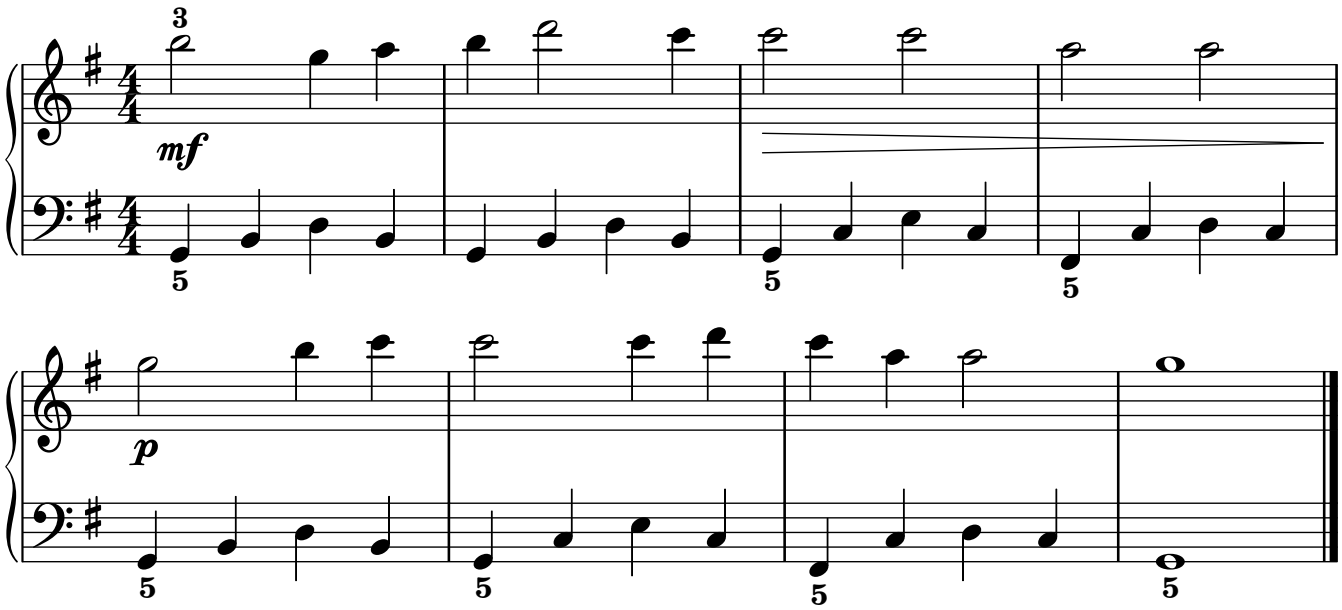
3.24



3.25



3.26

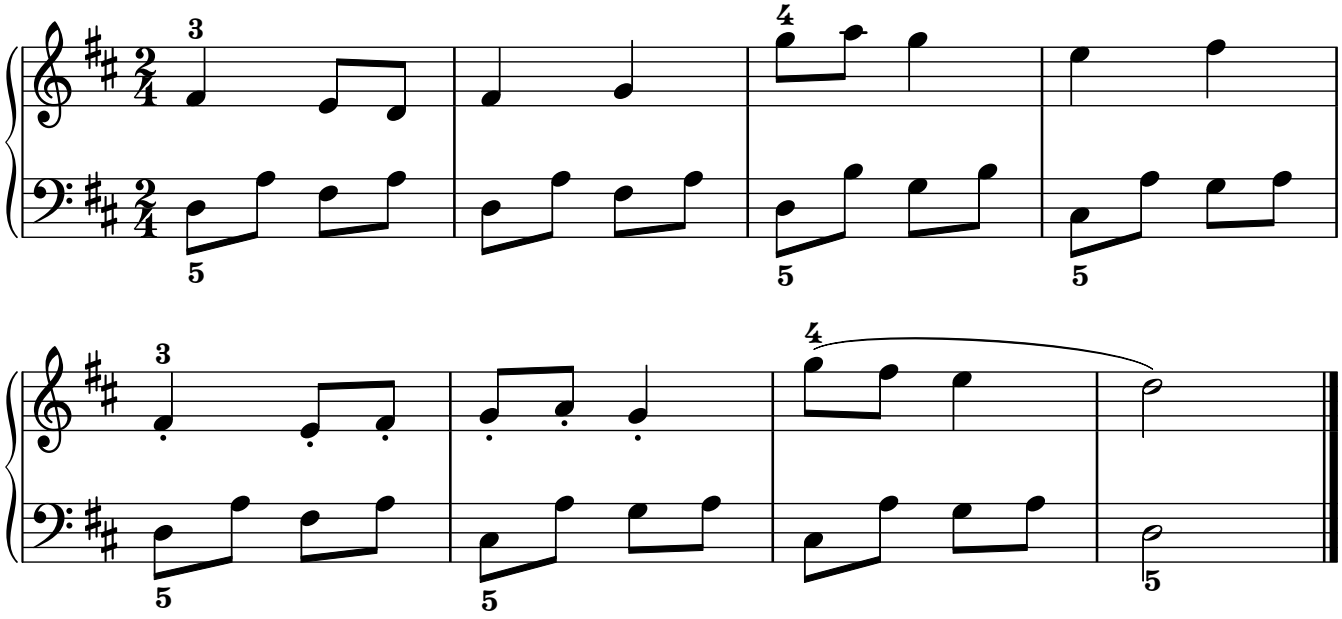


Part D: D major in 2/4, high and low

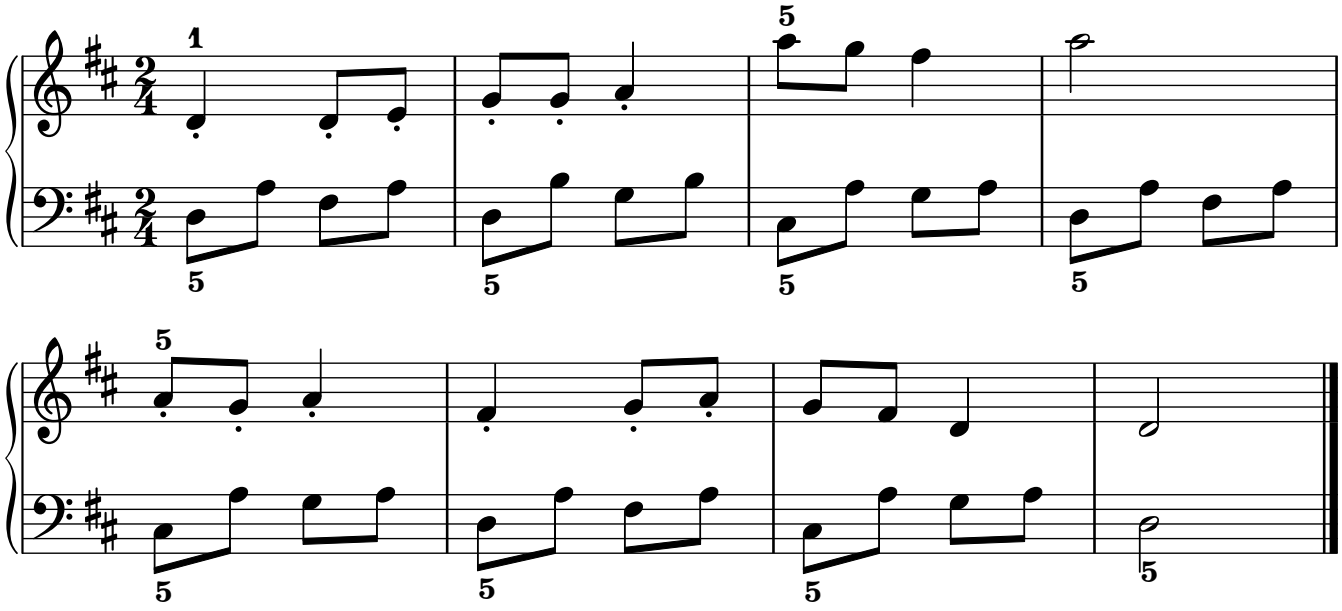
♩ = 80

D major in 2/4: the right hand moves between D position and high D position over an Alberti bass.

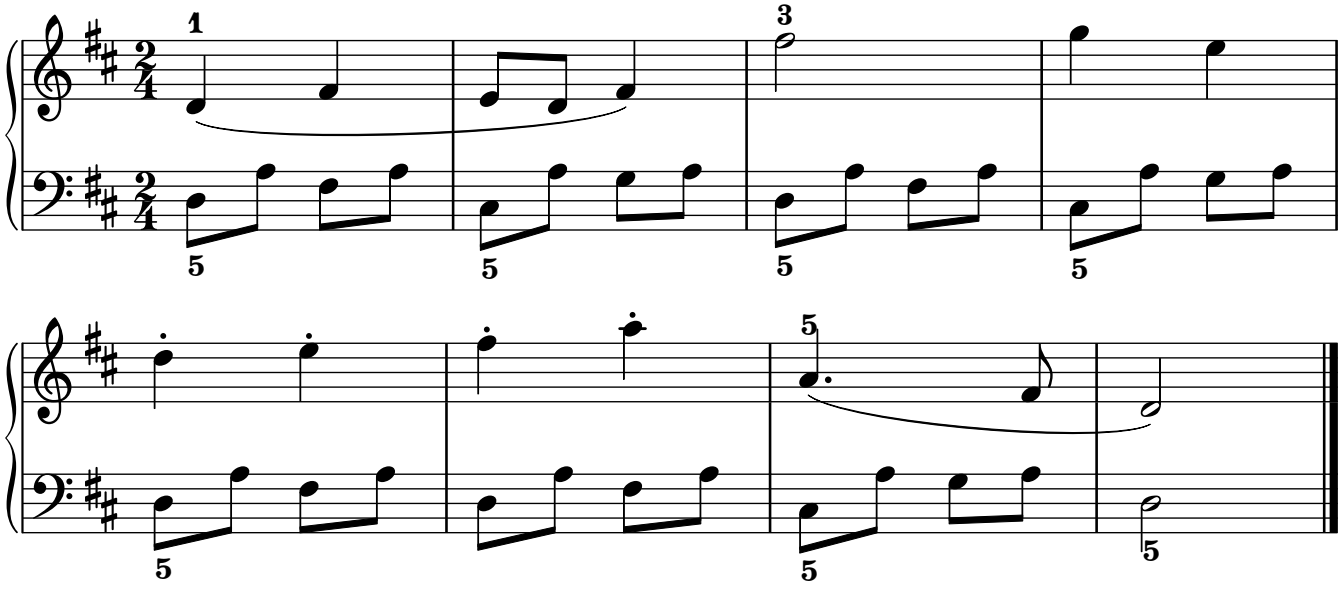
☐ **3.27**



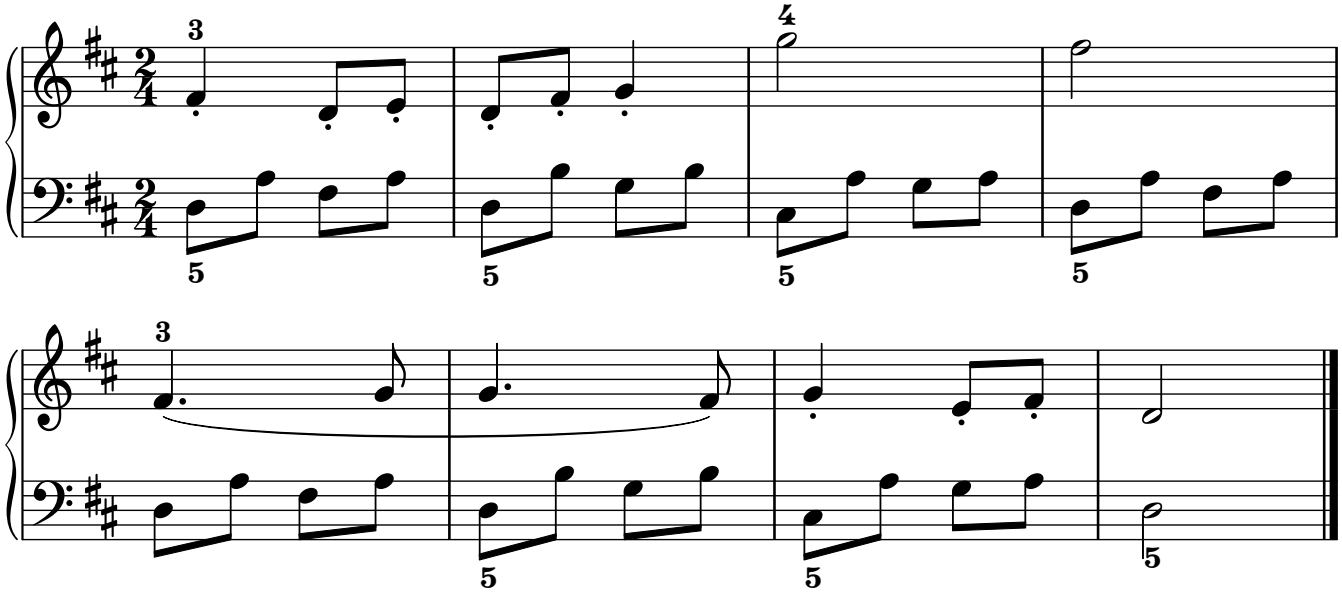
☐ **3.28**
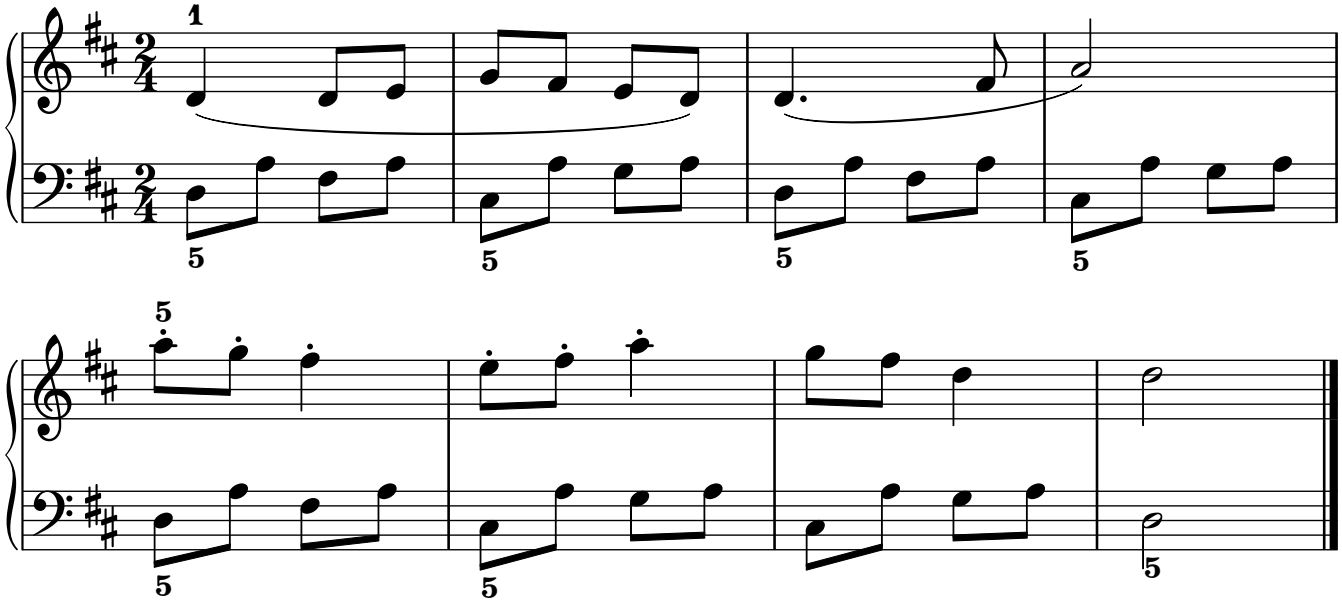


3.29



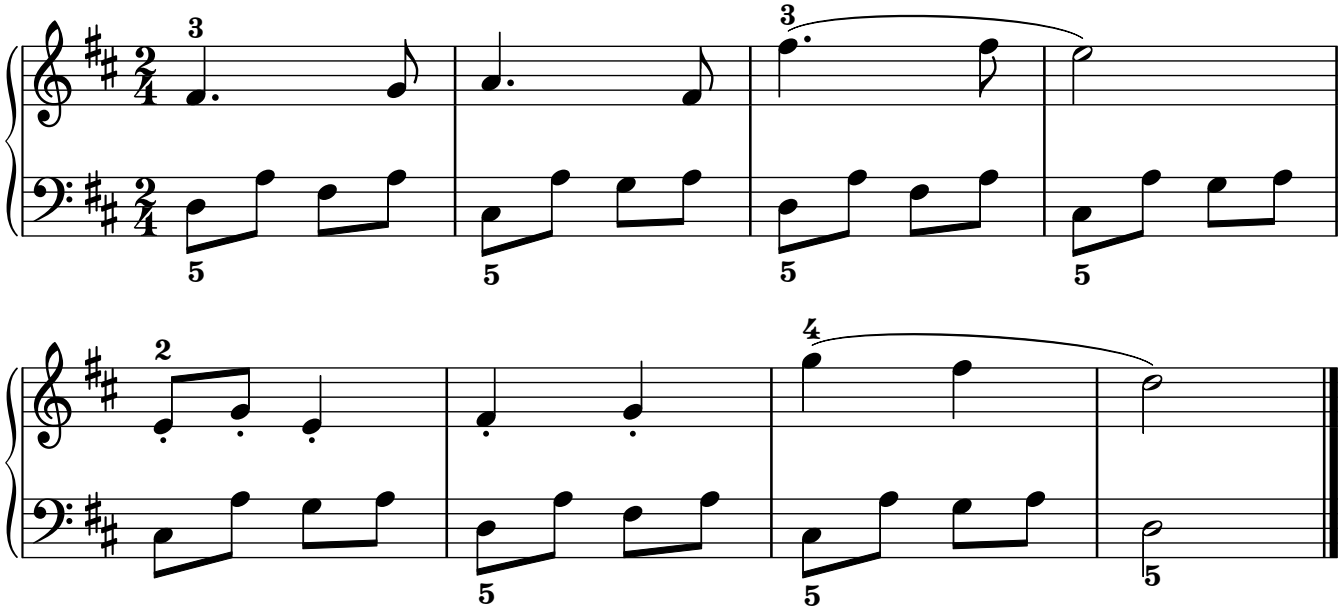
3.30



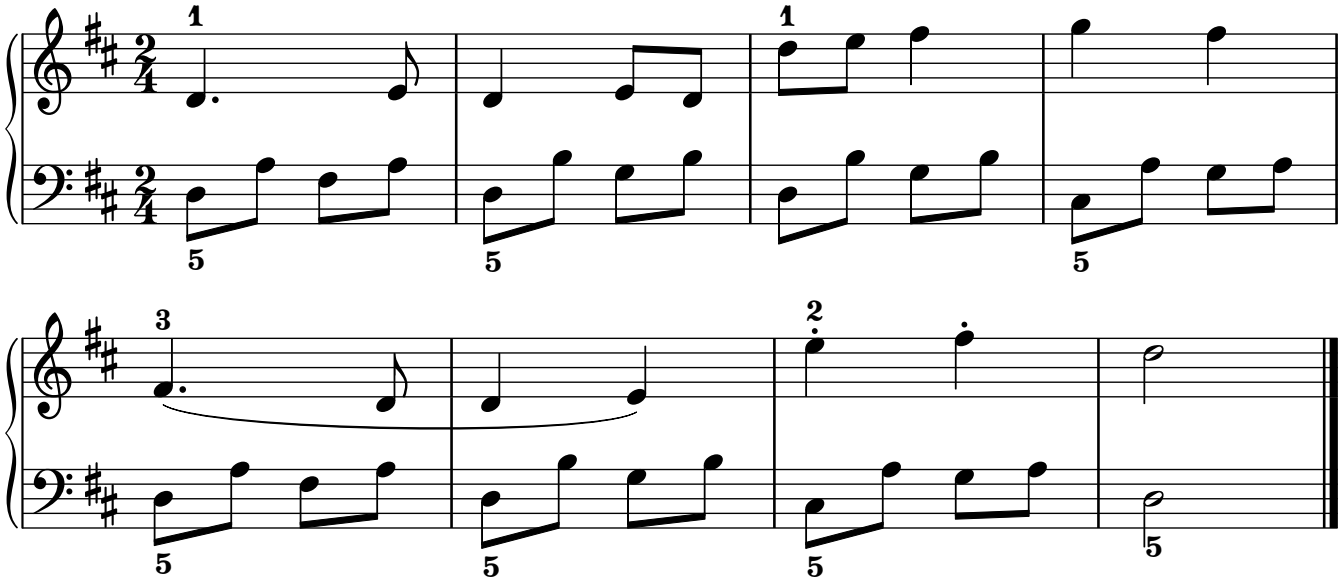
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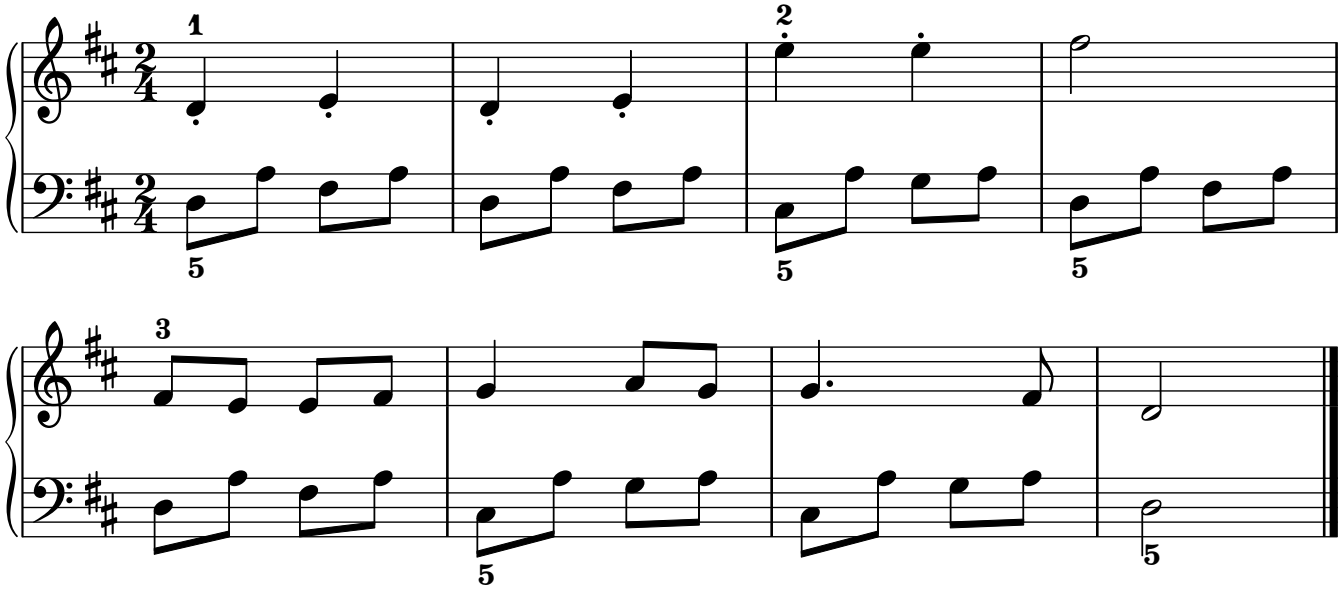


3.32



3.33



3.34
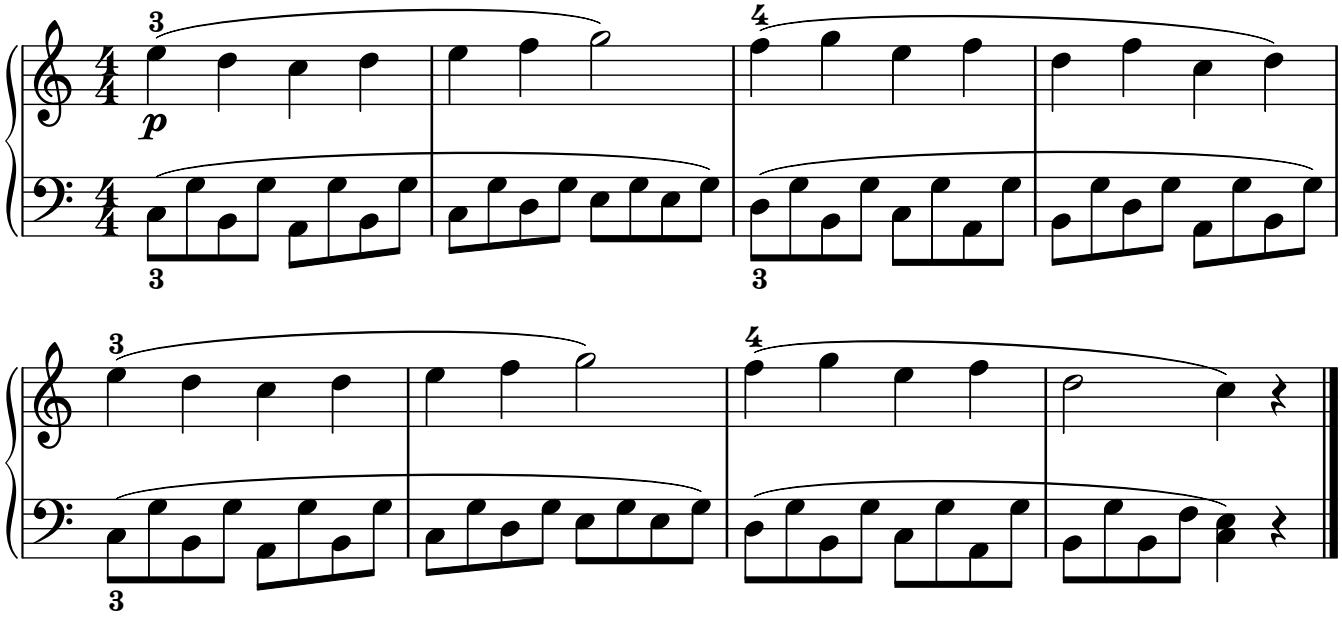


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Humming Song ♩ = 72

Robert Schumann, Op. 68 No. 3 (first section) - left hand an octave lower

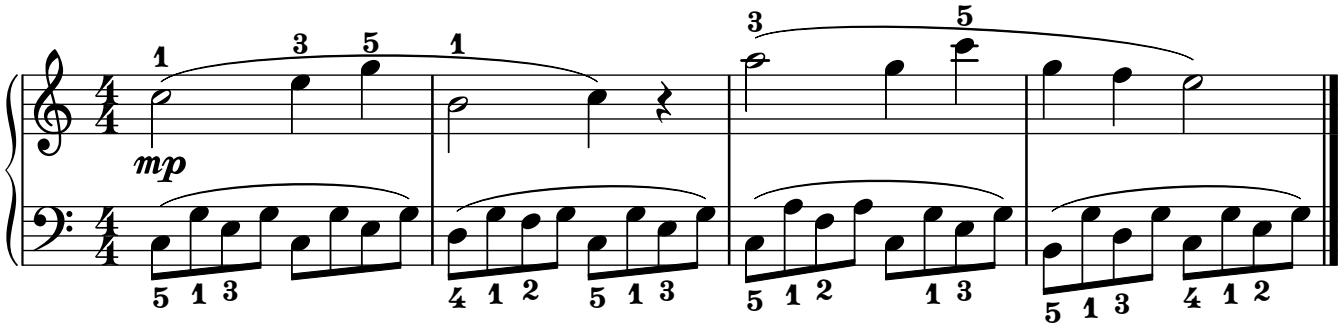
From Schumann's Album for the Young. The tune sits in high C position all the way through. Schumann wrote the left hand in the treble clef; here it is an octave lower, in the bass clef. Notes from Mutopia Project no. 651.



Sonata in C (opening) ♩ = 92

Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart, Sonata K. 545, first movement - simplified

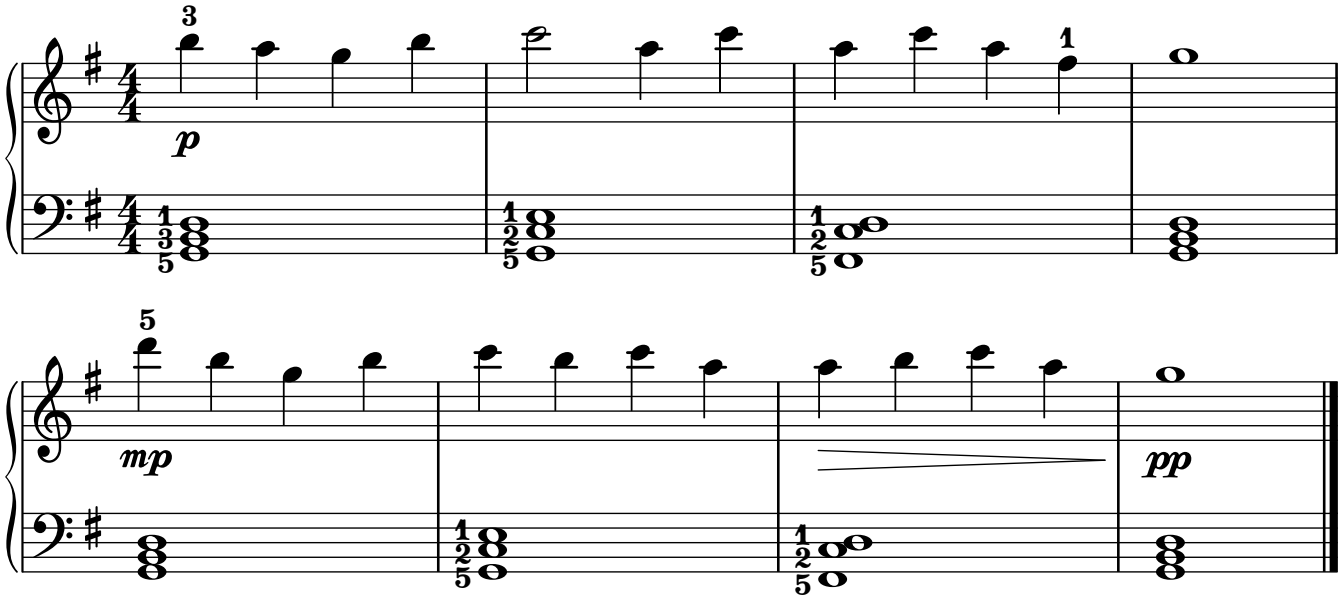
The famous opening of Mozart's 'easy' sonata. The tune climbs to high C in bar 3; the left hand plays an Alberti bass, here an octave lower than Mozart wrote it. The quick notes of bars 2 and 4 are simplified. Notes from Mutopia Project no. 998.



Starlight ♩ = 66

Original

A quiet piece in high G position: G5 above the staff up to D6. The left hand holds block chords. In bar 3 the thumb stretches down to F-sharp.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 4?

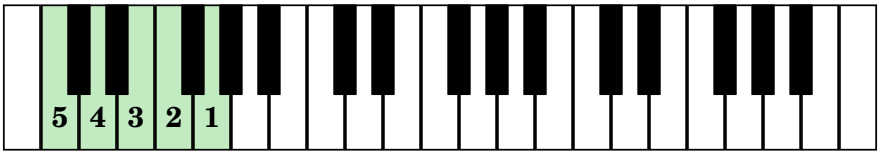
- Play five new Part B to D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Name any note up to D6 at a glance, and make octave moves without looking down.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 4.

Unit 4

Low Notes and the Middle

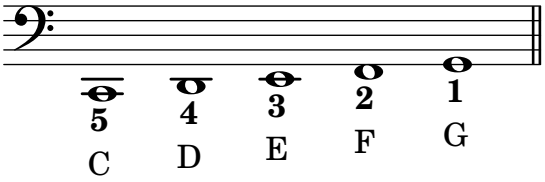
New: Ledger lines below the bass staff, down to C2; both hands near middle C

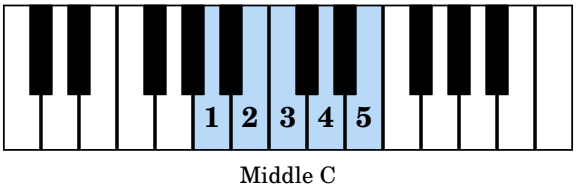
The bass staff ends at G on its bottom line; lower notes need ledger lines too. And between the two staves, around middle C, either hand can borrow ledger lines: the right hand reads notes below the treble staff, and the left hand reads notes above the bass staff. The same key can be written in either staff.



Left hand low C position: finger numbers on the keys

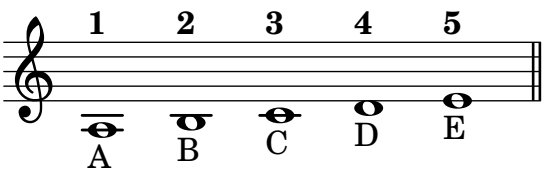
Your five notes

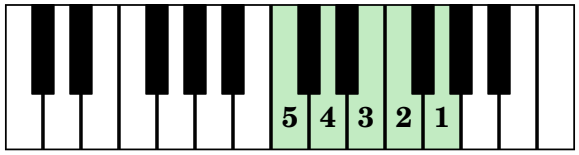




Right hand below middle C: finger numbers on the keys

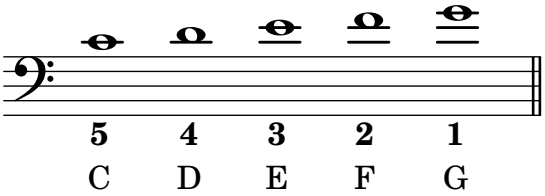
Your five notes





Left hand above middle C: finger numbers on the keys

Your five notes



What is new

Ledger lines below

F2 sits just below the bass staff, E2 on its first ledger line, D2 below it and C2 on the second ledger line. Landmark: low C (C2) on two ledger lines.

Between the staves

Middle C has one ledger line in both clefs. In the treble staff, B3 hangs just below it and A3 sits on the second ledger line down. In the bass staff, D4 sits above middle C and E4 on the second ledger line up.

The tune in the bass

When the left hand has the tune, the right hand accompanies with short chords on the off-beats. Let the left hand sing and keep the right hand light.

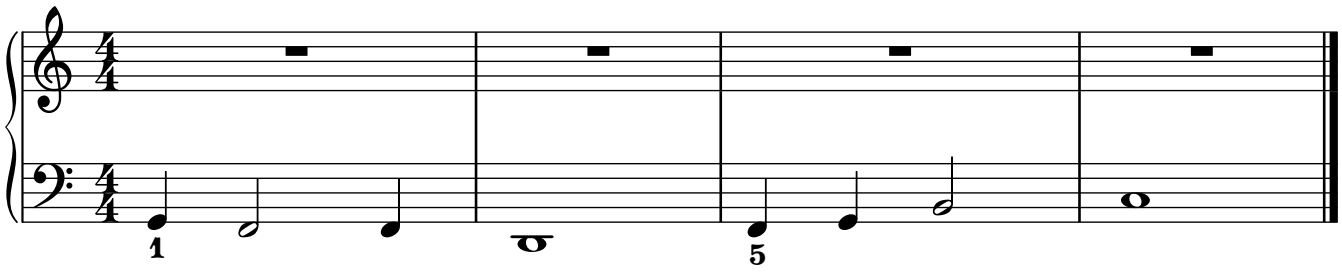
Reading tips

1. Find the lowest note first and name it from low C or middle C.
2. Near middle C, check which staff a note is in before you decide which hand plays it.
3. When the right hand plays after the beat, count out loud and let the left hand land on the beat.

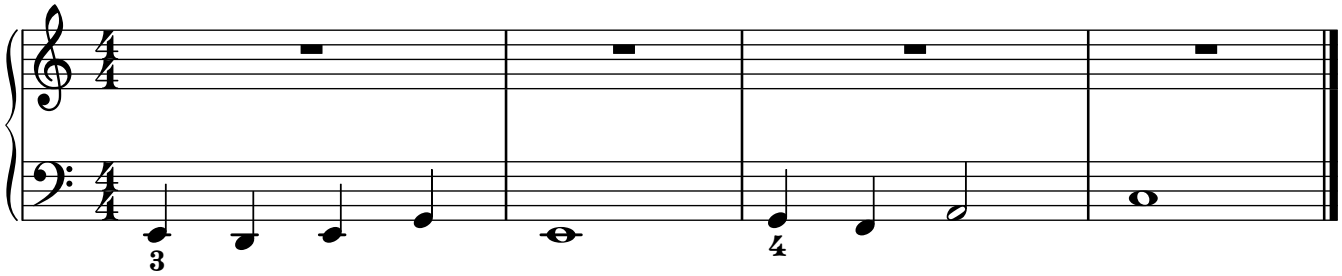
Part A: The left hand down low ♩= 60

The left hand down low: low C position (C2 to G2) and low F position (F2 to C3).

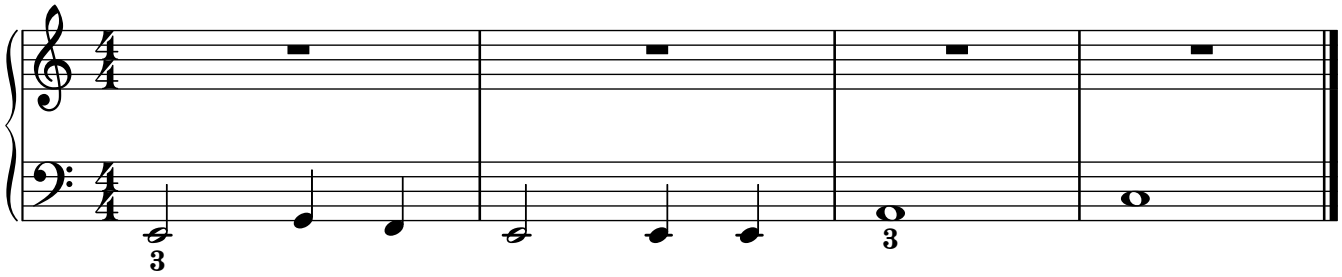
☐ **4.1**



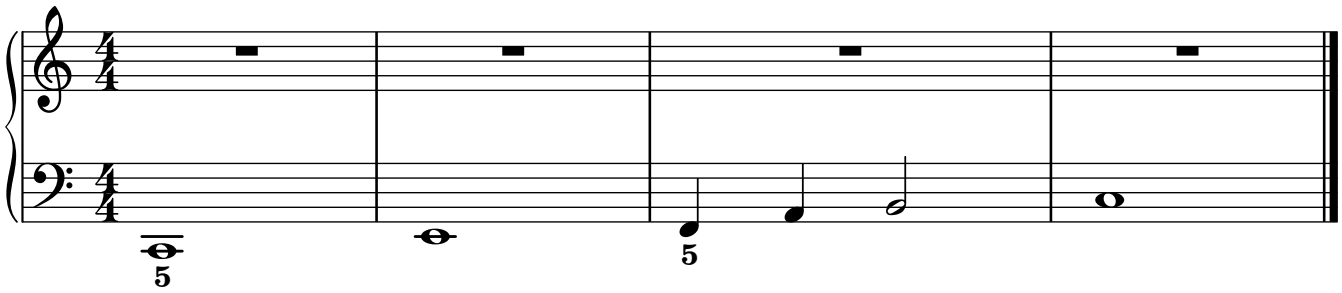
☐ **4.2**



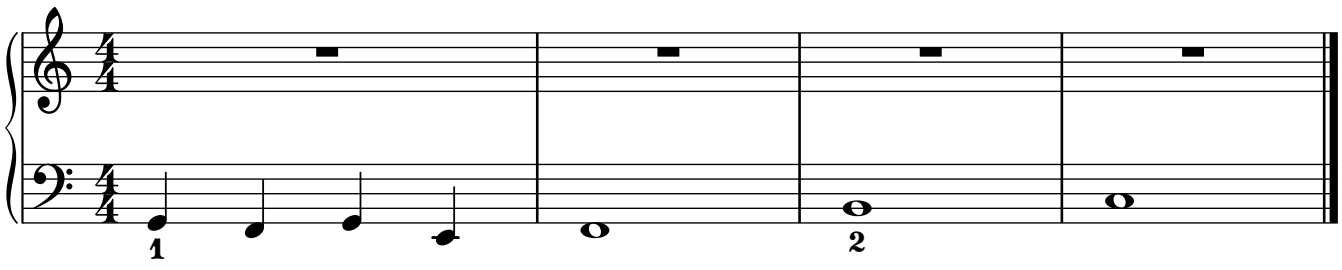
☐ **4.3**



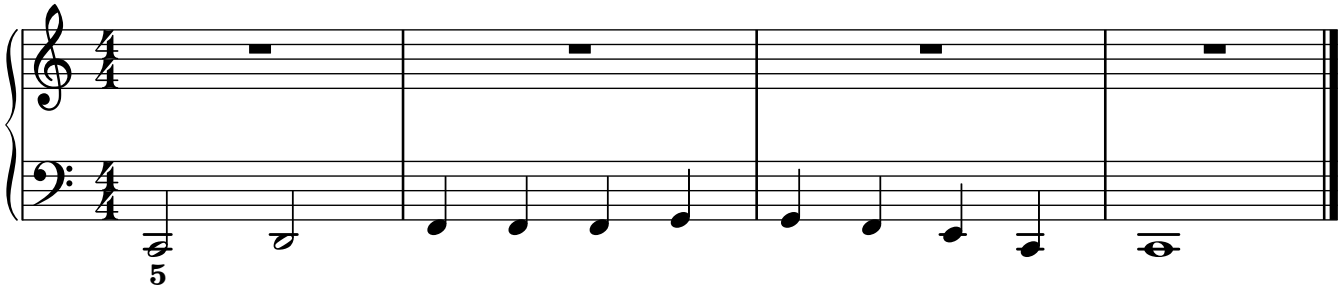
☐ **4.4**



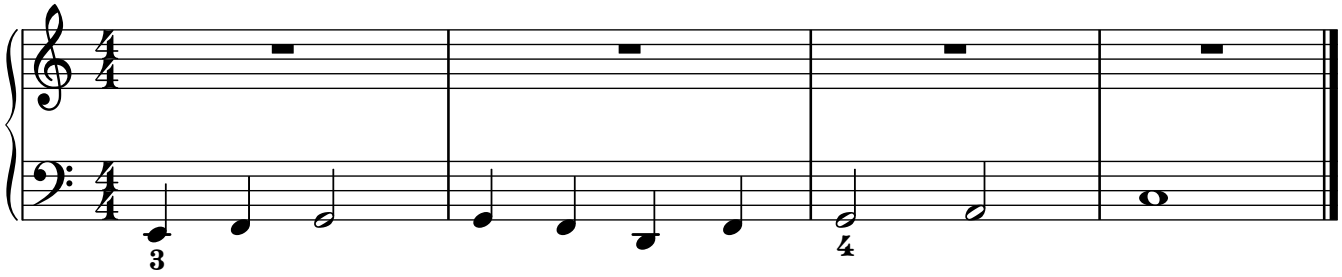
☐ **4.5**



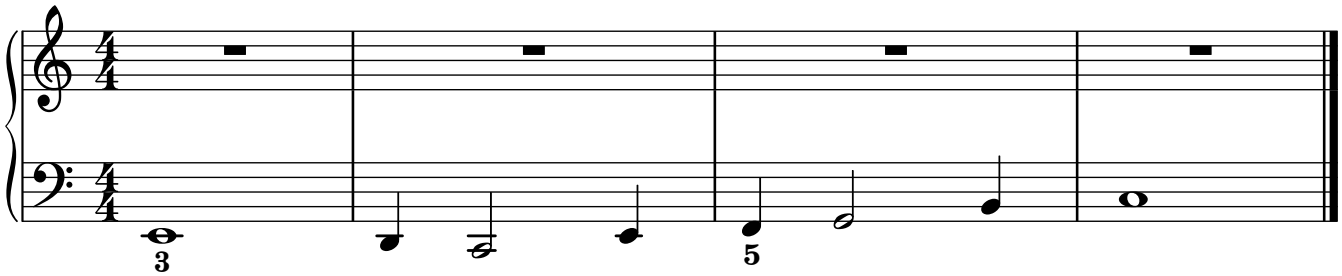
4.6



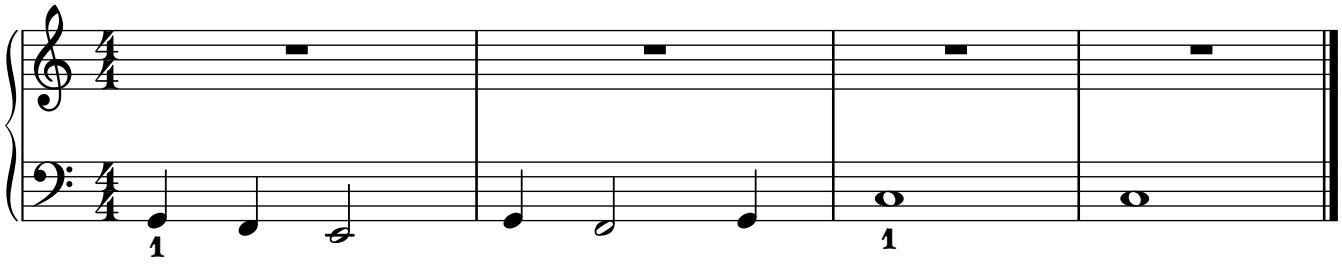
4.7



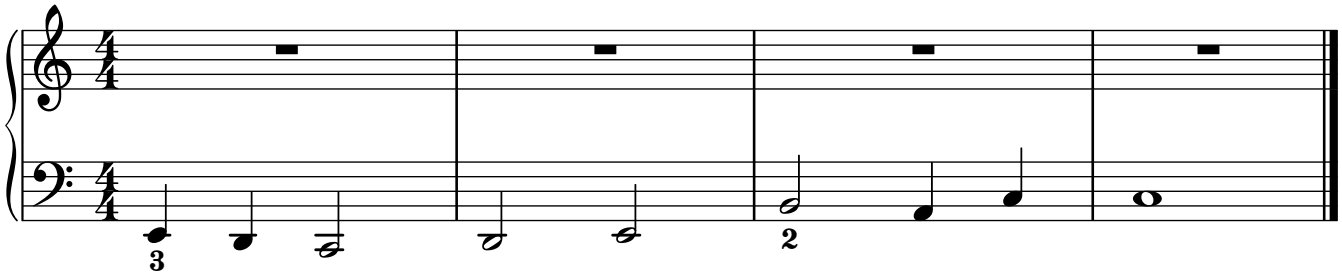
4.8



4.9



4.10
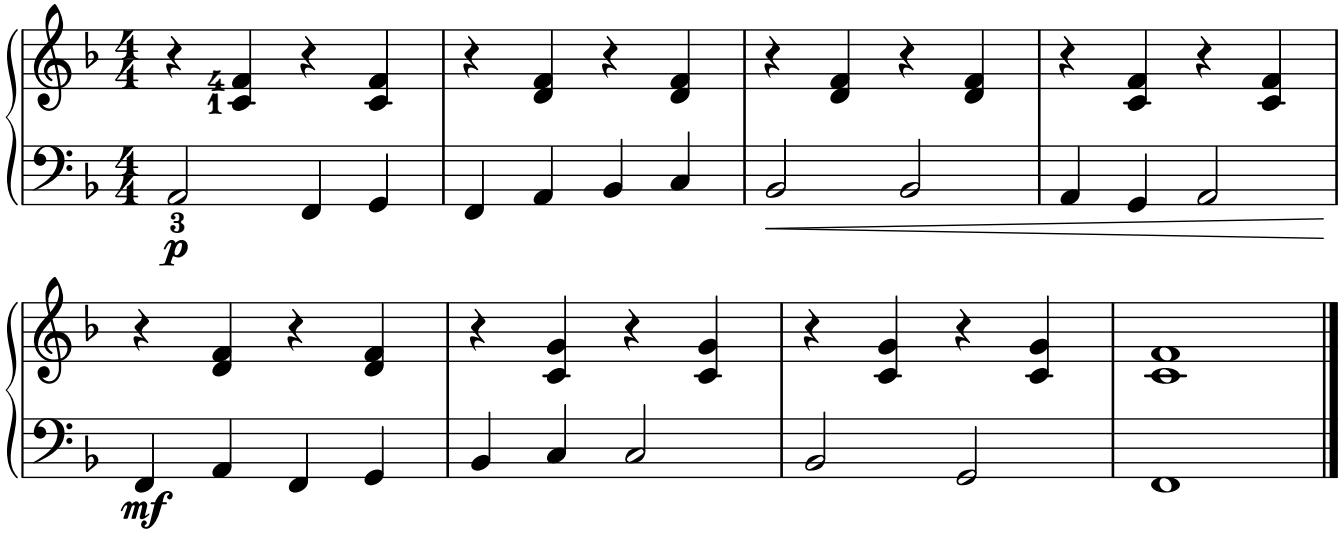


Part B: The tune in the bass, chords above
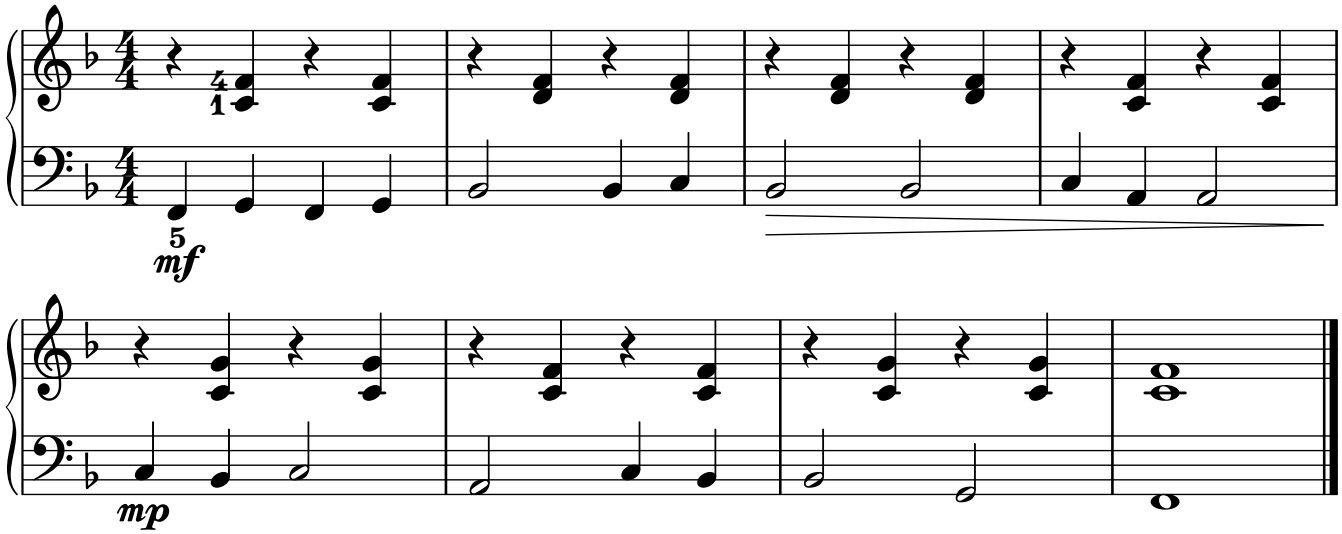
♩ = 80

F major: the tune in the left hand, low F position; the right hand plays chords on beats 2 and 4.
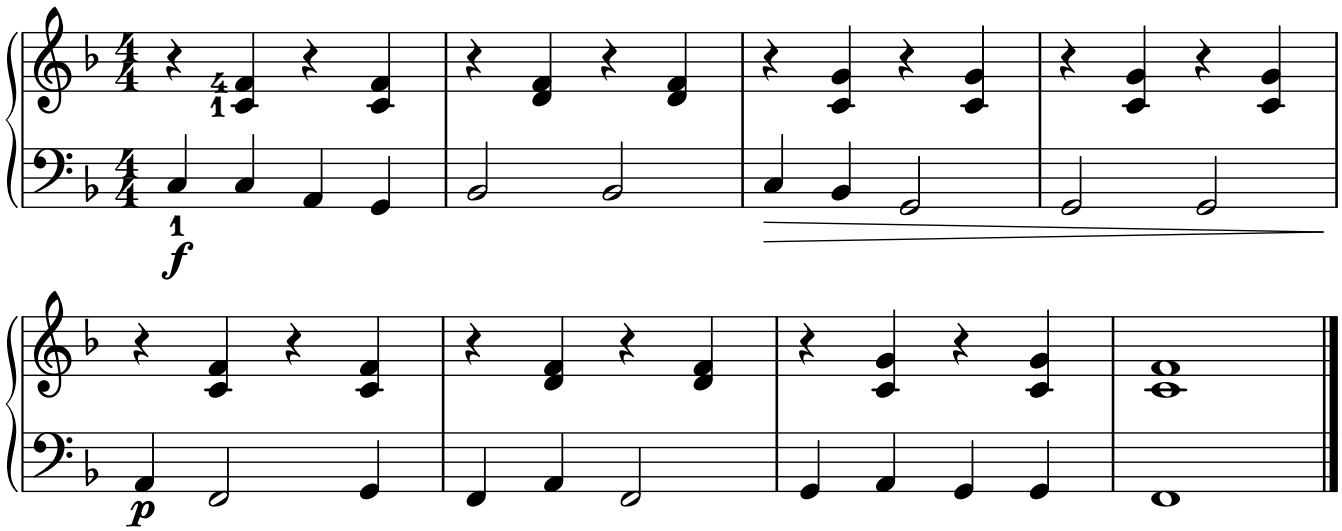
☐ **4.11**
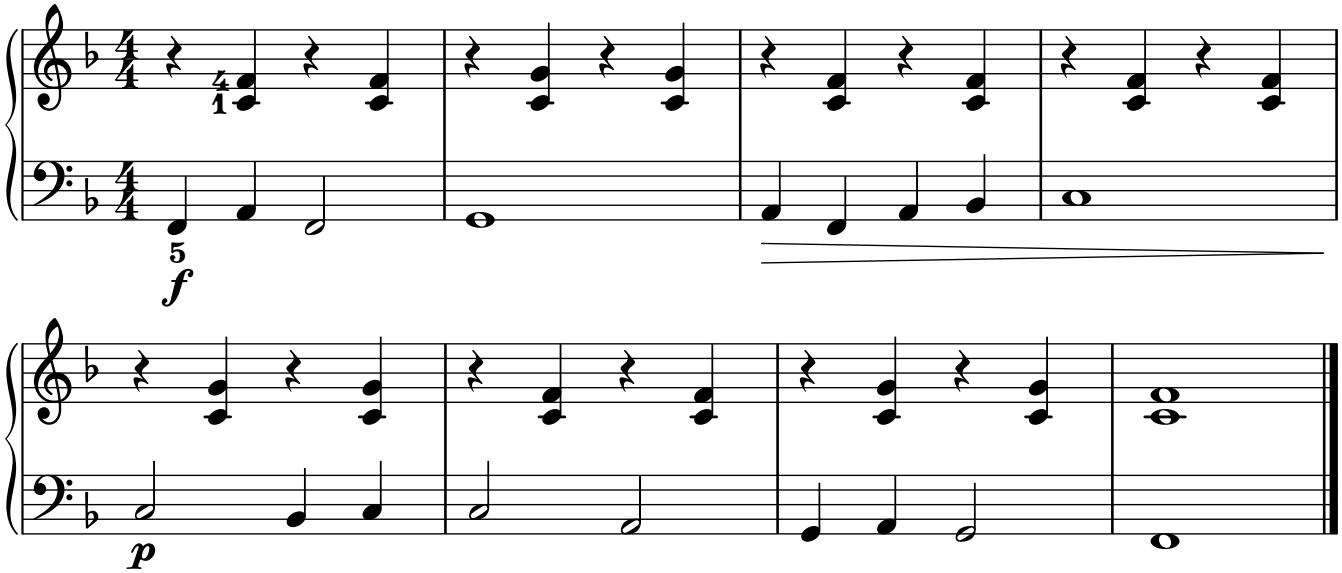


☐ **4.12**
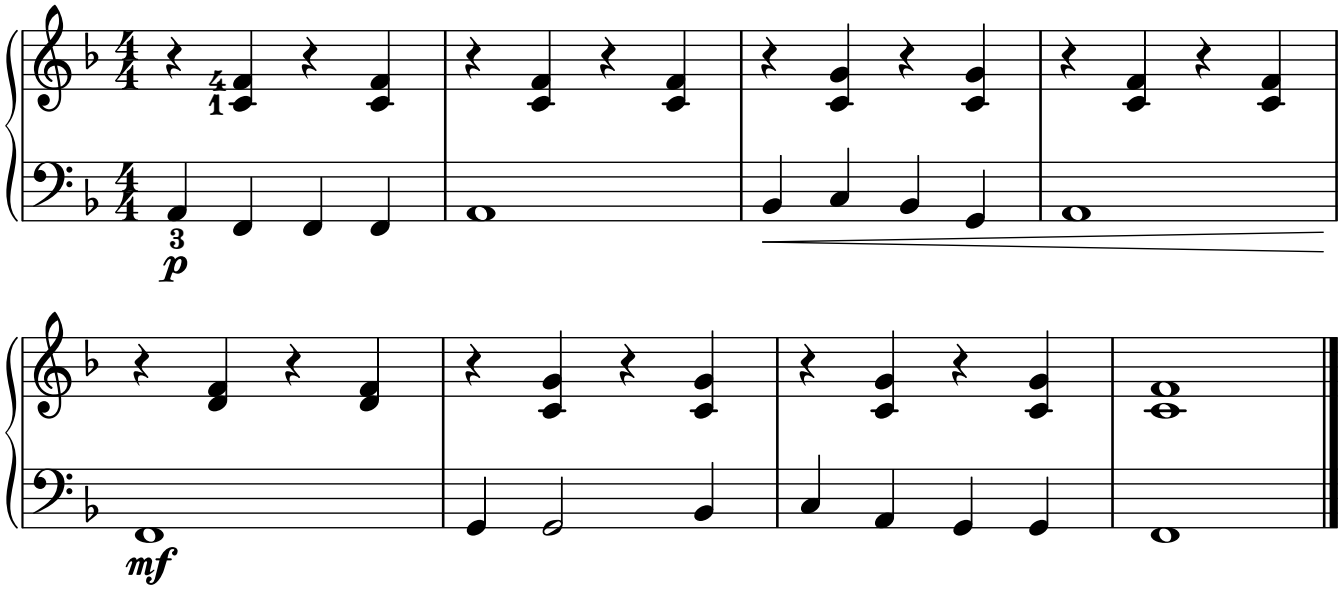


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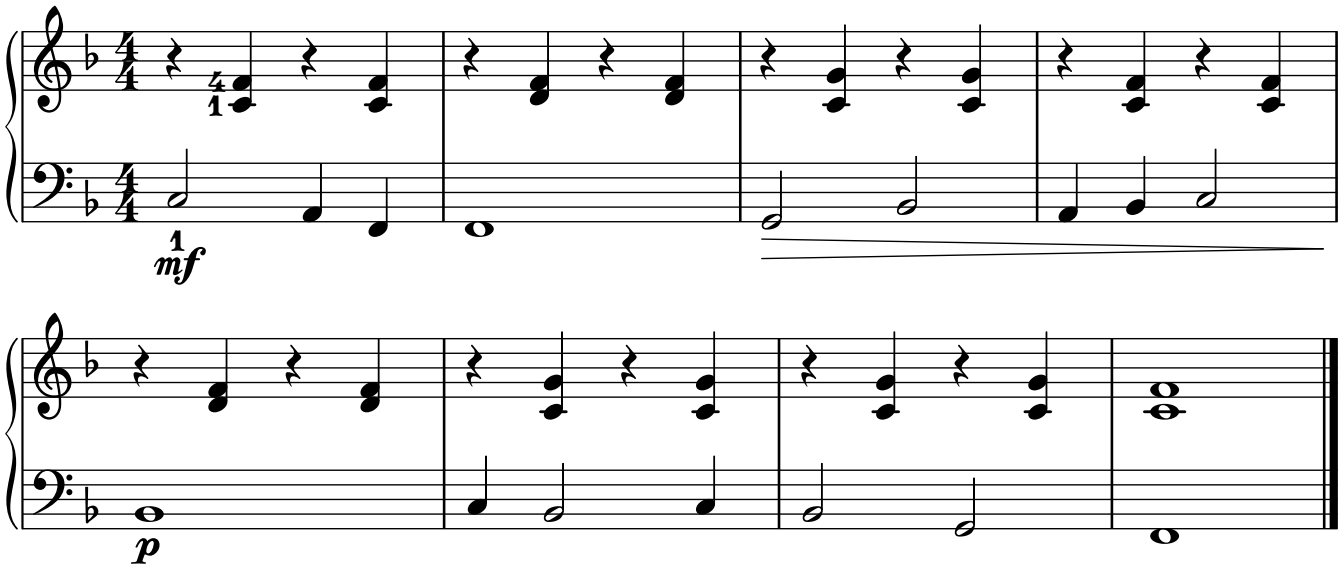


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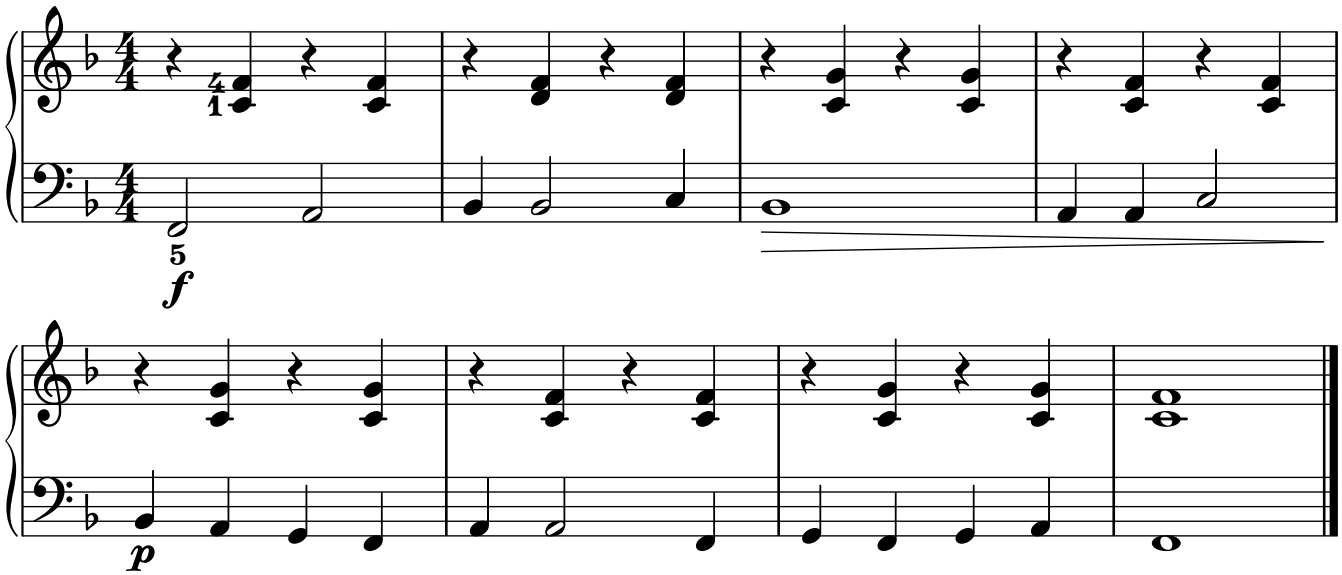
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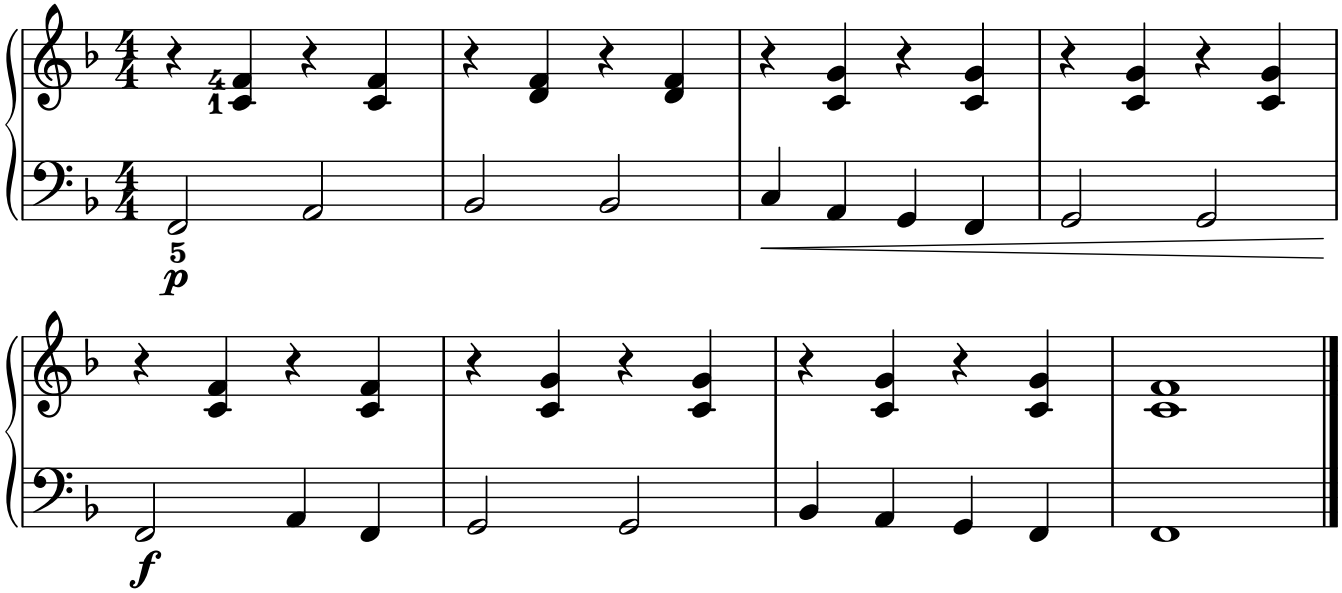


4.16



4.17



4.18

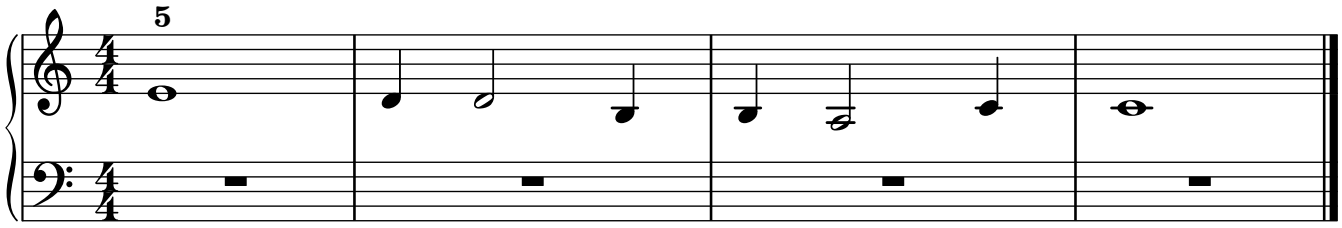


Part C: The right hand below middle C
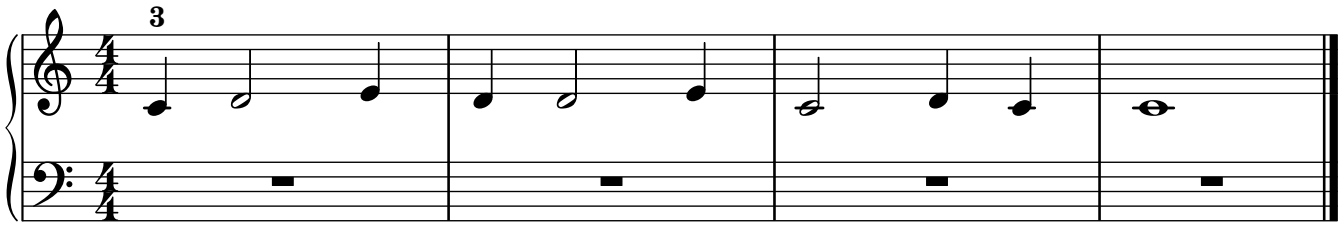
♩ = 60

The right hand below middle C, from A3 up to E4.

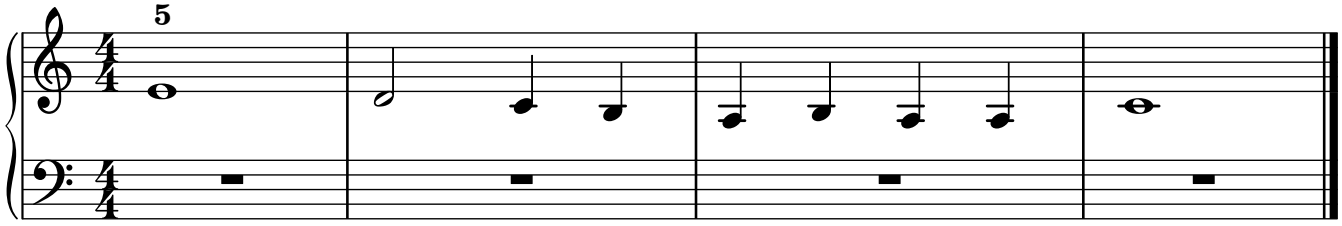
☐ **4.19**



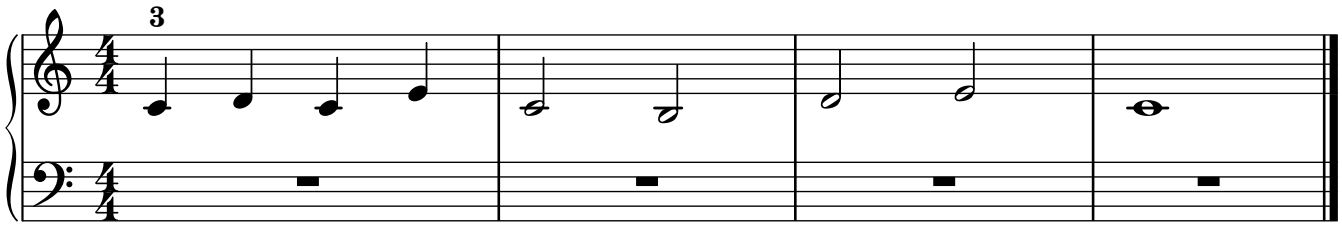
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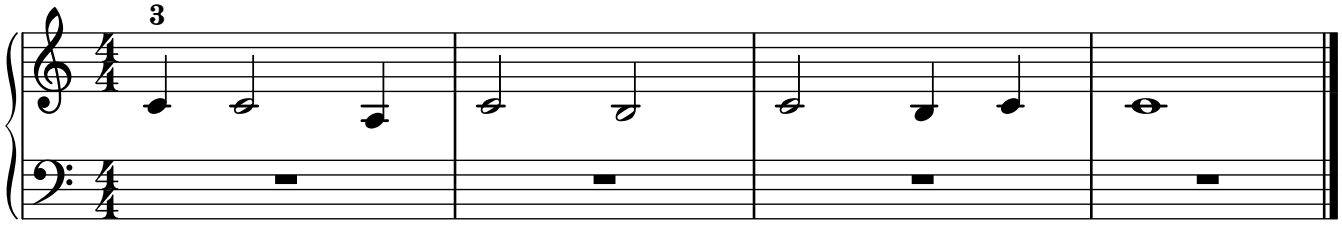
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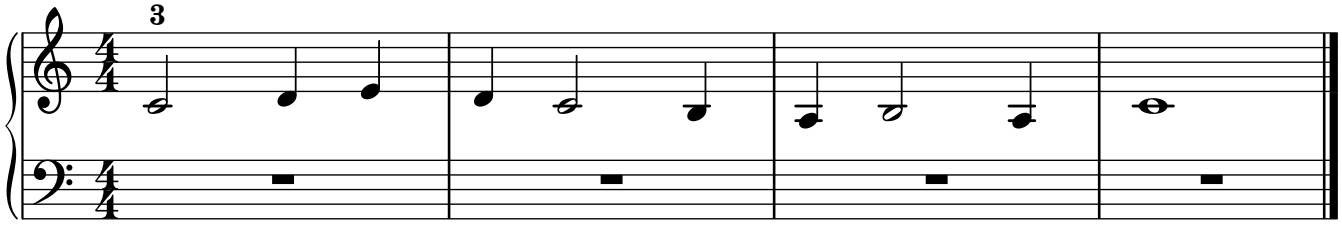
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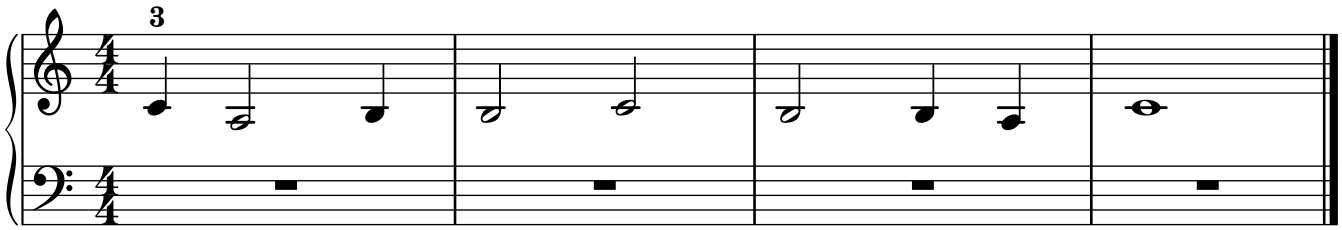
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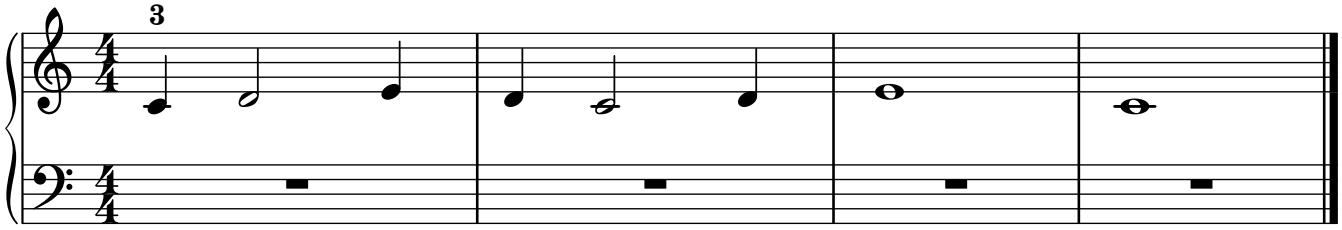
☐ **4.24**



4.25



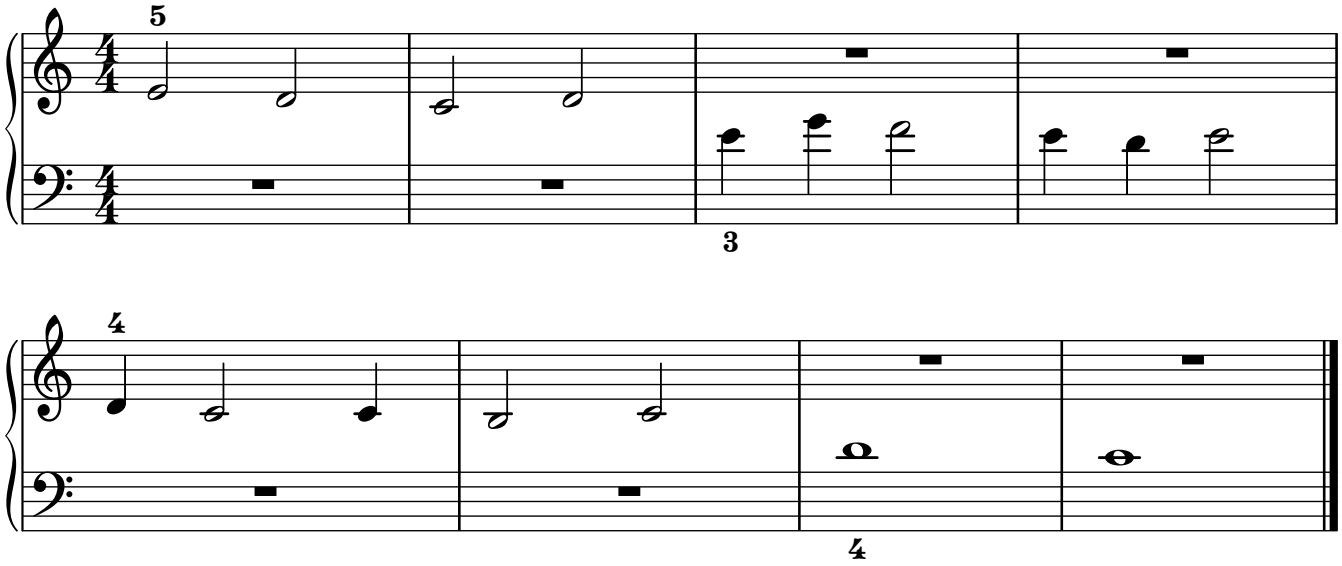
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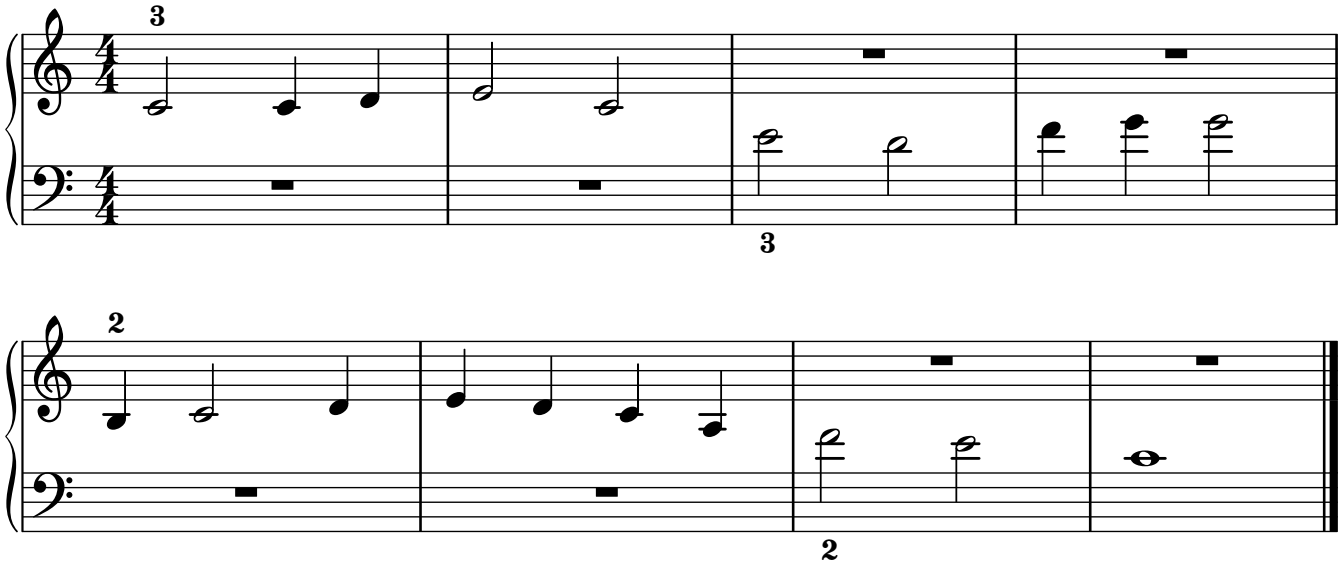
Part D: Both hands around middle C ♩ = 66

Both hands near middle C, taking turns: the right hand below it in the treble staff, the left hand above it in the bass staff.

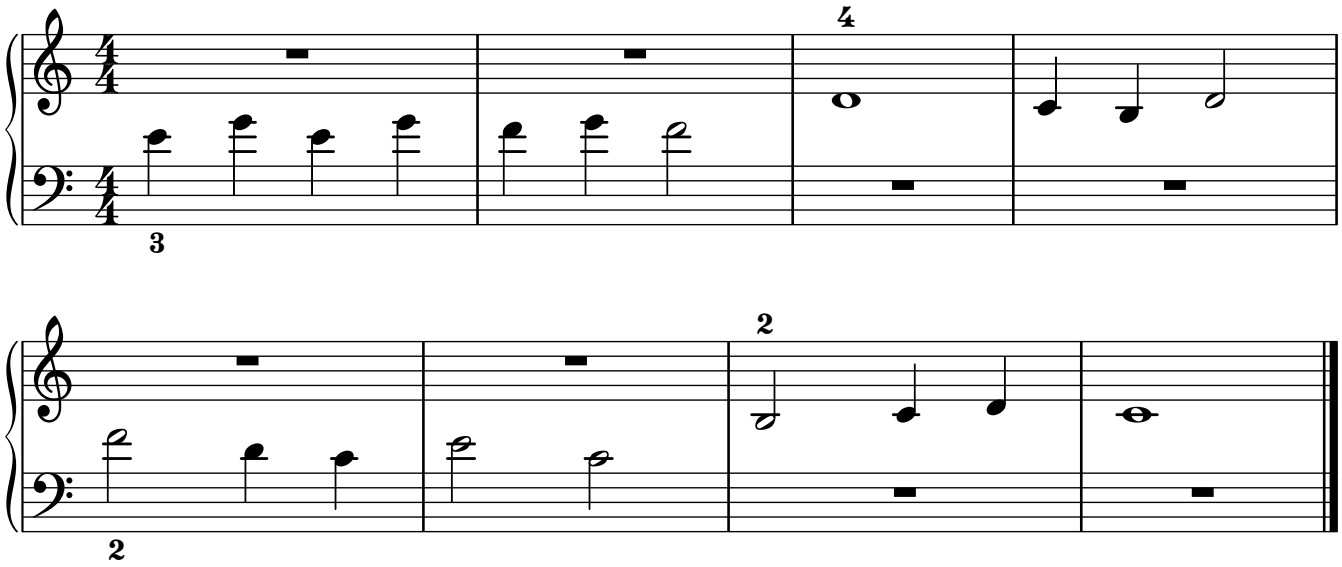
☐ **4.27**



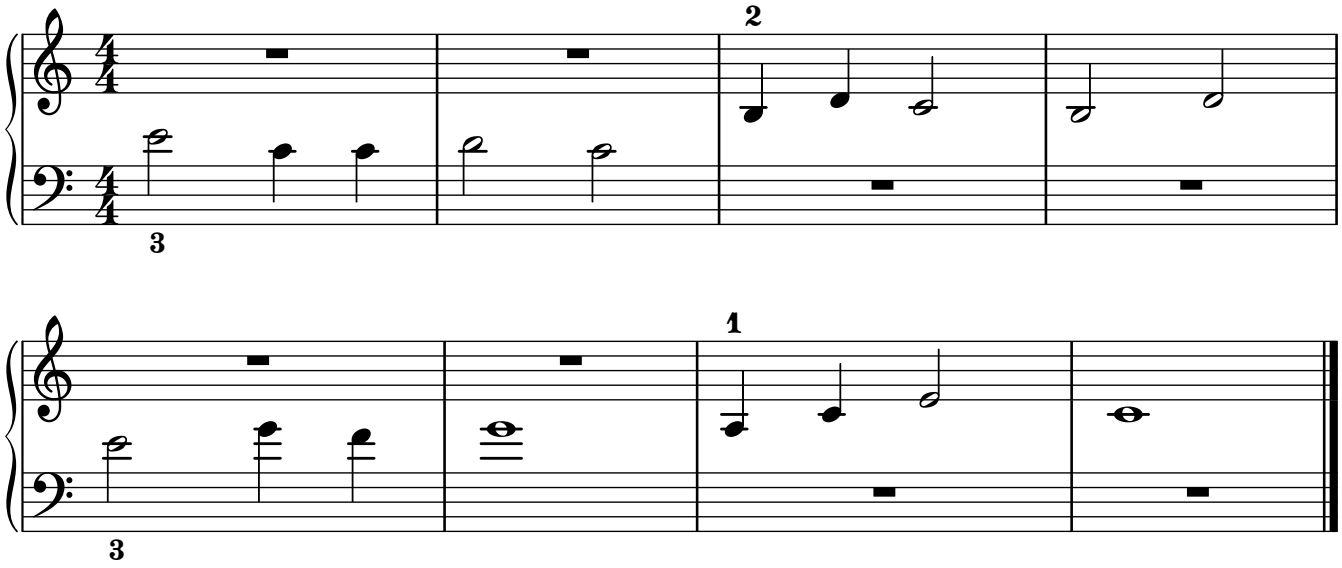
☐ **4.28**



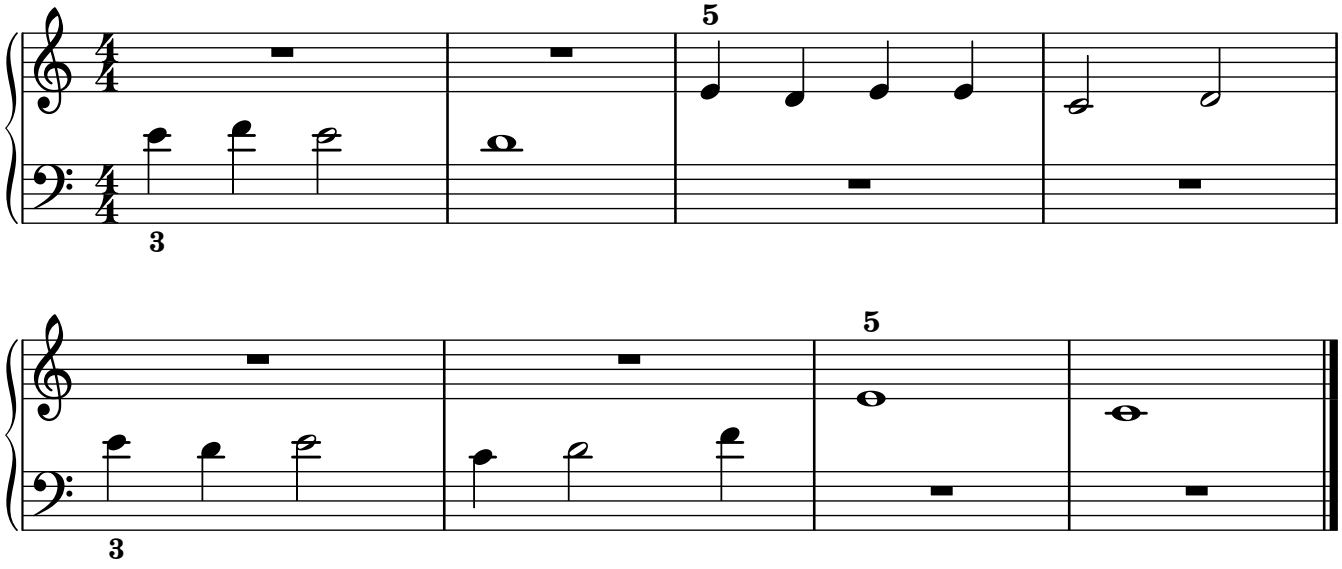
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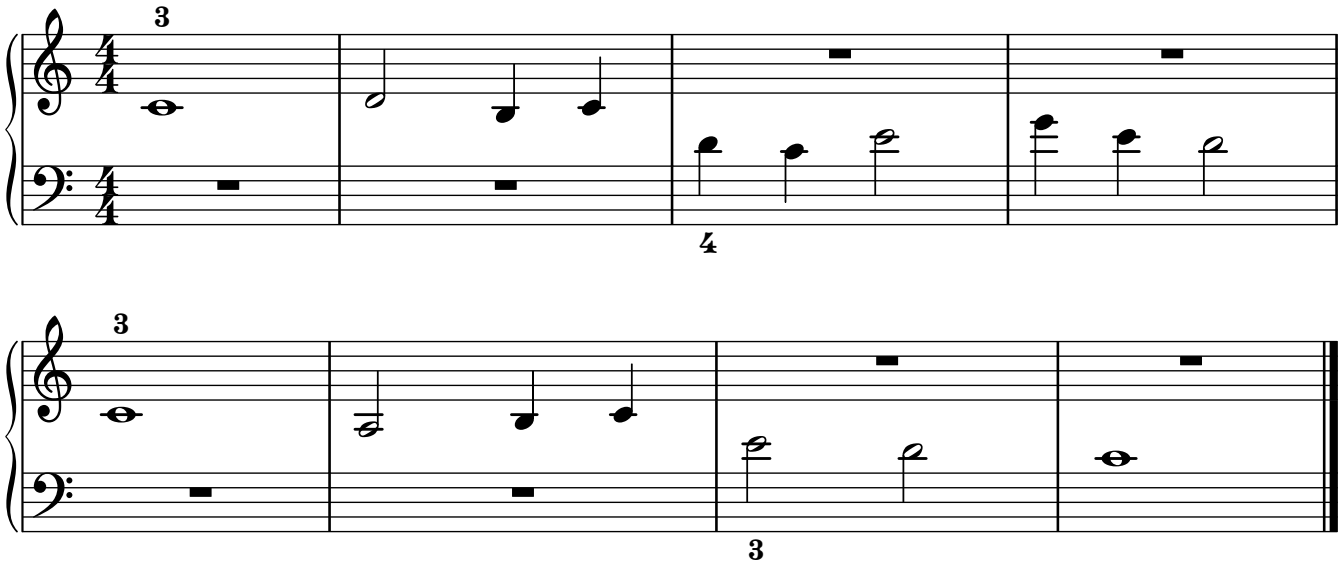
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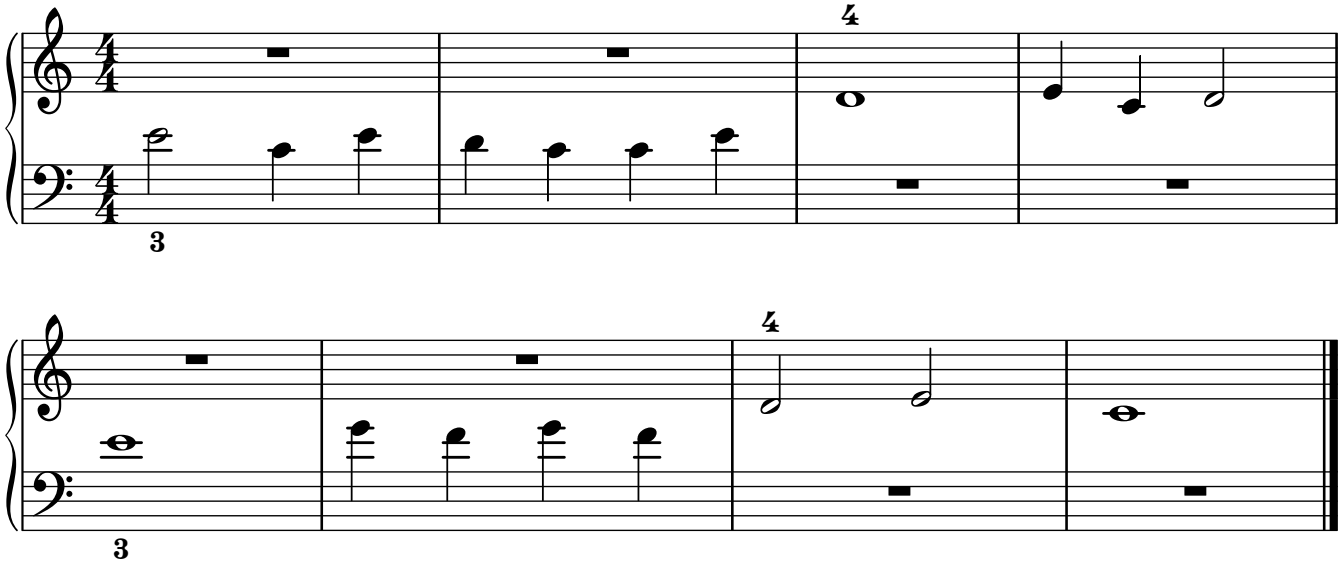
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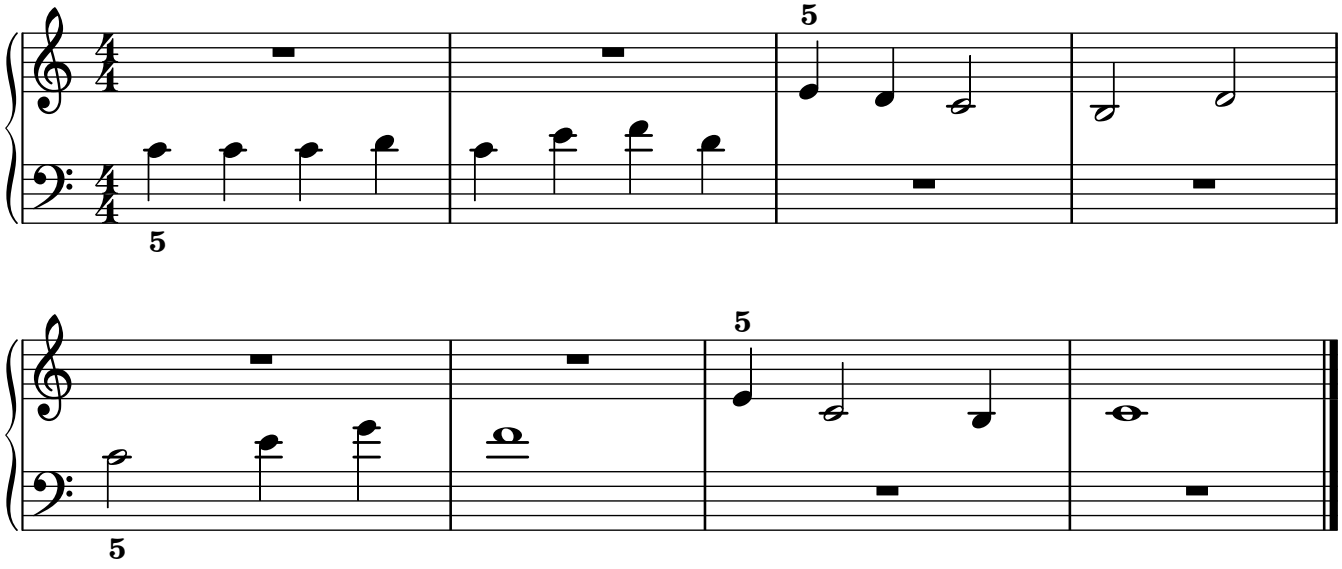
4.32



4.33



4.34
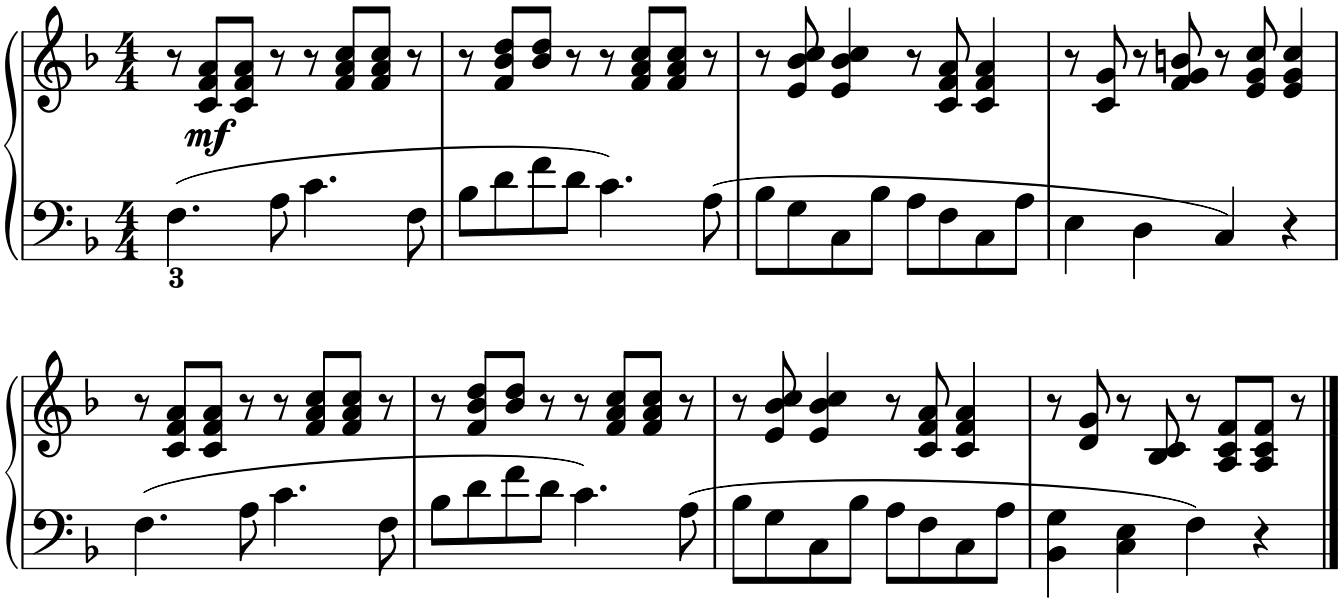


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

The Happy Farmer ♩ = 108

Robert Schumann, Op. 68 No. 10 (first part) - simplified
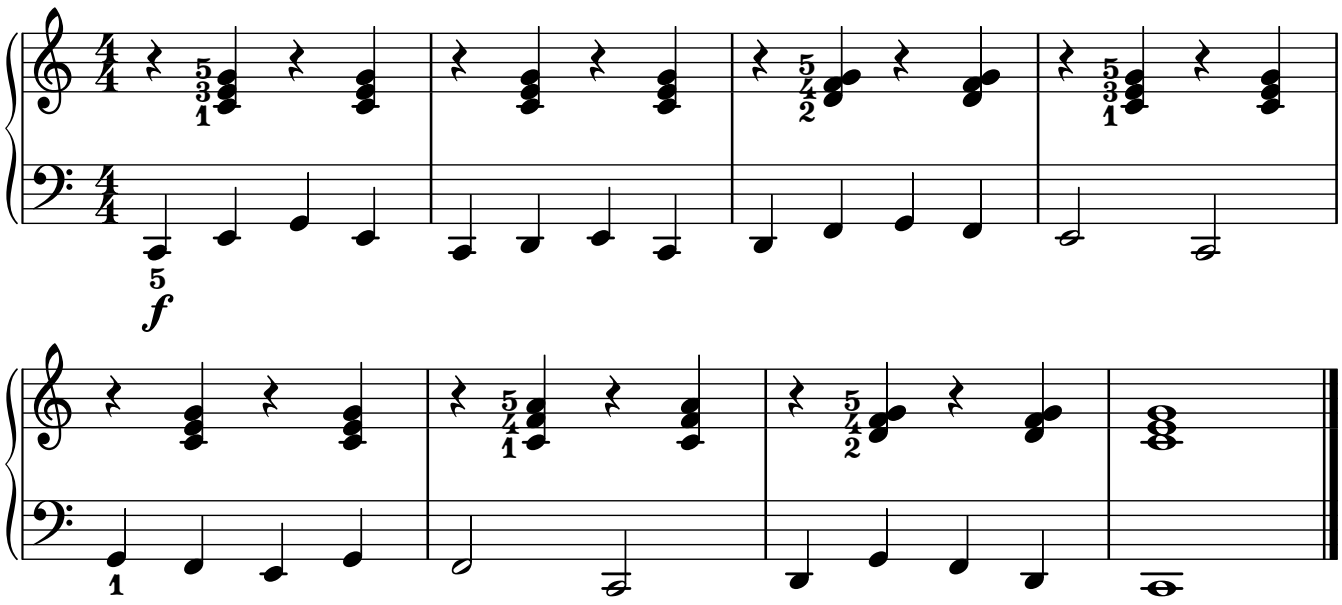
Schumann's farmer sings in the left hand, coming home from work; the right hand answers with short chords on the off-beats. The tune rises above the bass staff to F, on a ledger line. The opening upbeat is left out, and bars 3 and 7 use the same chord. Notes from Mutopia Project no. 659.



The Bear ♩ = 80

Original

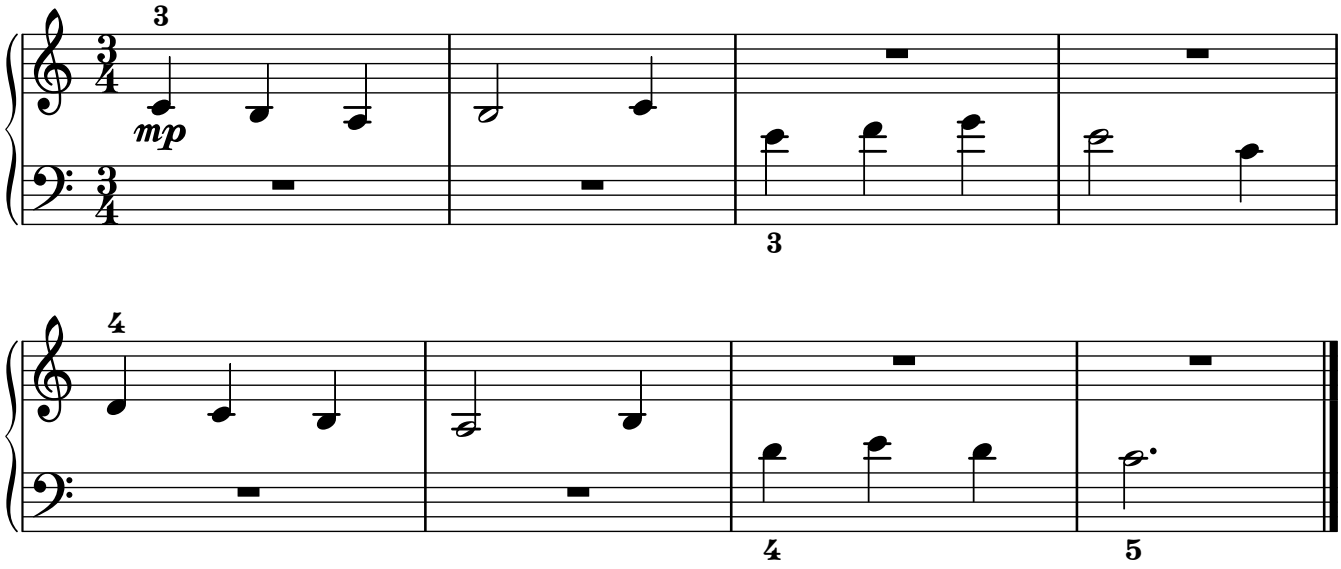
A heavy dance in low C position, C2 to G2, two ledger lines below the bass staff. The right hand plays chords on beats 2 and 4.



Meeting in the Middle ♩= 88

Original

The hands take turns around middle C. The right hand plays below it, in the treble staff; the left hand plays above it, in the bass staff, with up to three ledger lines.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 5?

- Play five new Part B to D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Name any note from C2 up to G4 in the bass staff, and from A3 up in the treble staff, at a glance.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 5.

Unit 5

Syncopation

New: Notes that start between the beats: ties over the beat and the bar line, accents

Most notes so far started on a beat. A syncopated note starts between two beats and holds through the next one, so the accent falls where you do not expect it. Syncopation gives ragtime, jazz and many dances their bounce. The secret is to keep the beat completely steady underneath: the syncopation only works against a beat that does not move.

What is new

Eighth, quarter, eighth

Count 1-and-2-and: the quarter note starts on 'and' and lasts through beat 2. Clap it first: short-LONG-short.

Accents

The sign > over or under a note means: play it a little louder. In this unit it marks the syncopated notes.

Ties over the beat and the bar line

A note tied over the bar line starts early, on the last 'and' of the bar, and is not played again on beat 1. This 'anticipation' is the sound of ragtime.

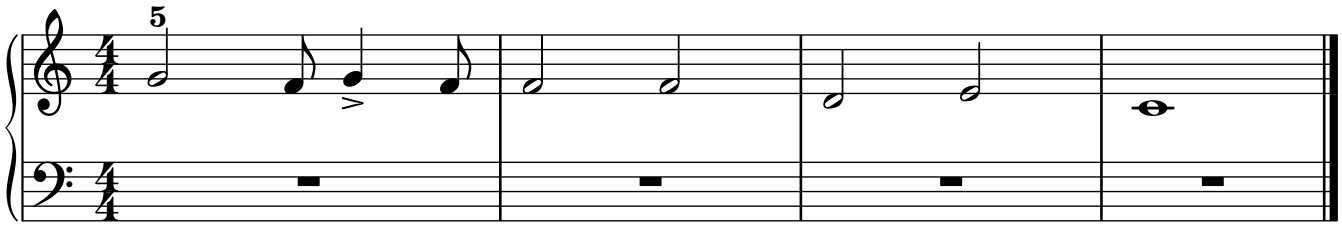
Reading tips

1. Count out loud, with the 'and's, the first few times: 1-and-2-and-3-and-4-and.
2. Let the left hand play exactly on the beats; the right hand's accents fall between them.
3. At a tie over the bar line, feel beat 1 in the left hand while the right hand holds.
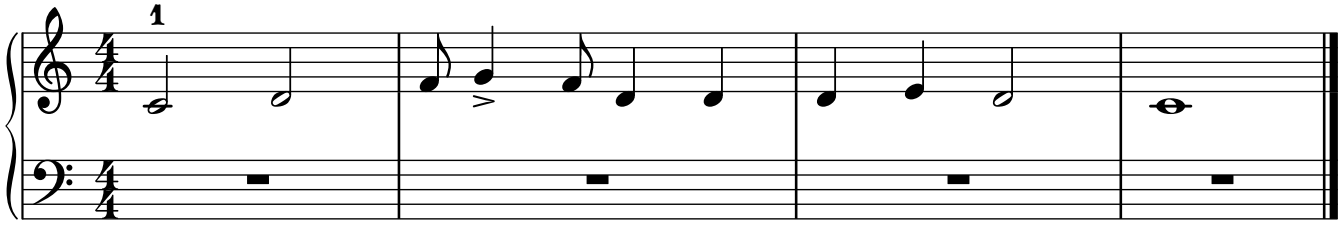
Part A: Off the beat ♩ = 60

Right hand alone in C position: syncopated rhythms with accents.

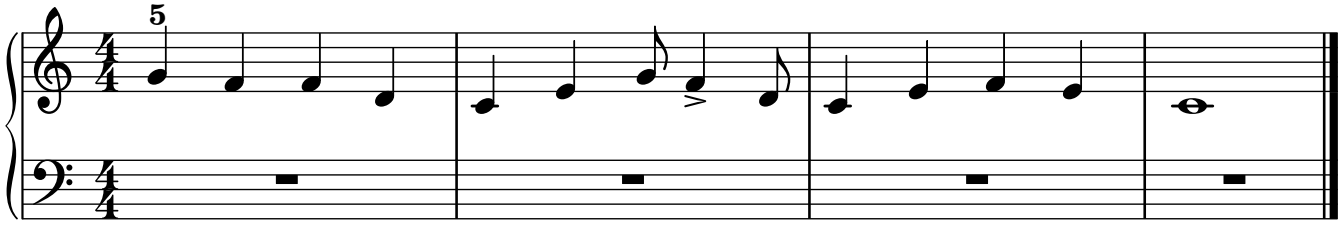
☐ **5.1**



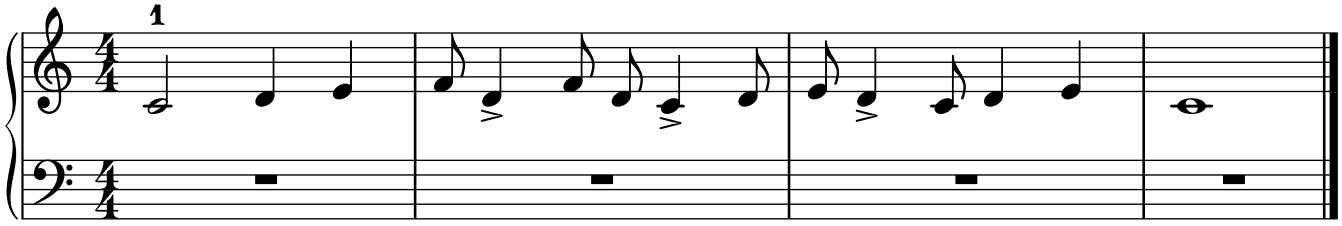
☐ **5.2**



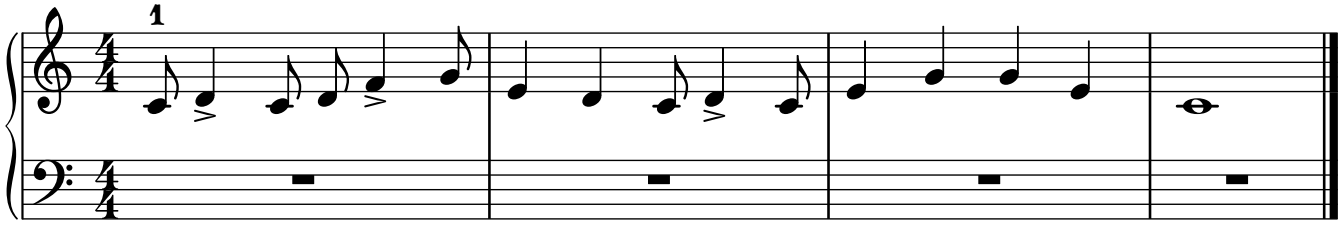
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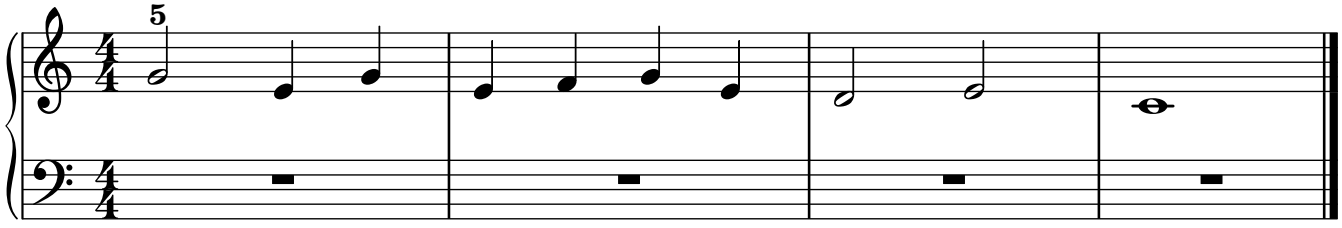


☐ **5.4**



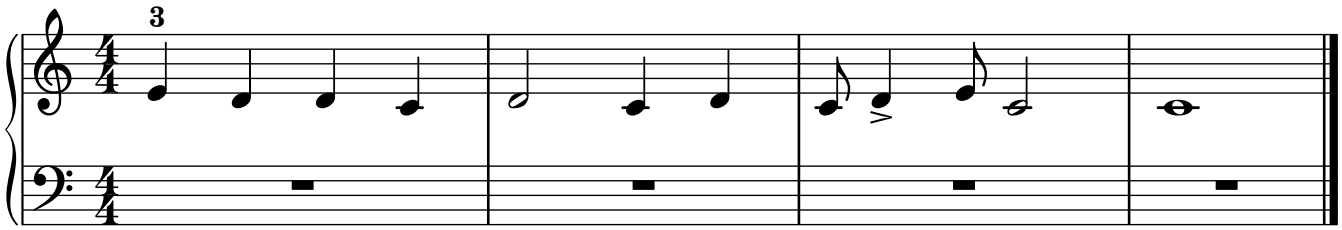
☐ **5.5**



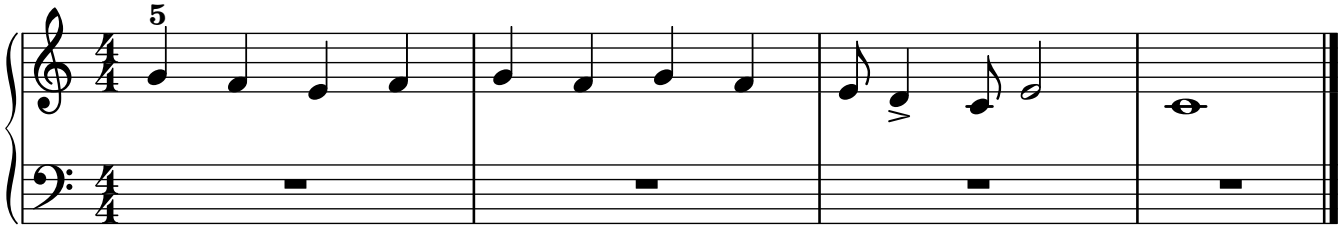
☐ **5.6**



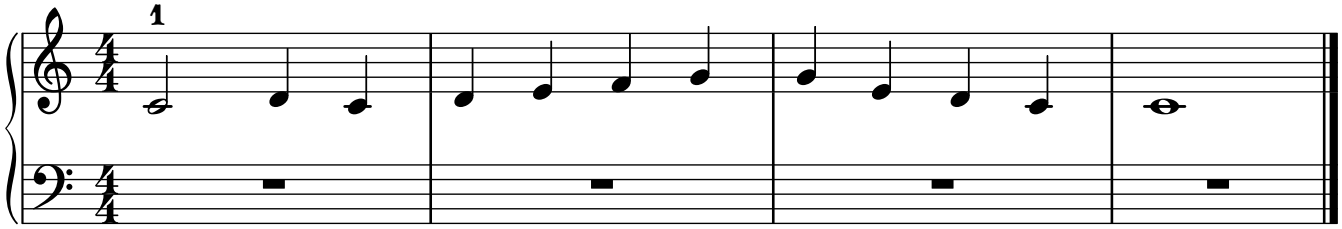
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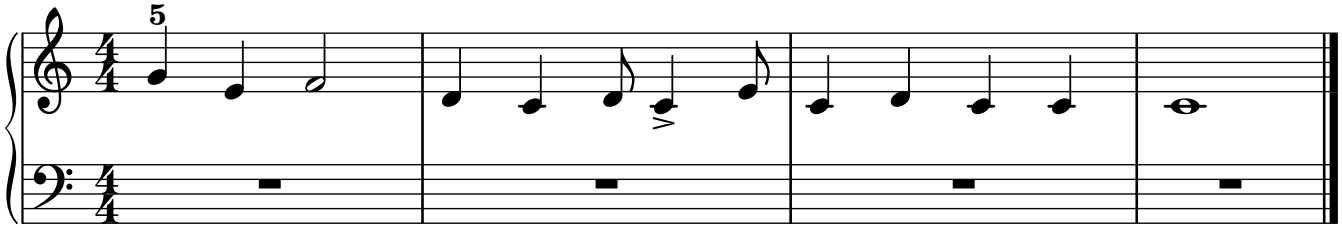
☐ **5.8**



☐ **5.9**



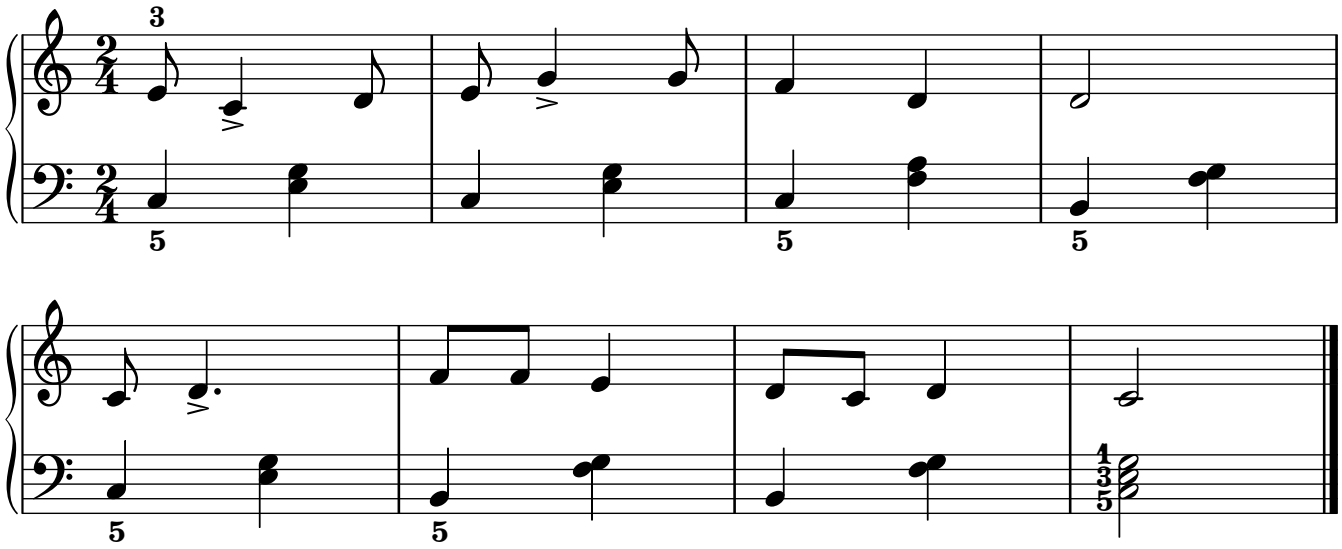
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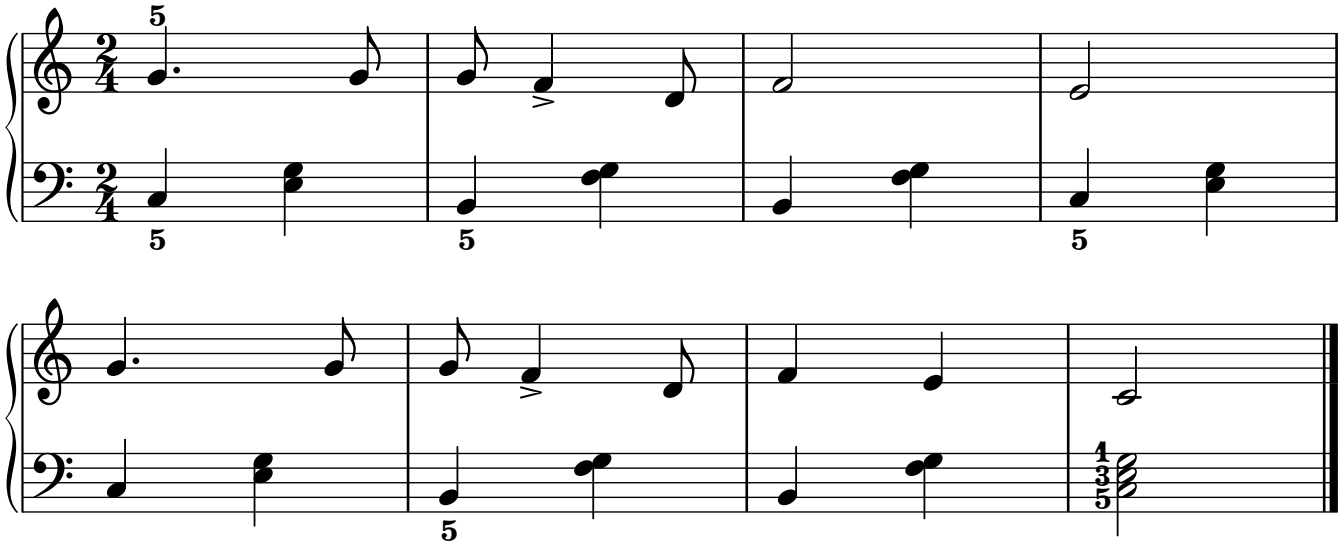


Part B: Ragtime in 2/4 ♩ = 72

Ragtime in 2/4: a syncopated tune over an oom-pah bass.

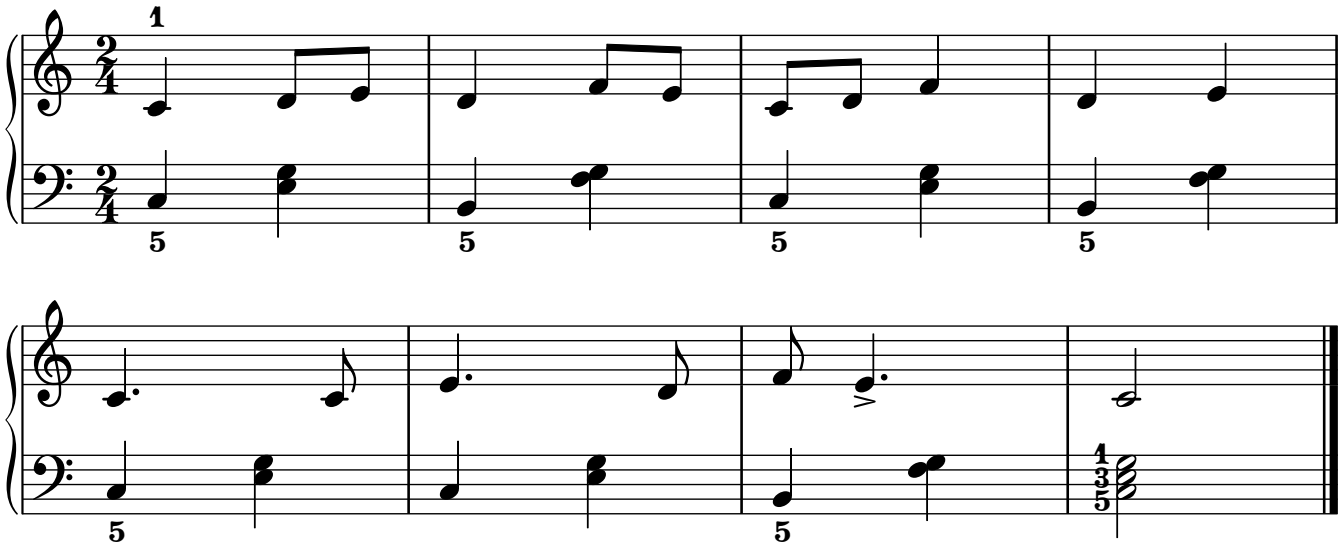
☐ **5.11**



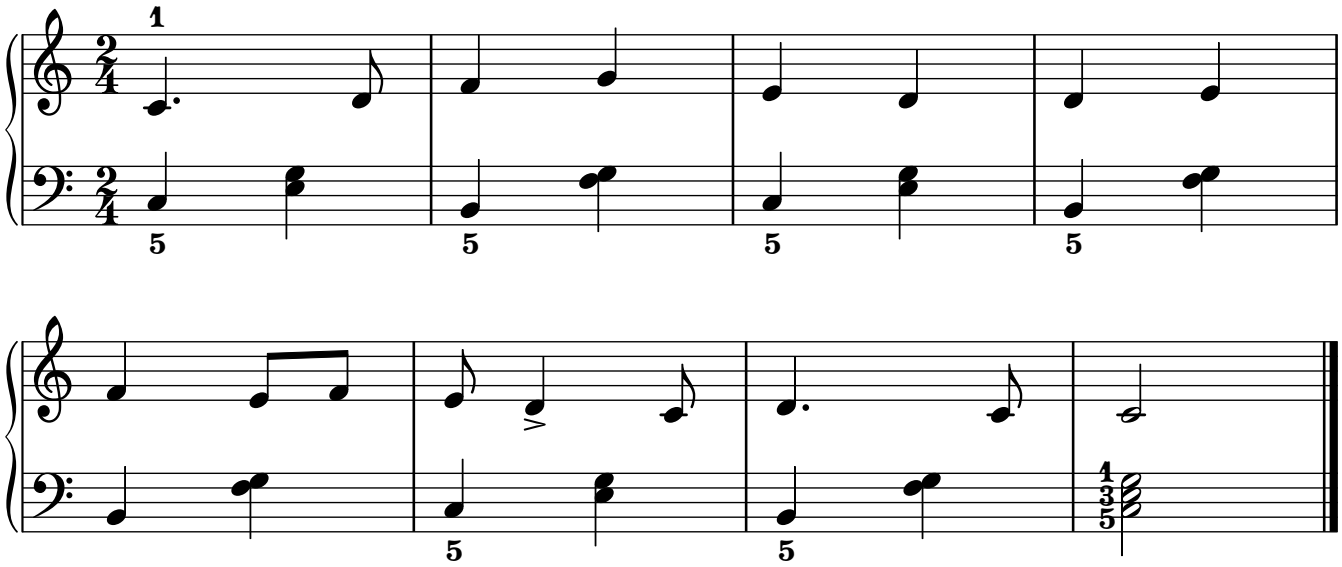
☐ **5.12**



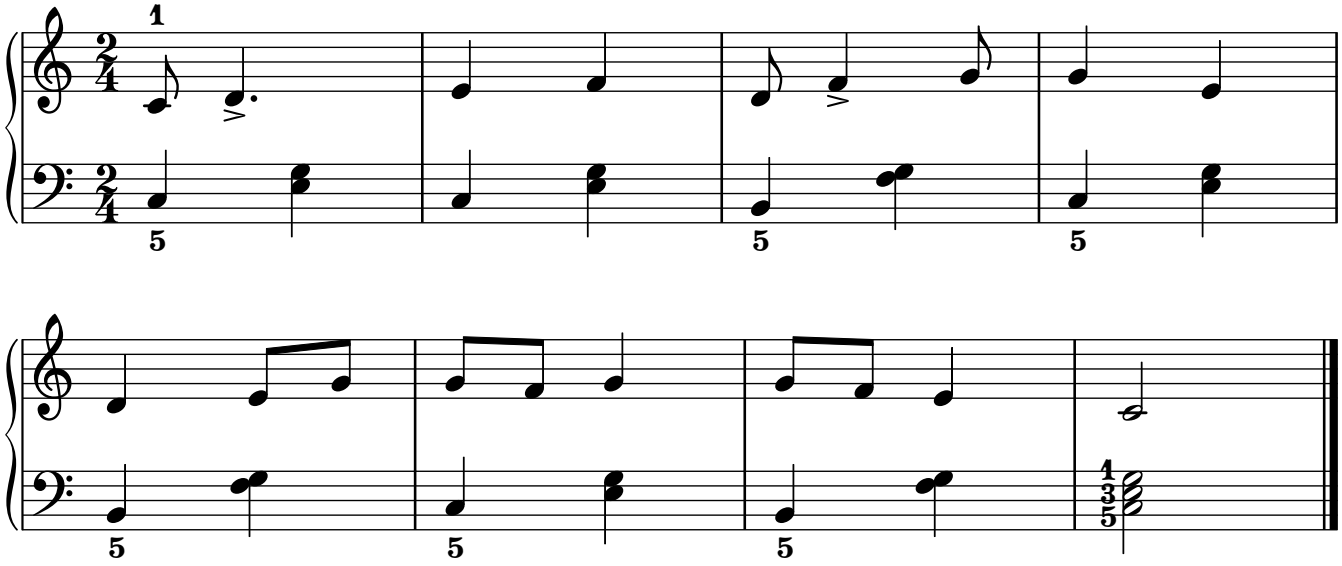
☐ **5.13**



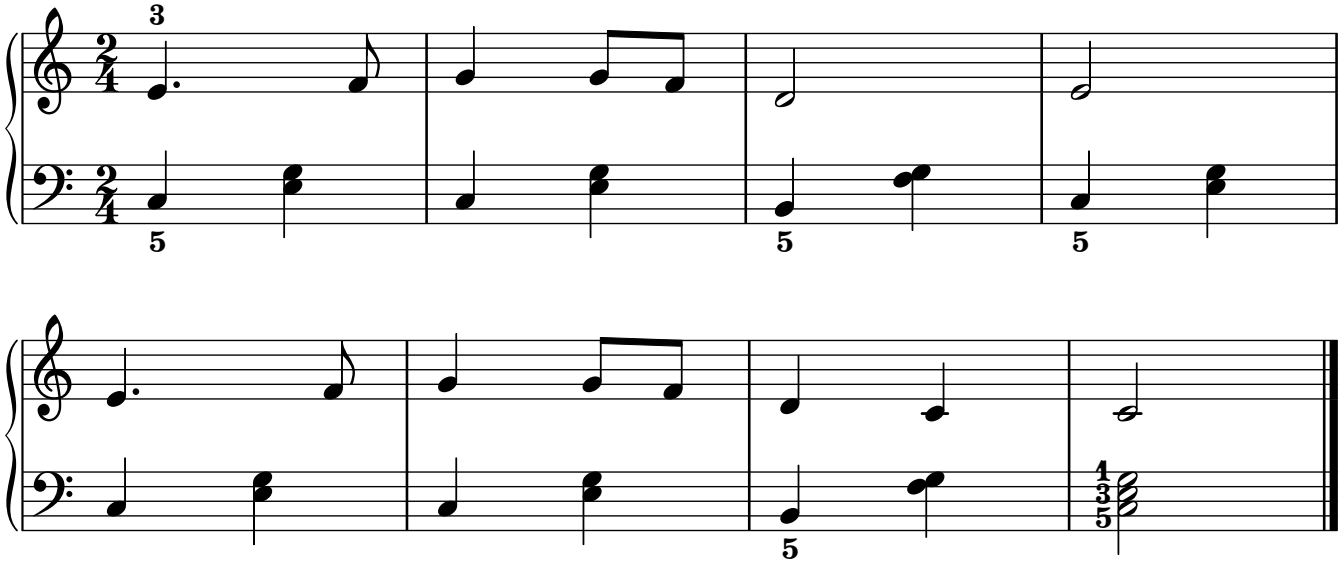
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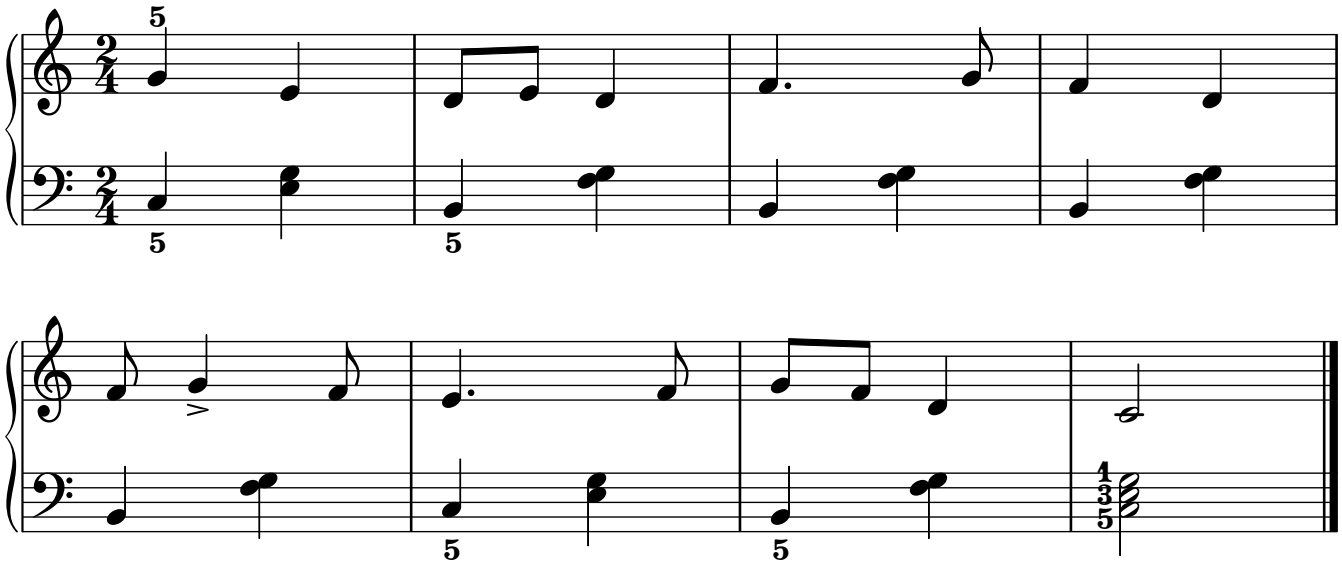


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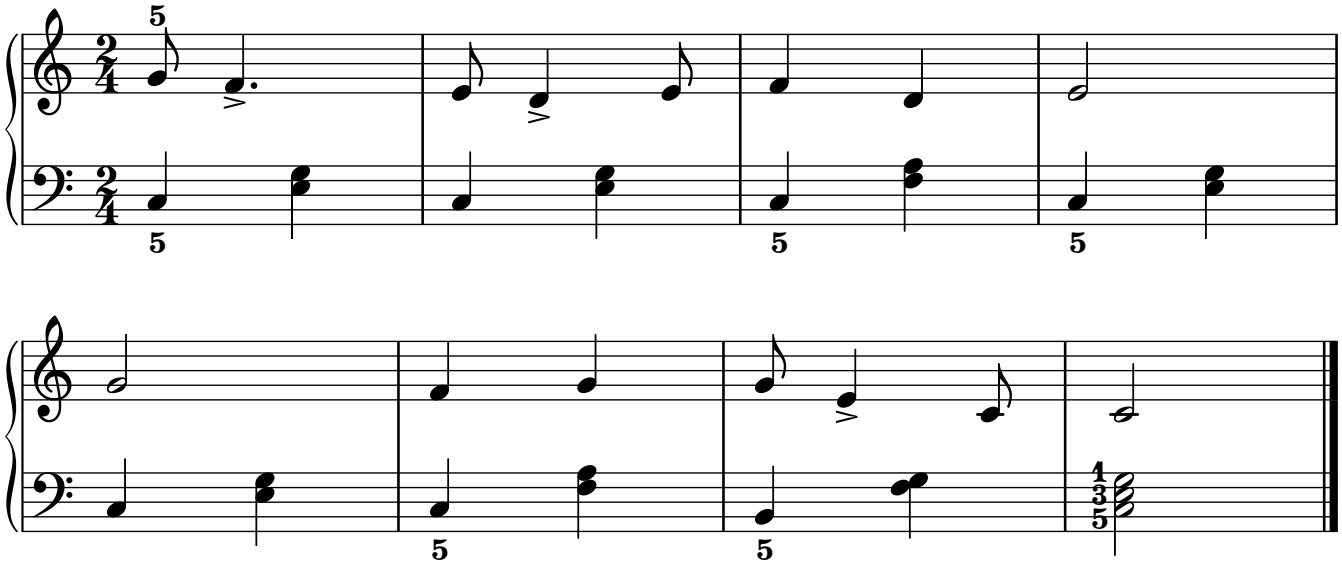
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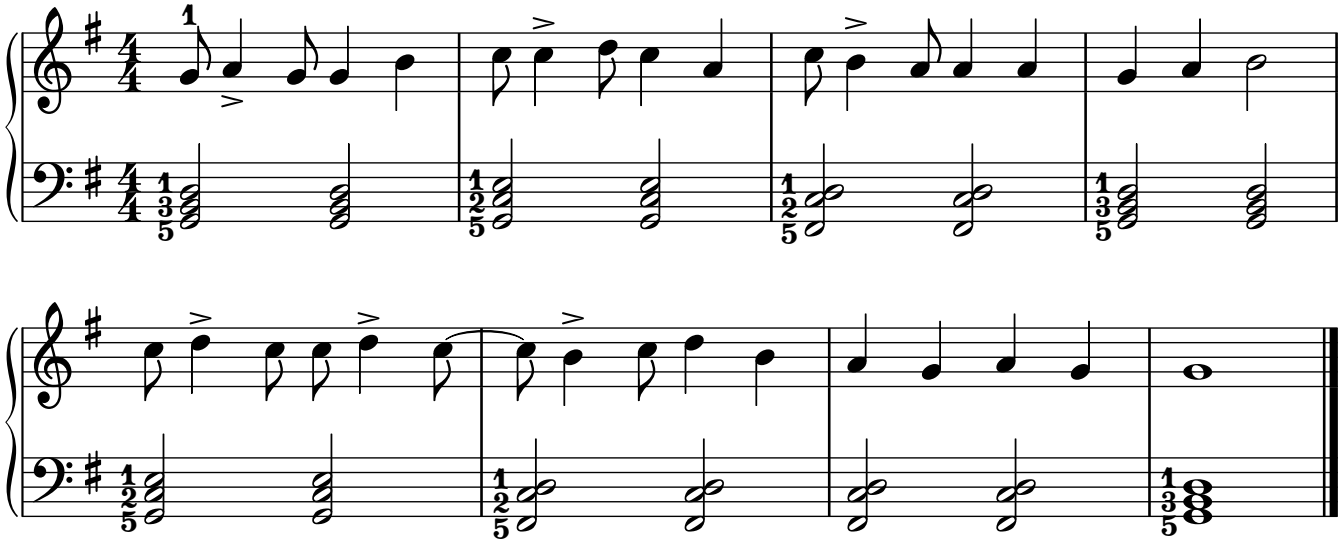


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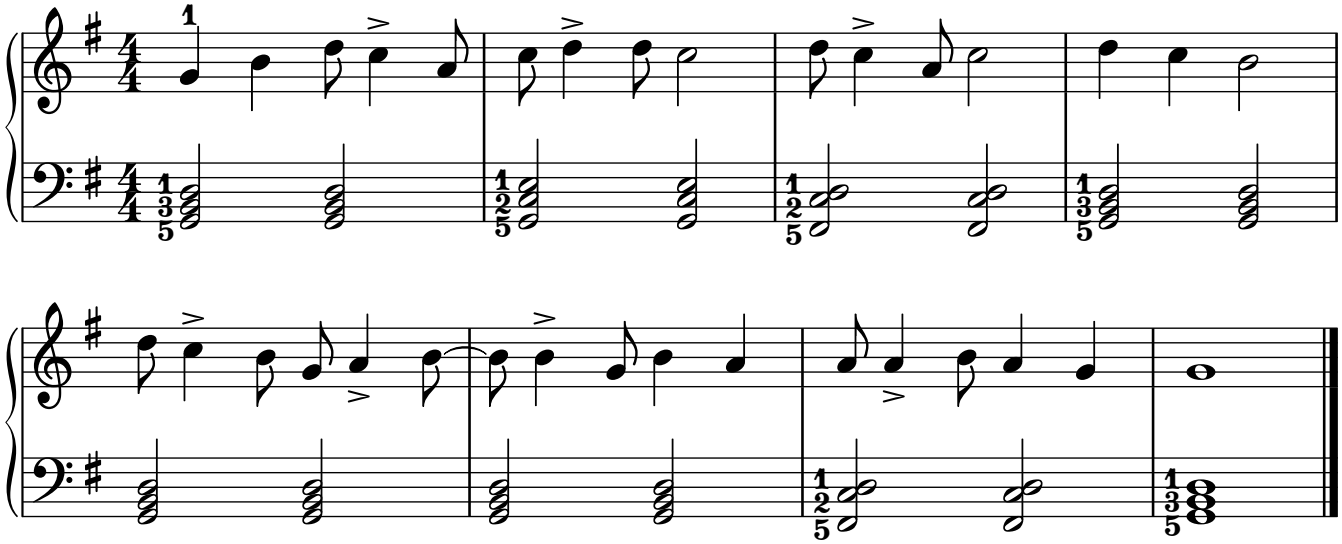


Part C: Across the bar line ♩ = 66

G major: notes tied over the bar line, over block chords.
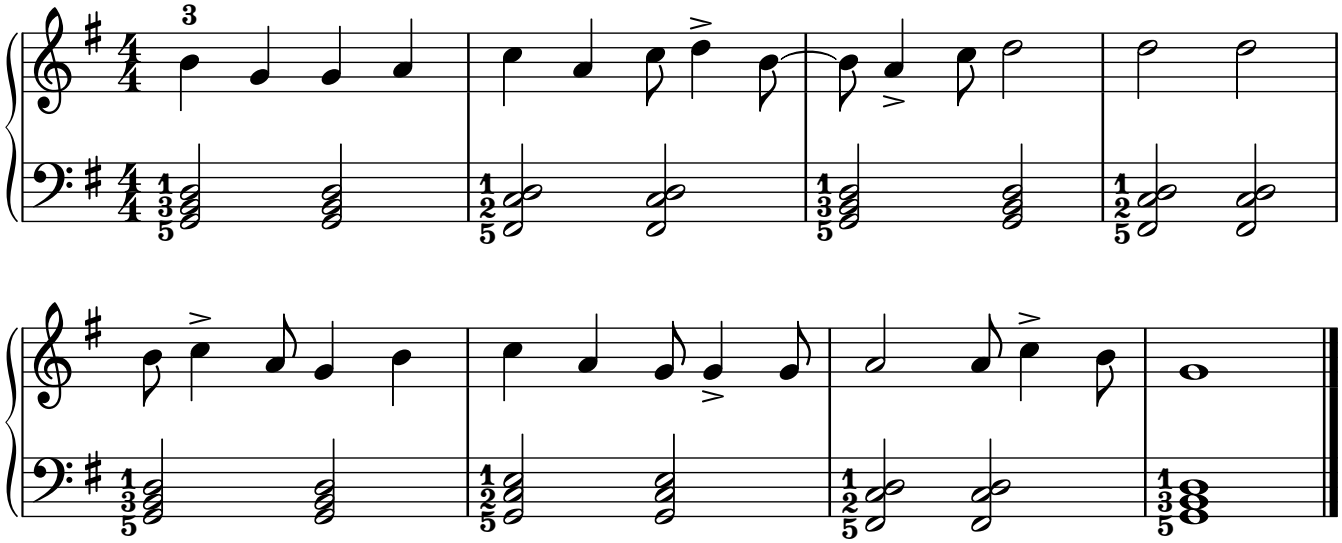
☐ **5.19**
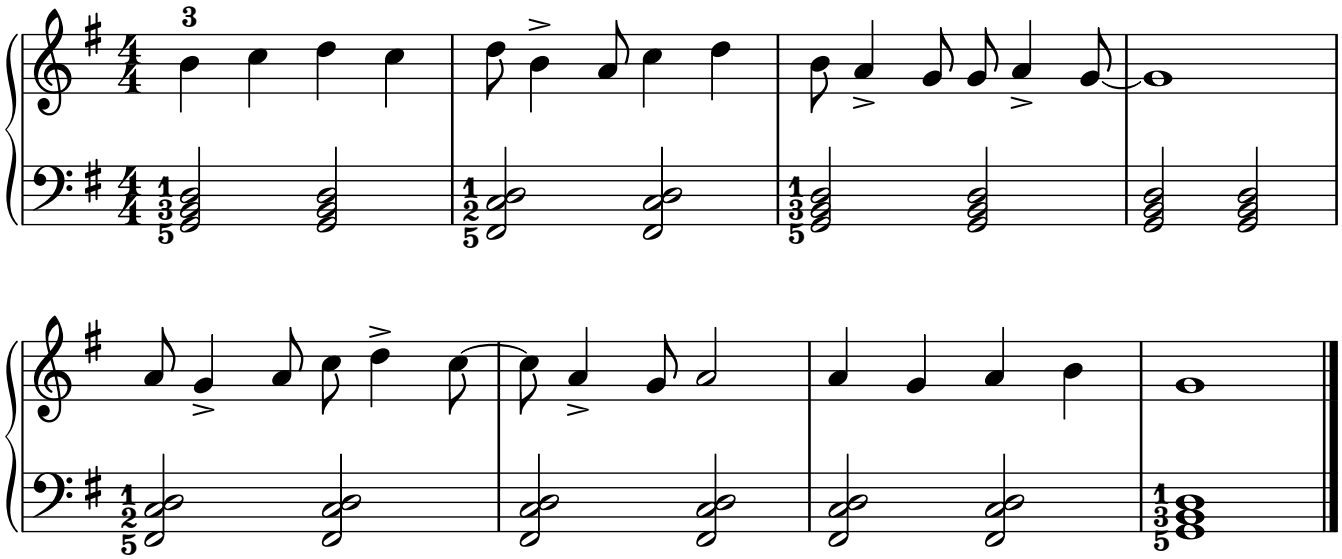


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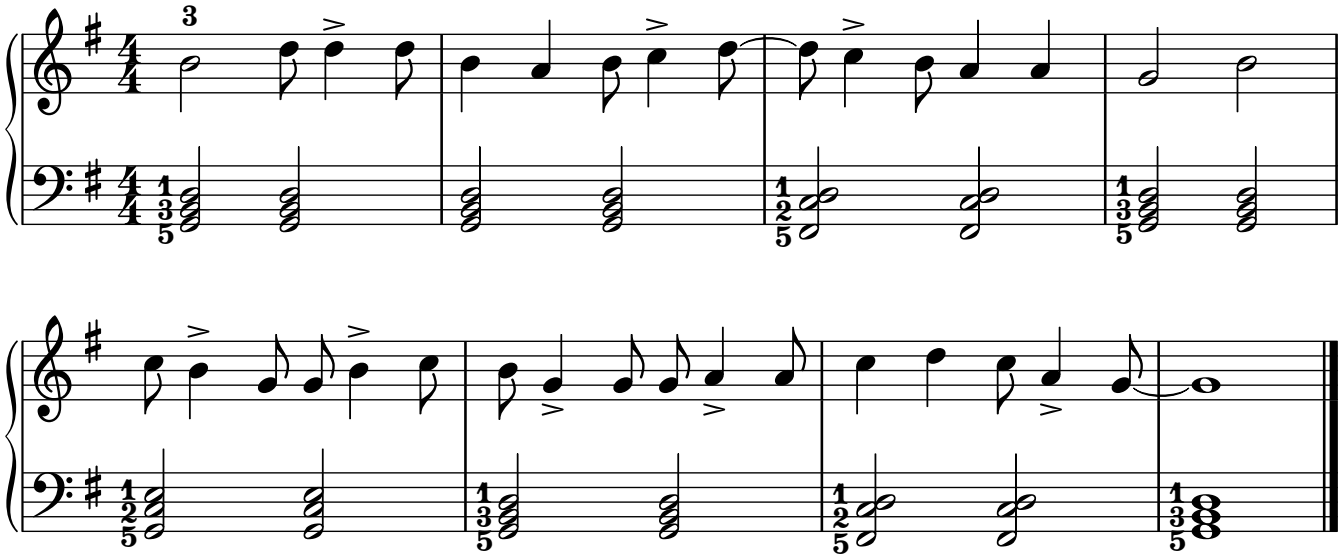


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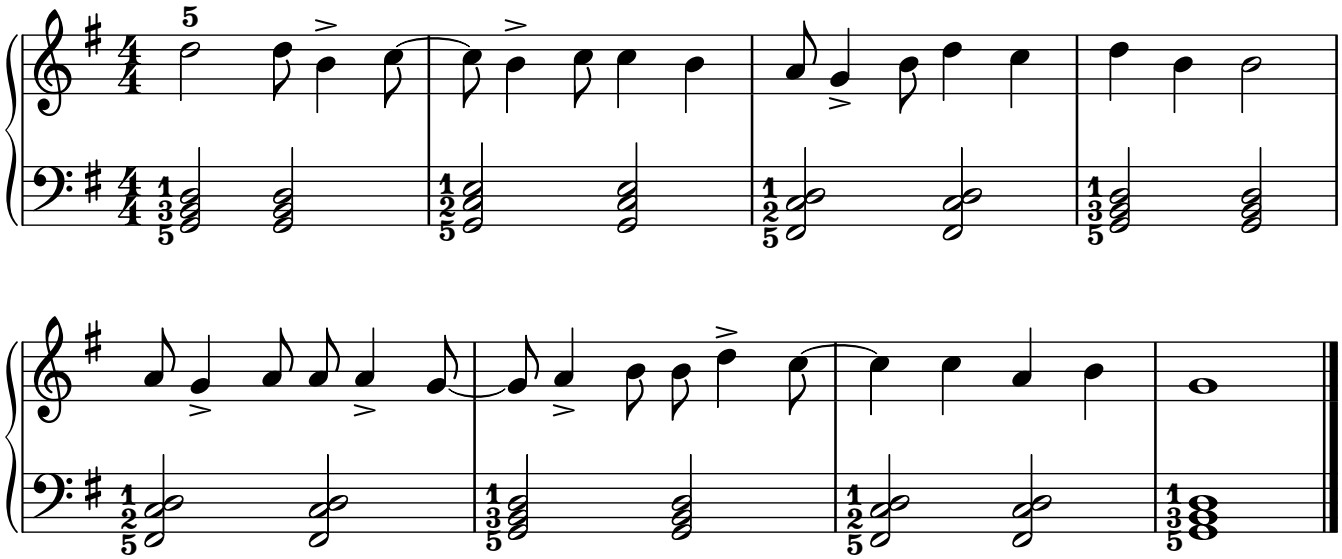


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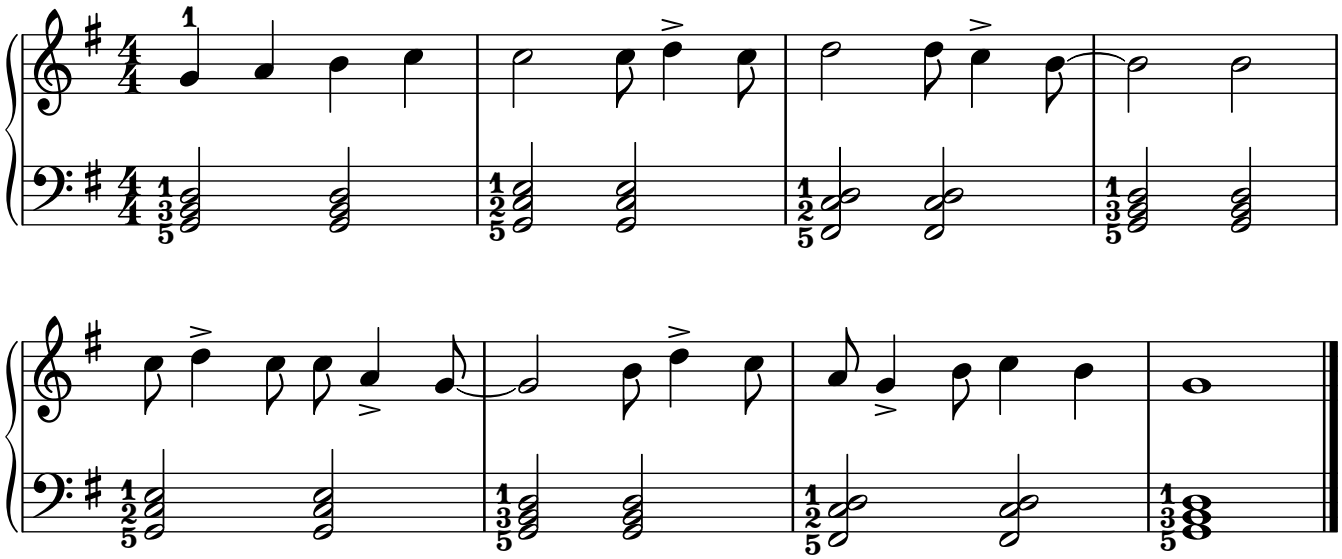


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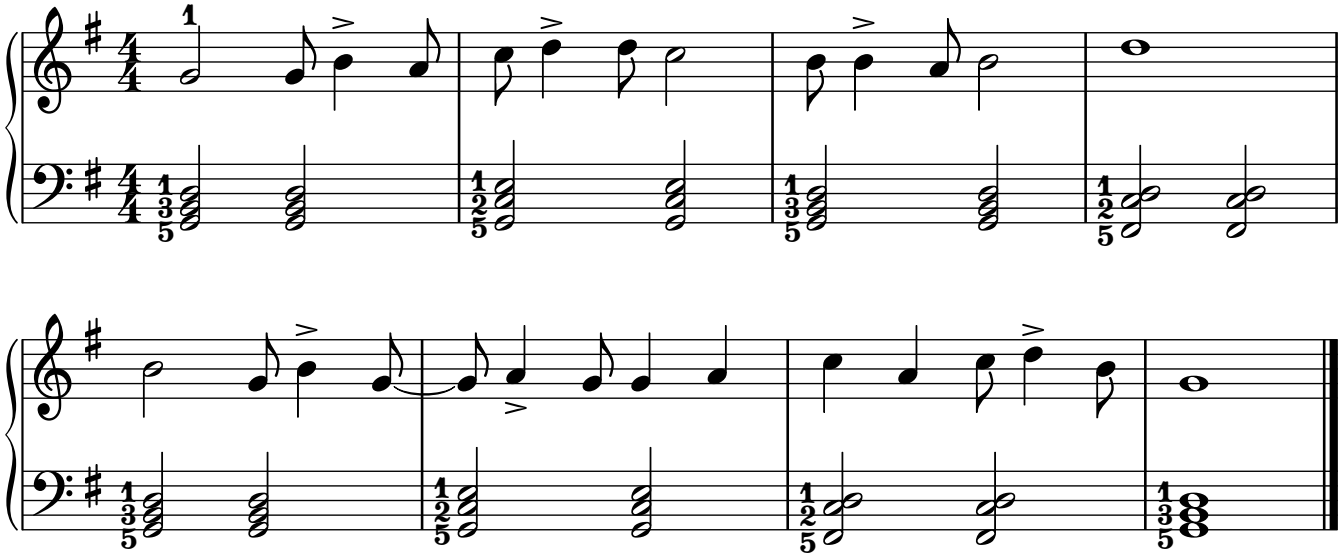


5.24



5.25



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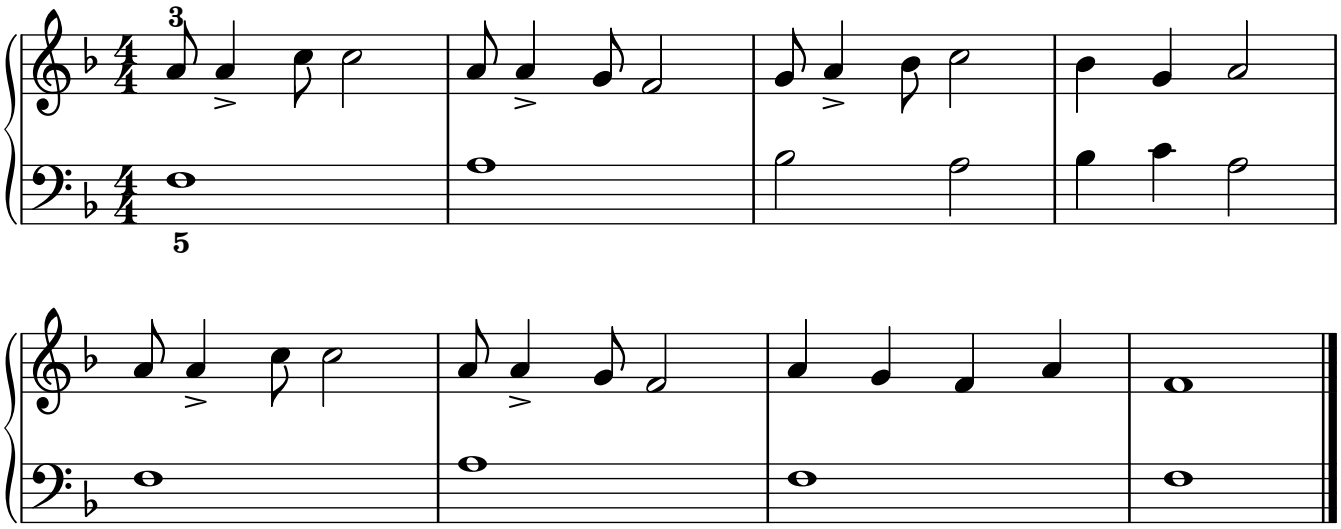


Part D: Syncopation in two voices
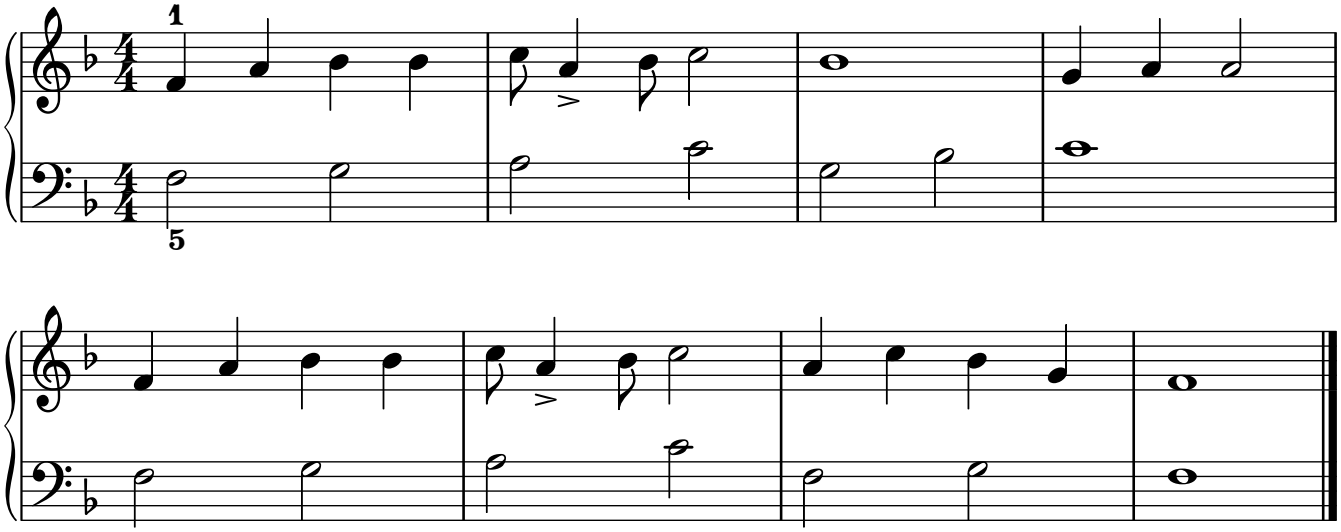
♩ = 66

Two voices: a syncopated tune above a steady left hand in half notes.
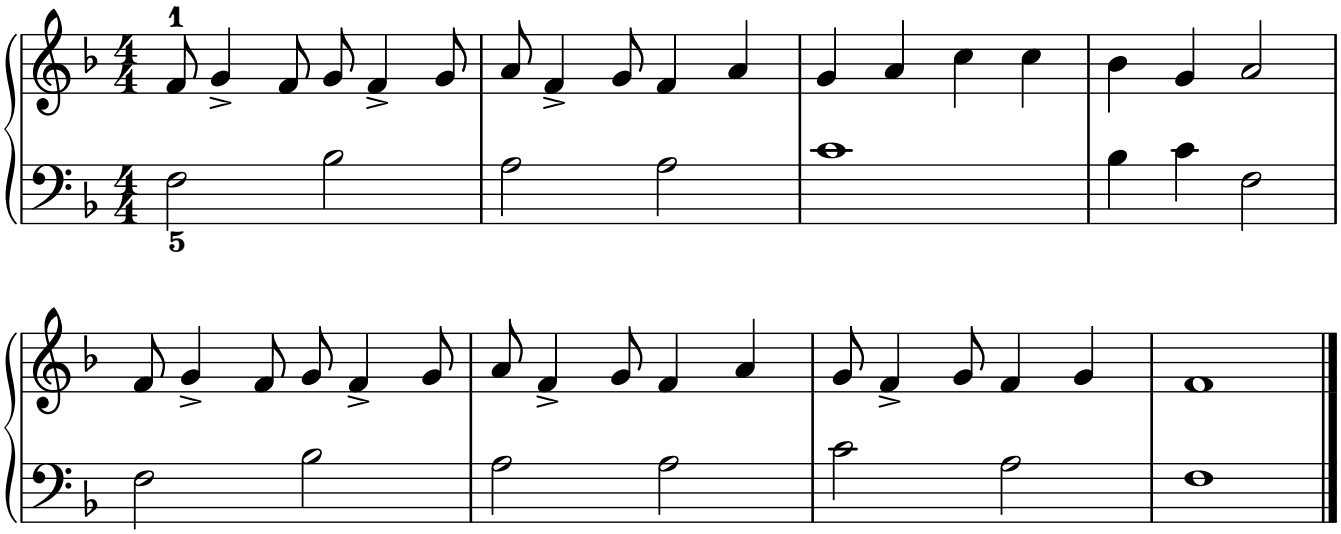
☐ **5.27**
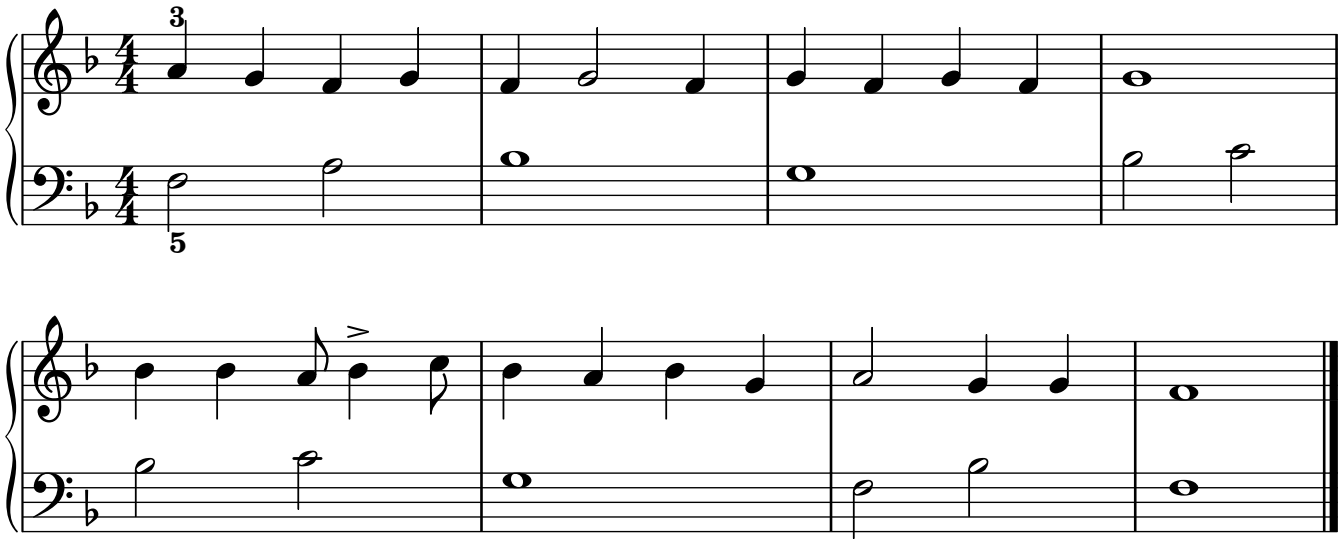


☐ **5.28**
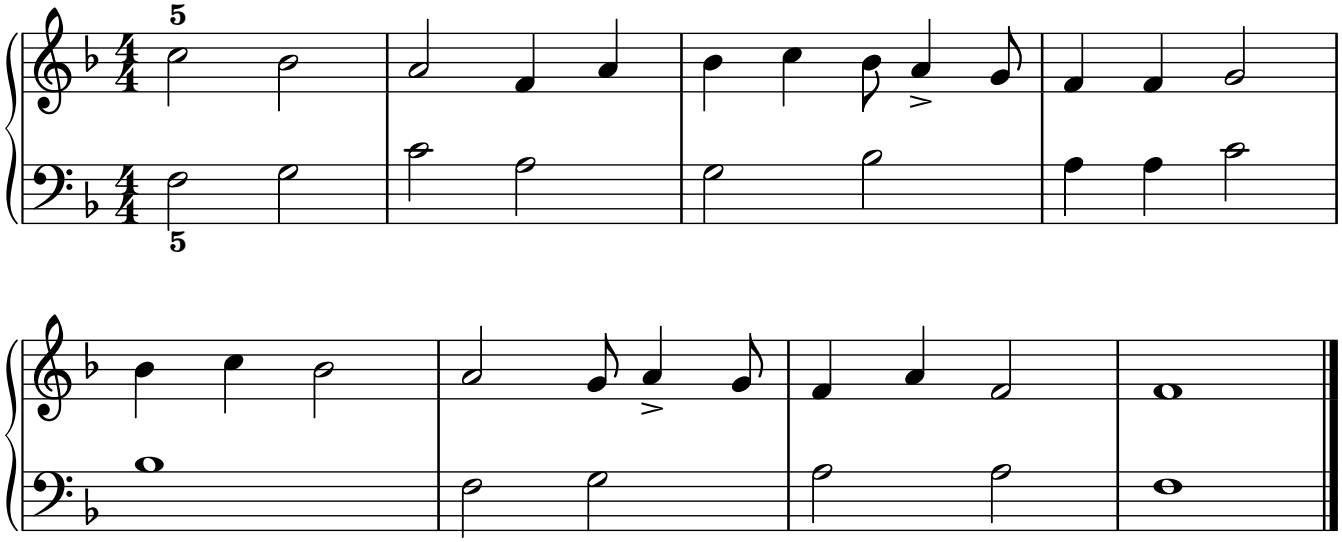


☐ **5.29**
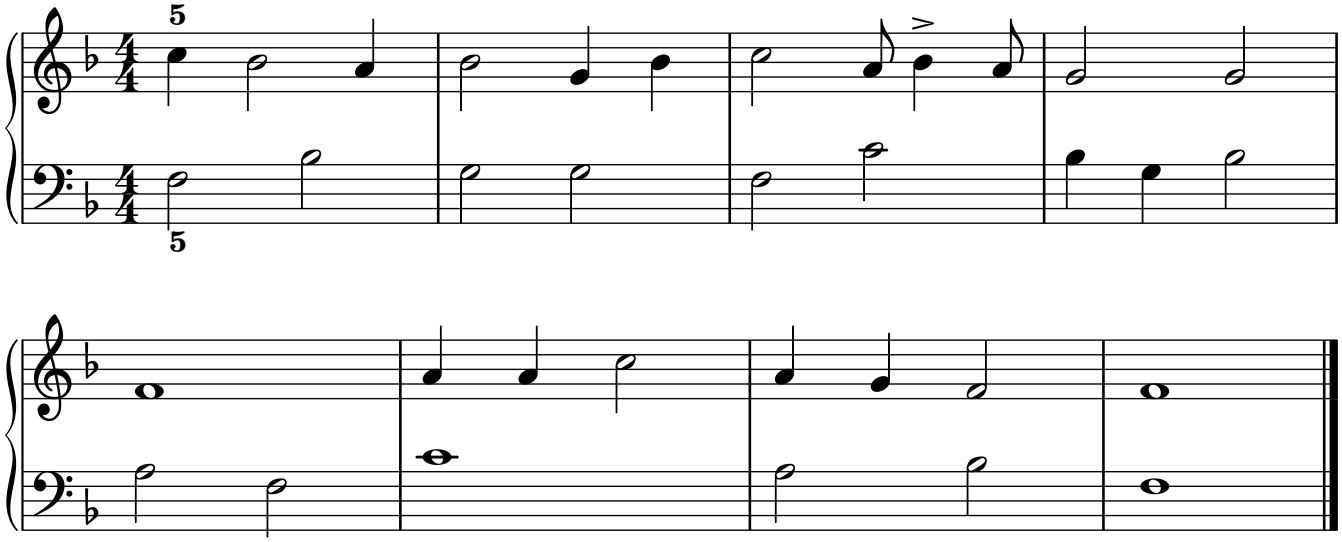


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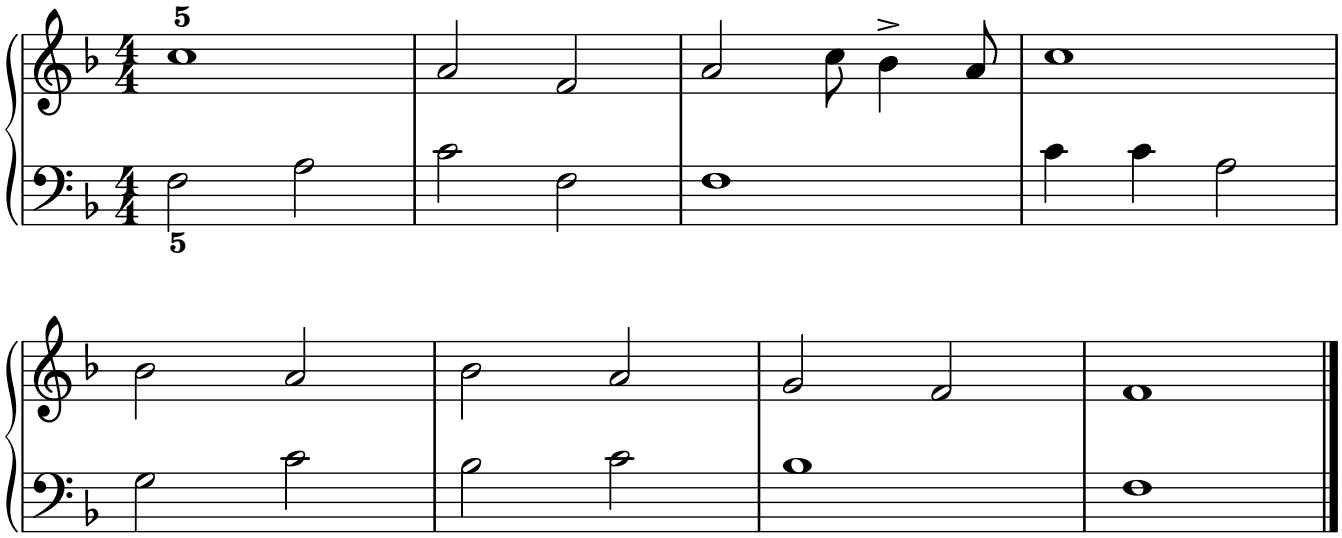


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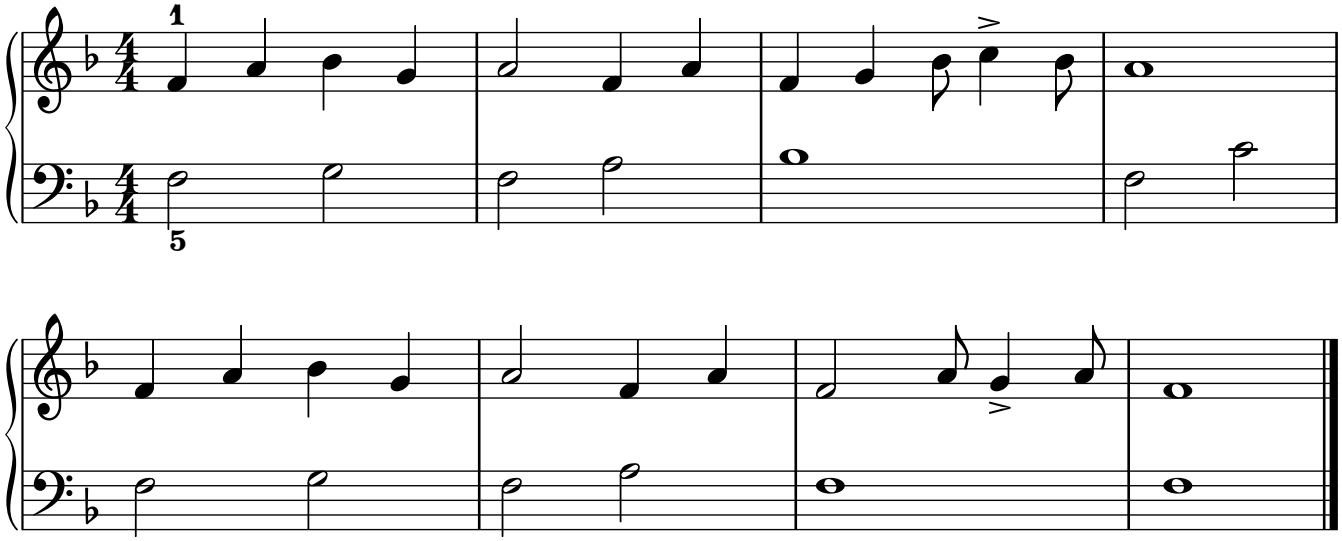


5.32



5.33



5.34
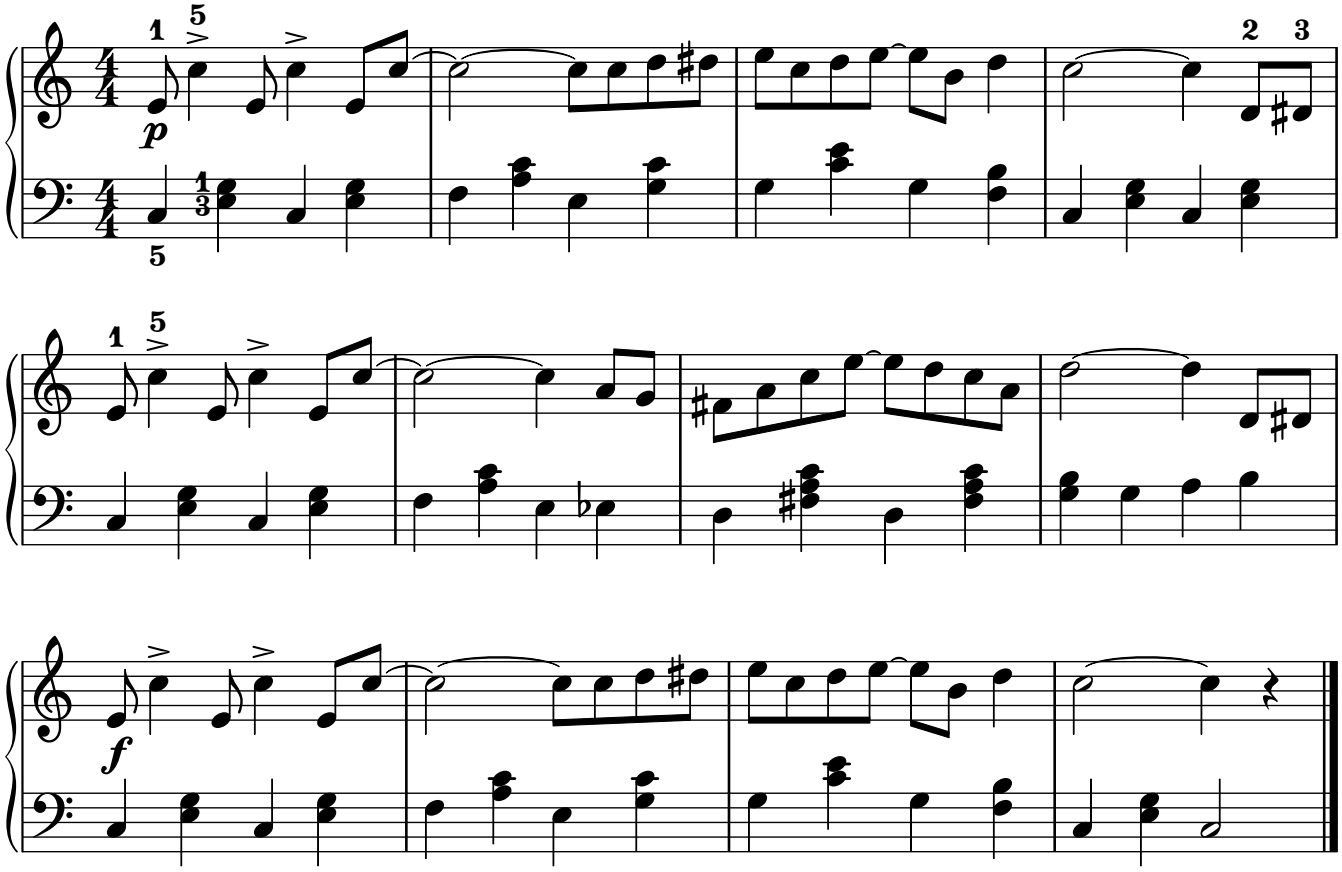


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

The Entertainer ♩ = 72

Scott Joplin (1902), first strain - simplified, note values doubled

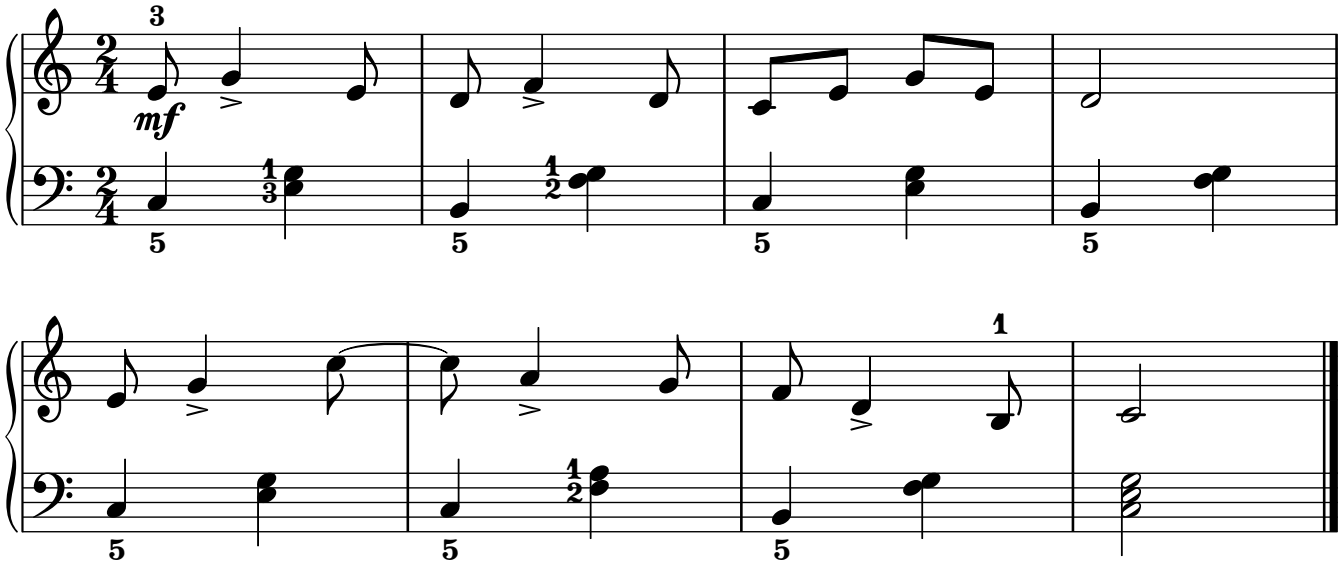
The most famous ragtime. Joplin wrote it in 2/4 with sixteenth notes; here every note lasts twice as long, so it reads in 4/4 with eighths. The tune is an octave lower than written and the bass is a simplified oom-pah. Watch the ties over the bar lines. Source: Mutopia Project no. 263.



Ragtime Rabbit ♩ = 84

Original
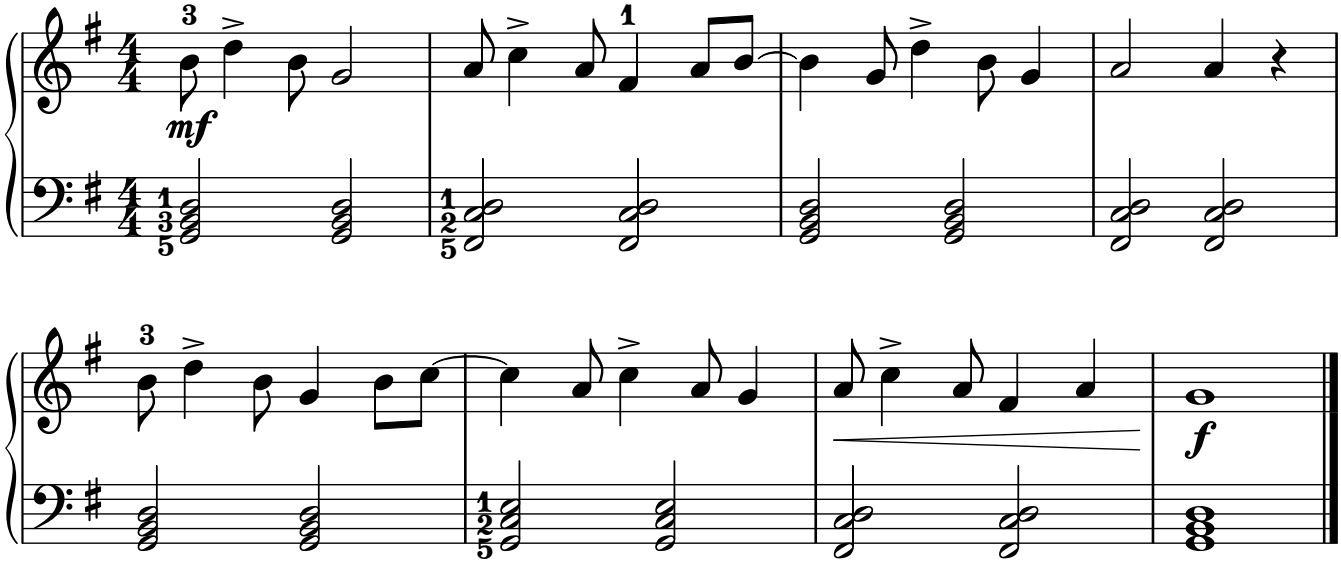
Eighth-quarter-eighth in nearly every bar, over an oom-pah bass in 2/4. In bar 5 the last note is tied over the bar line: it starts early and is not played again.



Late for the Train ♩ = 76

Original

Syncopated in G major over steady block chords. Two notes are tied over the bar line (bars 2 and 5).



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 6?

- Play five new Part B to D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- The beat stays steady under every syncopation, and tied notes are not played again.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 6.

Unit 6

Sixteenth Notes

New: Four sixteenths, an eighth and two sixteenths, the dotted eighth and sixteenth

A sixteenth note has two beams (or two flags) and lasts half an eighth: four of them fill one beat. Sixteenths come in a few common groups, and each group has its own look on the page. Learn to recognise the group as one picture and count it as one beat.

What is new

Four sixteenths

Four notes beamed together with two beams: one beat. Count 1-e-and-a, 2-e-and-a. In this unit four sixteenths always move by step, like a tiny scale.

Eighth and two sixteenths

One beam over the group and a second beam under the last two notes: long, short-short. Count 1, and-a.

Dotted eighth and sixteenth

A dotted eighth lasts three sixteenths, so the pair goes long-short, snappier than a dotted quarter and eighth. Count 1, a. It is the rhythm of marches.

Reading tips

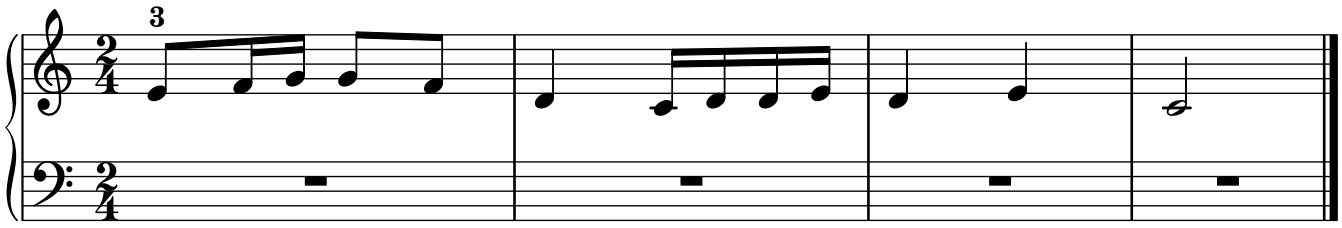
1. Count sixteenths slowly at first: say '1-e-and-a' for every beat, then just feel the beats.
2. Read four sixteenths as one shape: which way does the little scale go, up or down?
3. Keep dotted rhythms crisp: the sixteenth belongs to the next beat, almost like a grace note.

Part A: Sixteenths in the right hand

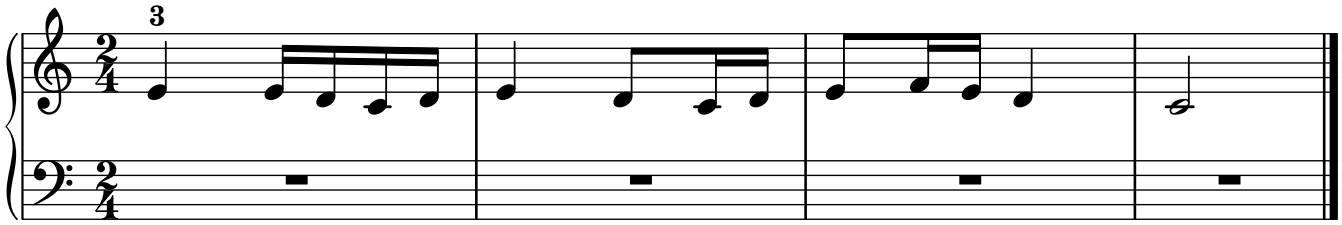
♩ = 60

Right hand in C position, 2/4: sixteenths in groups of four and two.

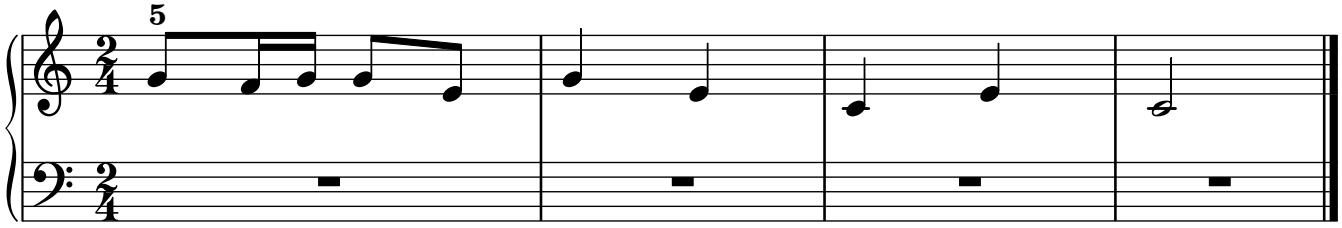
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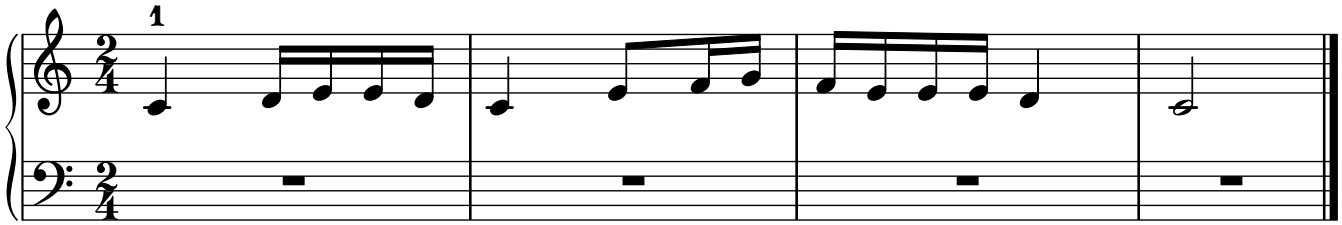


☐ **6.2**



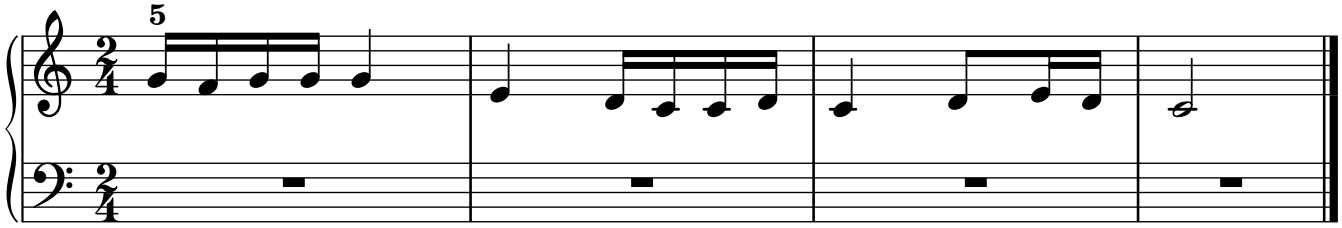
☐ **6.3**



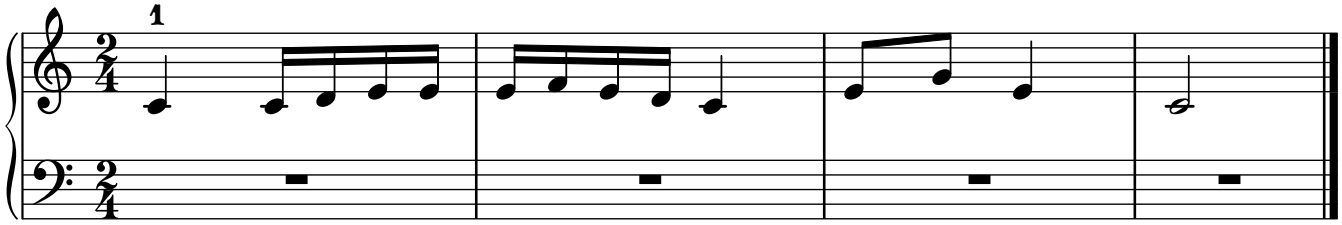
☐ **6.4**



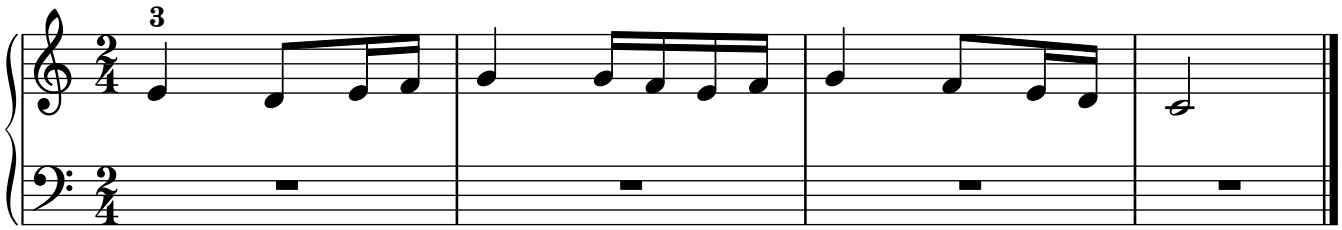
☐ **6.5**



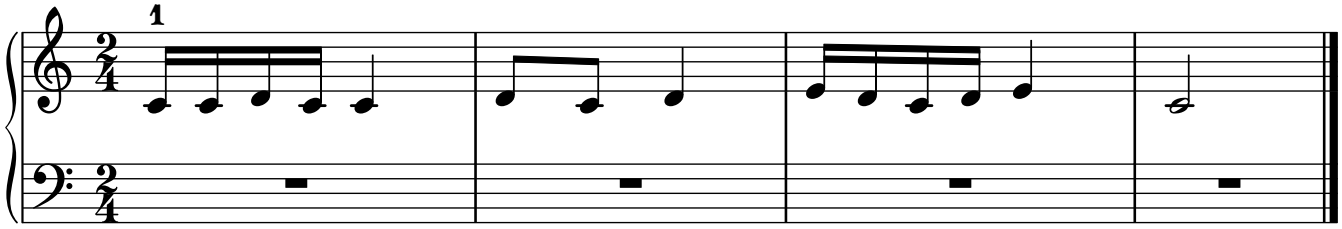
☐ **6.6**



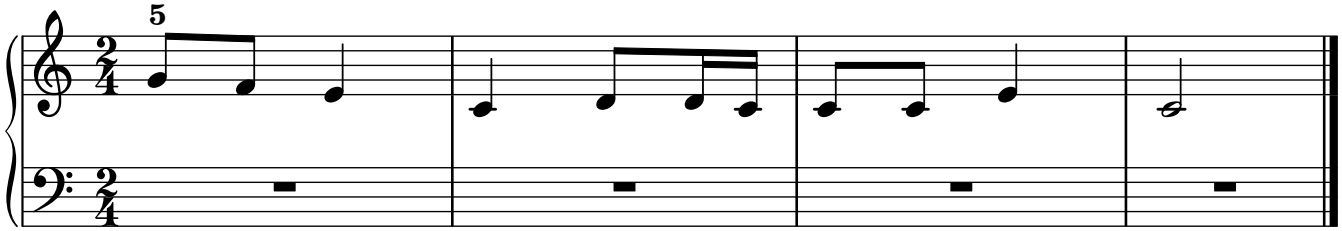
☐ **6.7**



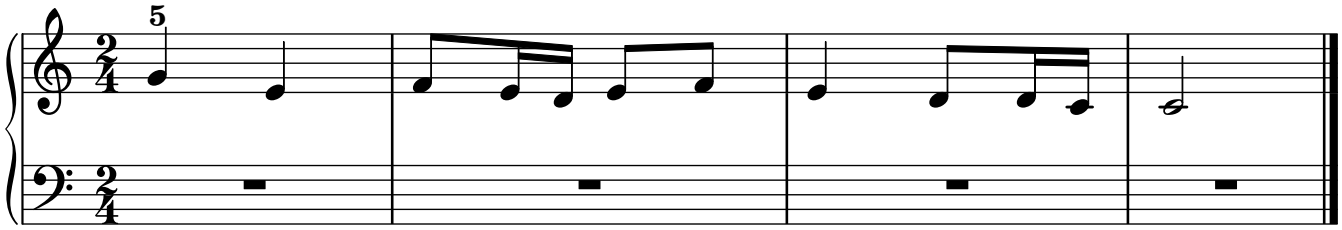
☐ **6.8**



☐ **6.9**



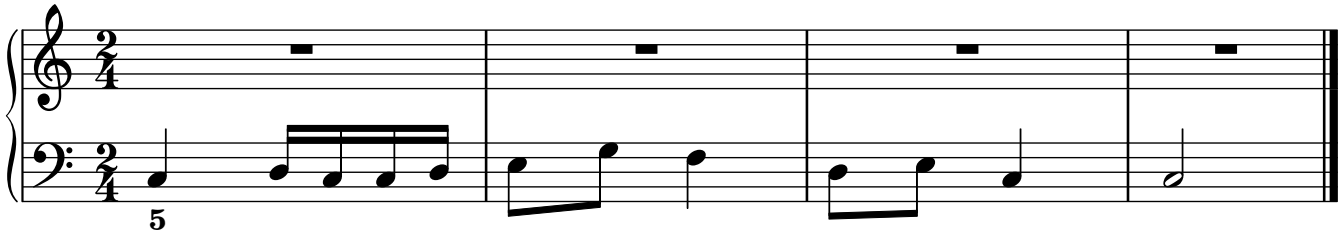
☐ **6.10**
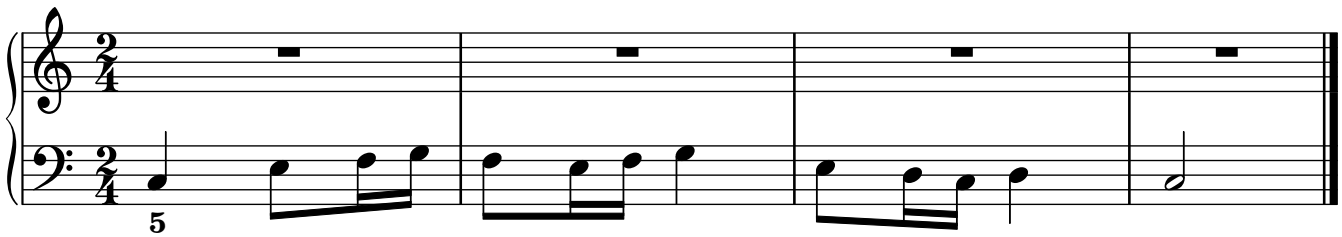


Part B: Sixteenths in the left hand ♩ = 60

Left hand in C position, 2/4.

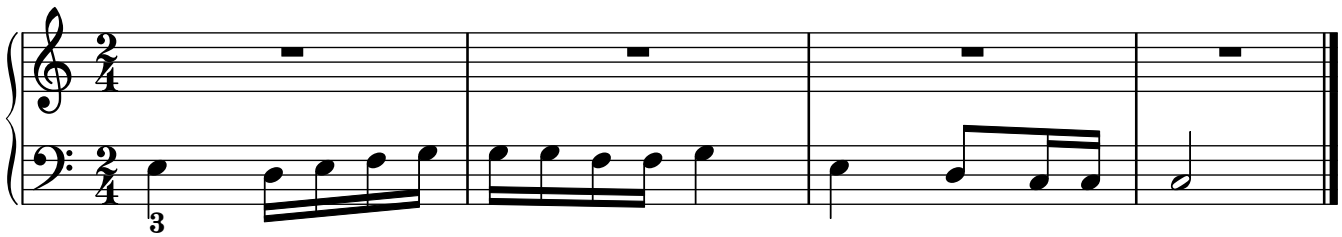
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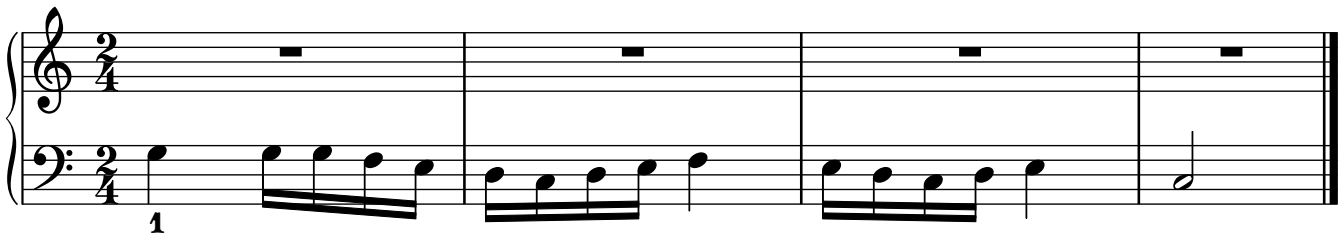
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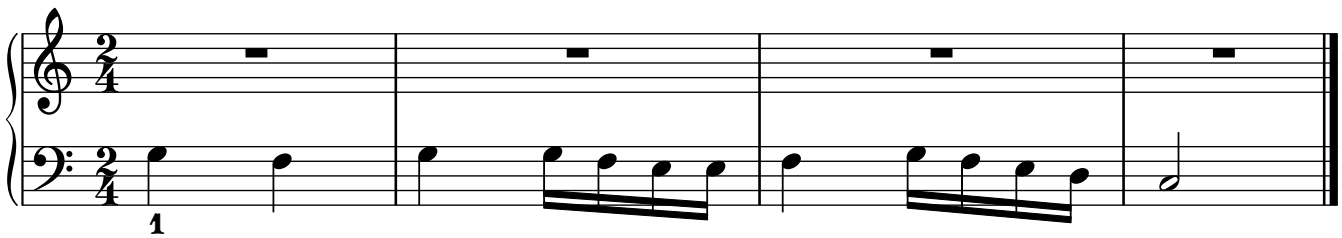
☐ **6.13**



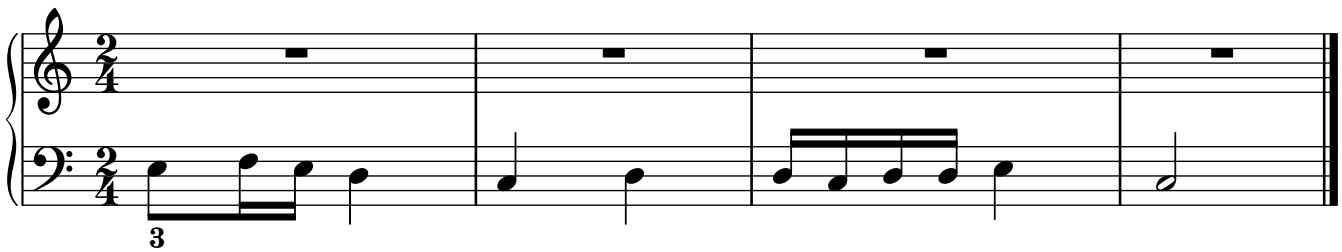
☐ **6.14**



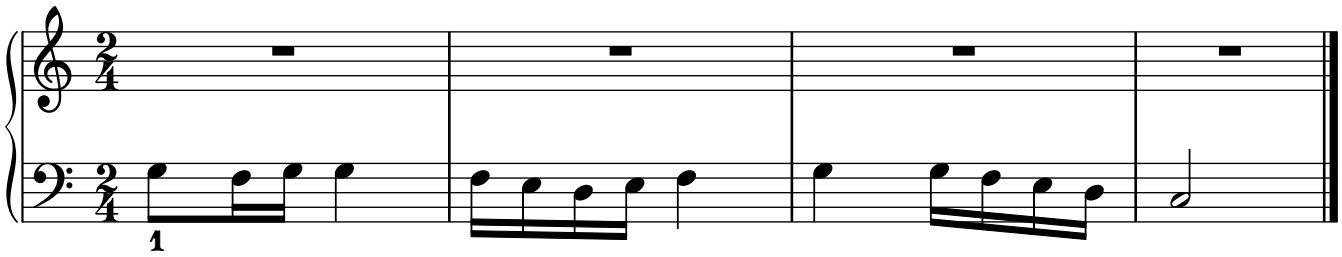
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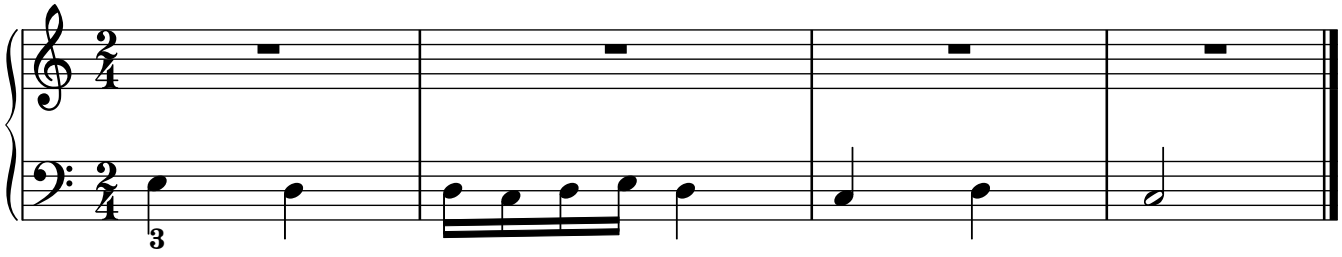
☐ **6.16**



6.17



6.18
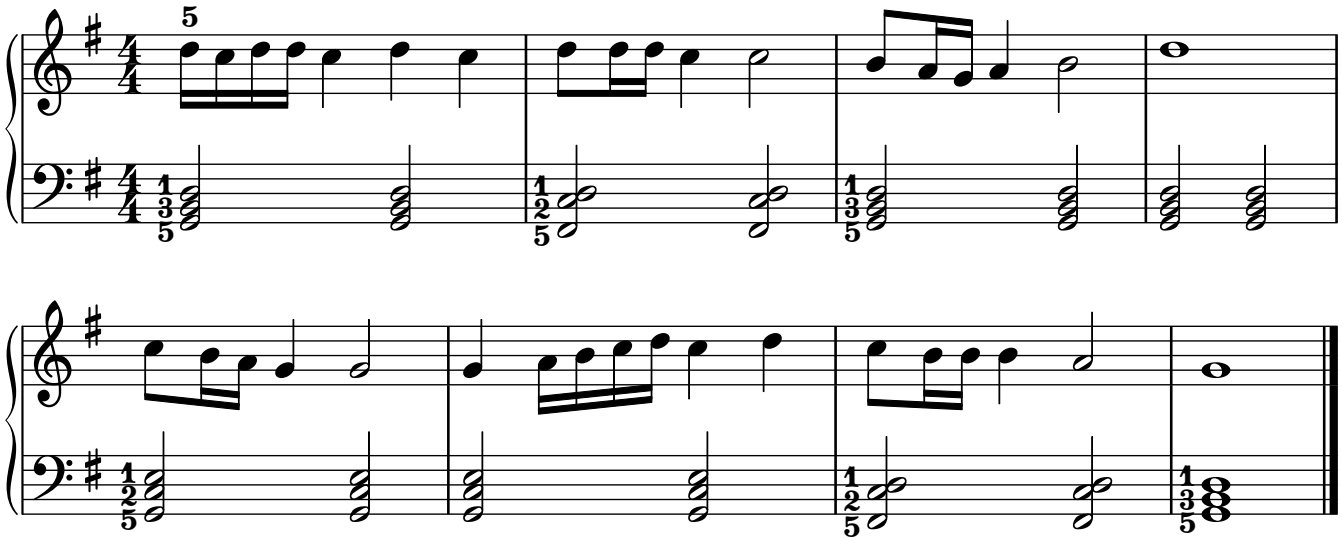


Part C: Sixteenths over block chords
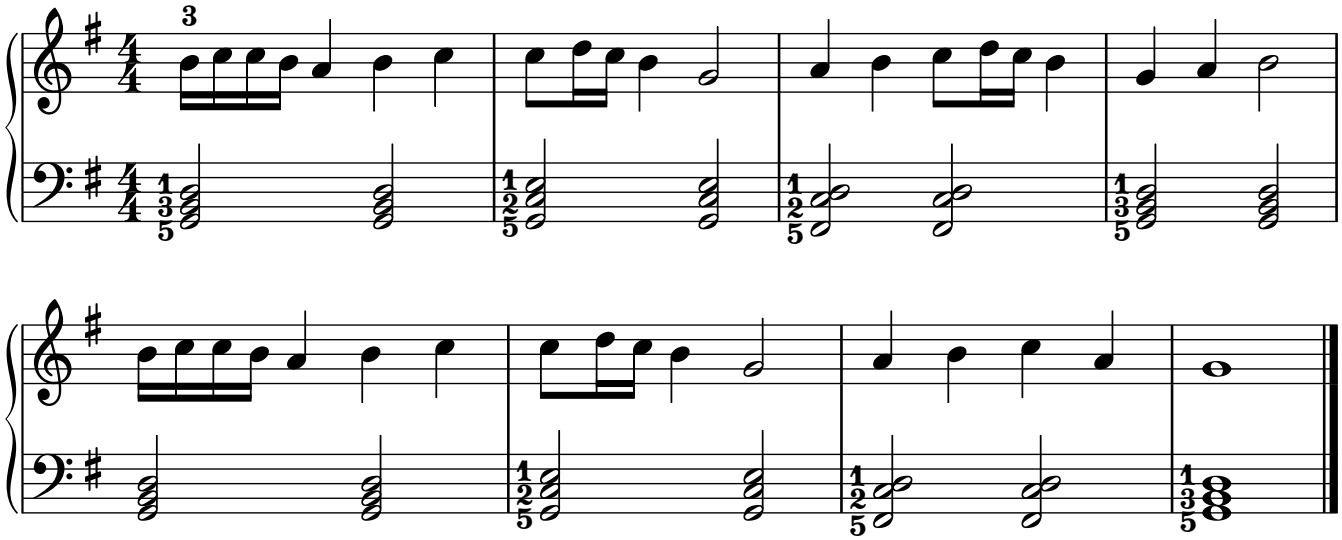
♩ = 60

G major in 4/4: sixteenths in the right hand over block chords.
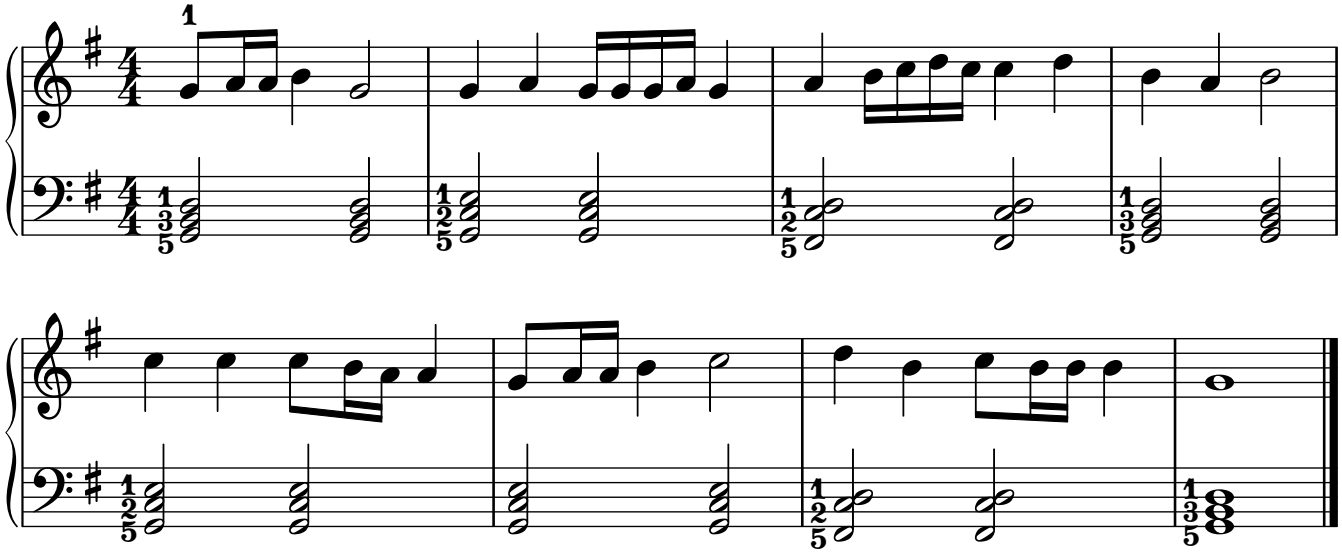
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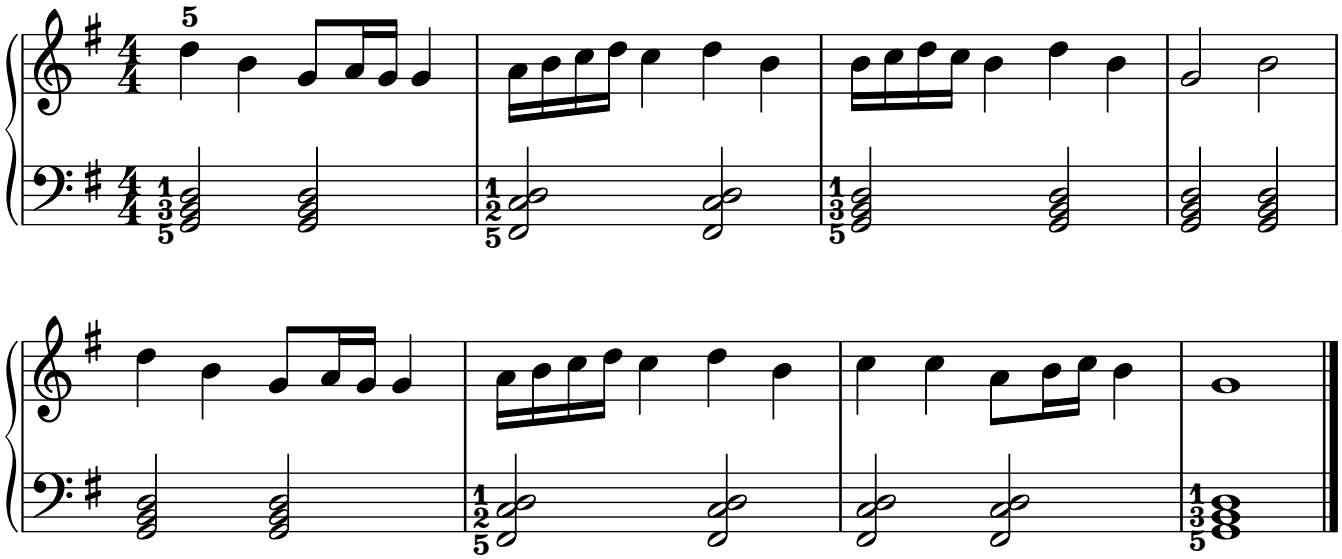


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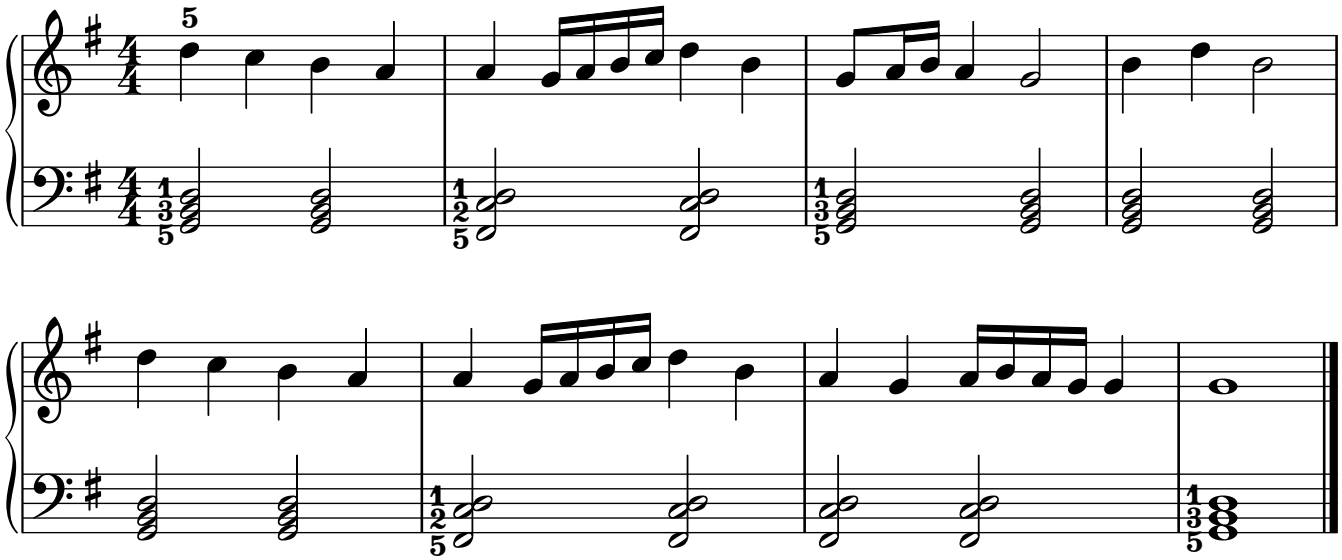


☐ **6.21**
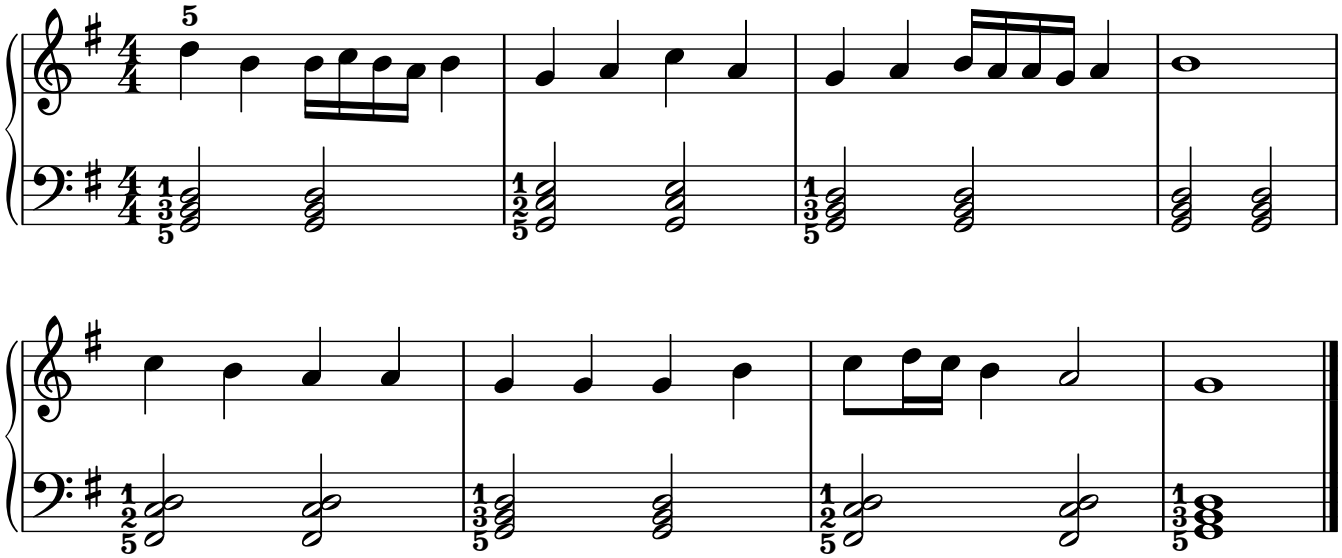


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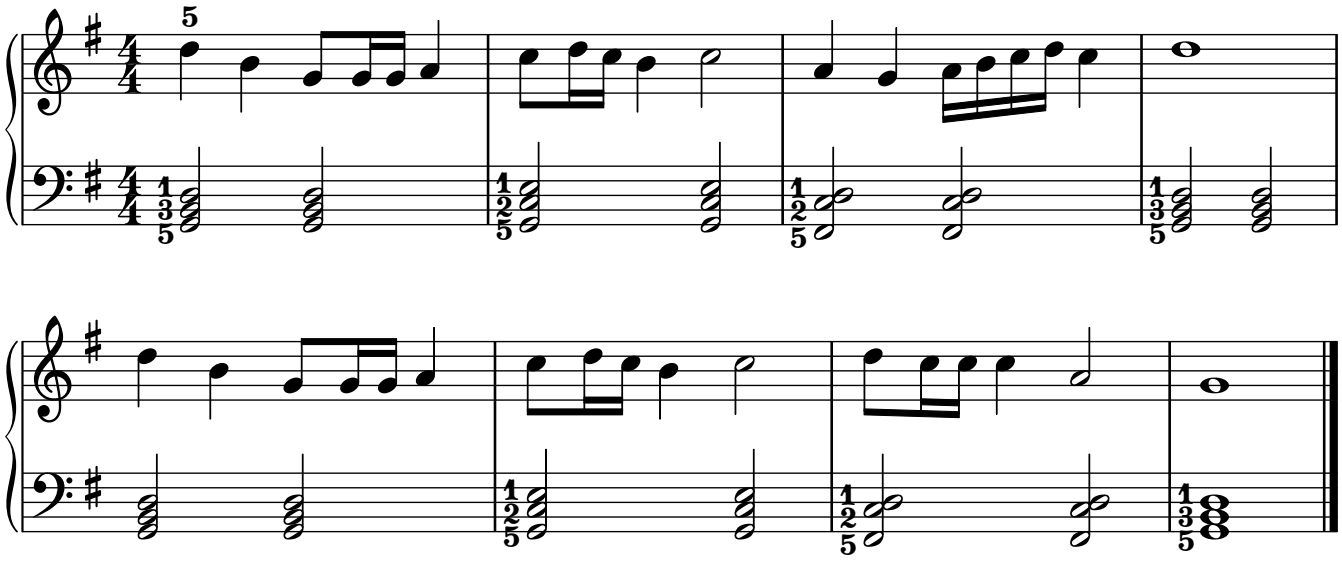


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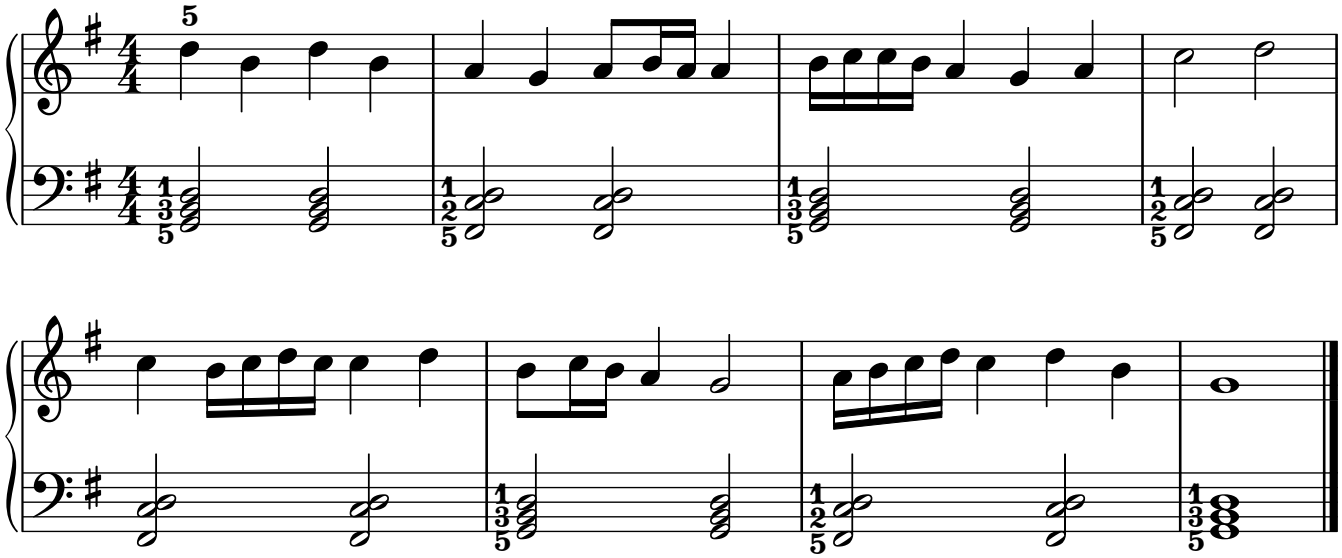


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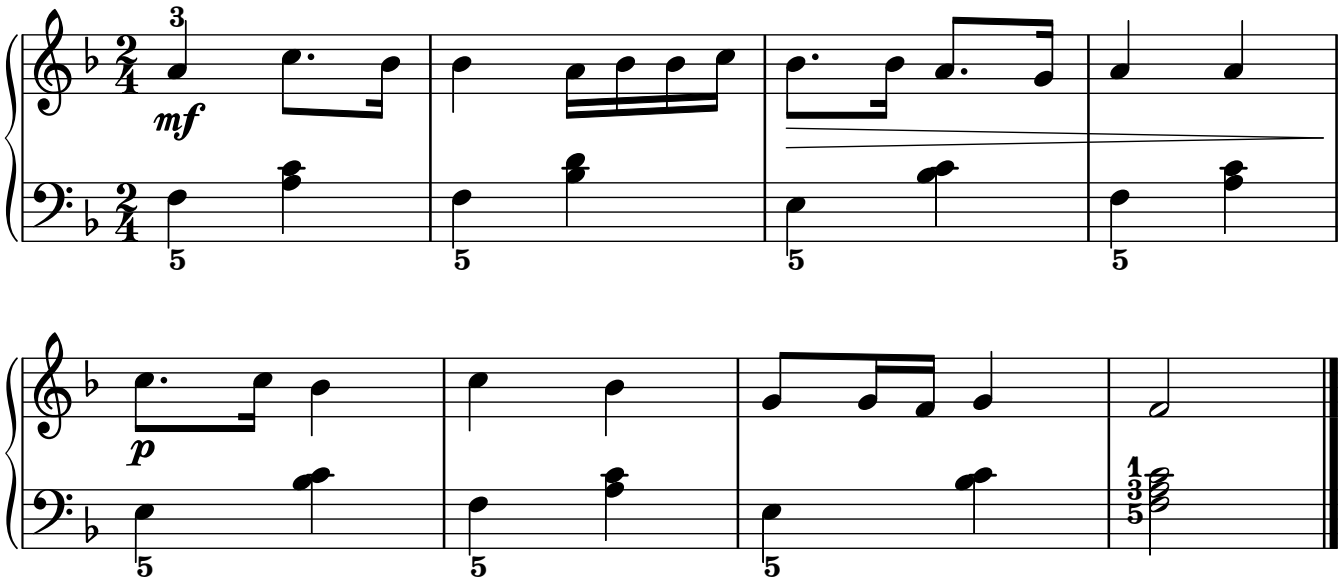


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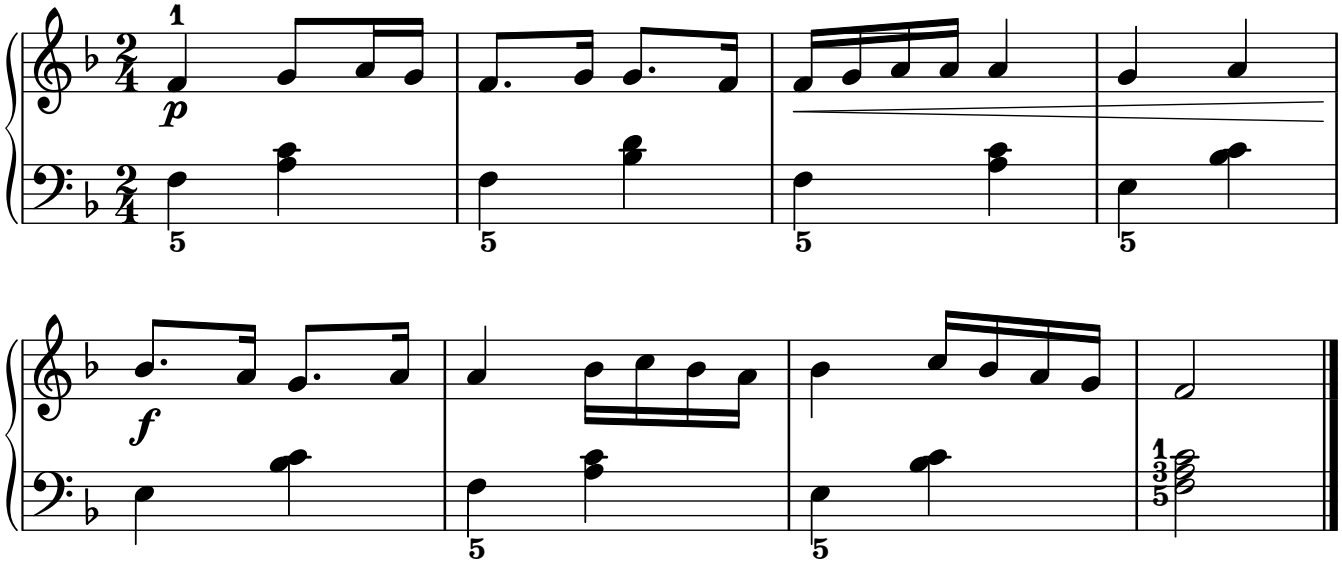


Part D: Dotted eighth and sixteenth ♩ = 66

F major in 2/4: dotted eighths and sixteenths over an oom-pah bass.

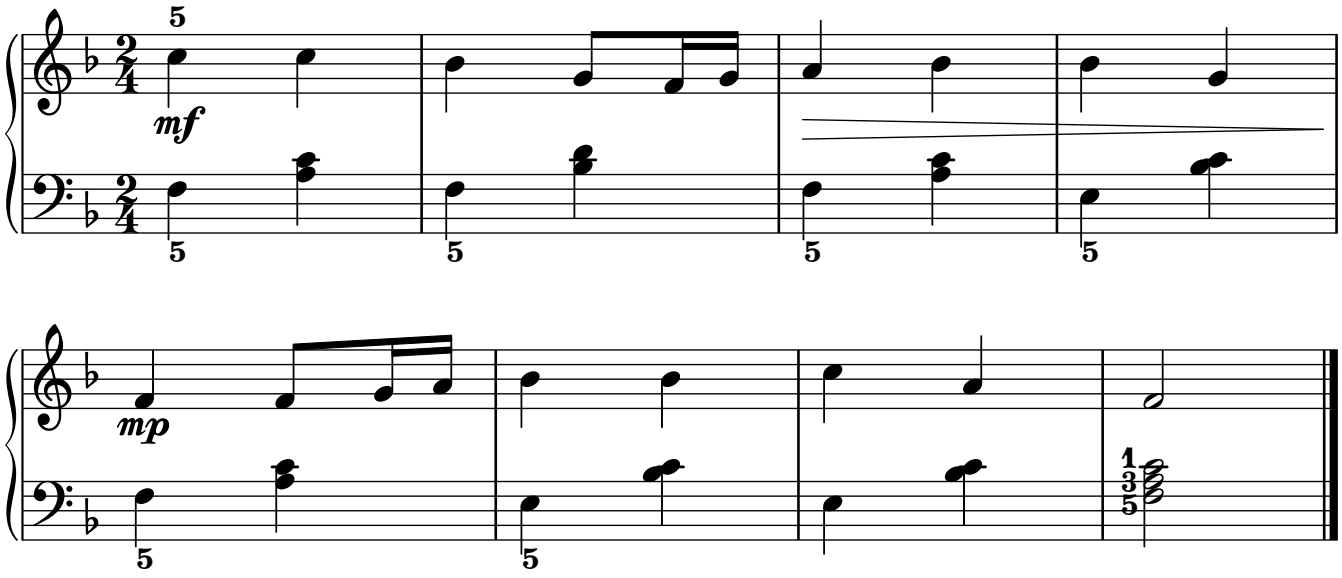
☐ **6.27**
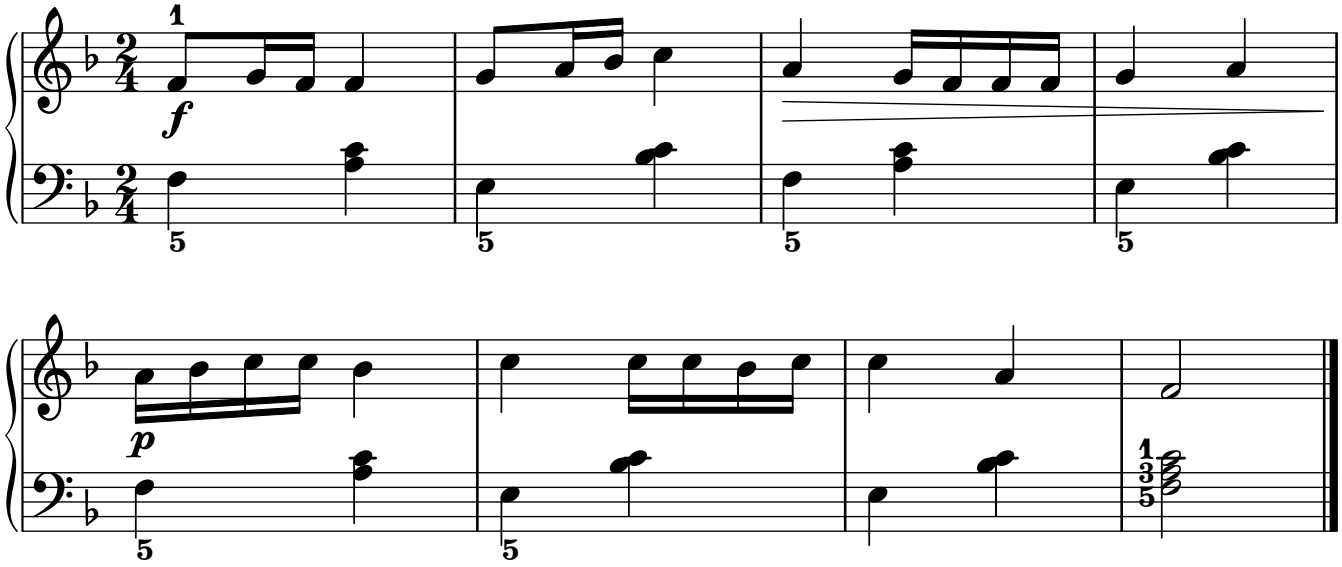


☐ **6.28**
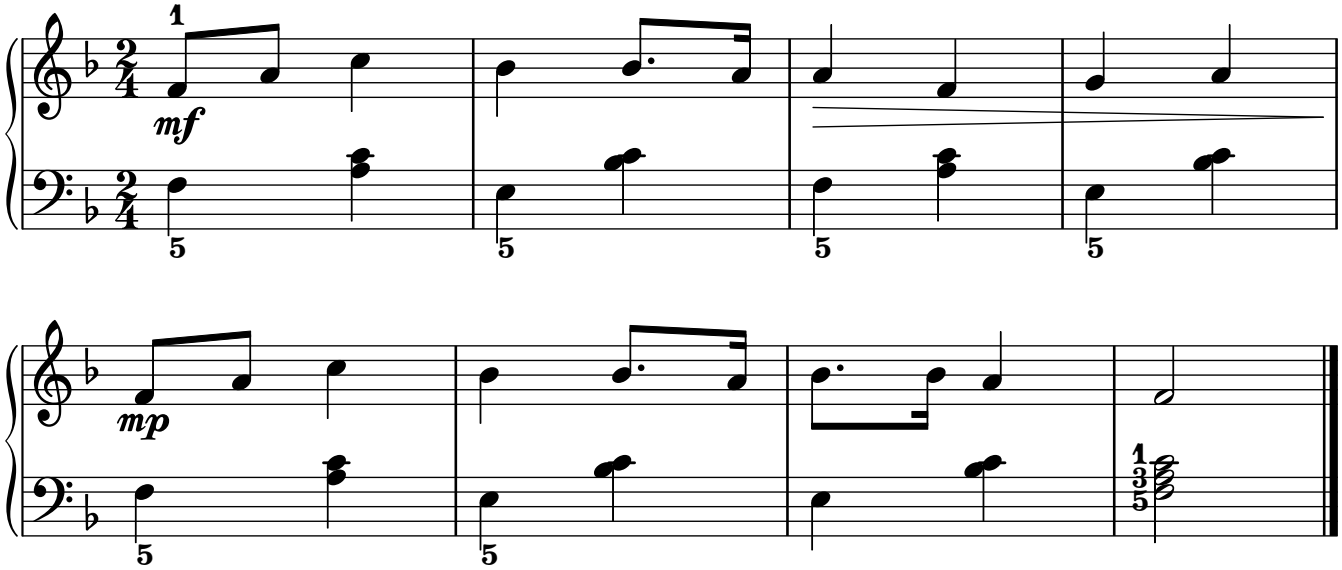


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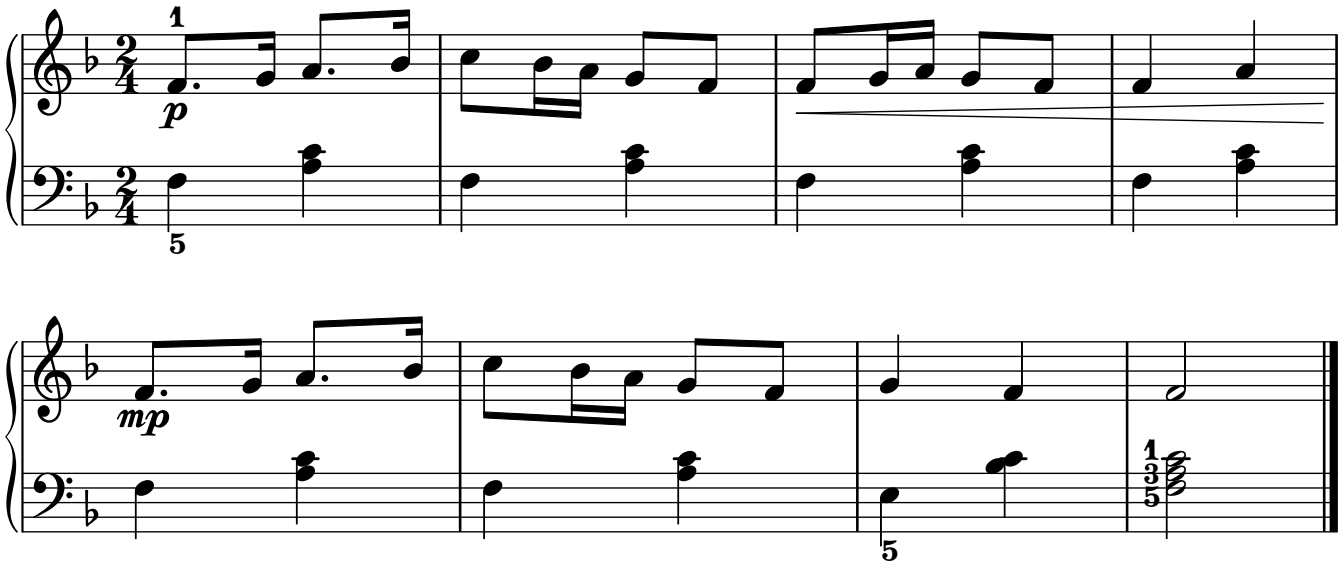


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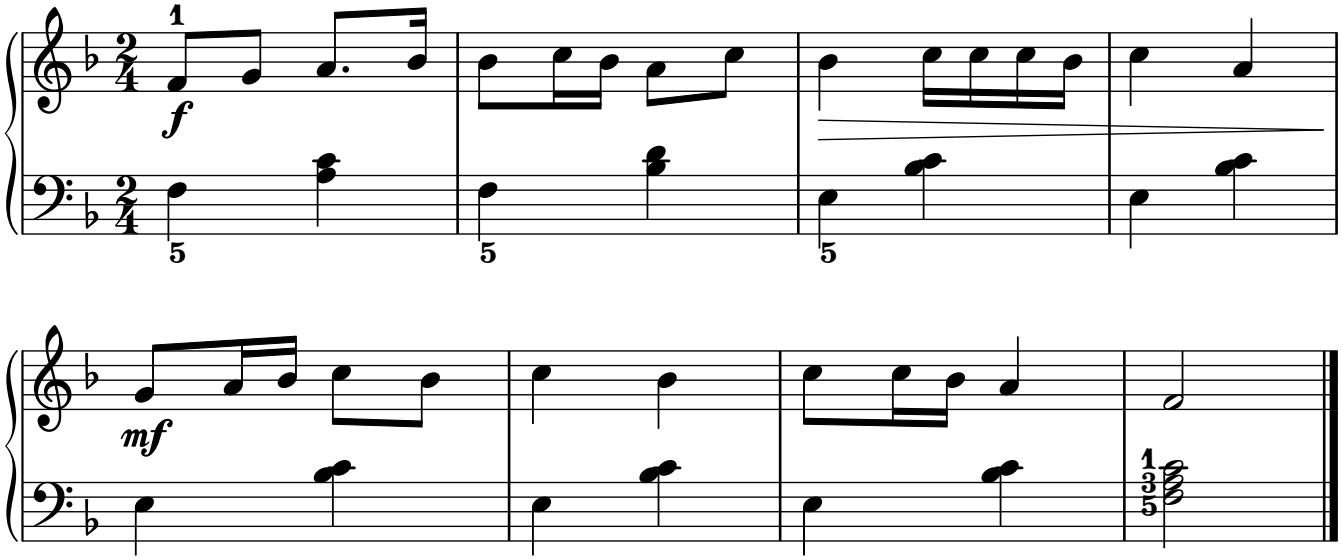


6.31



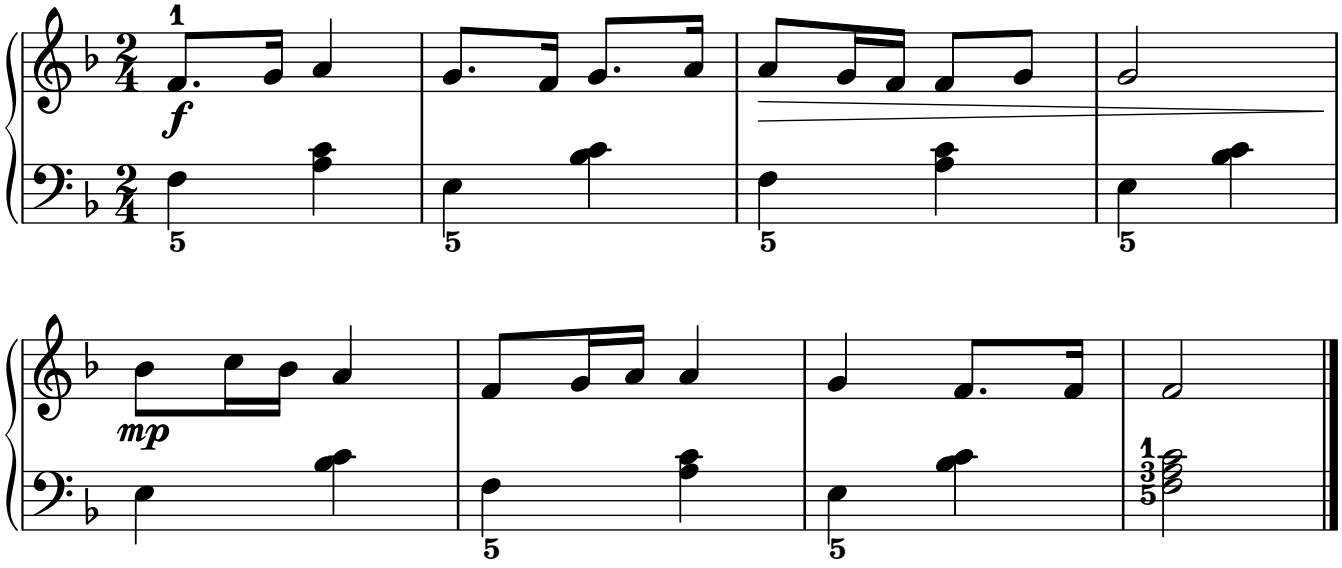
6.32



6.33



6.34
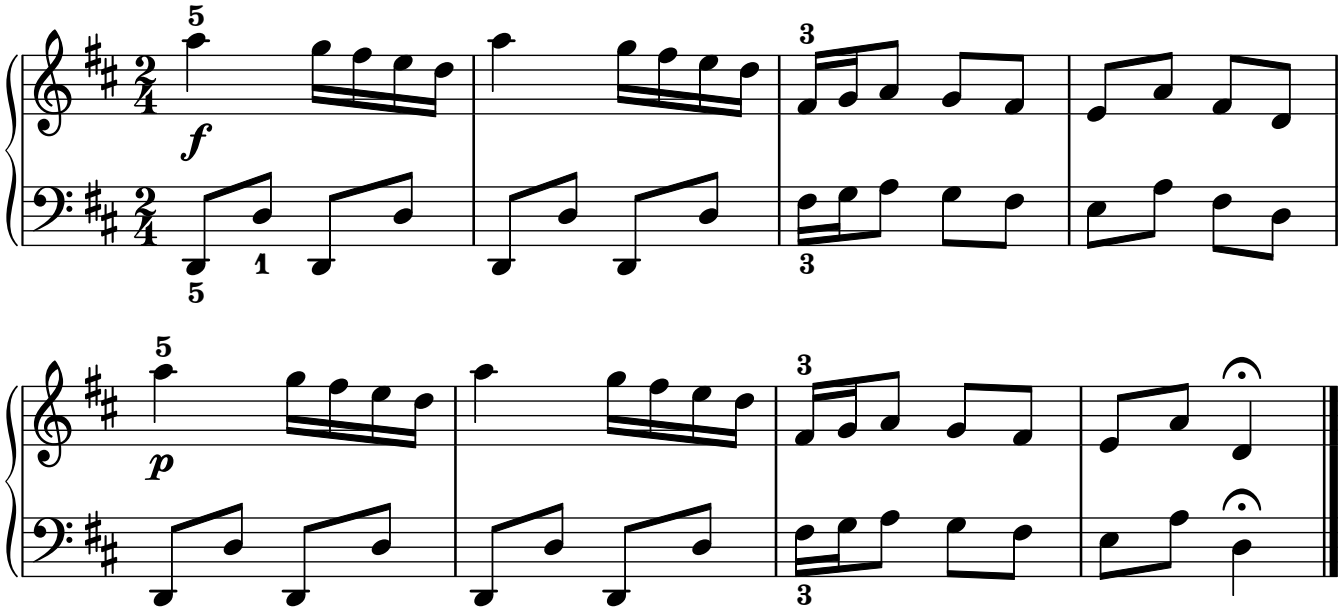


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Musette in D ♩= 72

From the Notebook for Anna Magdalena Bach (1725), BWV Anh. 126 - first part
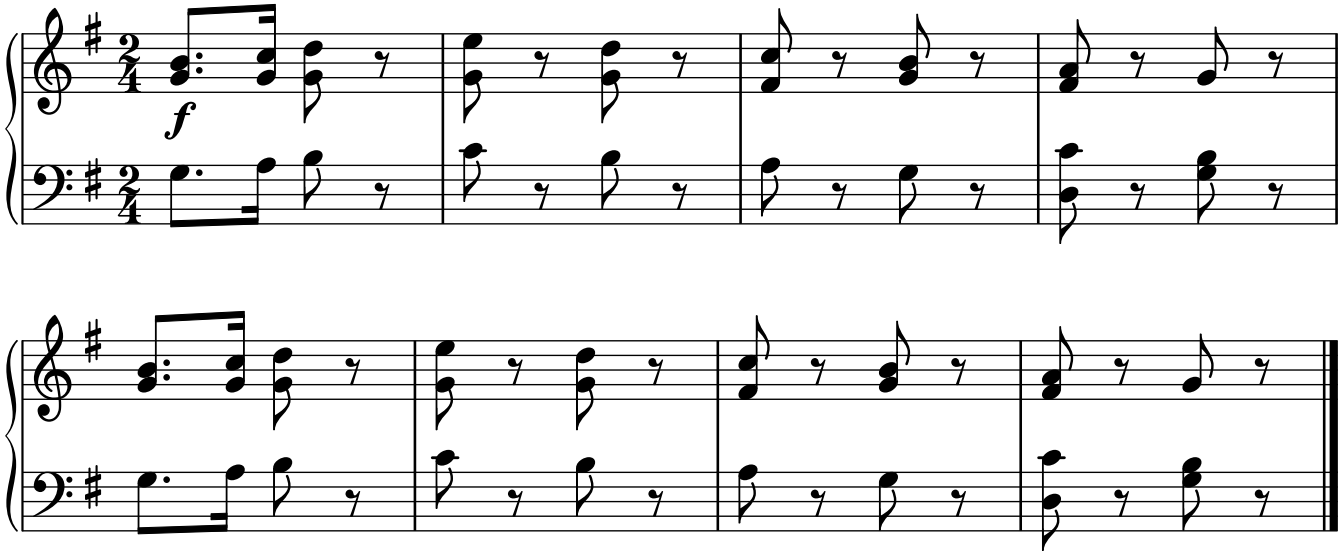
A musette imitates bagpipes: the left hand drones on low D in octaves, two ledger lines below the bass staff. The right hand starts high, on A above the staff, drops an octave in bar 3, and leaps back up for bar 5. Source: Mutopia Project no. 79.



Soldiers' March ♩= 108

Robert Schumann, Op. 68 No. 2 (first part) - shortened

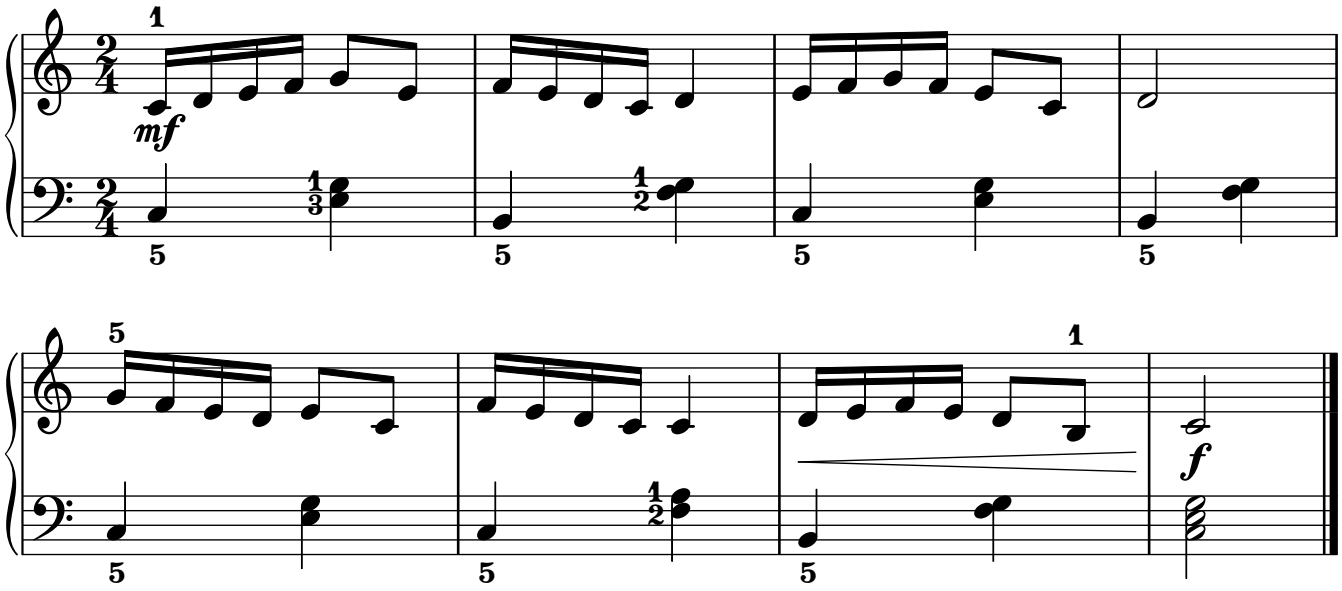
From Schumann's Album for the Young: crisp dotted rhythms and chords in both hands, with rests between the chords. Bars 1-6 are as Schumann wrote them; bars 7-8 come from the end of his second phrase, so the march stops at home. Notes from Mutopia Project no. 650.



Busy Bee ♩= 72

Original

Groups of four sixteenths buzz up and down the C position; each group is a little scale. The left hand plays oom-pah.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 7?

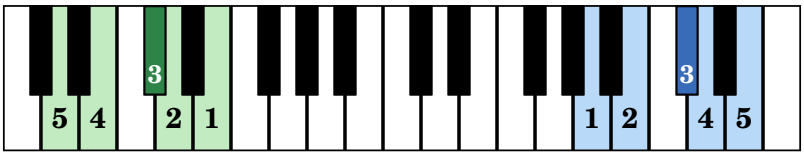
- Play five new Part B to D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Every group of sixteenths fits evenly into its beat, and dotted rhythms stay crisp.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 7.

Unit 7

Three Sharps and Three Flats

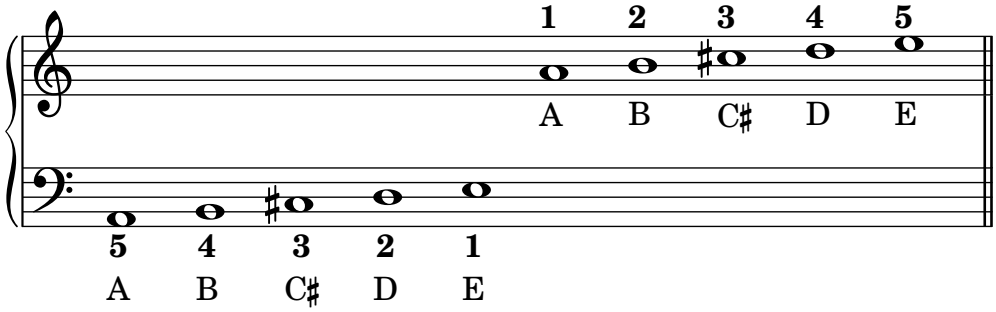
New: A major, E-flat major, F-sharp minor and C minor

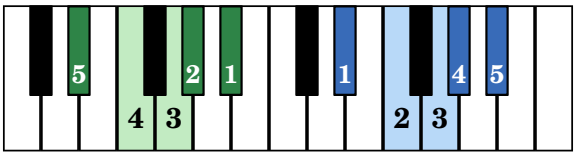
Two new major keys and their relative minors. A major has three sharps (F, C and G); its relative minor is F-sharp minor. E-flat major has three flats (B, E and A); its relative minor is C minor. Each new sharp or flat adds one black key to the hand positions you already know.



Left hand A position and Right hand A position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

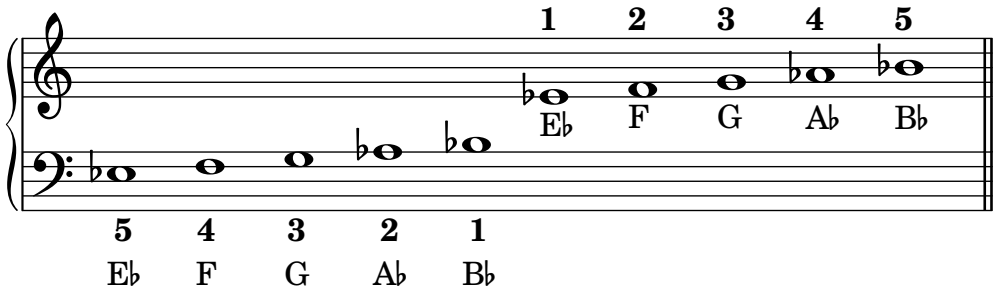
Your notes



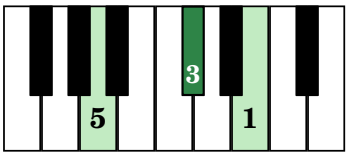


Left hand E-flat position and Right hand E-flat position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

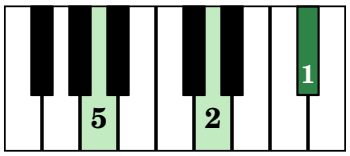
Your notes



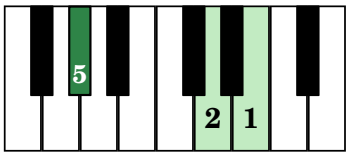
A major: left-hand chord shapes



I = A

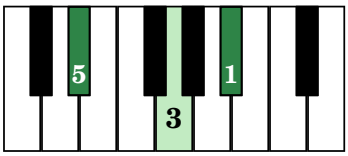


IV = D

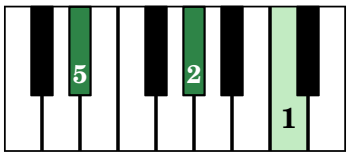


V7 = E7

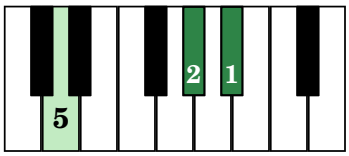
E-flat major: left-hand chord shapes



I = E♭

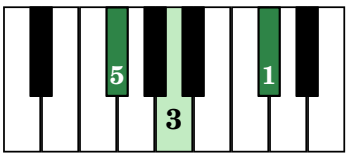


IV = A♭

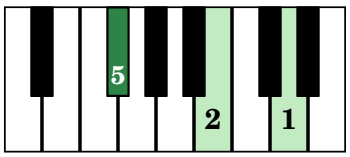


V7 = B♭7

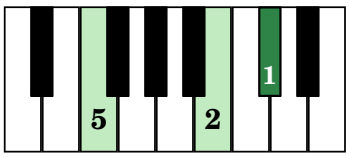
F-sharp minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = F♯m

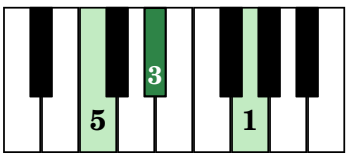


iv = Bm

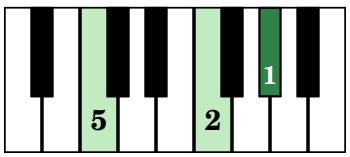


V7 = C♯7

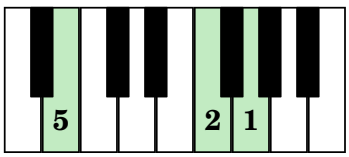
C minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = Cm

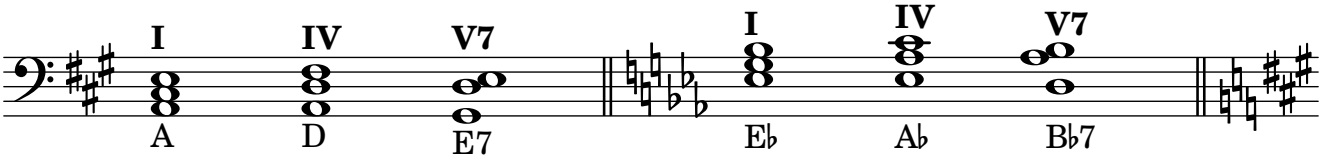


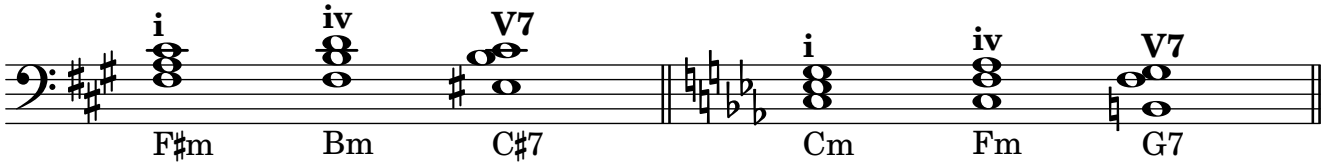
iv = Fm



V7 = G7

The same shapes on the staff





What is new

Three sharps, three flats

Sharps come in the order F C G (D A E B); flats in the order B E A (D G C F). The last sharp is the 7th note of the major key: G-sharp in A major. The second last flat names the key: E-flat.

F-sharp minor: E-sharp

The raised 7th of F-sharp minor is E-sharp, which is the white key F. It looks strange but is just the key below F-sharp.

C minor: B-natural

The raised 7th of C minor is B-natural: the key signature has B-flat, so the accidental is a natural sign.

Reading tips

1. Before you play, name the three sharps or flats and touch those keys with the right fingers.
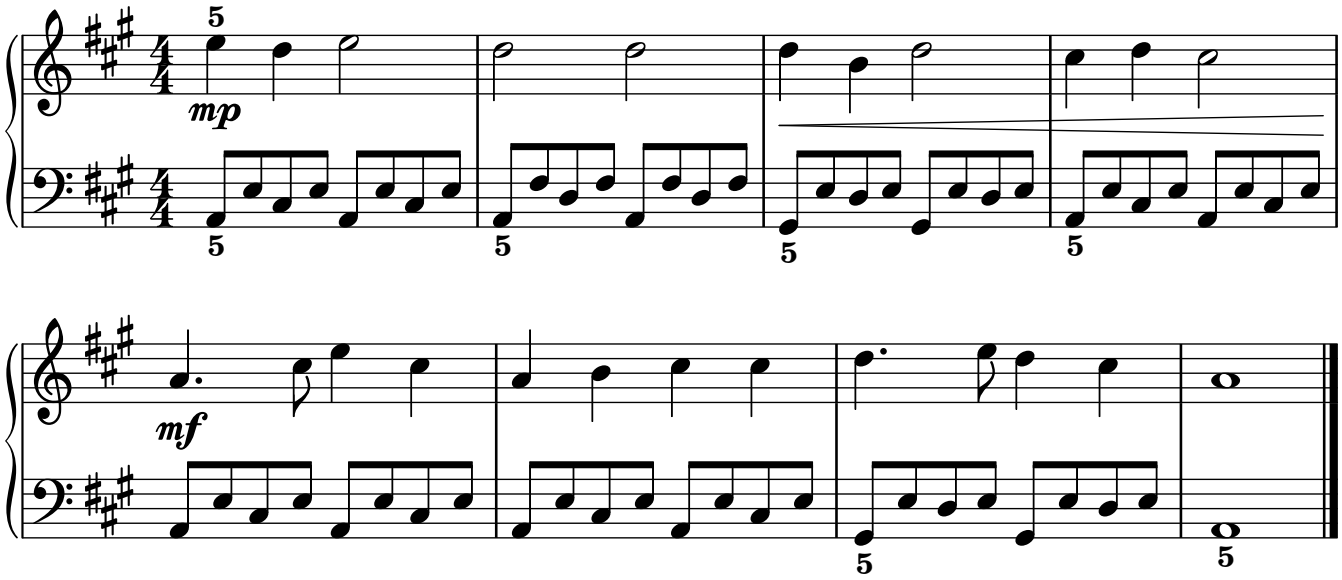
2. In the minor keys, expect the accidental (E-sharp or B-natural) in V7 bars.

3. E-sharp and B-sharp, C-flat and F-flat are white keys: read the note name, then trust your hand.
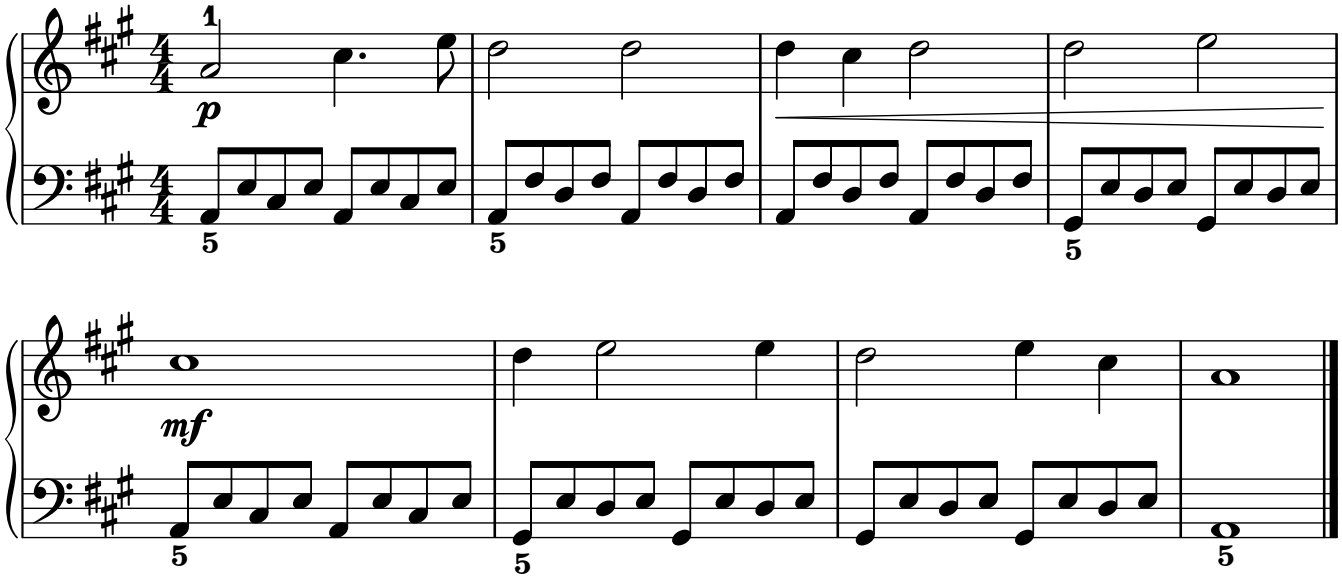
Part A: A major ♩ = 60

A major with an Alberti bass. G-sharp is the bottom note of the V7 shape.
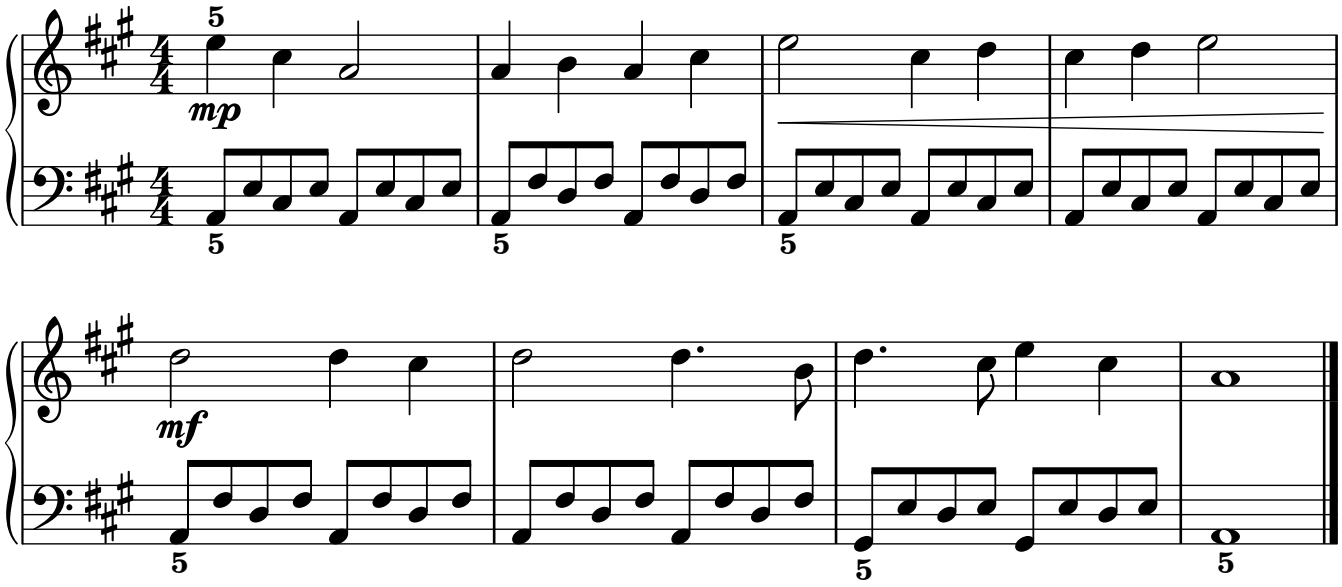
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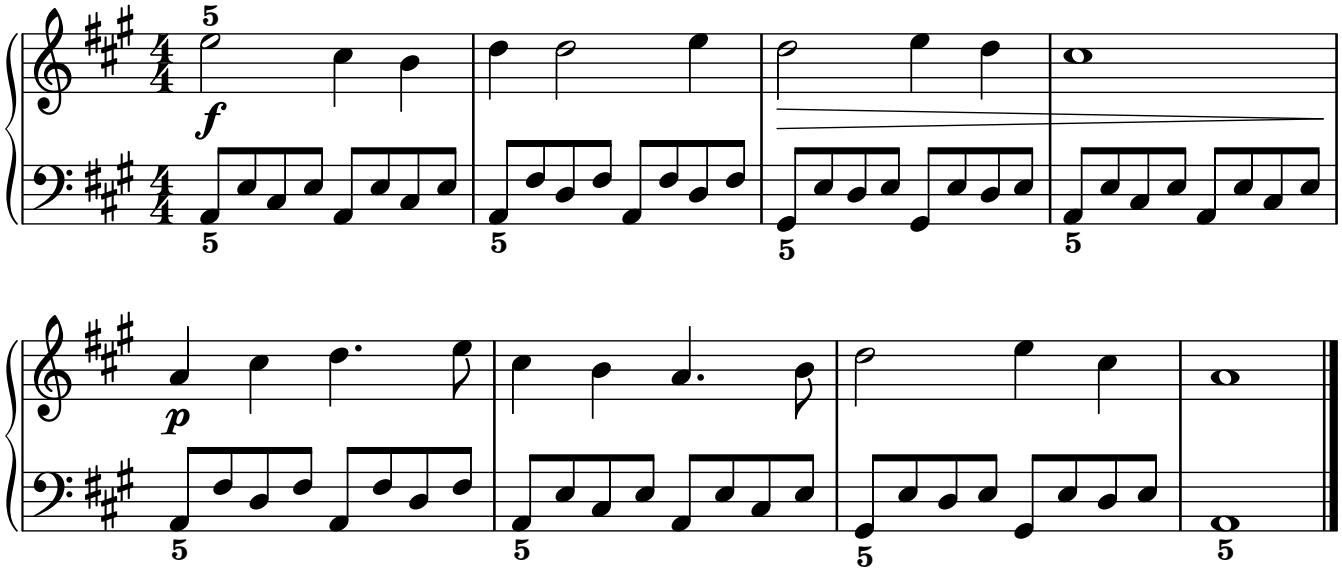


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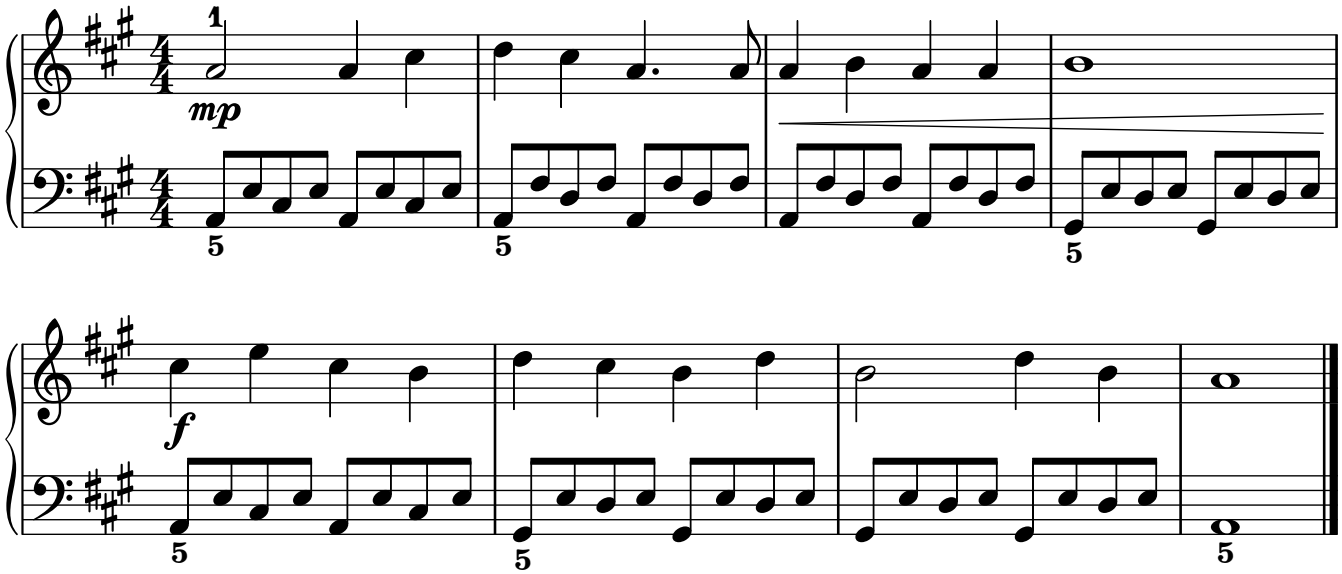


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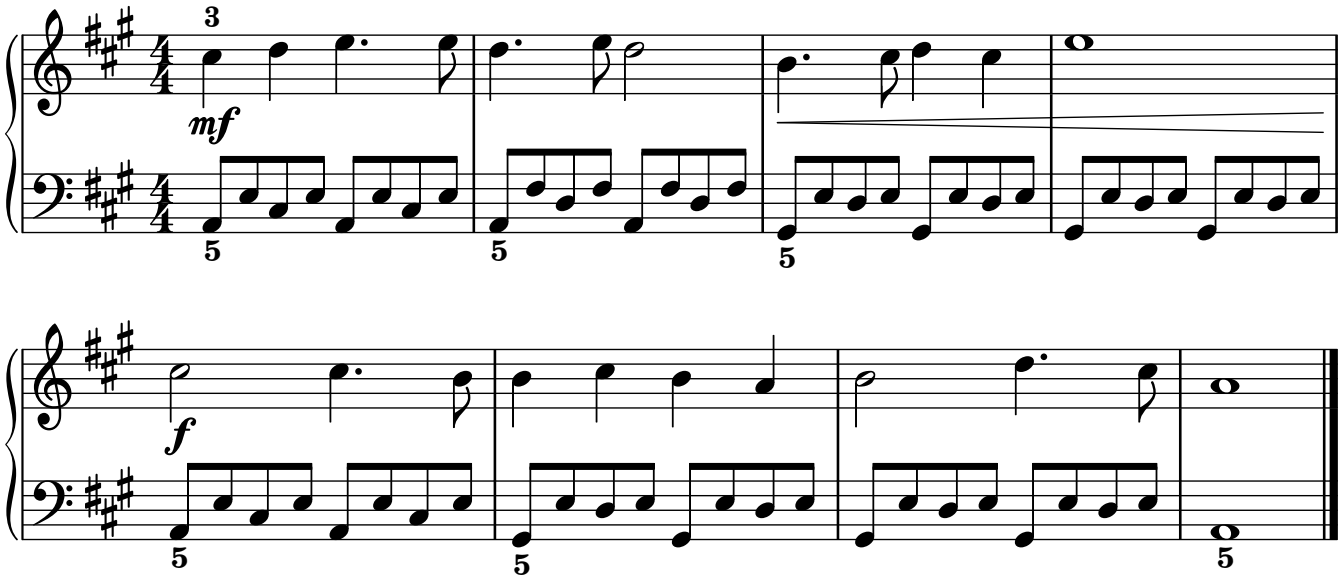


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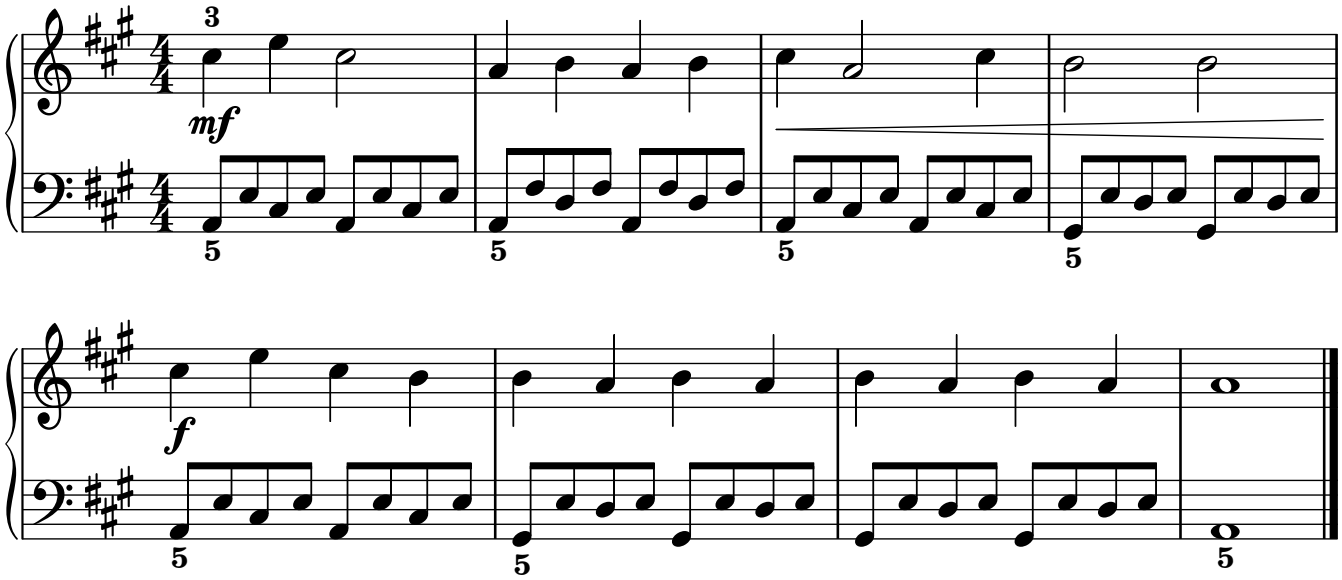


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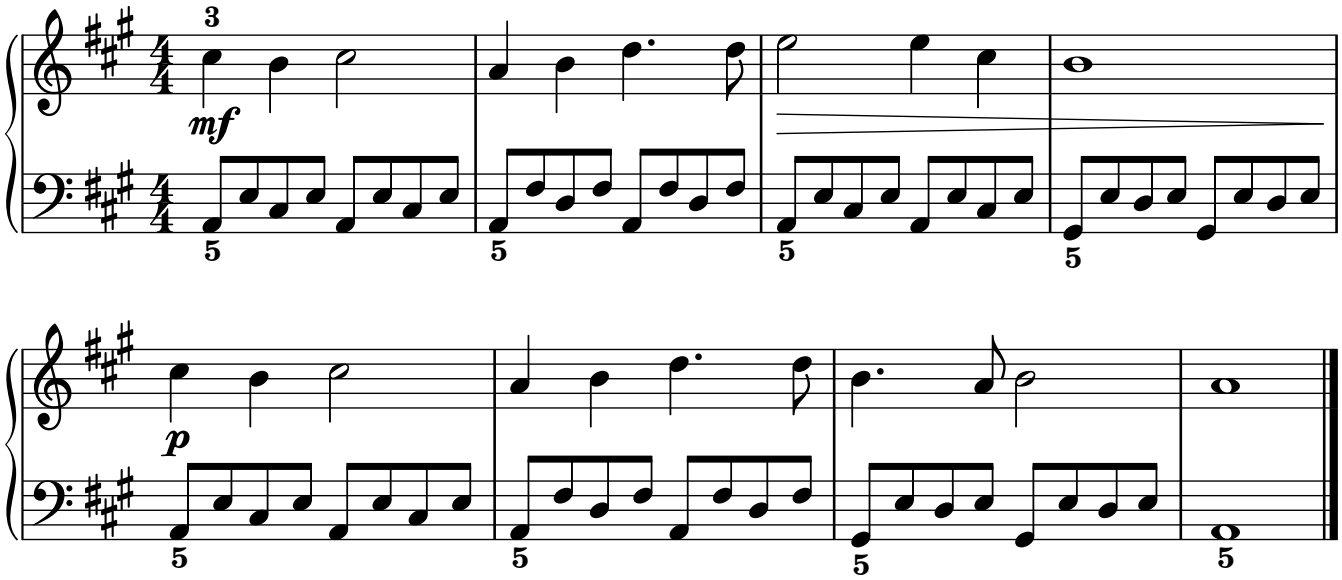


7.6



7.7



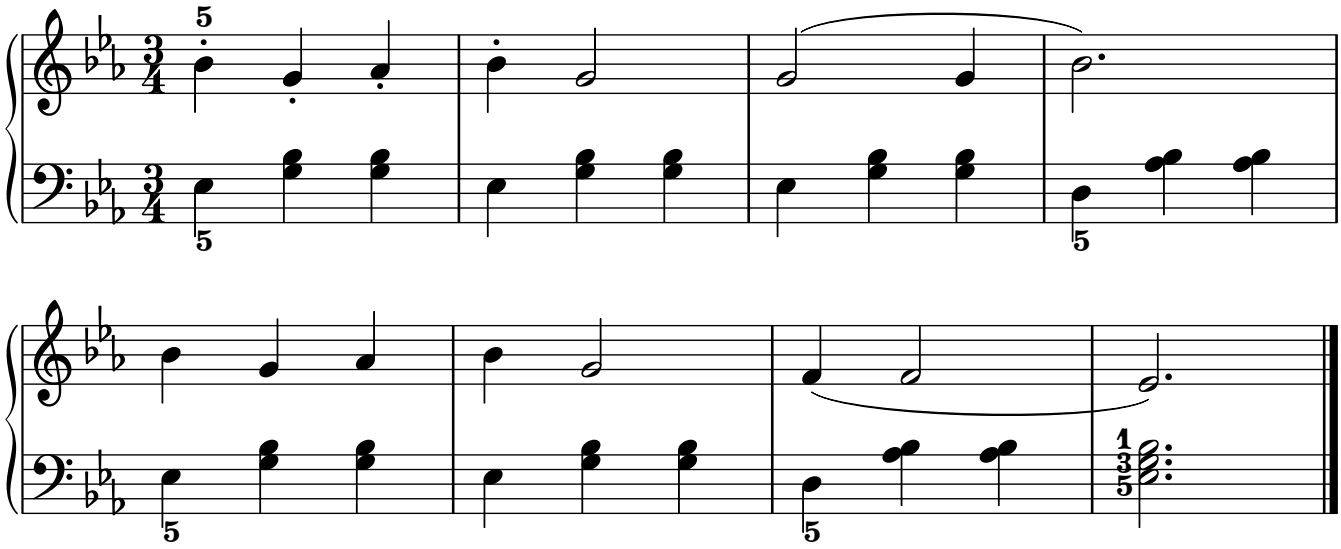
7.8



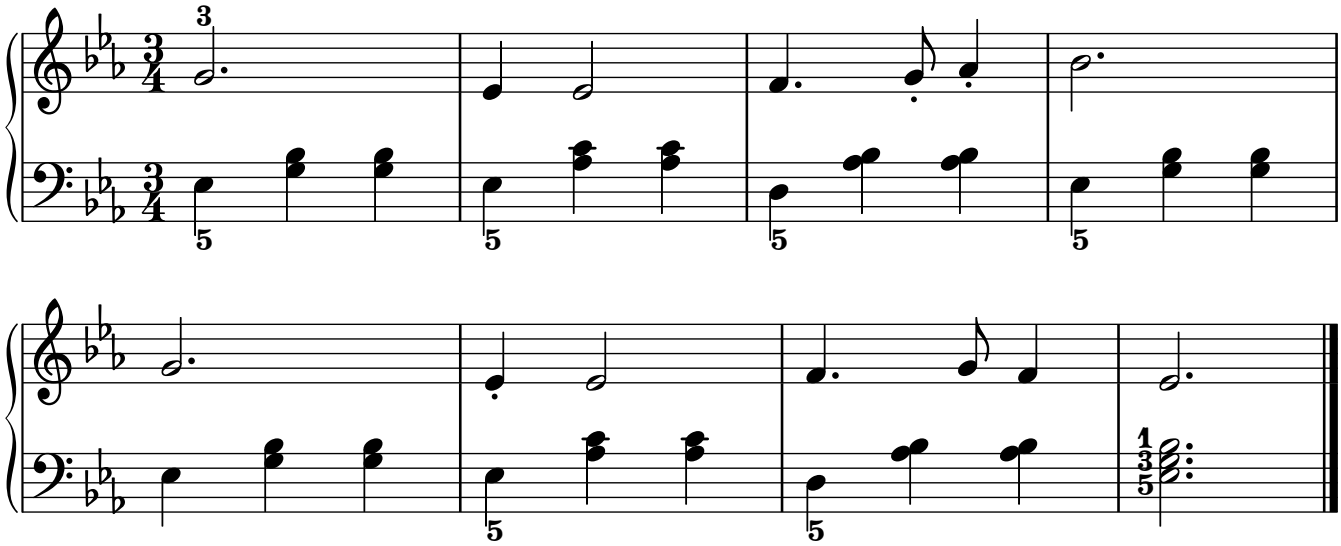
Part B: E-flat major waltz ♩ = 80

E-flat major waltzes. The thumb of the right hand sits on E-flat.
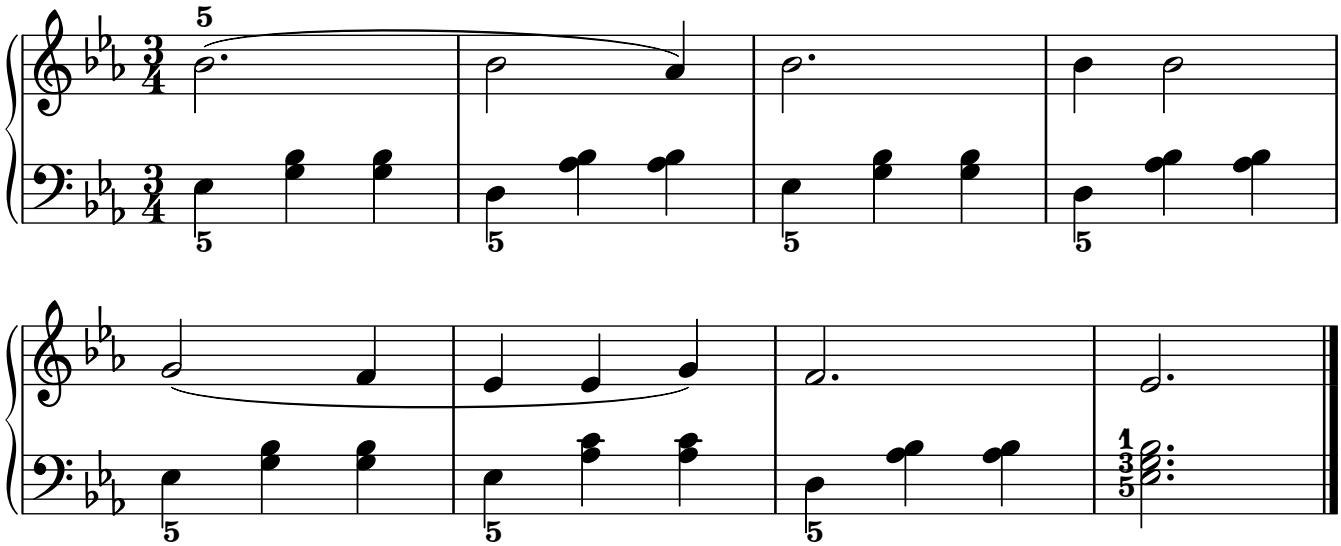
☐ **7.9**



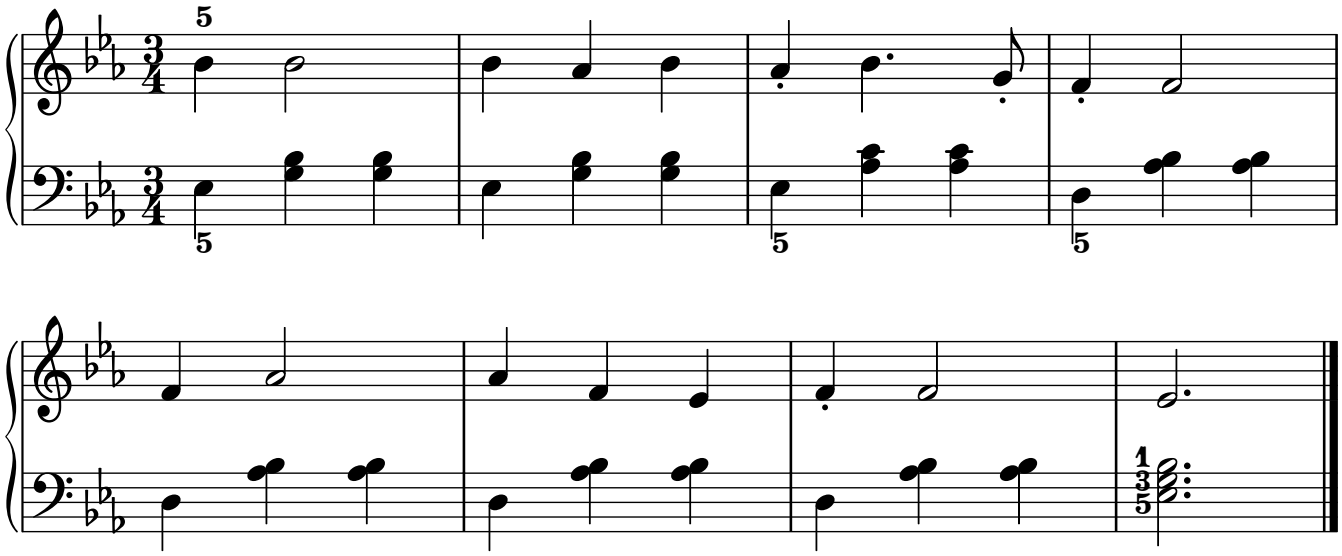
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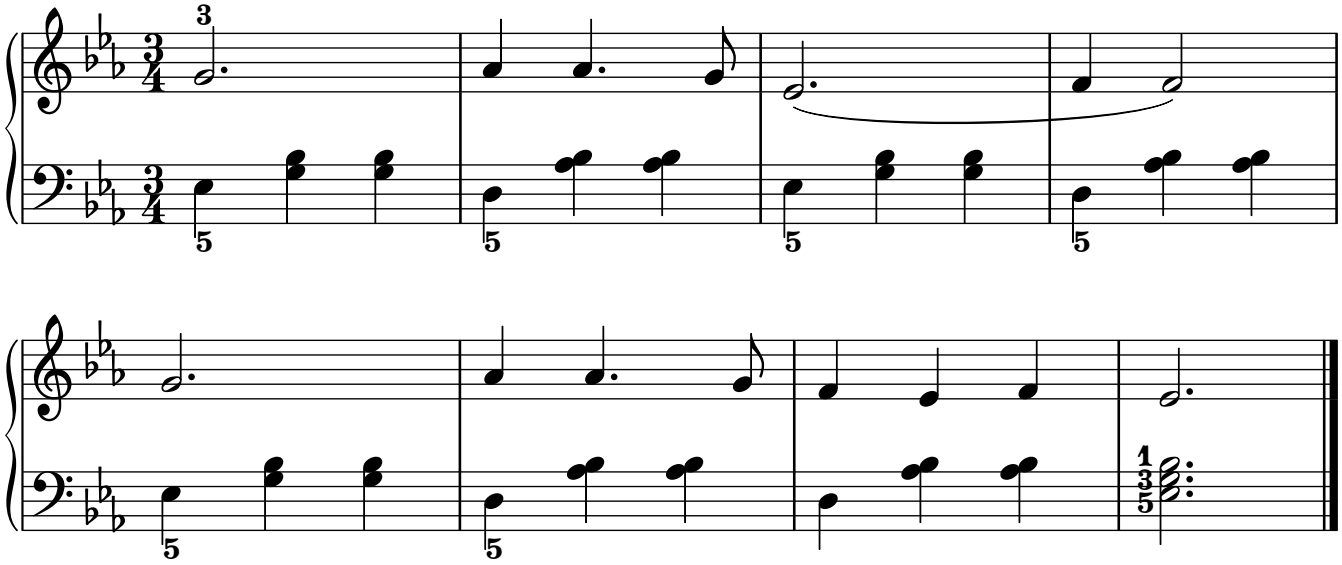


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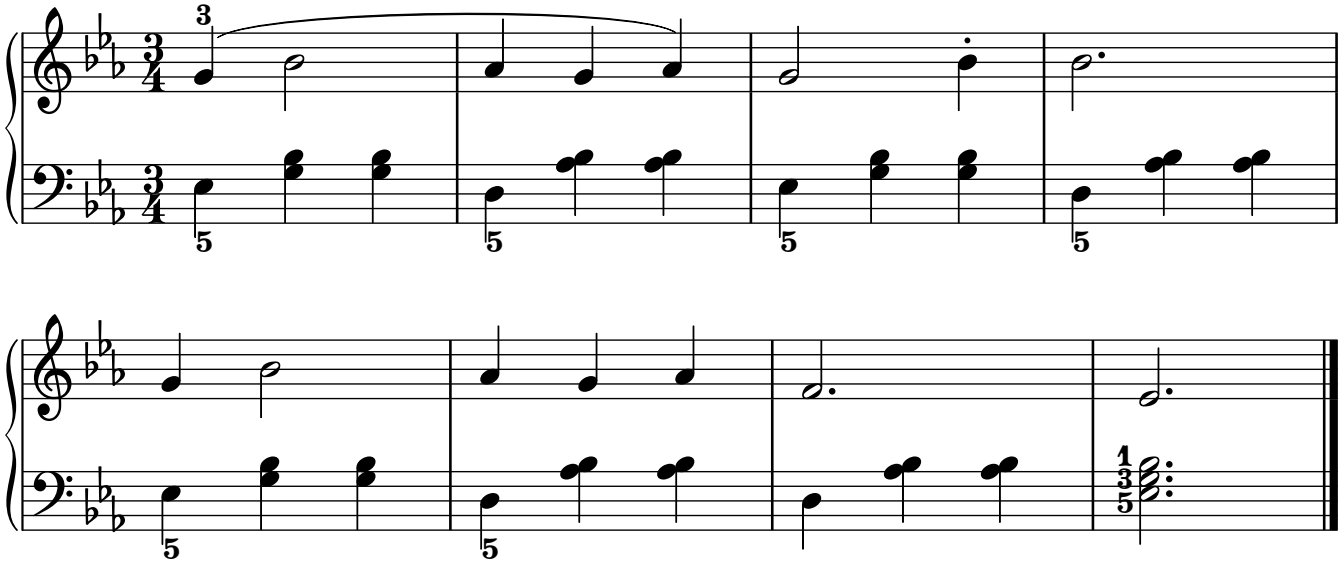


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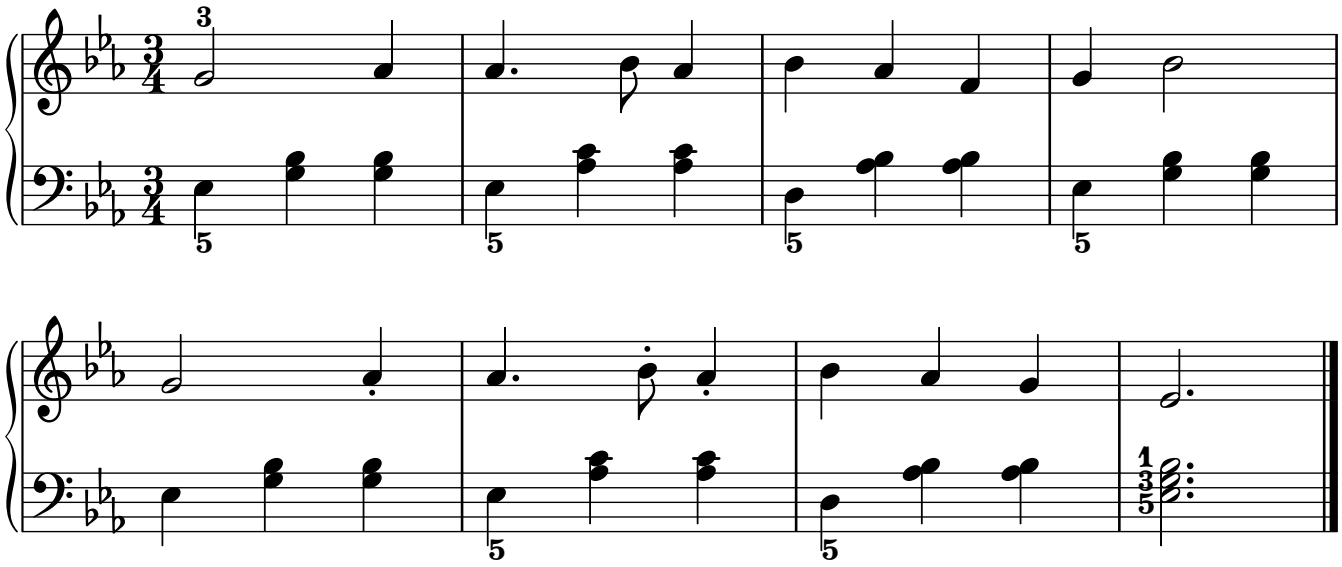
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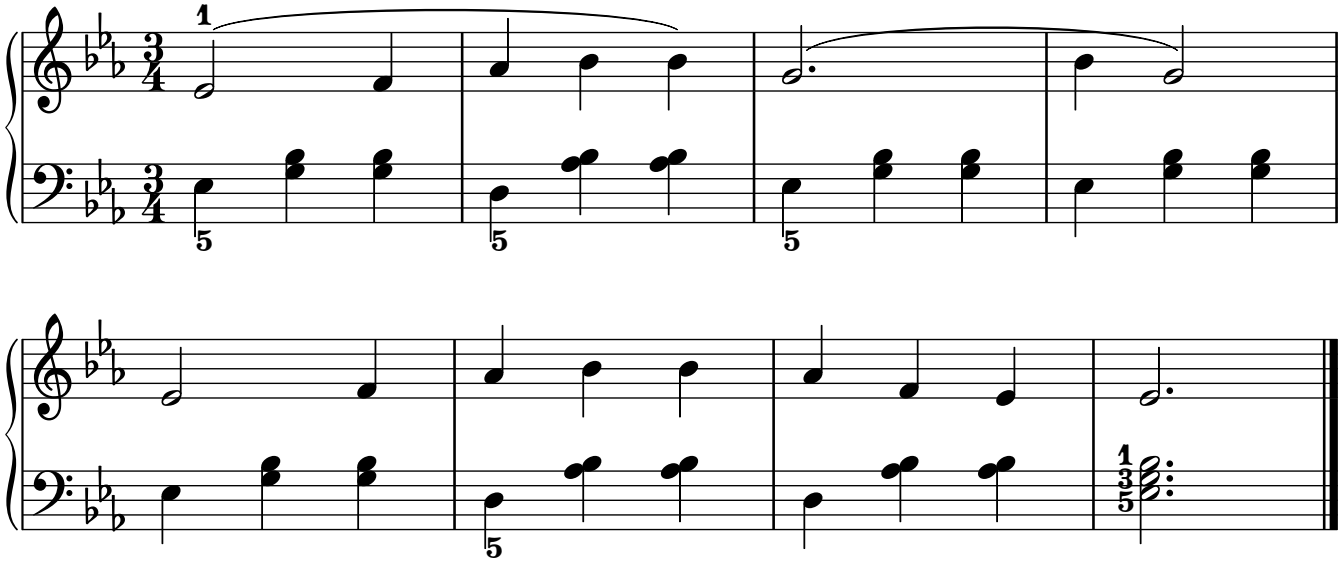
7.14



7.15



7.16

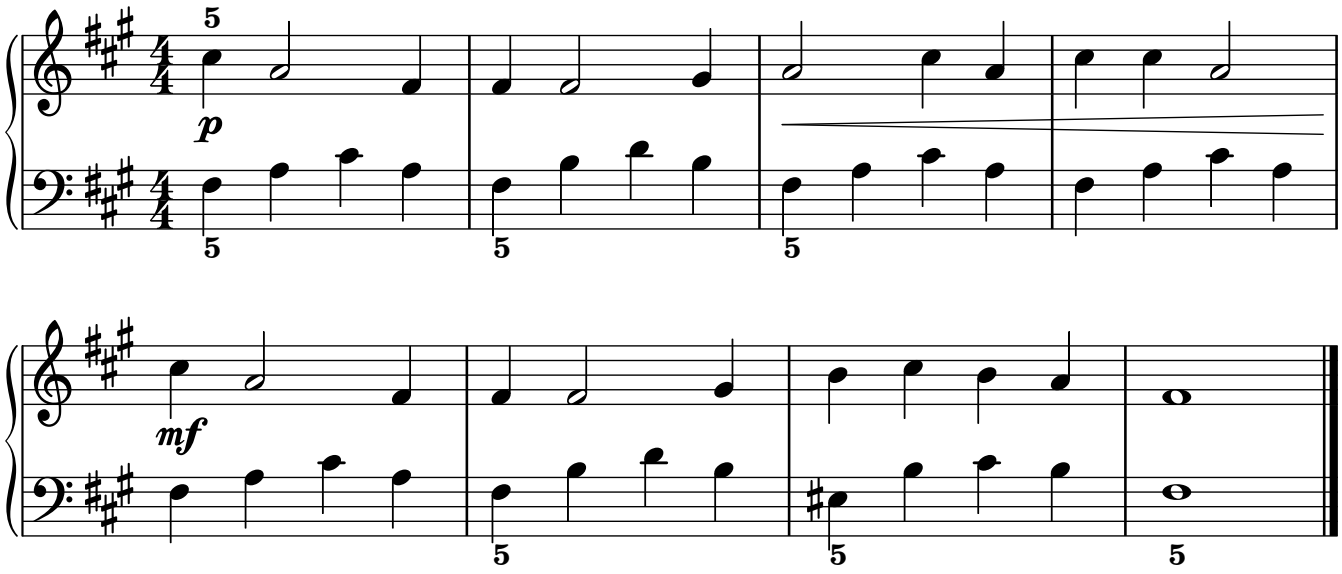


Part C: F-sharp minor: E-sharp

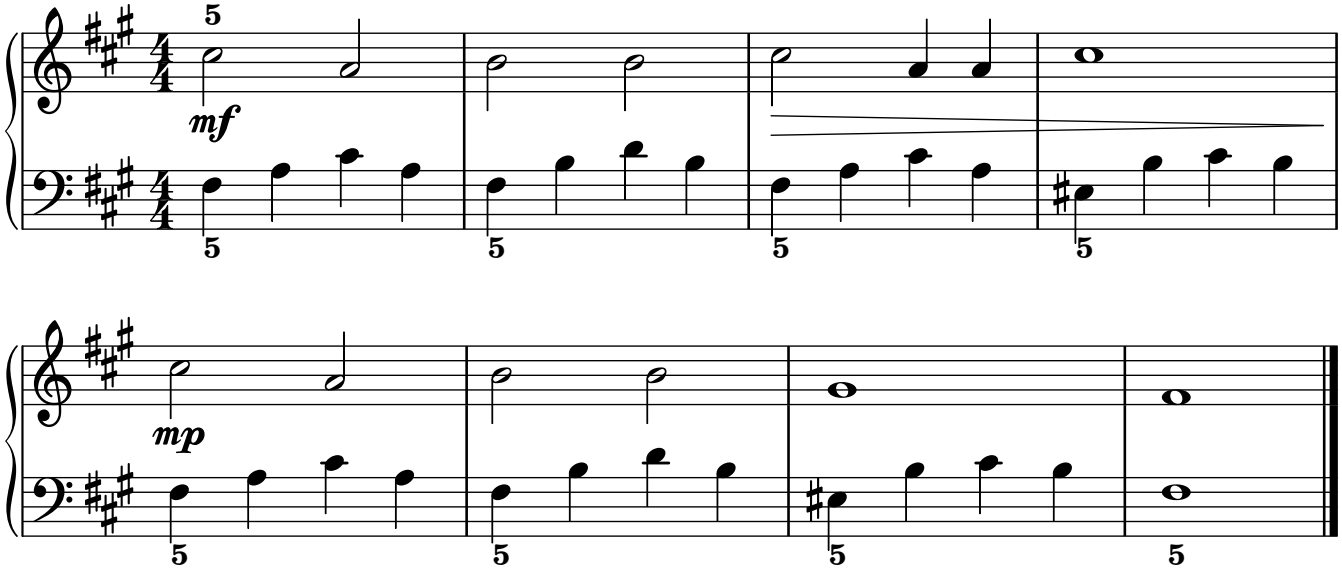
♩ = 60

F-sharp minor: E-sharp (a white key) in the V7 bars.

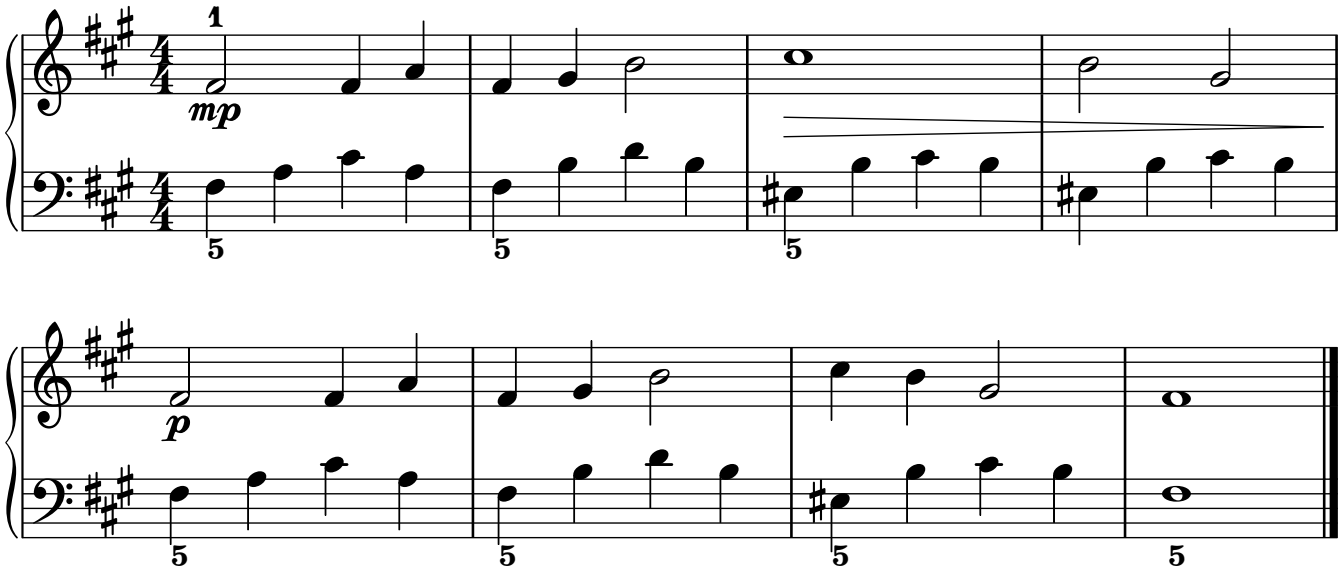
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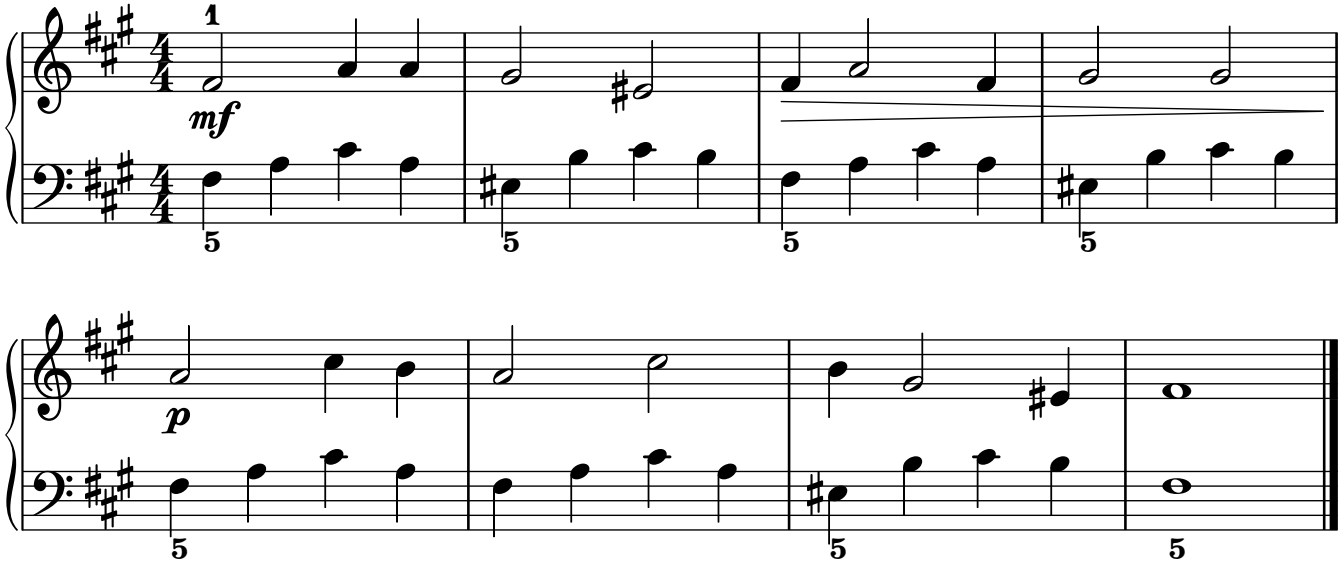


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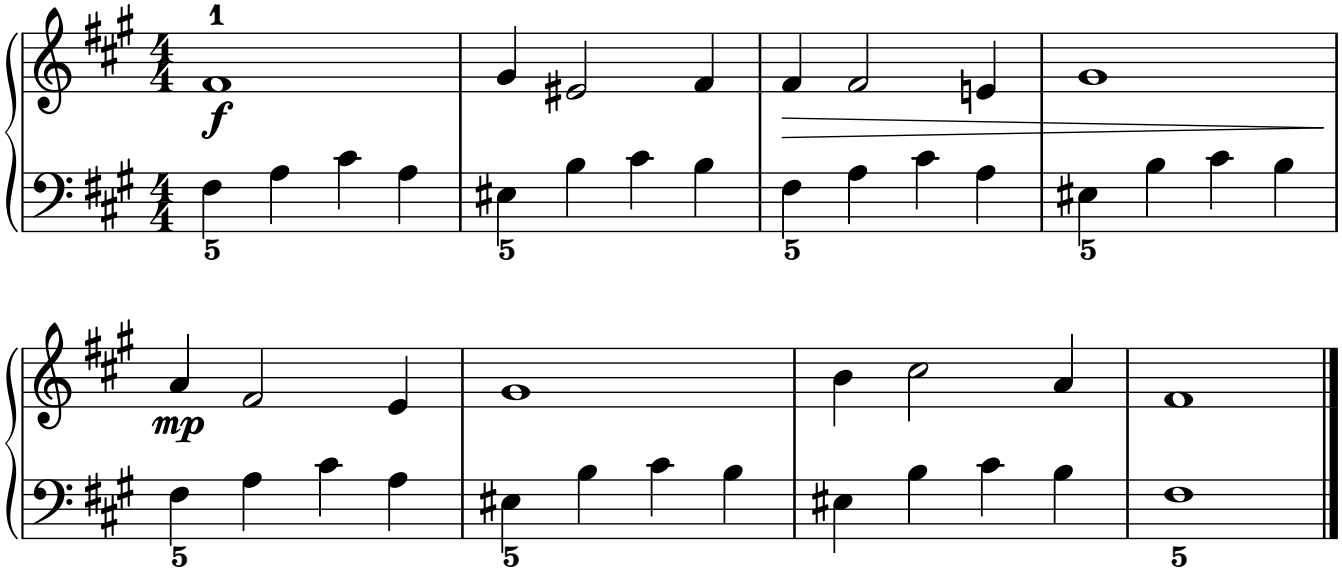


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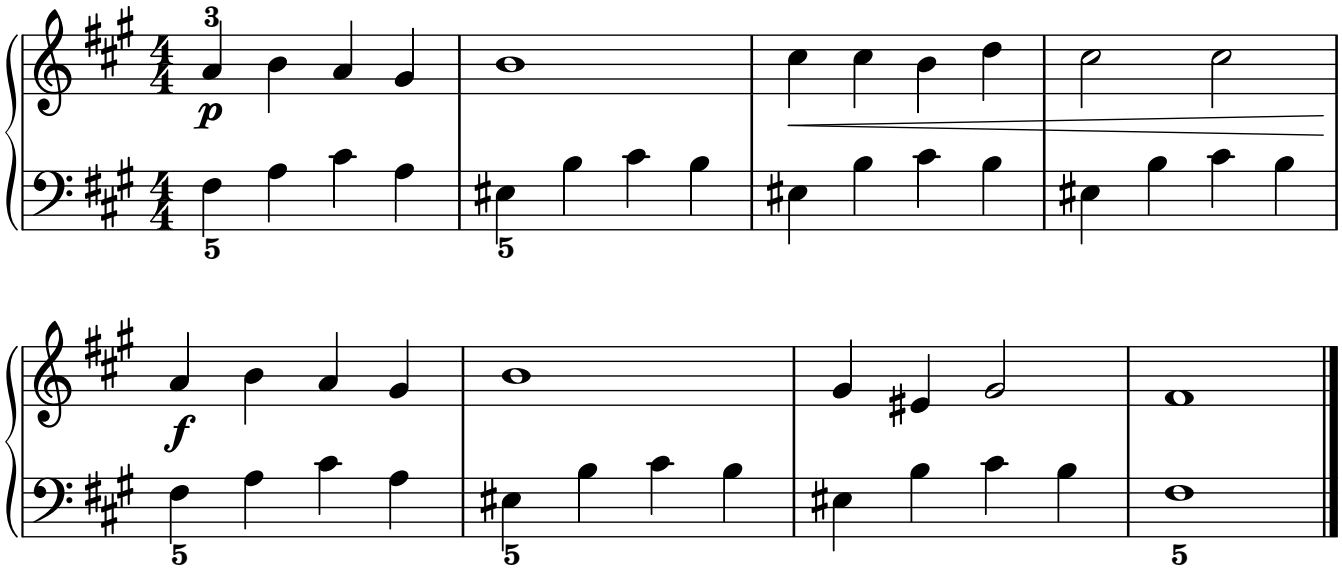


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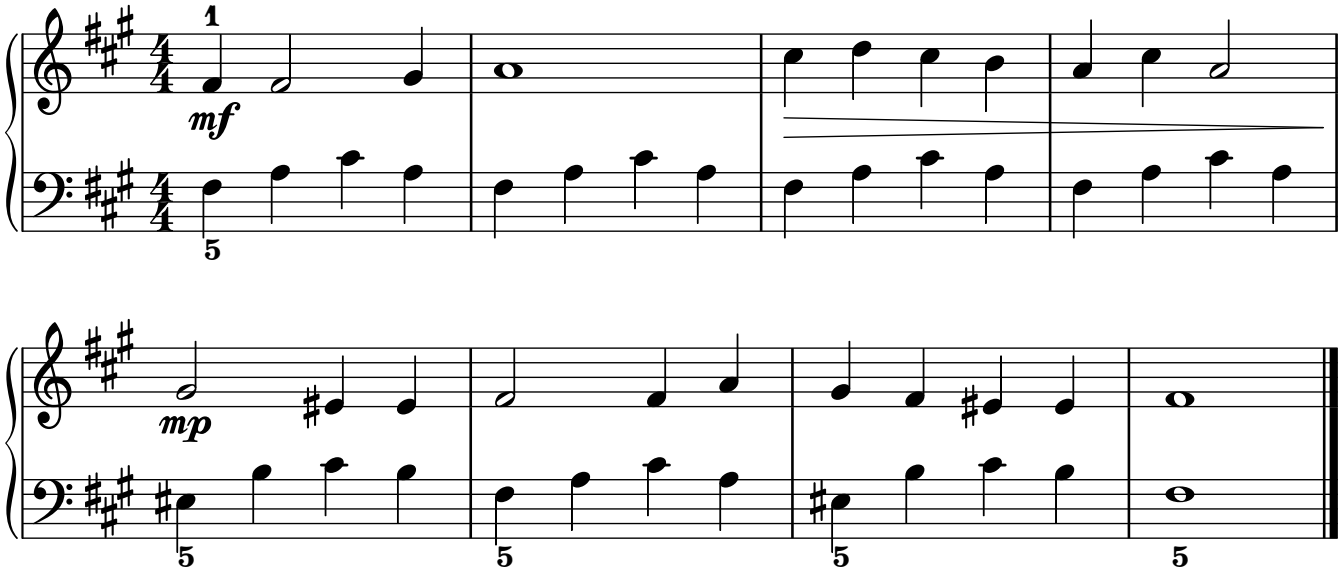
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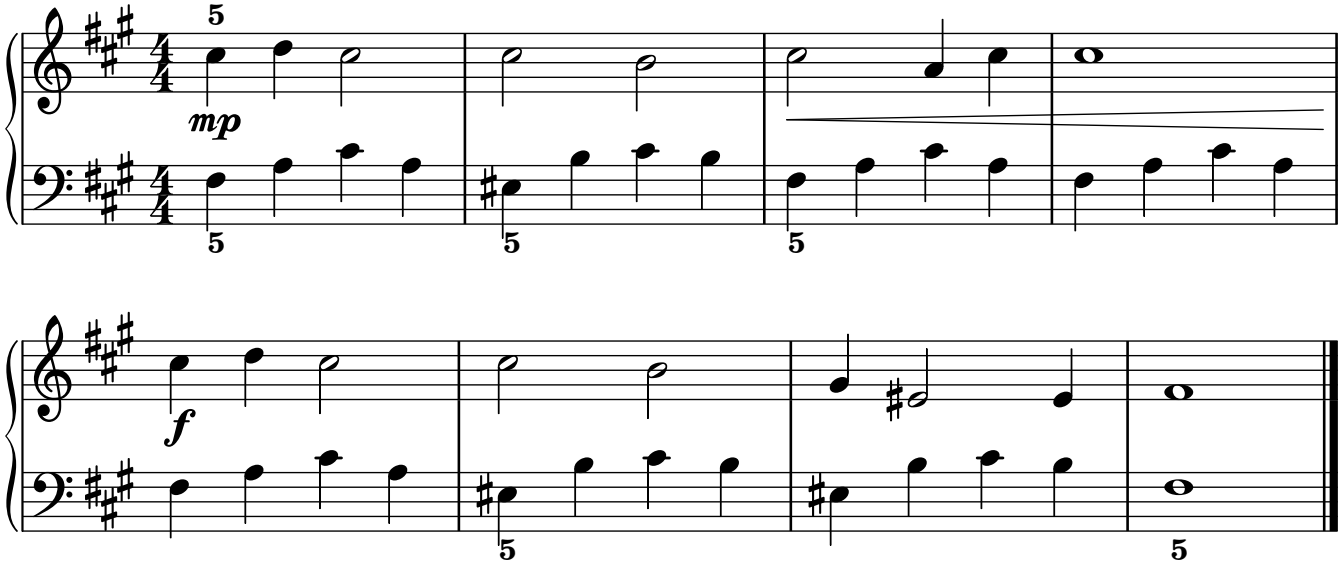


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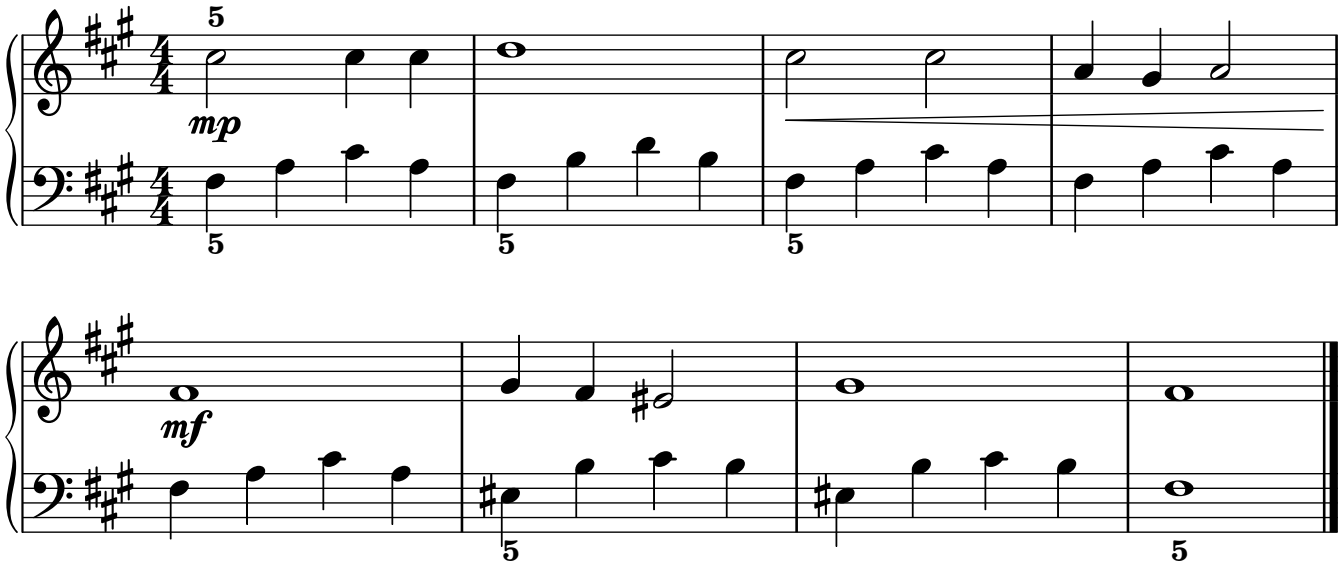
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7.24
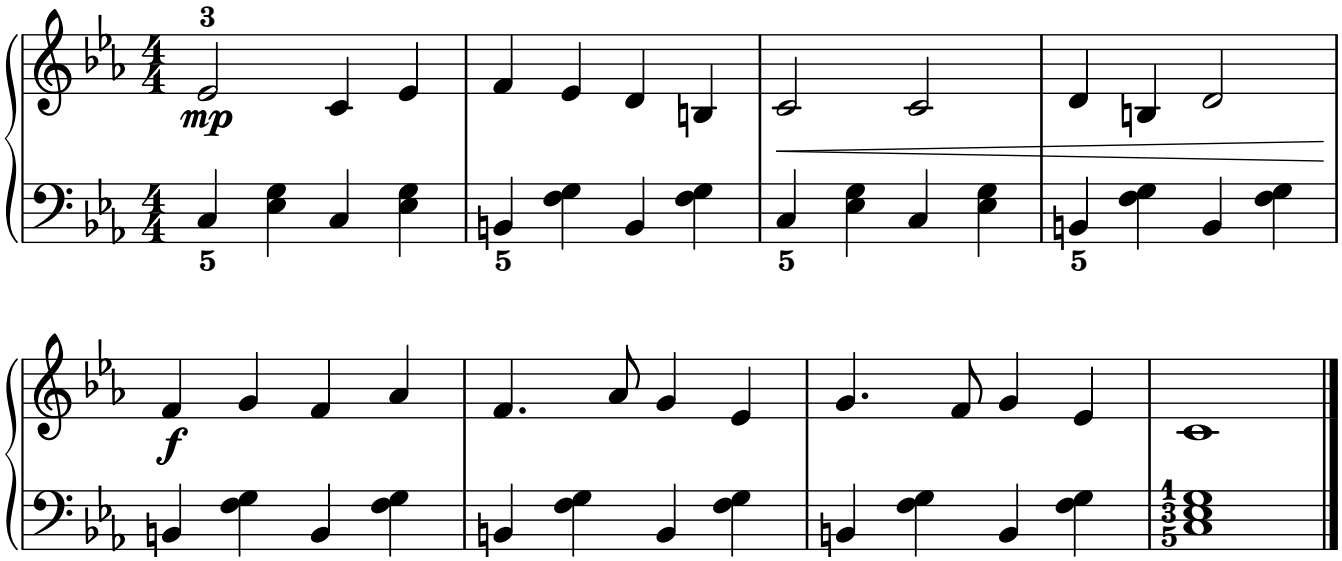


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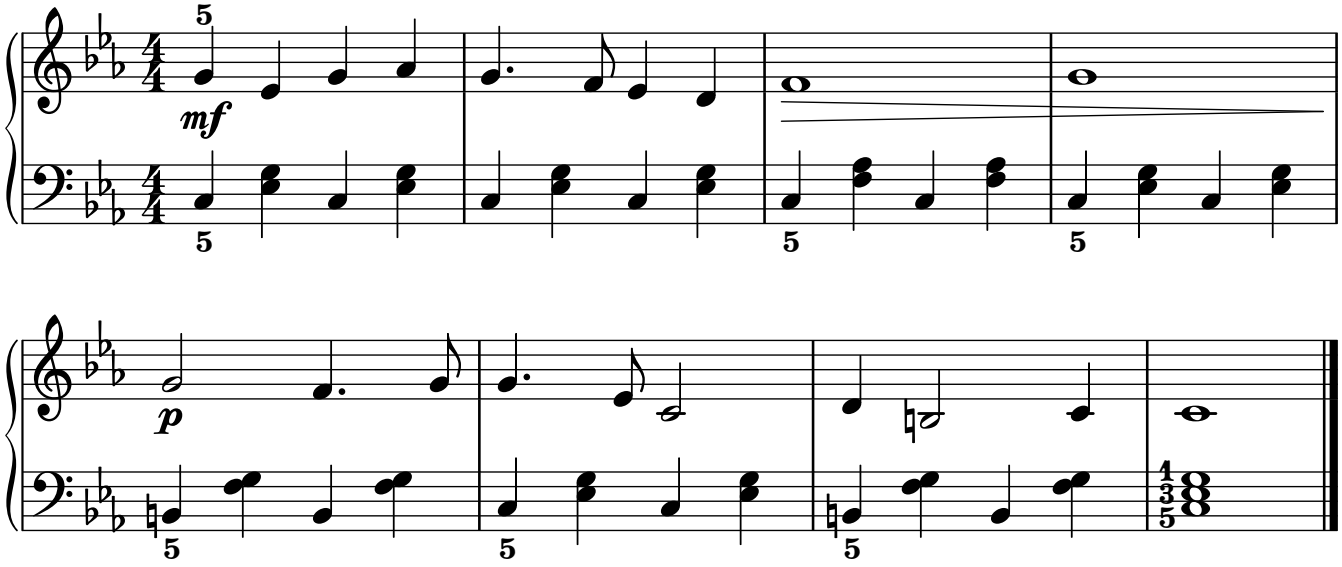


Part D: C minor: B-natural ♩ = 66

C minor with an oom-pah bass: B-natural in the V7 bars.
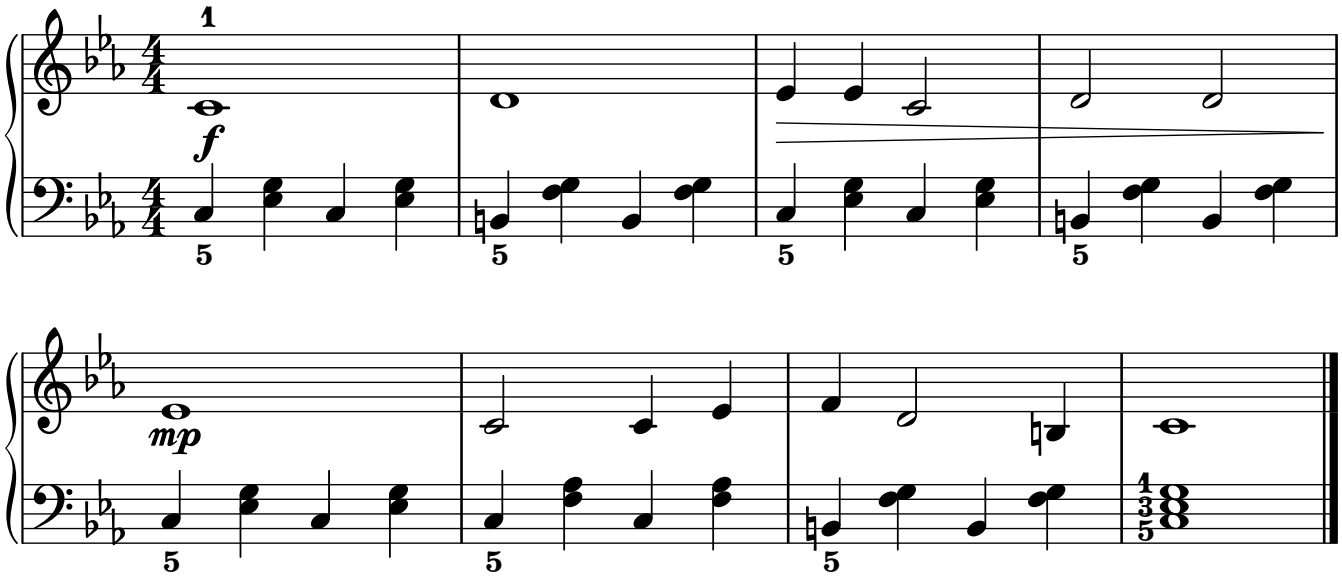
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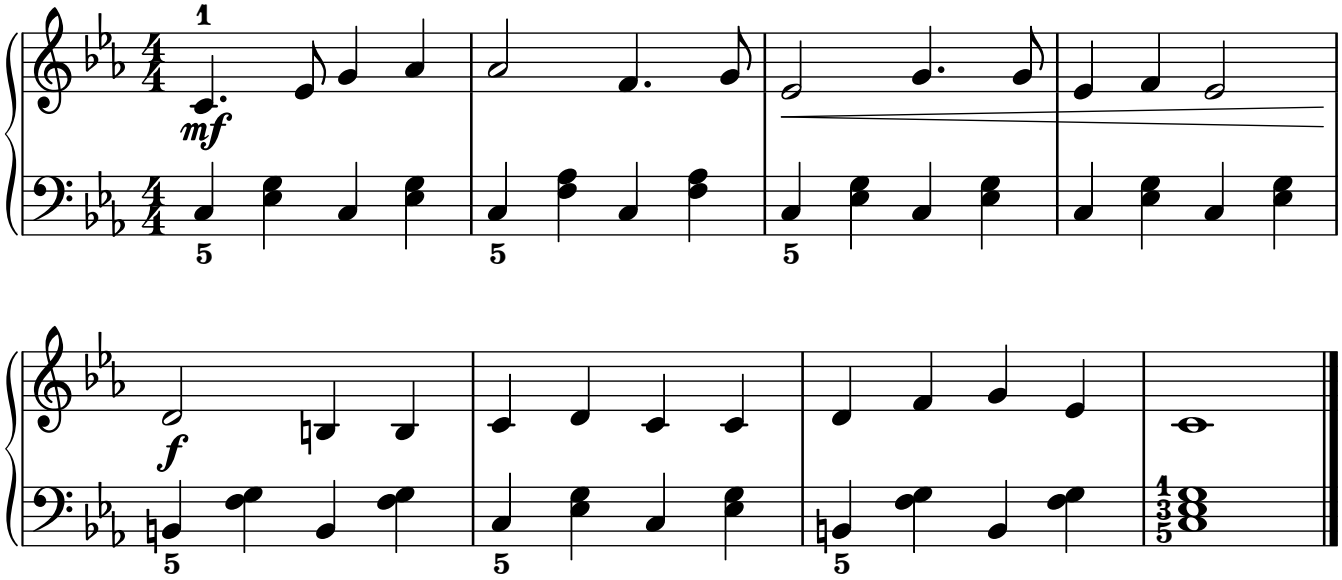


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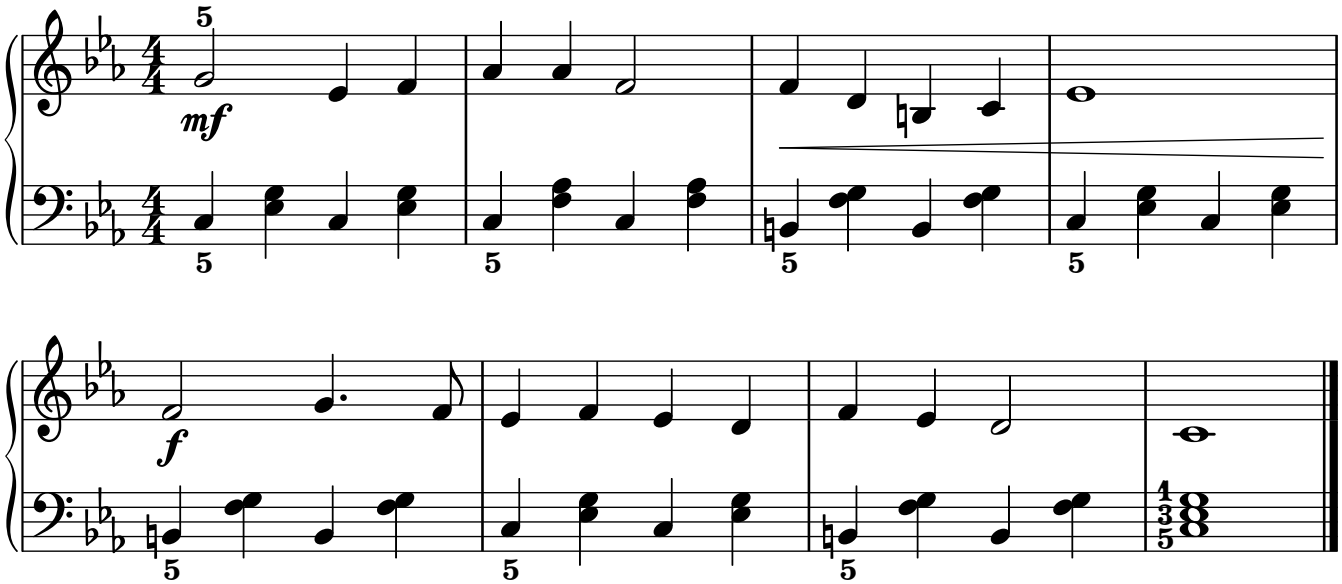


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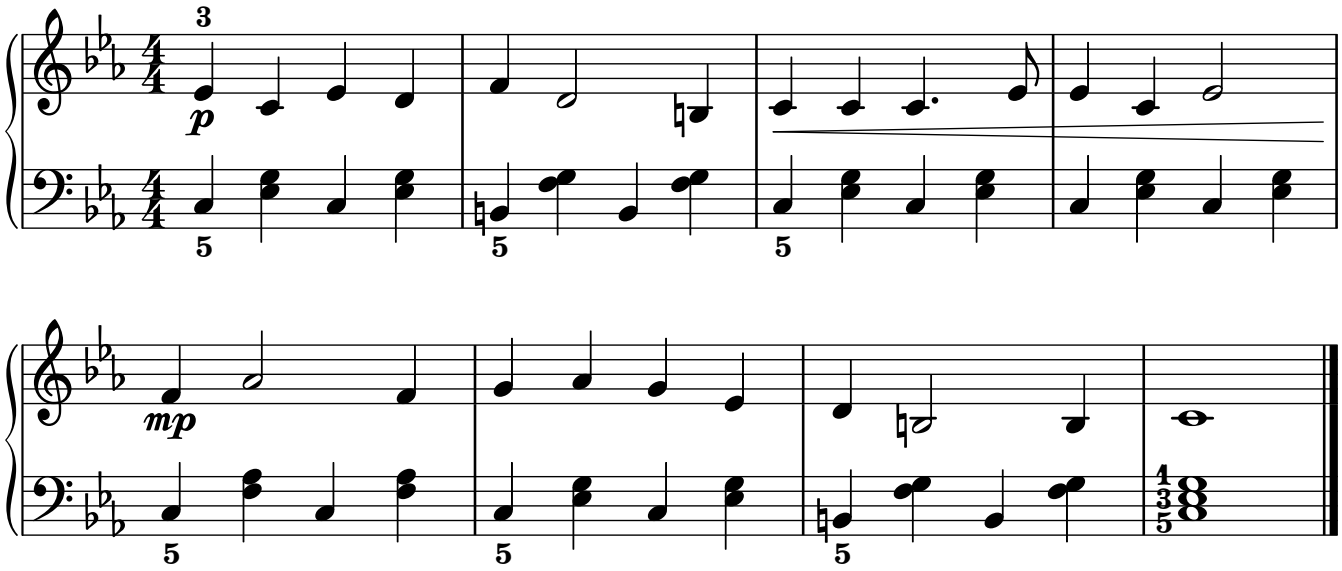


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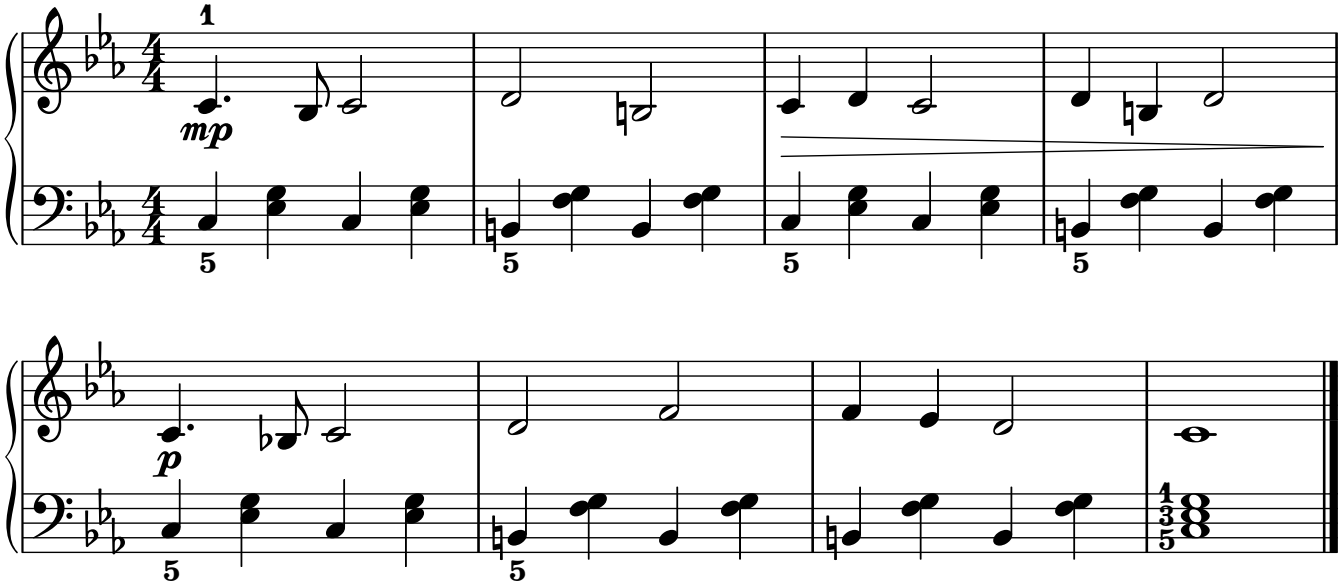


7.30



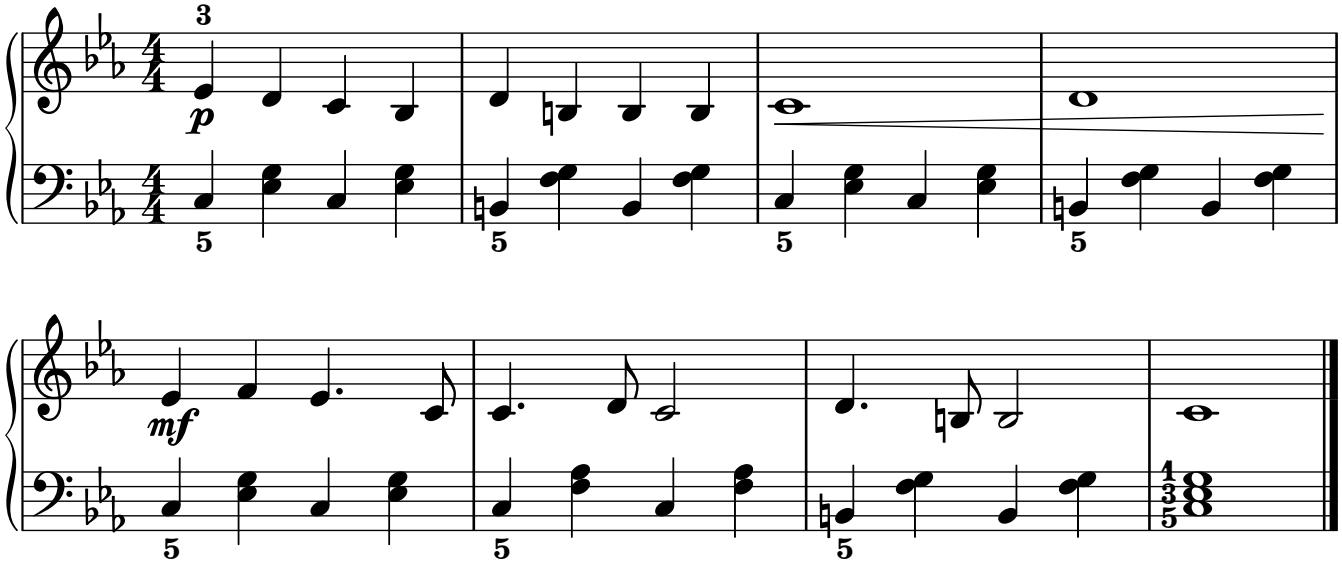
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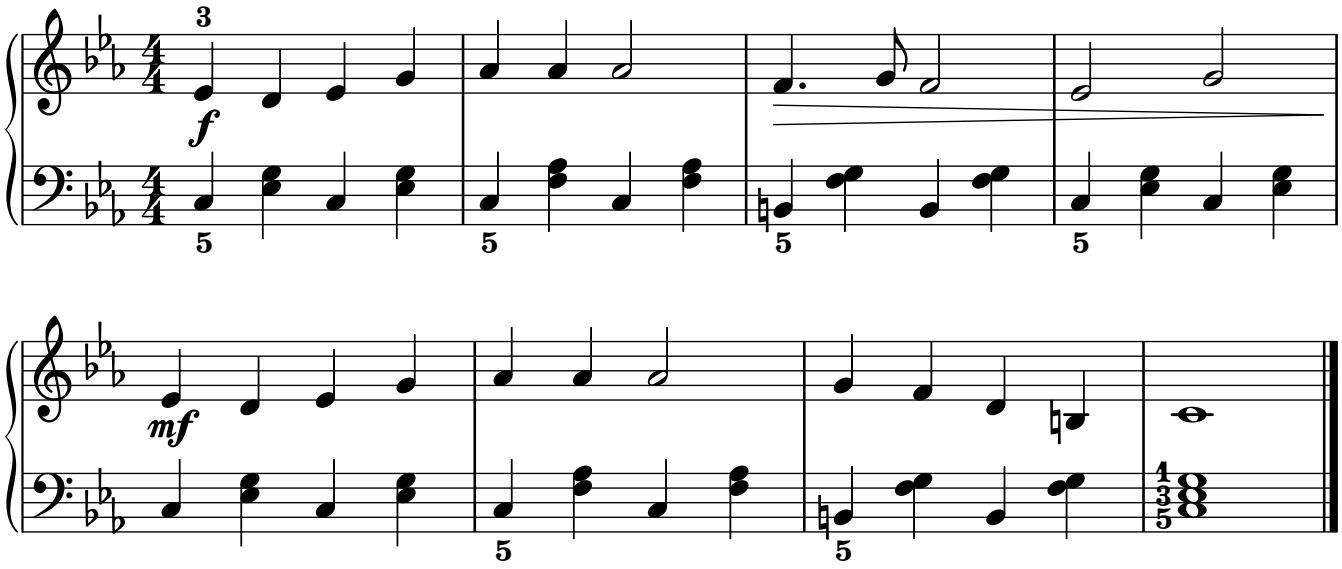
☐ **7.32**



☐ **7.33**



7.34
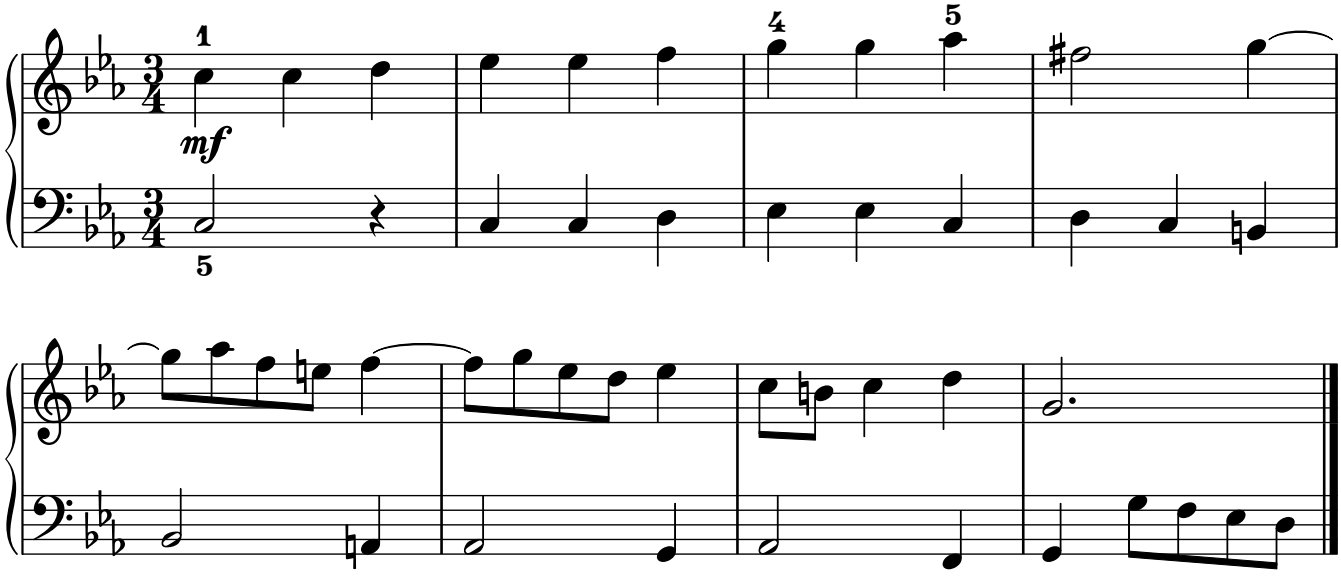


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Minuet in C minor ♩ = 92

From the Notebook for Anna Magdalena Bach, BWV Anh. 121 - first part
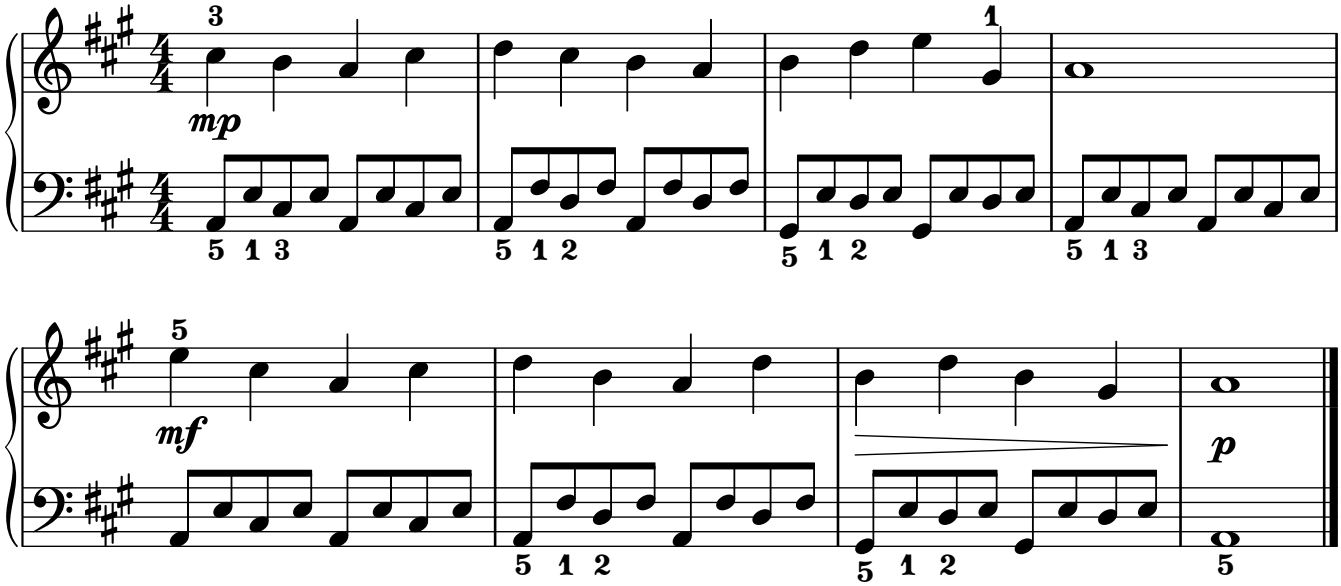
High in the right hand, low in the left. Three accidentals: B-natural (the raised 7th) in bar 7, and E-natural (right hand) and A-natural (left hand) in bar 5, which lean briefly towards F minor. The trill in bar 4 is left out. Source: Mutopia Project no. 1613.



Spring in A ♩ = 72

Original
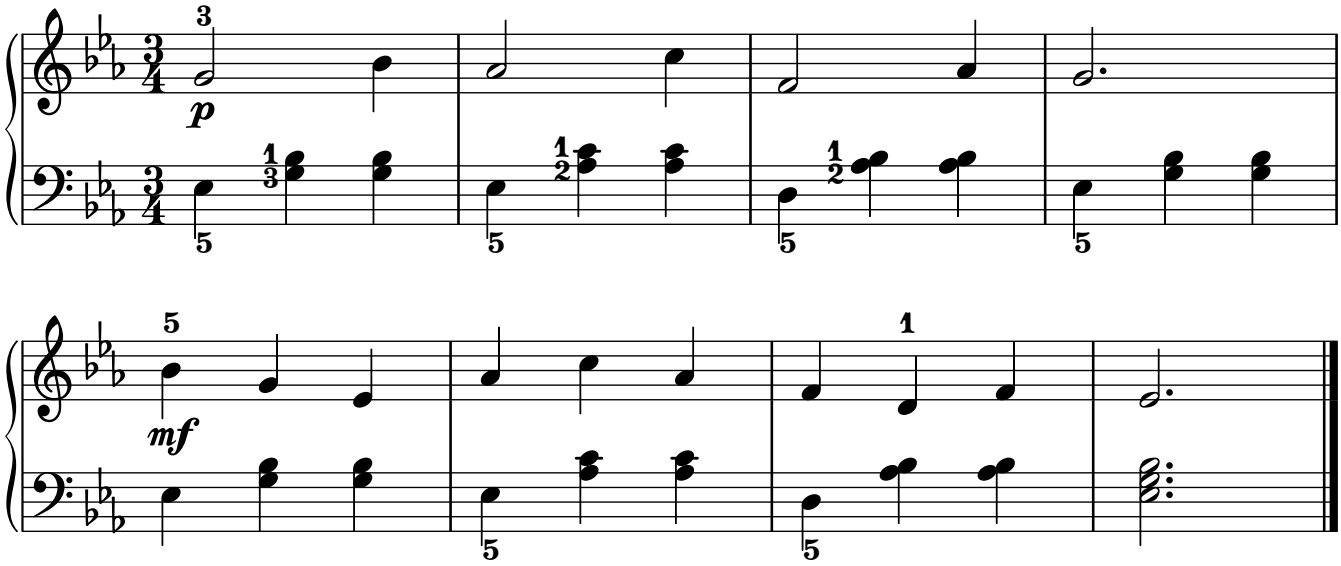
A major over an Alberti bass. C-sharp and F-sharp are in the right hand's position; G-sharp comes in bars 3 and 7, where the thumb stretches down to it.



E-flat Waltz ♩ = 120

Original

Three flats: B-flat, E-flat and A-flat. Both hands start with a finger on E-flat; in bar 7 the right-hand thumb stretches down to D.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 8?

- Play two new exercises from each part at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Name the key of each exercise before you start, and play every sharp, flat and accidental.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 8.

Unit 8

Changing Key

New: A new key mid-piece, shown by a new key signature or by accidentals; review

Music often travels to a new key and settles there for a while: this is called modulation. Sometimes the composer writes a new key signature after a double bar line; more often the new key shows itself only through accidentals. Either way, a good reader notices the change before it arrives and moves the hand's black keys with it. This unit is also the review of Volume 4.

What is new

A new key signature

A double bar line followed by a new key signature: from here on, read with the new sharps or flats. Cancelled sharps or flats are shown with natural signs.

Modulation by accidentals

With no new signature, the new key arrives as an accidental: its leading note. C-sharp in a piece in F major means D minor is near; F-sharp in C major means G major.

The pivot

Just before a change, the left hand usually plays the new key's V7 chord: its bottom note is the new leading note. Spot that shape and you know where the music is going.

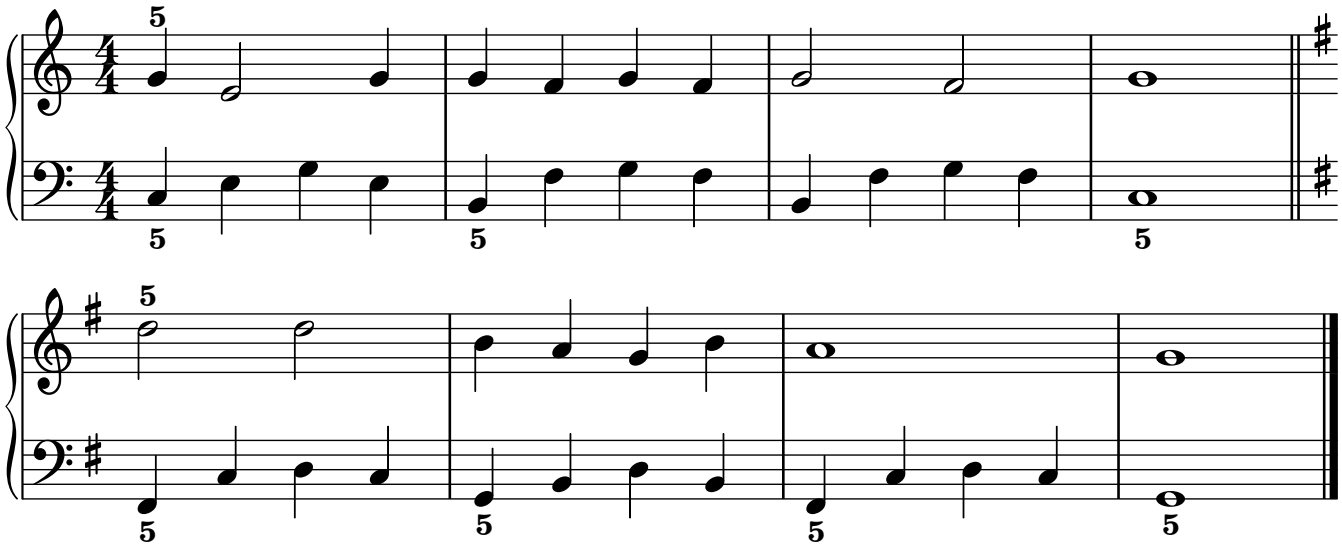
Reading tips

1. In your scan, look for double bar lines, new key signatures and repeated accidentals: they mark a new key.
2. When the key changes, say the new key aloud in your head and prepare the black keys for it.
3. In the review part, use the full scan: key, time, left-hand pattern, right-hand chords, rhythm.

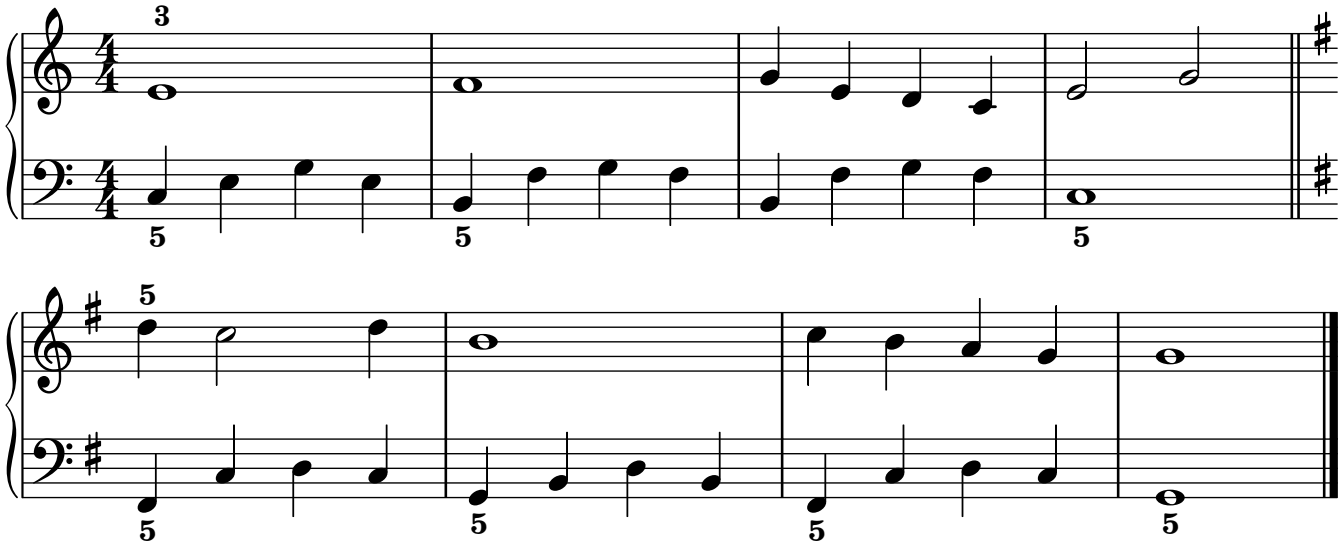
Part A: C major to G major ♩ = 66

C major to G major: a new key signature halfway through.

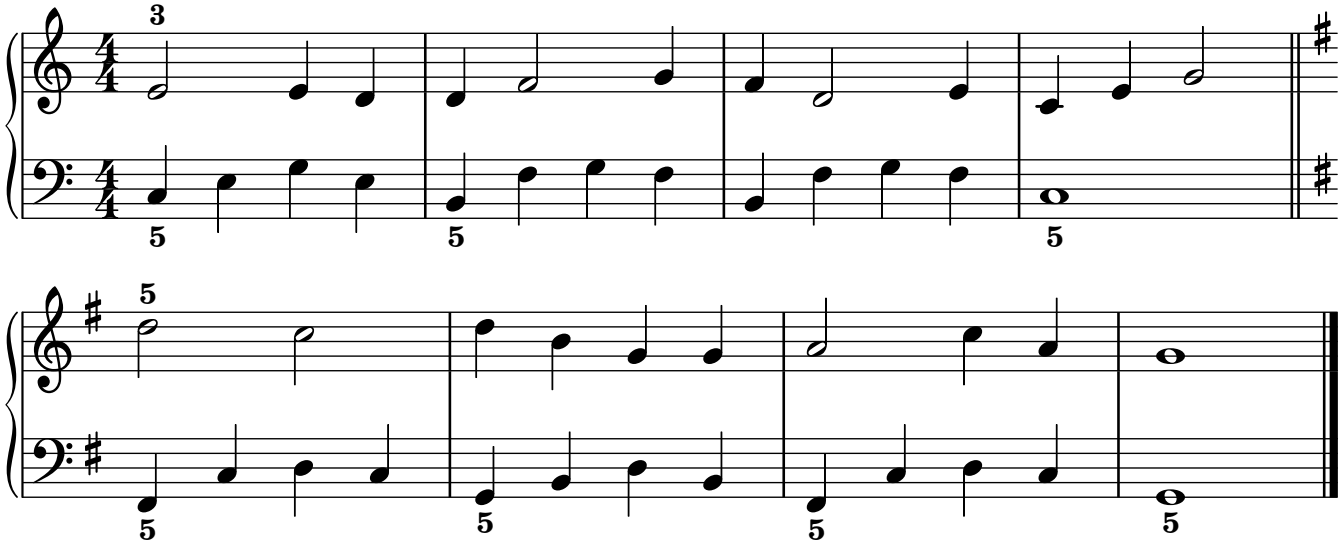
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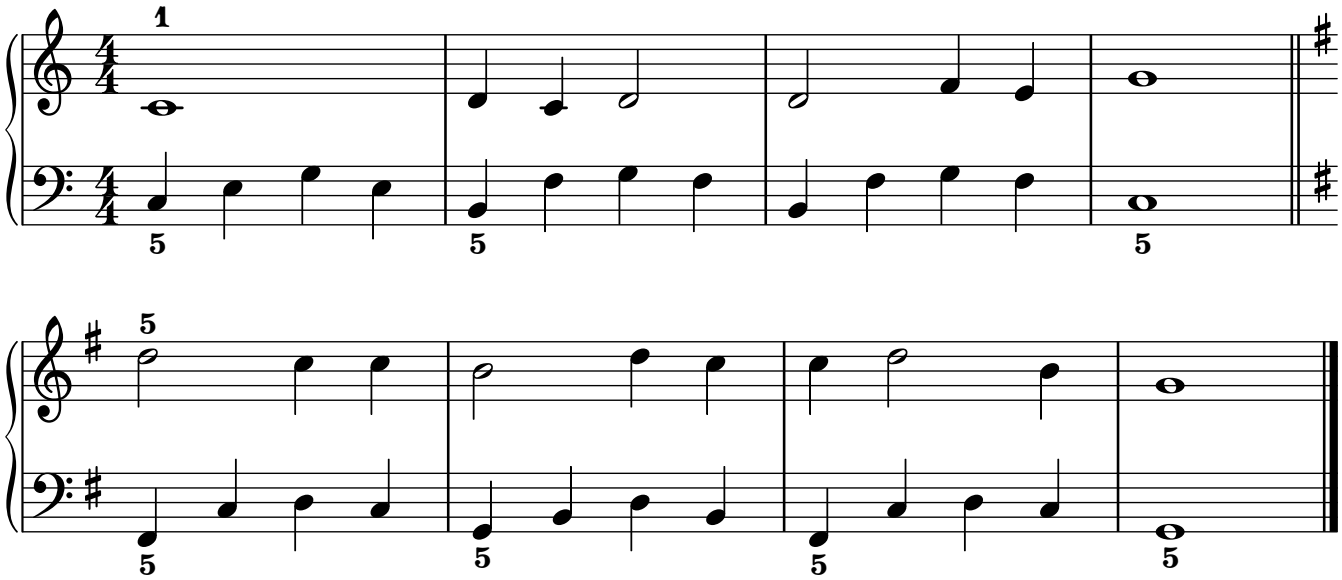


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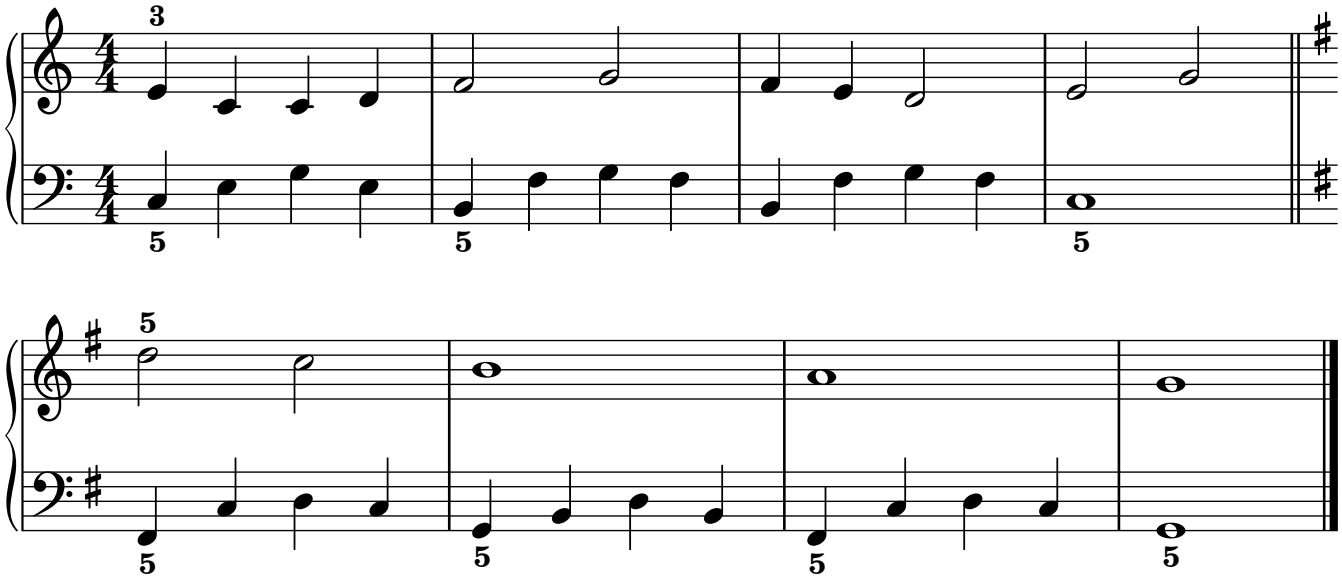
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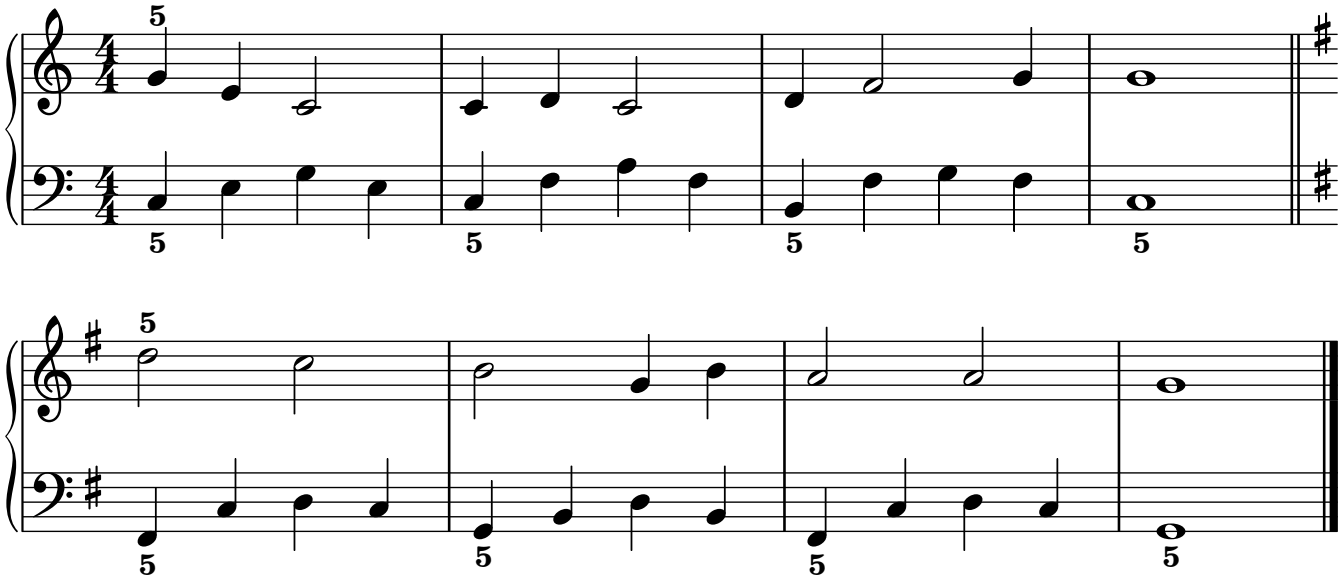


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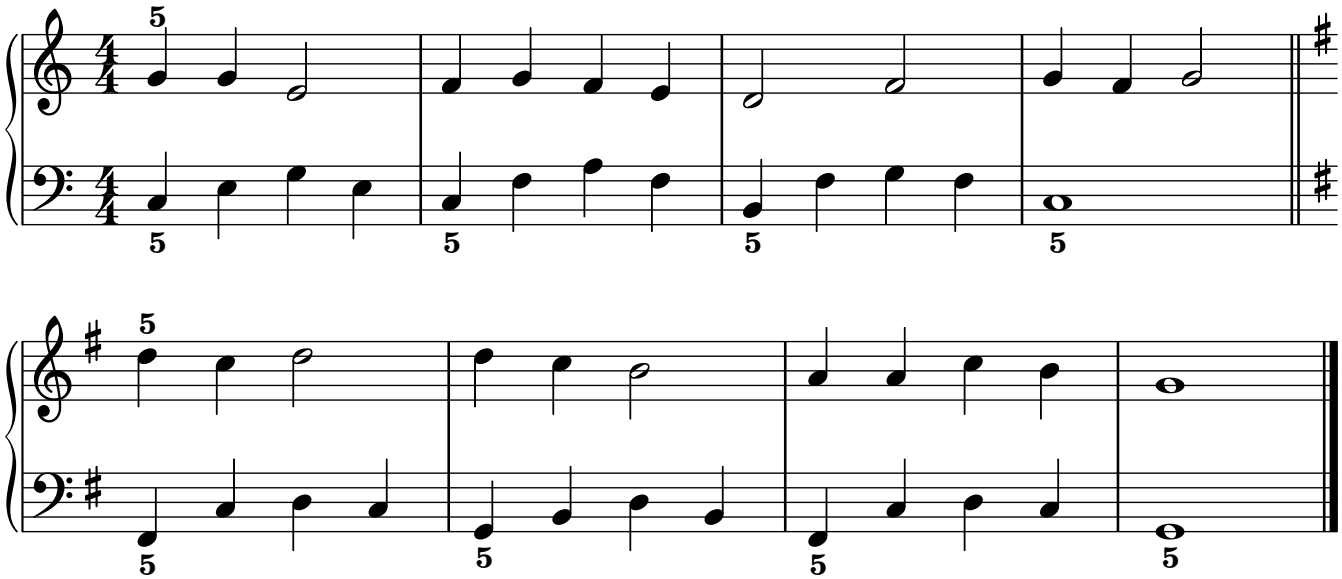
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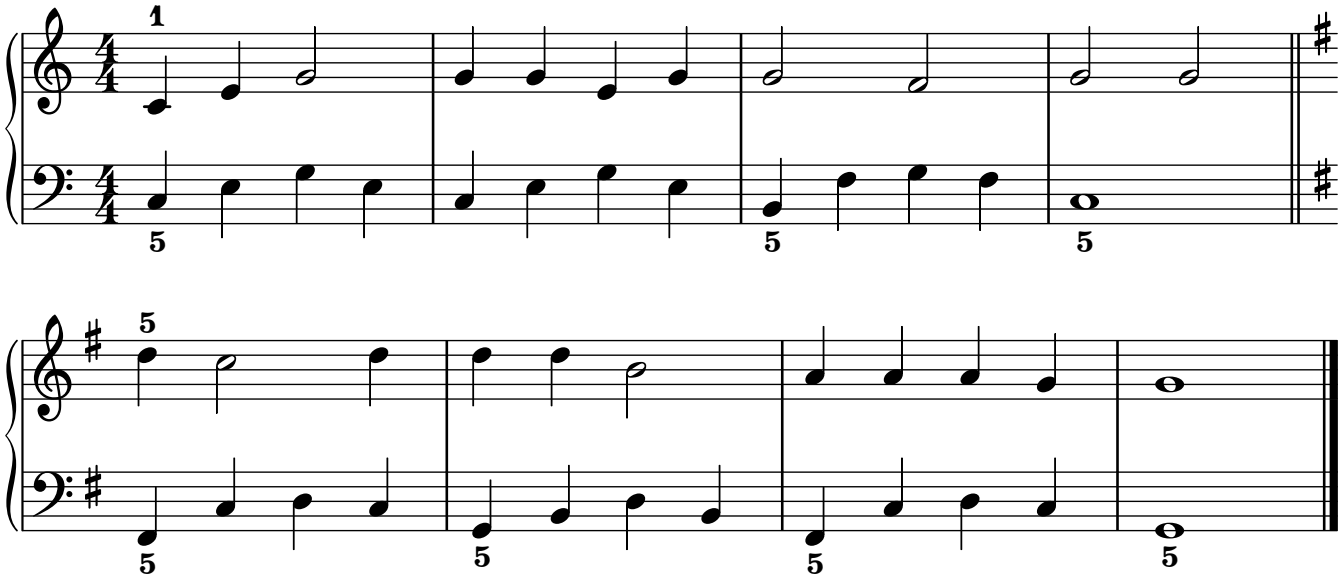
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8.7



8.8

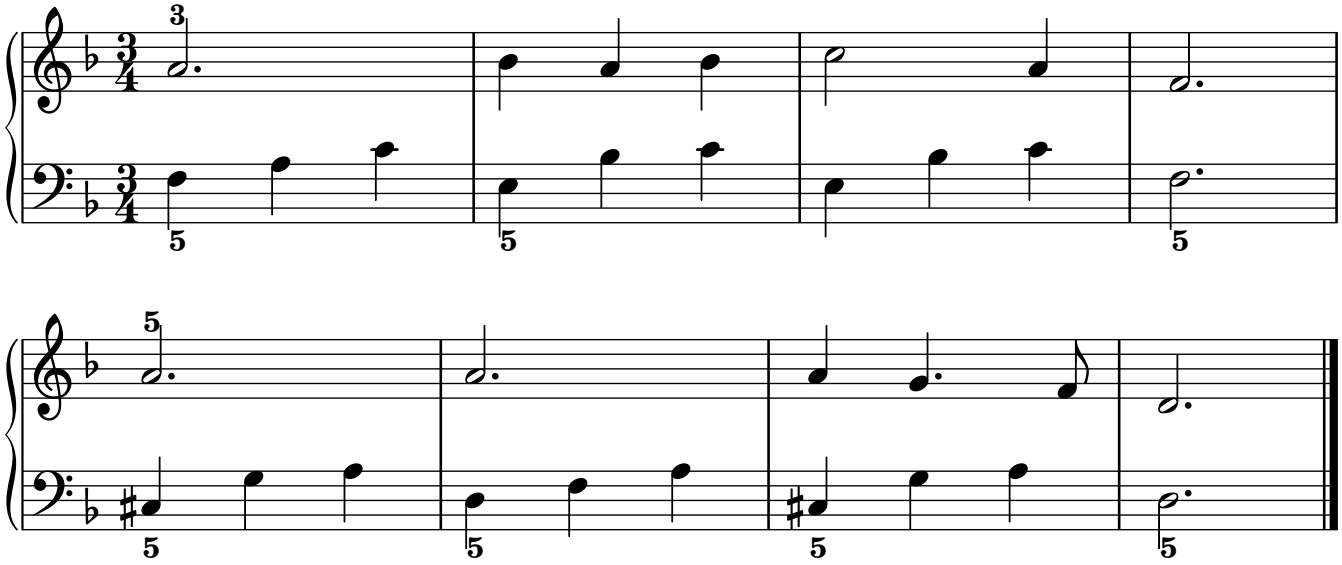


Part B: F major to D minor, with accidentals

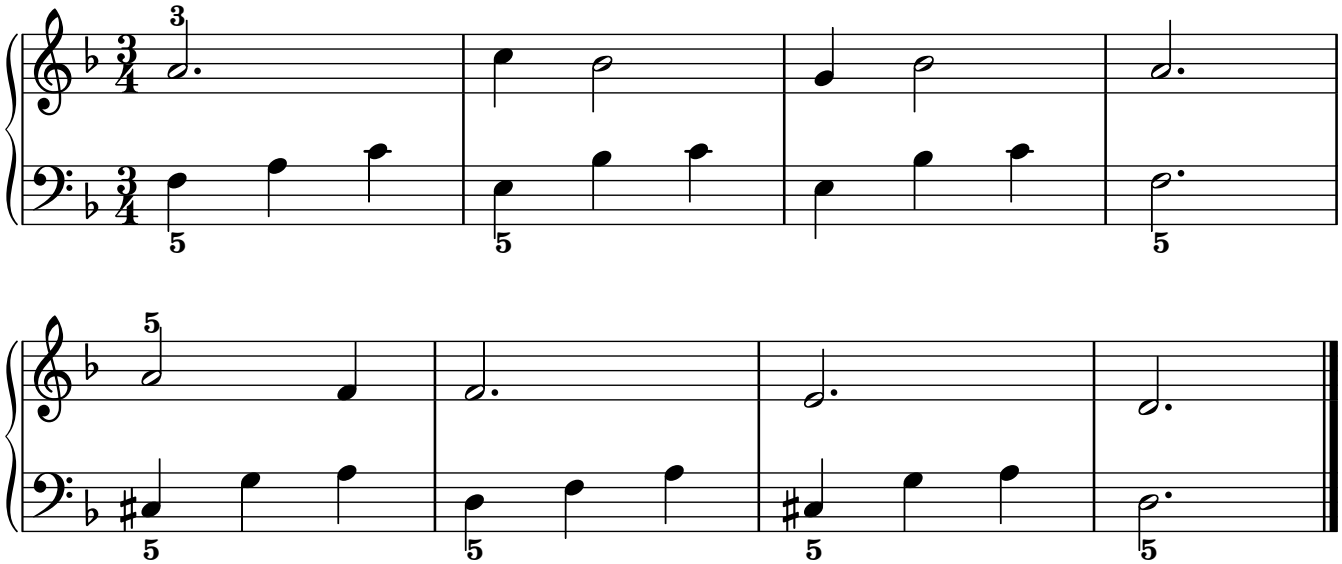
♩ = 72

F major to D minor in 3/4, shown only by accidentals: C-sharp is the new leading note.

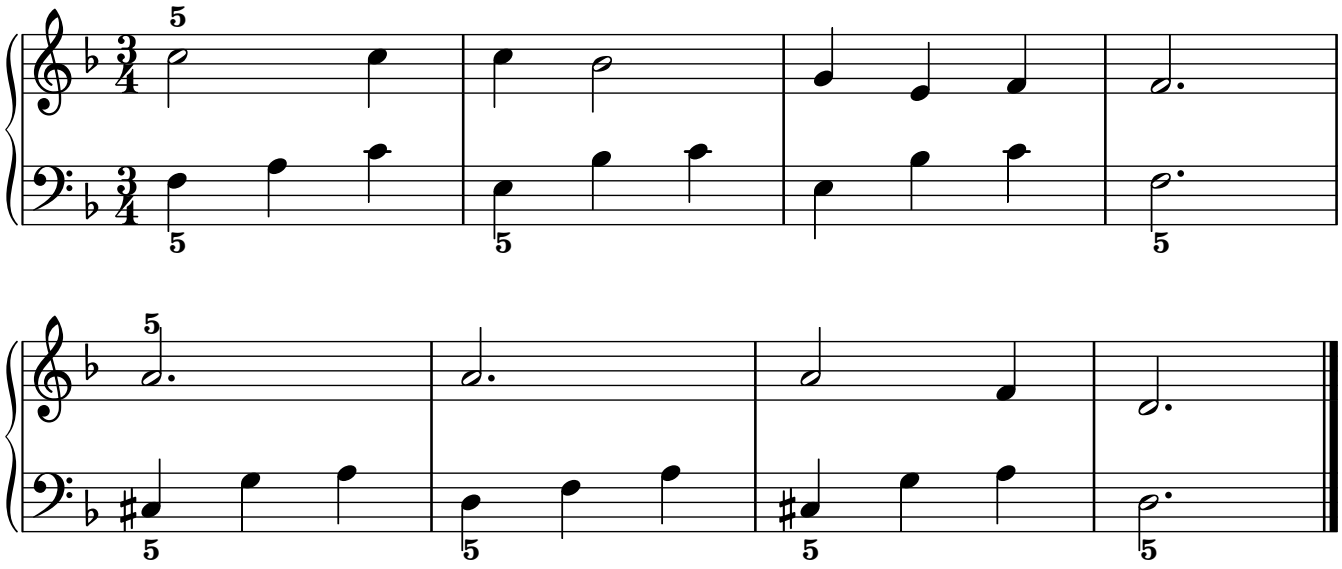
☐ **8.9**



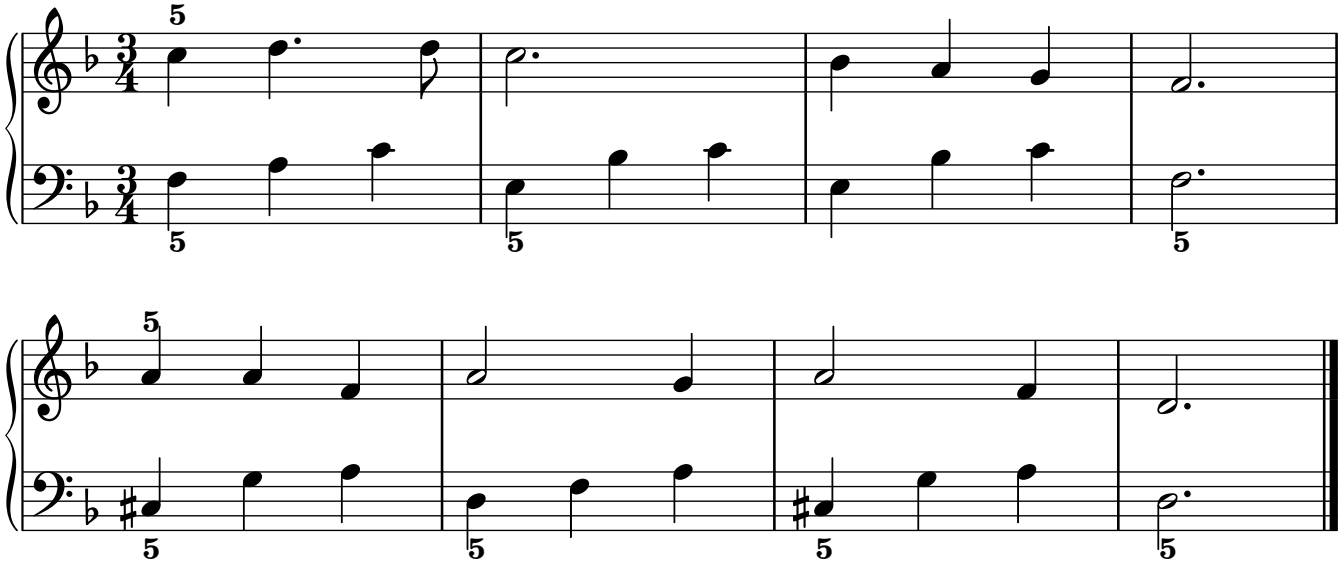
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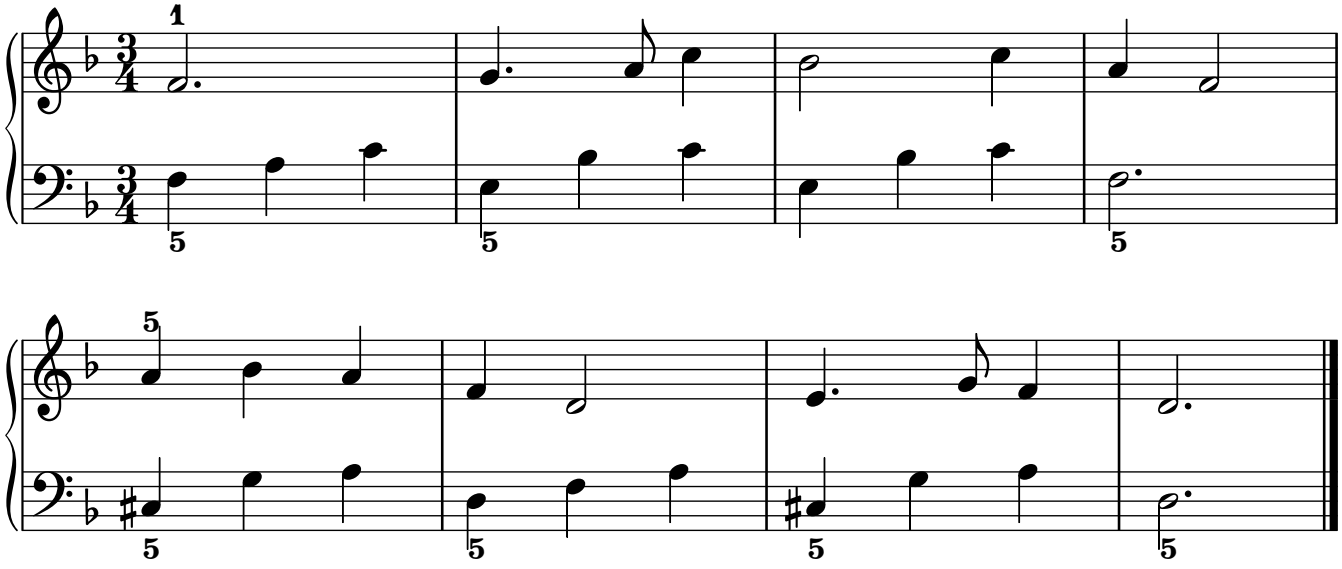
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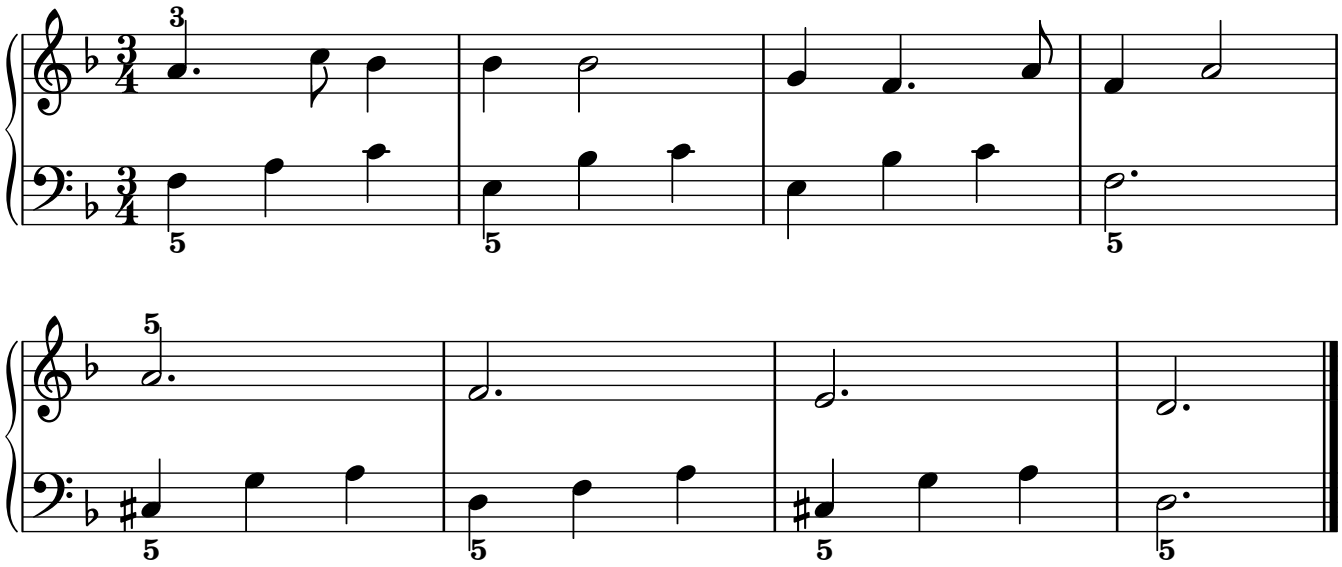


☐ **8.12**



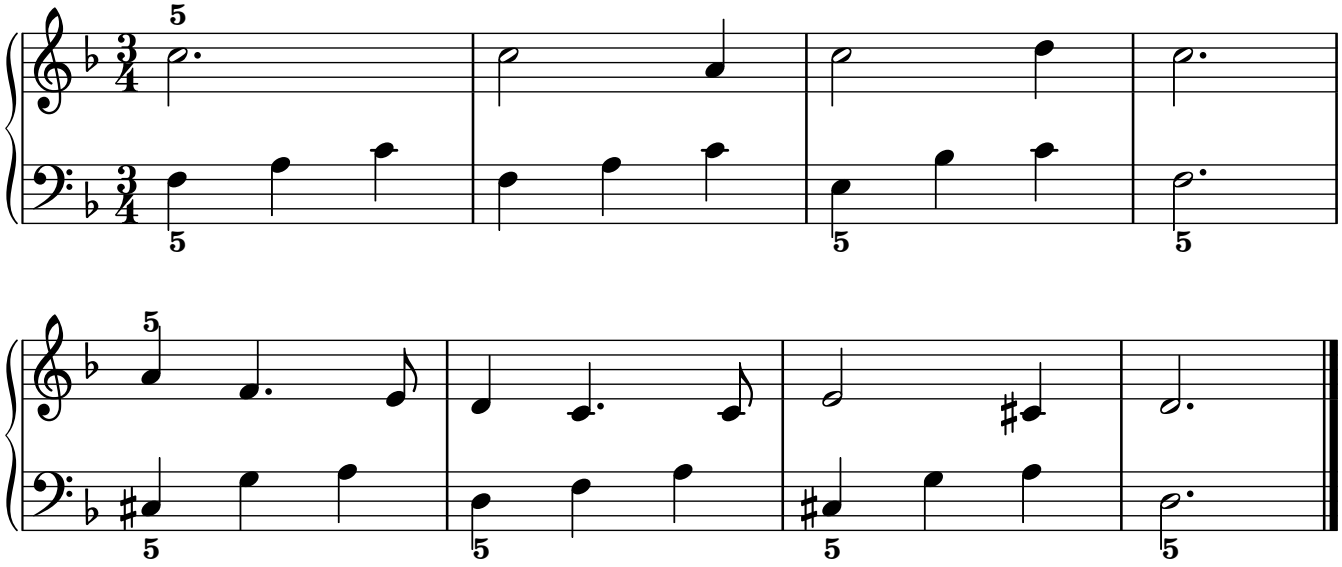
☐ **8.13**



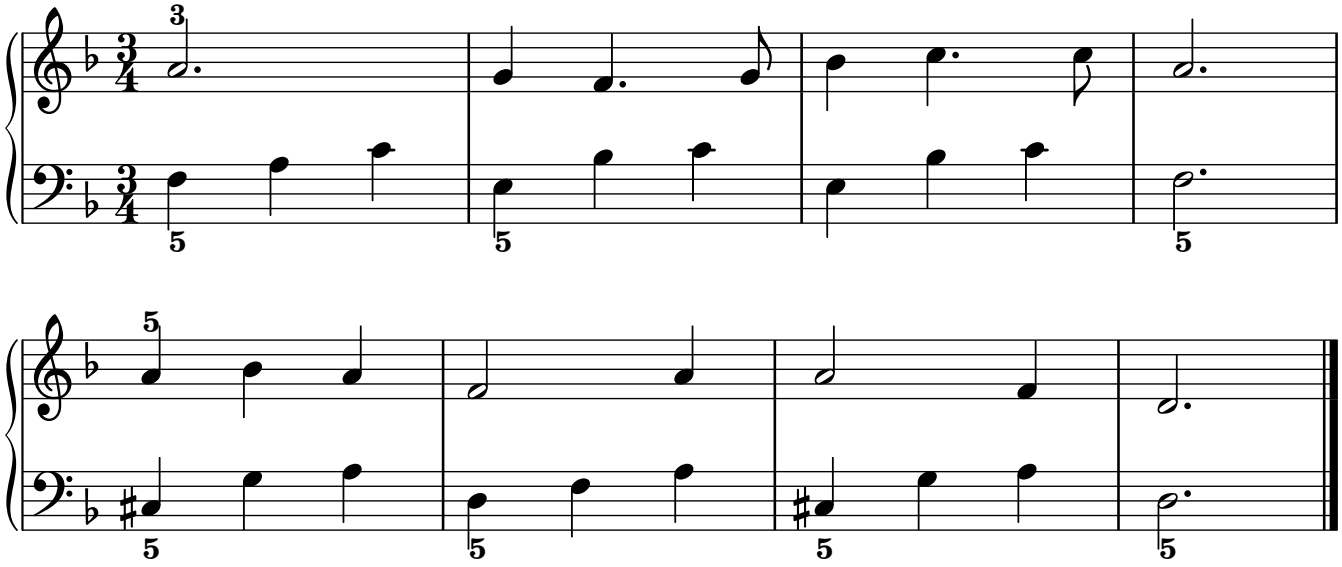
8.14



8.15
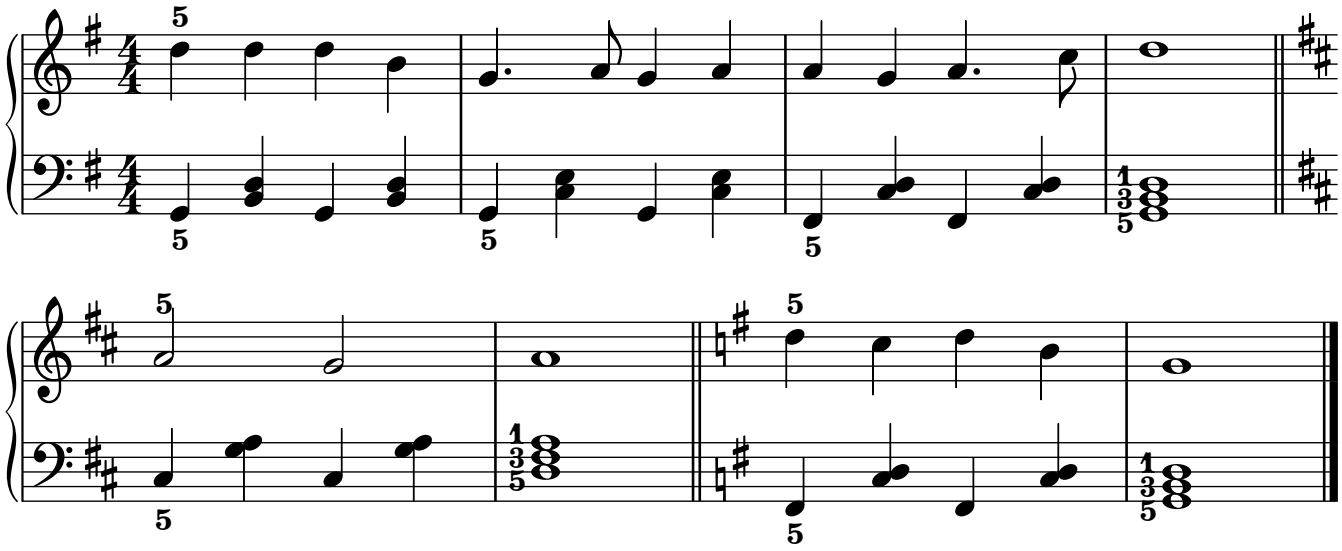


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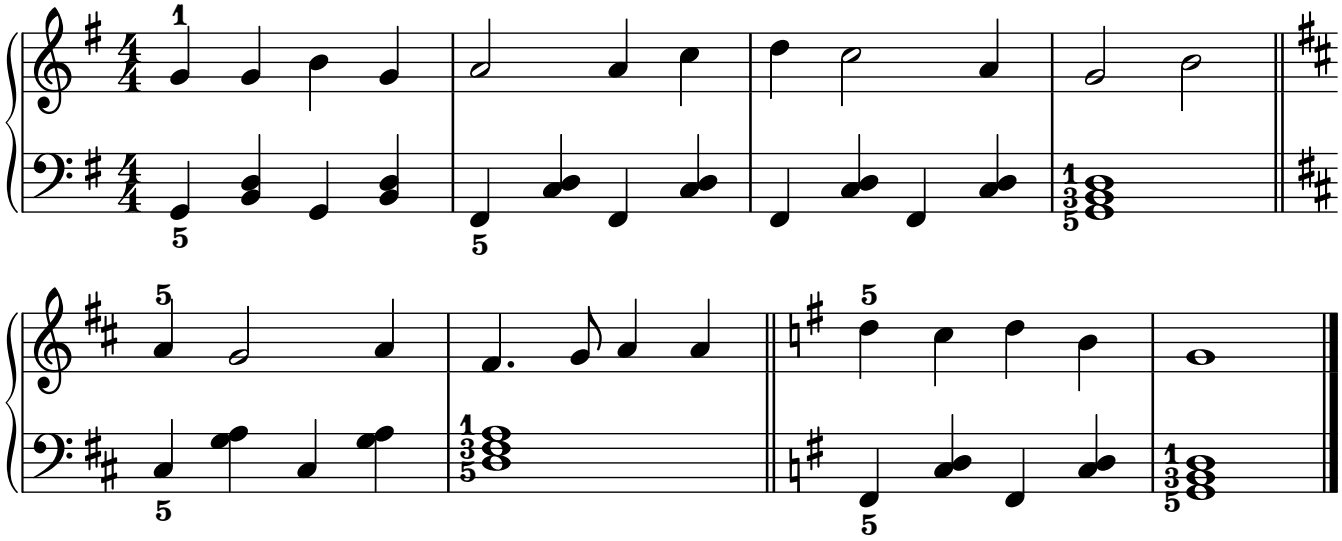


Part C: Away and back: G, D, G ♩ = 66

G major to D major for two bars, and back home to G.
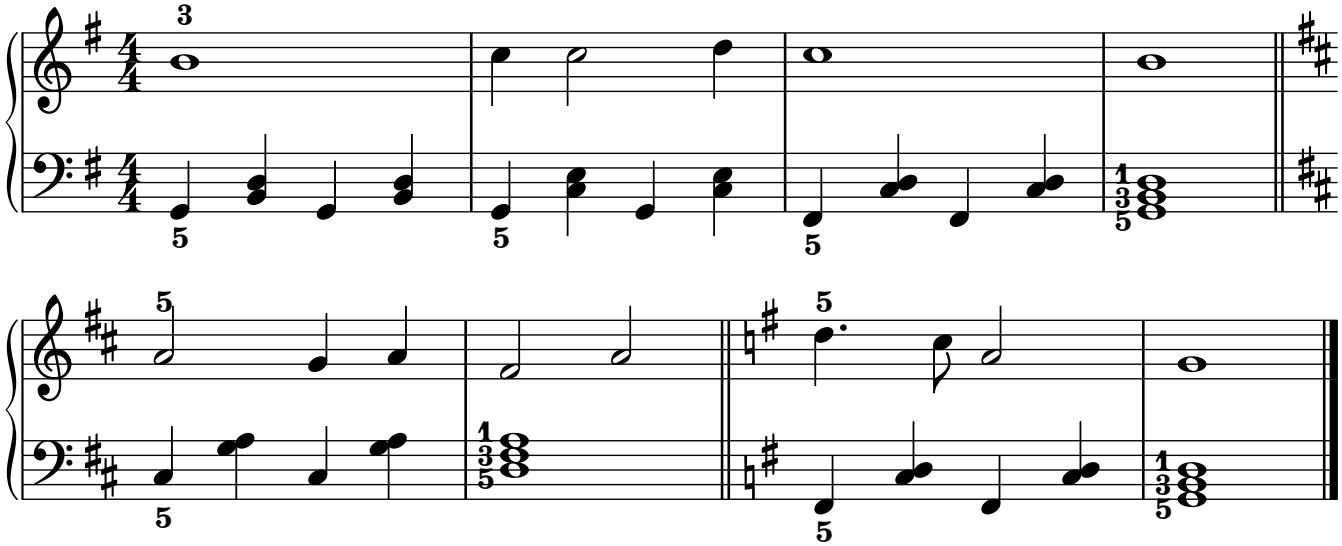
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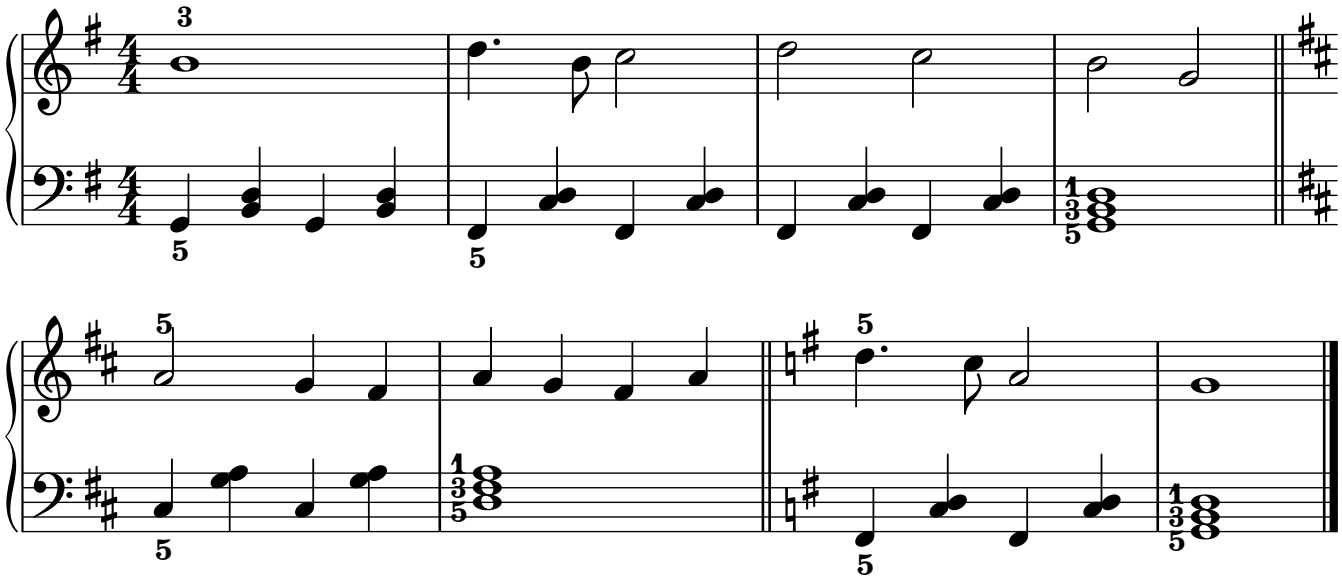


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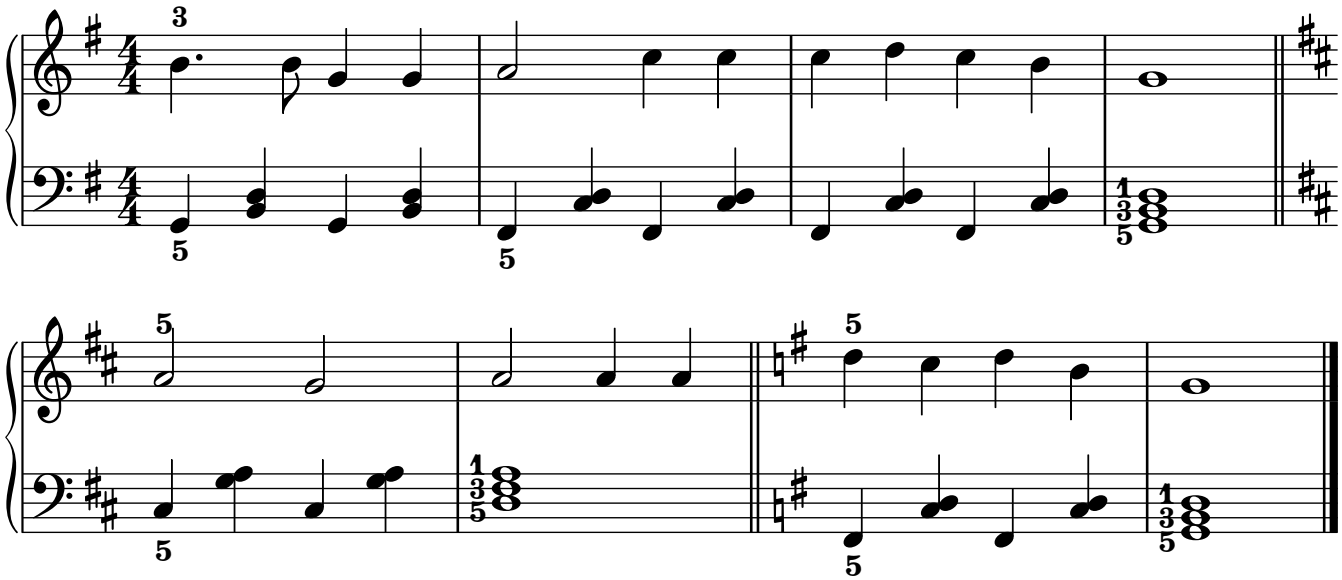


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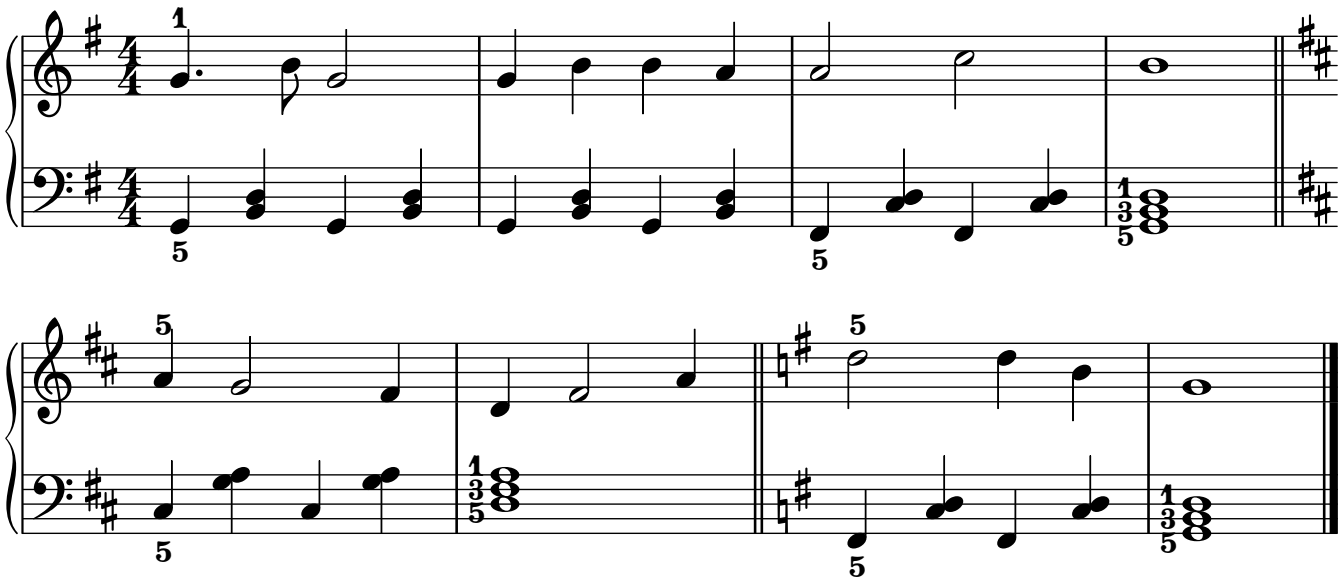


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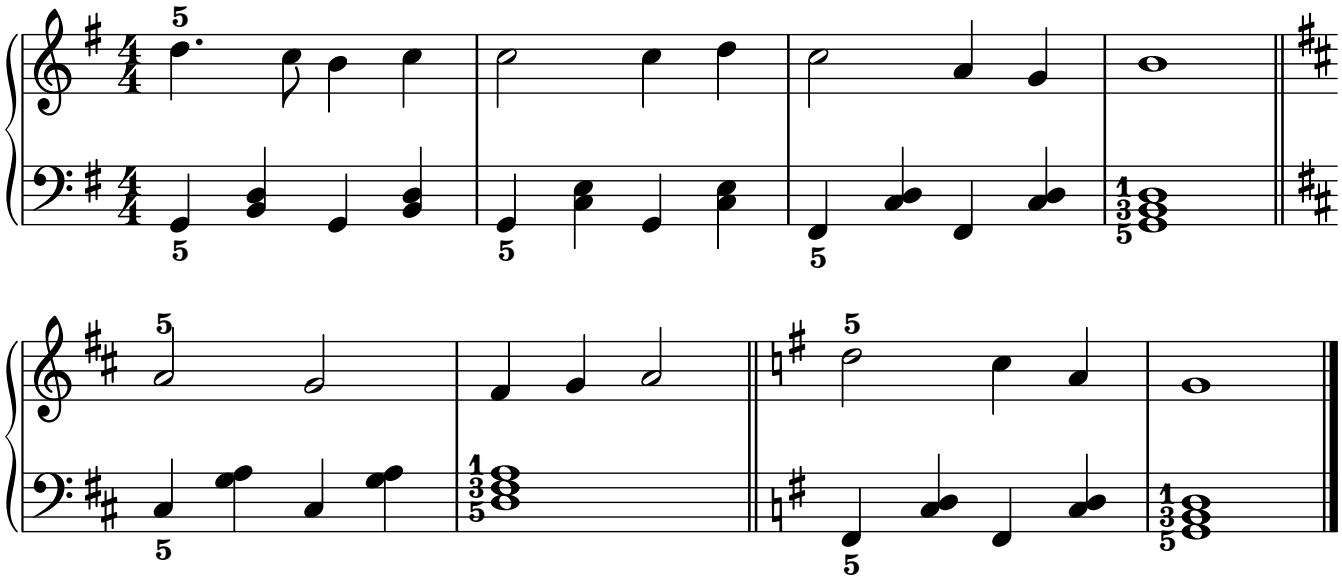


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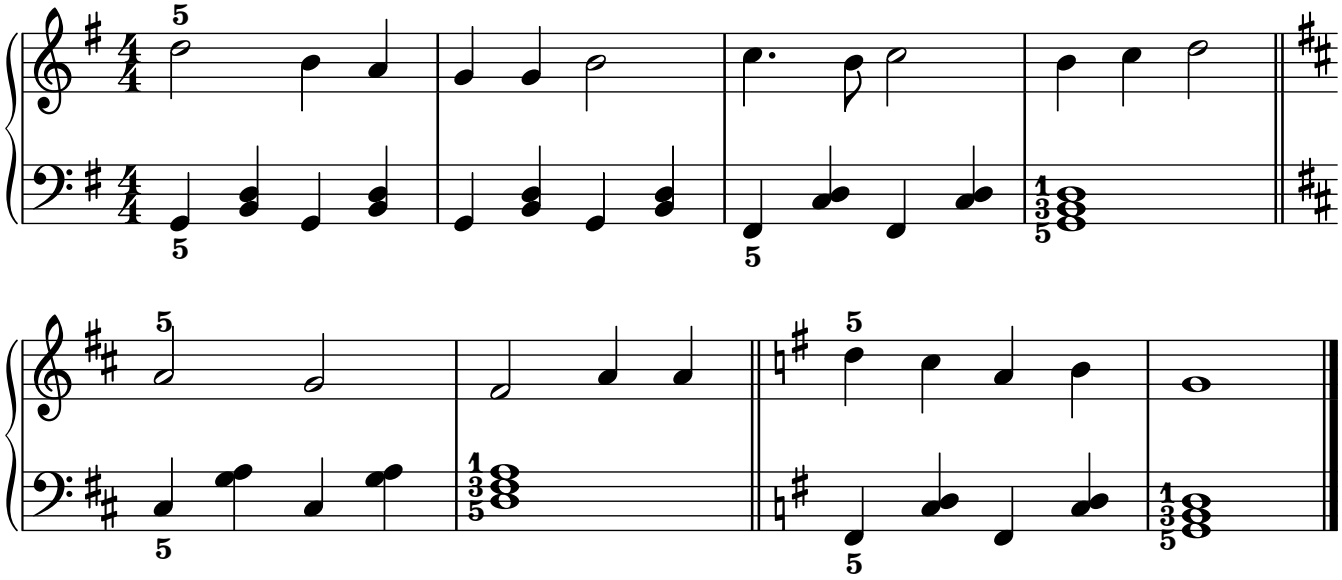


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8.23



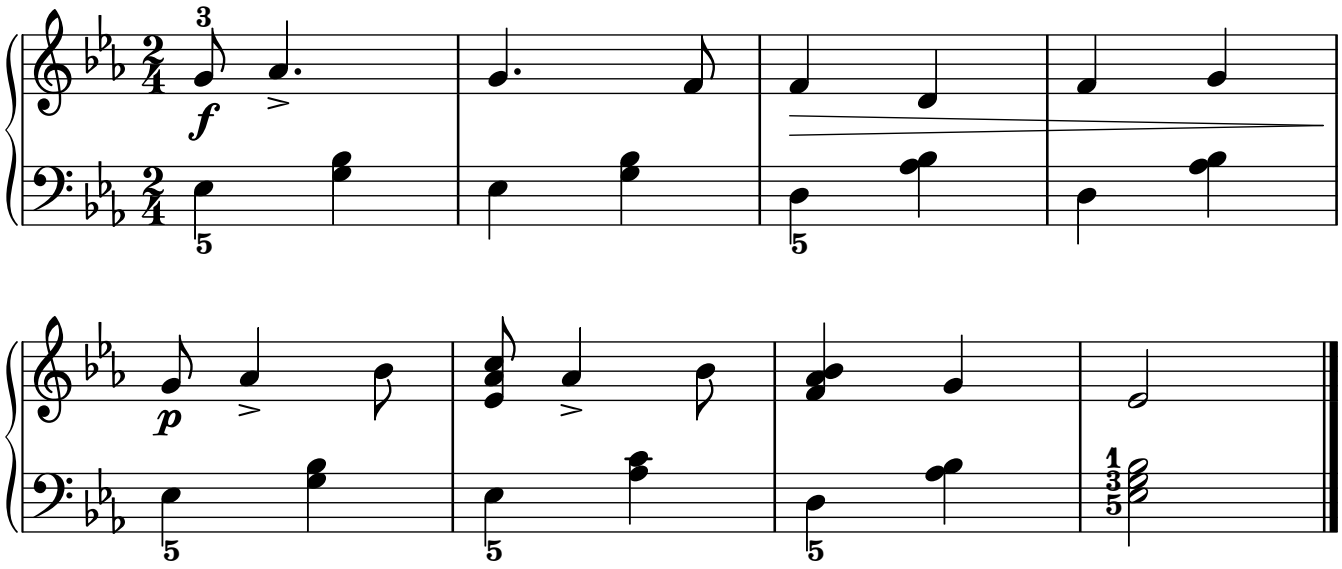
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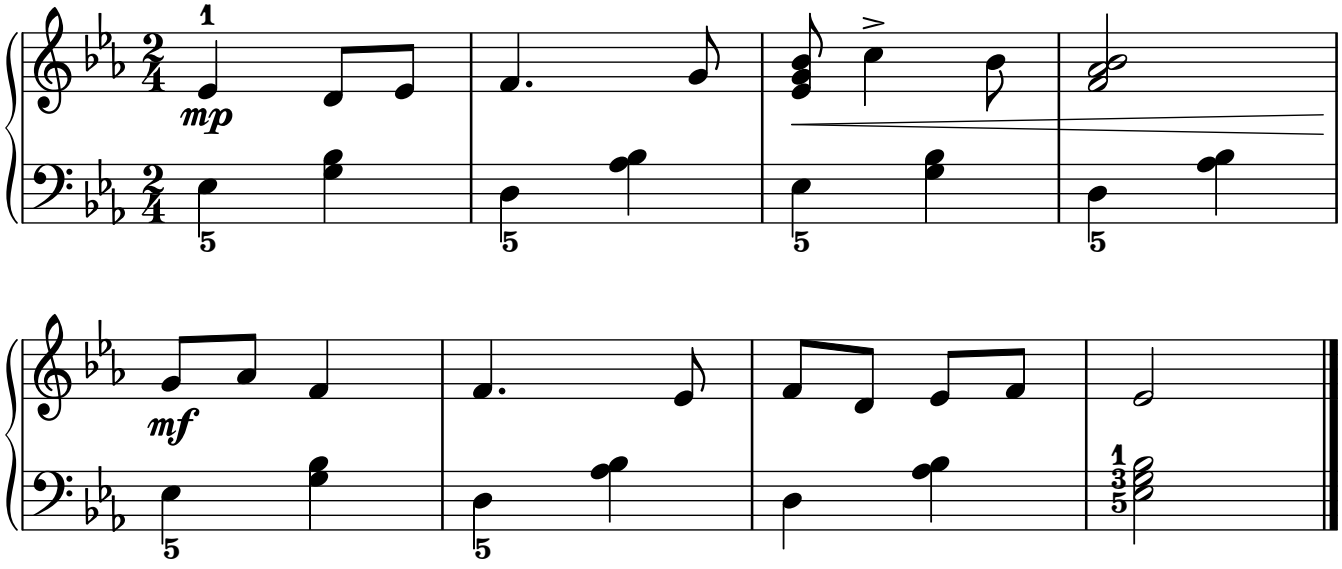


Part D: Review: E-flat major march ♩ = 80

Review: an E-flat major march in 2/4 with right-hand chords and syncopation.

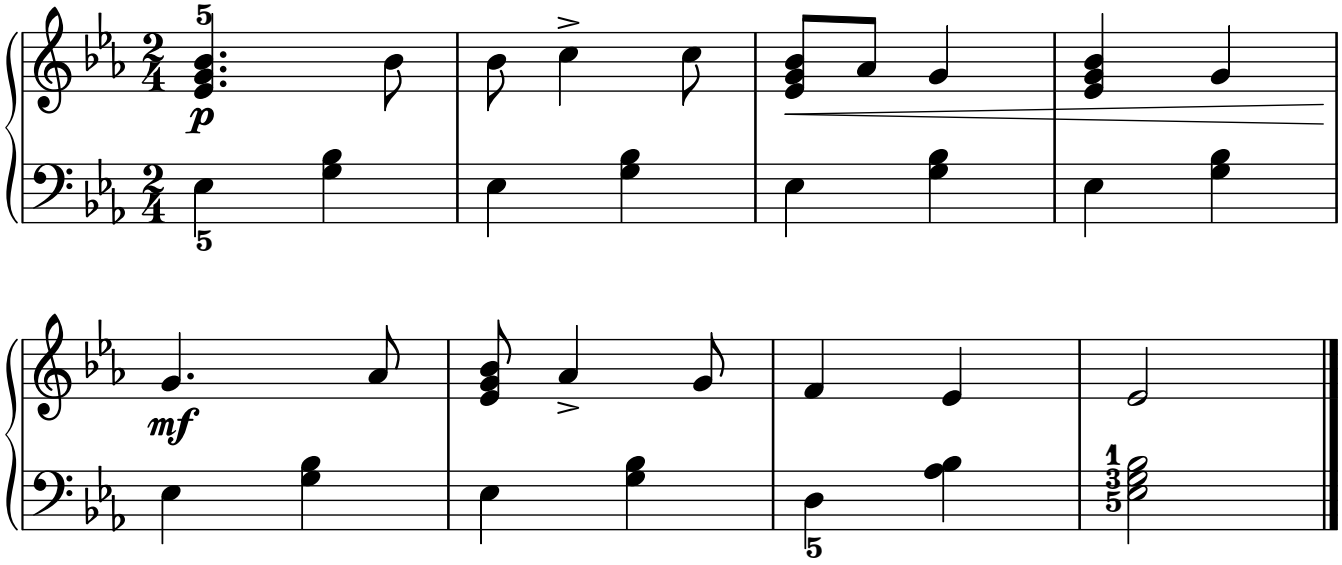
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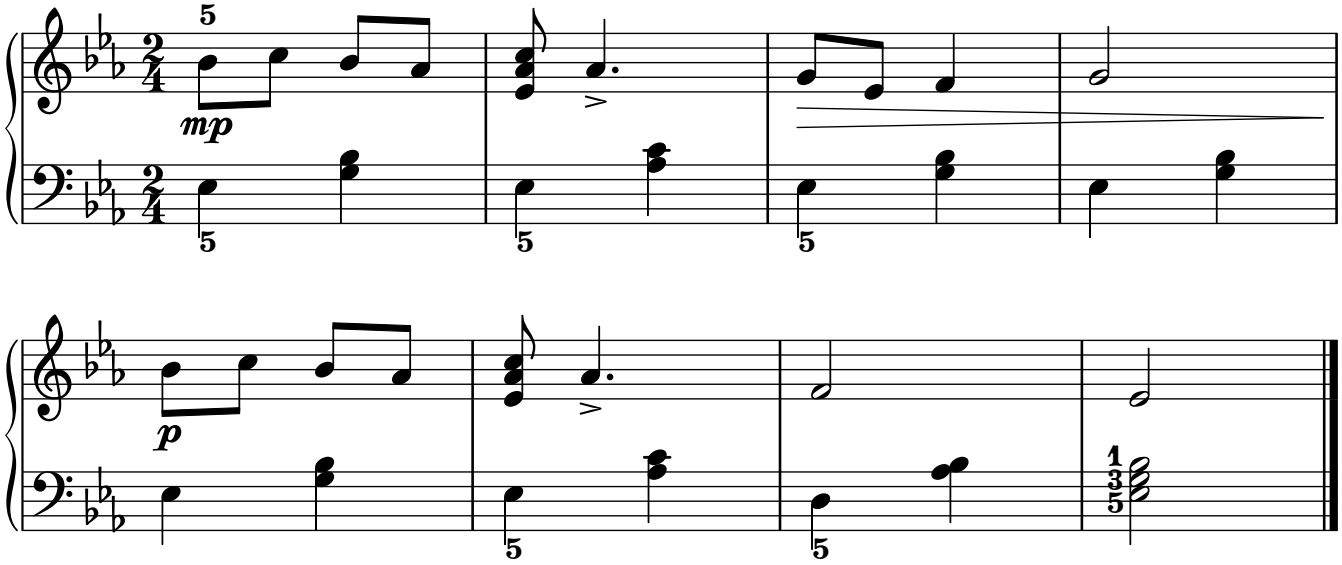


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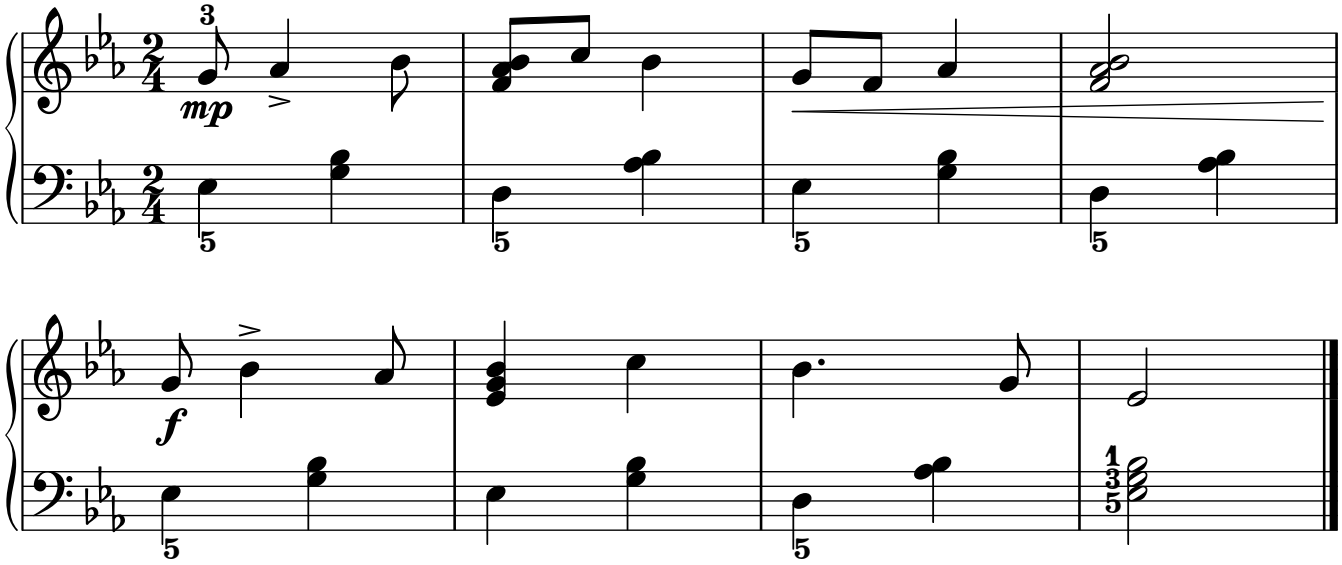


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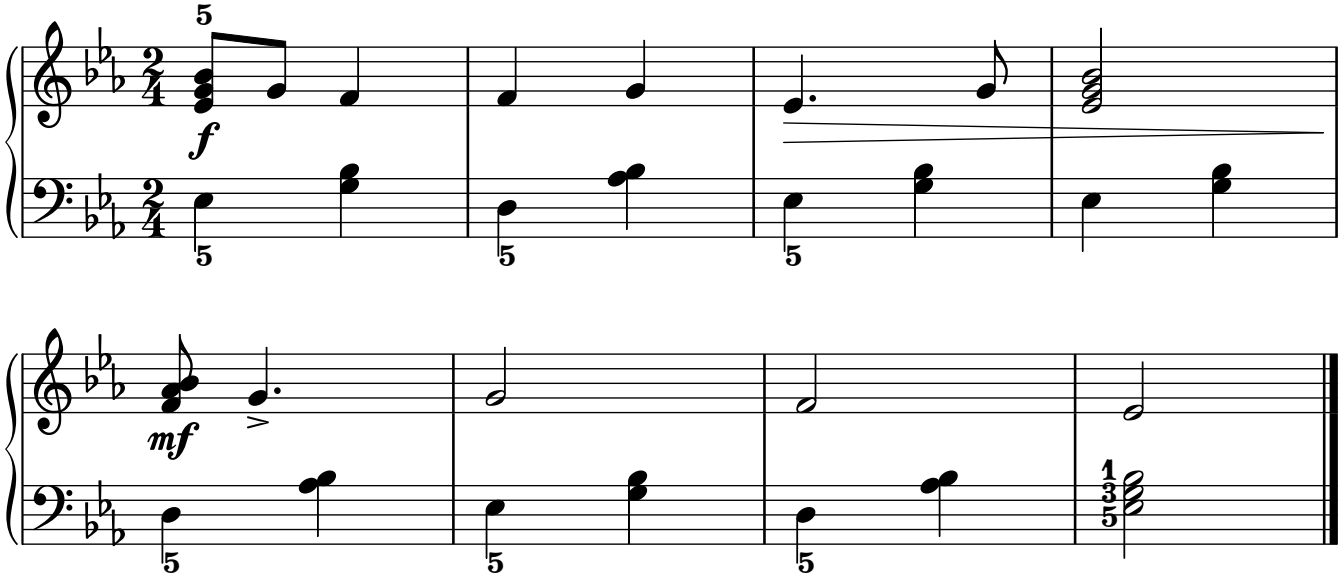
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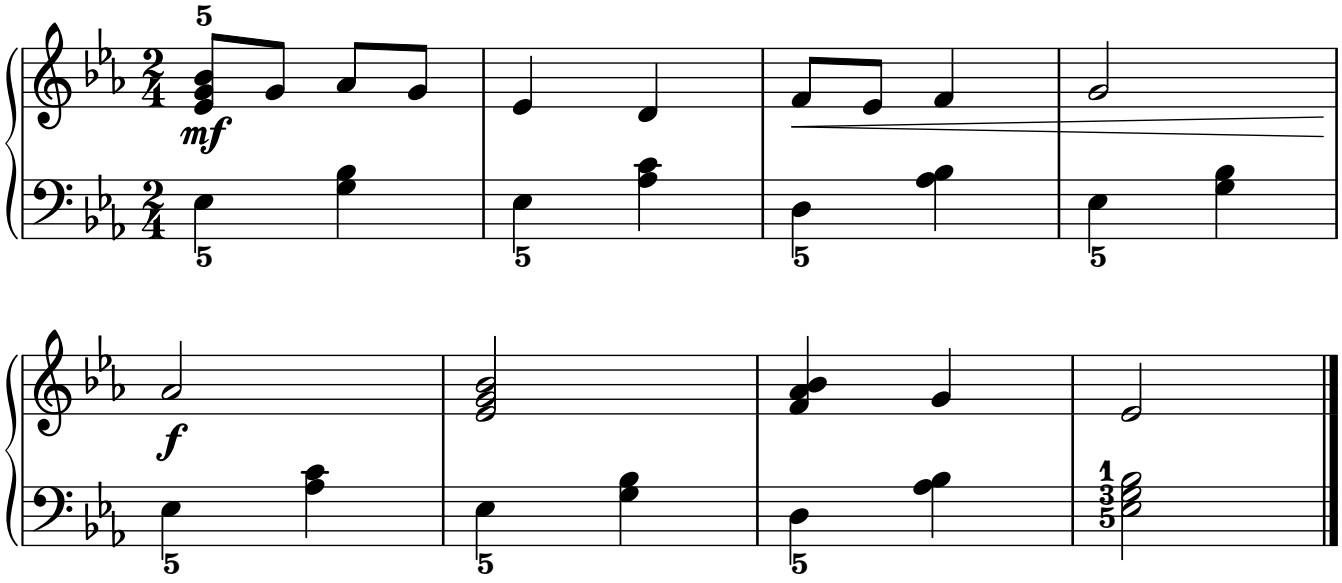


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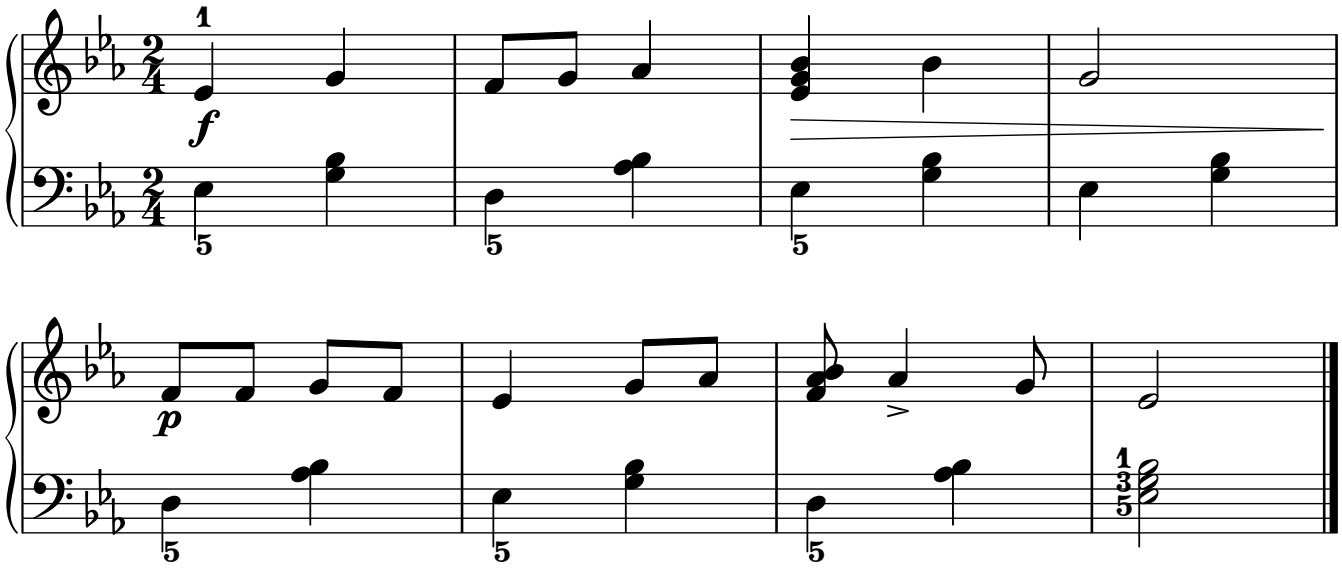


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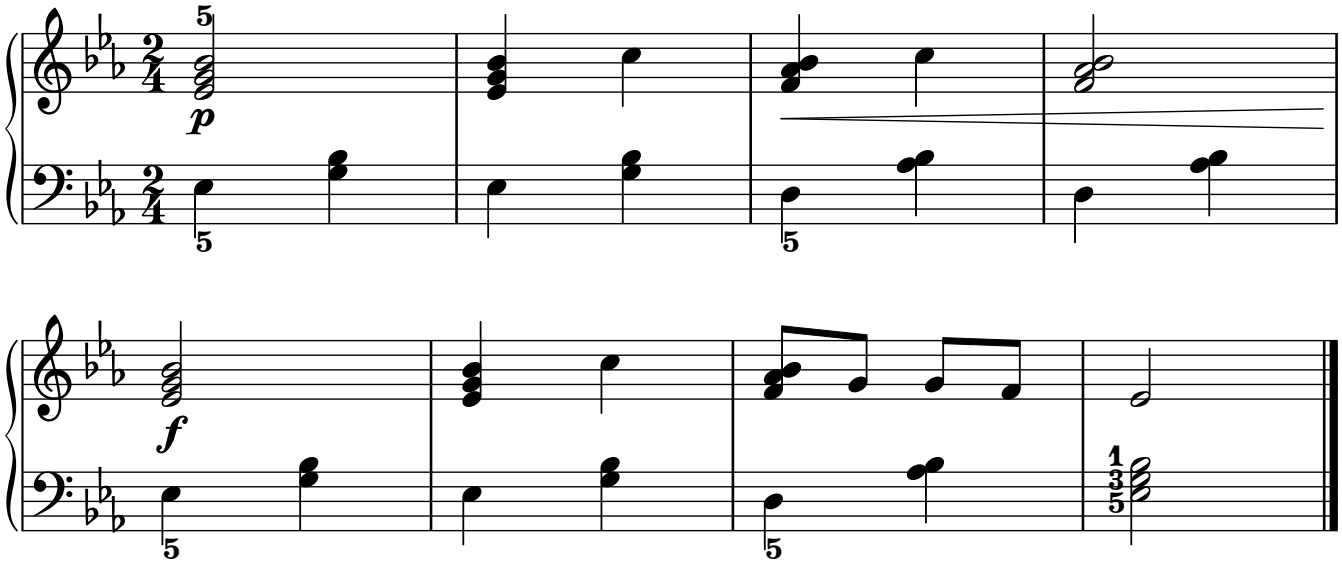
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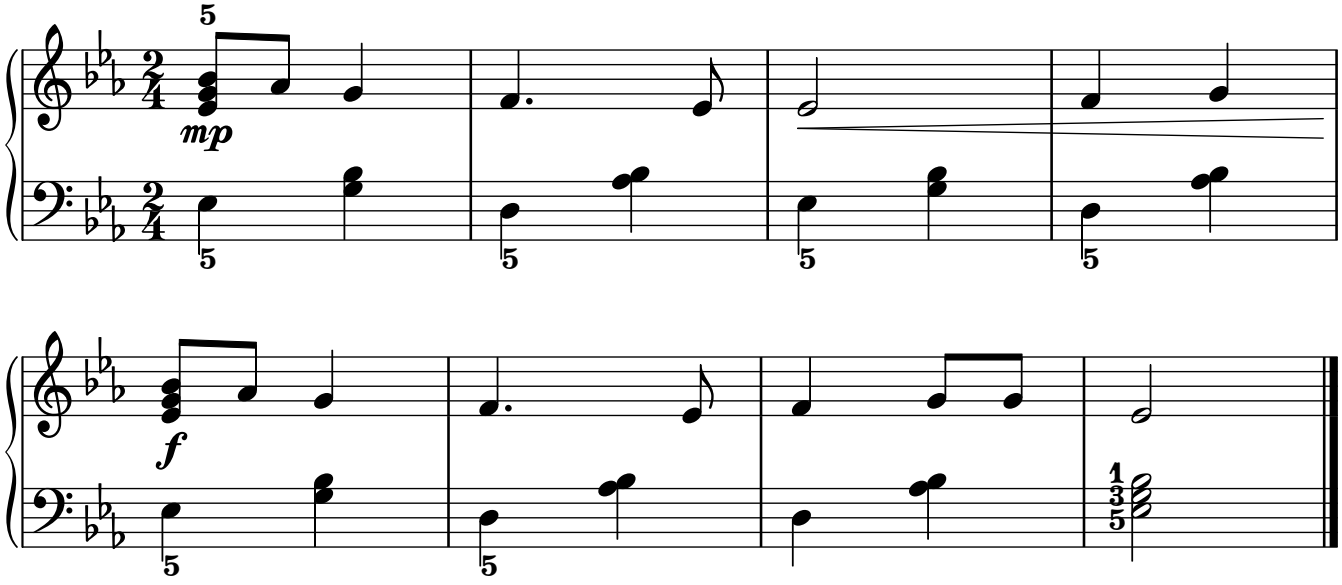
8.32



8.33



8.34



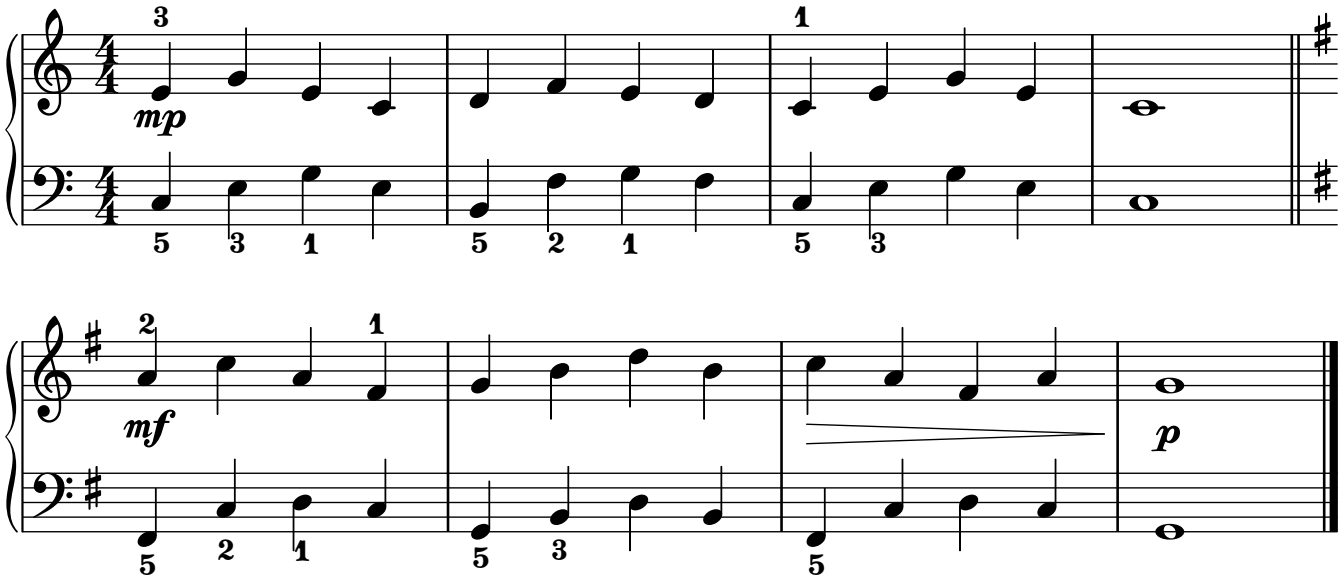
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

A Change of Scene ♩ = 76

Original
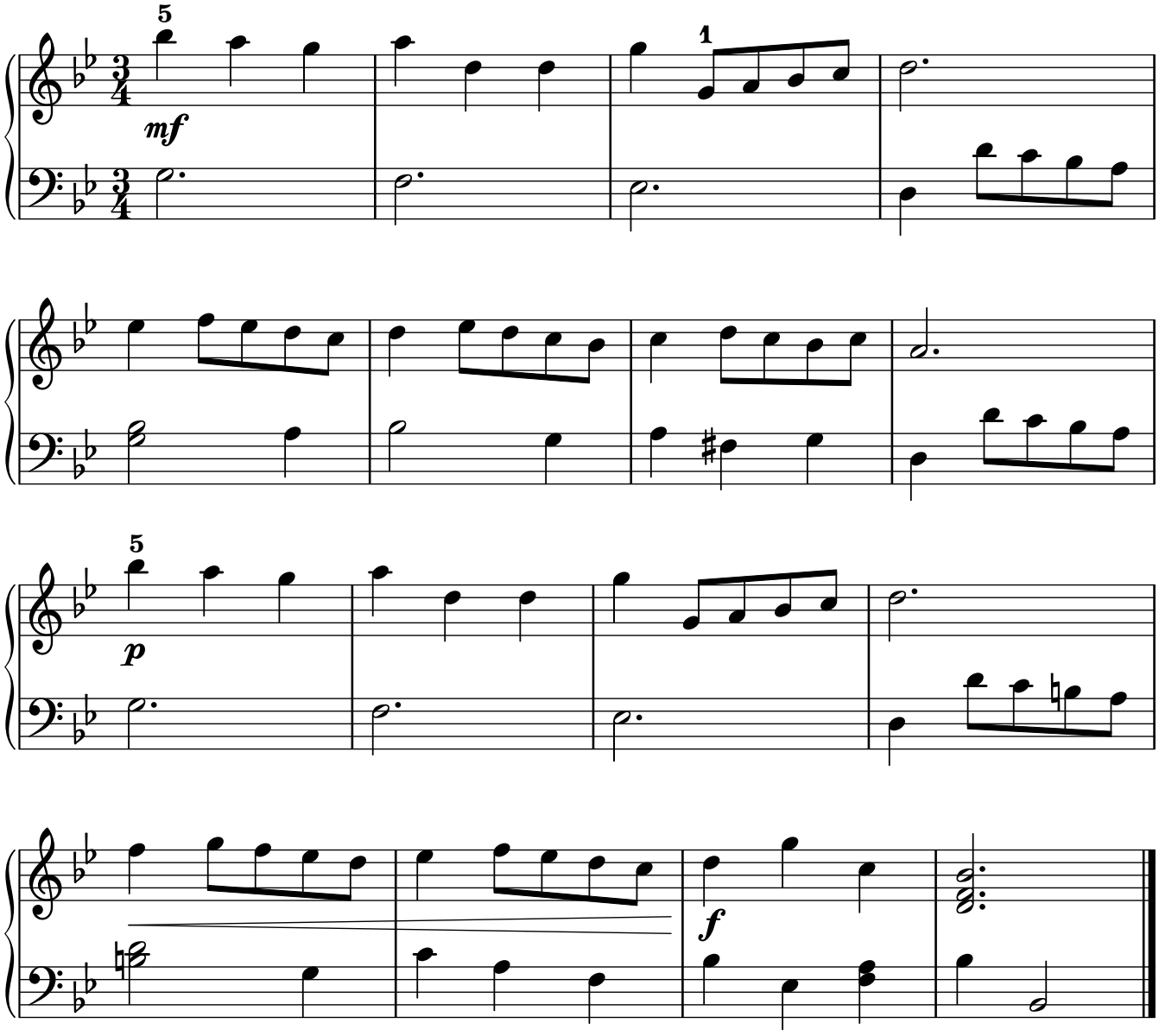
Four bars in C major, then a double bar and the key signature of G major. The left hand's first shape in the new key (F-sharp, C, D) is the V7 of G.



Minuet in G minor ♩ = 100

Christian Petzold (attributed), BWV Anh. 115 - first part
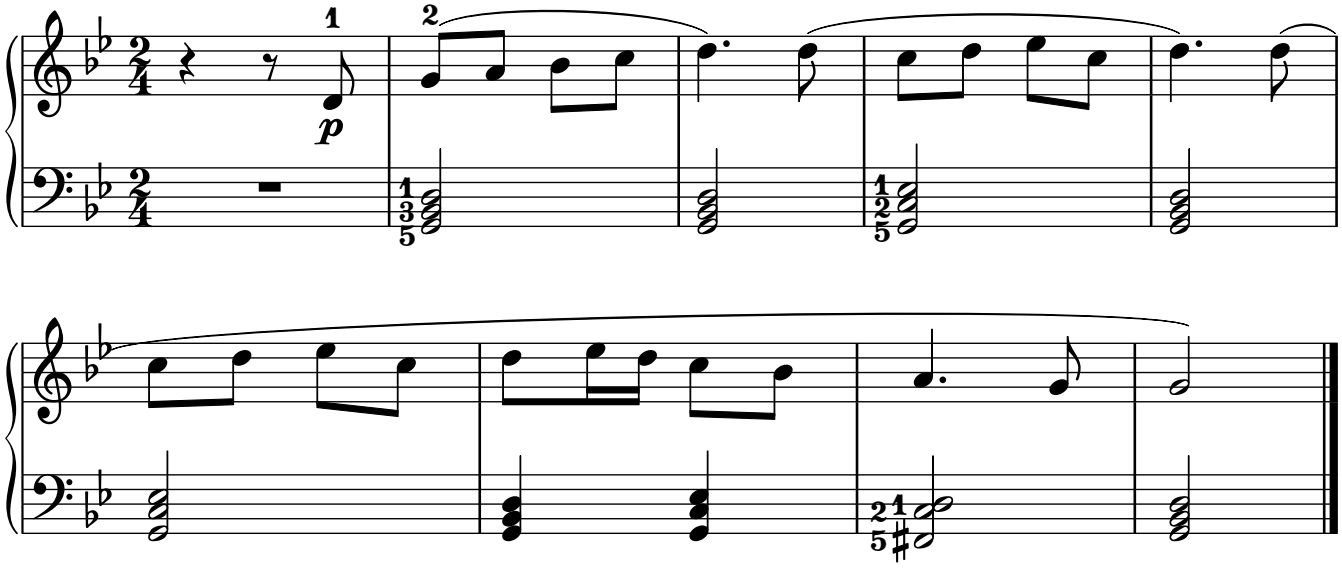
From the Notebook for Anna Magdalena Bach. The first eight bars stay in G minor (F-sharp in bar 7); the next eight travel to B-flat major, the relative major, and end there. The B-naturals in bars 12 and 13 lead into C minor on the way. Ornaments are left out. Source: Mutopia Project no. 76.



Old French Song ♩ = 60

Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky, Op. 39 No. 16 (opening) - simplified

A review of Volume 4: G minor in 2/4, a sixteenth-note turn in bar 7 and block chords in the left hand, with the F-sharp of the V7 chord in bar 8. Tchaikovsky's inner voices are left out and the rhythm of bar 8 is simplified. Source: Mutopia Project no. 2080.



Checkpoint: ready for Volume 5?

- Play two new exercises from each part (A to D) at the speeds shown, naming every key change before you start.
- Pass if you keep the beat with no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, you have finished Volume 4. If one skill keeps tripping you up, go back to its unit for a week.